Deloitte.



WALMART INC

Briefing Book
Saturday, November 07, 2026

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Key information



Walmart Inc.

Bentonville, Arkansas, United States
+4792734000 · corporate.walmart.com
Publicly Traded Company

EMPLOYEES
11700 (Total)
2100000 (Total)

D&B LEGAL STATUS TYPE
Corporation

CORPORATE LINKAGE
9761 Companies

TRADED
NASDAQ:WMT

INDUSTRY
Department Stores

FORTUNE 1000 RANK
2

SALES
713.16B

FISCAL YEAR END
01/31/2026

REPORTING CURRENCY
USD

TOTAL ASSETS
284.67B

MARKET VALUE
1.01T

D-U-N-S NUMBER
051957769

CREDIT RATING
Low Risk

ADDRESS
1 Customer Dr
Bentonville, Arkansas, 72716-5004
United States

Latitude: 36.36243
Longitude: -94.18332

Company summary

Walmart Inc. is a people-led, technology-powered omni-channel retailer helping people save money and live better. The company provides a broad assortment of merchandise and services at everyday low prices (EDLP) through its retail stores and eCommerce platforms. Operating in 19 countries, Walmart serves approximately 270 million customers weekly through more than 10,750 stores. Its operations are divided into three segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International, and Sam's Club U.S. The company is also expanding its ecosystem of services, including advertising, marketplace, fulfillment, and financial services. In fiscal 2025, Walmart generated total revenues of $681.0 billion.

Operations

The company engages in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, ecommerce websites, and mobile applications. The company operates through three segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International, and Sam's Club U.S. It operates supercenters, supermarkets, warehouse clubs, cash and carry stores, and discount stores under Walmart and Walmart Neighborhood Market brands; membership-only warehouse clubs; and ecommerce websites, such as walmart.com.mx, walmart.ca, flipkart.com, PhonePe and other sites. It offers grocery items, including dry grocery, snacks, dairy, meat, produce, deli and bakery, frozen foods, alcoholic and nonalcoholic beverages, as well as consumables, such as health and beauty aids, pet supplies, household chemicals, paper goods, and baby products; and fuel and other categories. In addition, it is involved in the provision of health and wellness products covering pharmacy, optical and hearing services, over-the-counter drugs, and protein and nutrition products; and home, hardlines, and seasonal items, including home improvement, outdoor living, gardening, furniture, apparel, jewelry, tools and power equipment, housewares, toys, and mattresses.

Short company profile

Walmart Inc. is a people-led, technology-powered omni-channel retailer helping people save money and live better. The company provides a broad assortment of merchandise and services at everyday low prices (EDLP) through its retail stores and eCommerce platforms. Operating in 19 countries, Walmart serves approximately 270 million customers weekly through more than 10,750 stores. Its operations are divided into three segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International, and Sam's Club U.S. The company is also expanding its ecosystem of services, including advertising, marketplace, fulfillment, and financial services. In fiscal 2025, Walmart generated total revenues of $681.0 billion.

Company operations summary

Walmart's operations comprise three reportable segments. Walmart U.S. is the largest segment, with 4,605 stores, and accounted for 69% of consolidated net sales in fiscal 2025 ($462.4 billion). It operates under the "Walmart" and "Walmart Neighborhood Market" brands. Walmart International is the second-largest segment, with 5,566 stores in 18 countries, representing 18% of fiscal 2025 net sales ($121.9 billion). Key international markets include Mexico, Canada, China, and India (Flipkart and PhonePe). Sam's Club U.S. is a membership-only warehouse club with 600 locations, contributing 13% of fiscal 2025 net sales ($90.2 billion). The company's global supply chain is supported by 164 distribution facilities for Walmart U.S., 184 for Walmart International, and 31 for Sam's Club U.S.

Geographic reach

Walmart is a global retailer with operations in 19 countries. Its business is segmented into Walmart U.S., Sam's Club U.S., and Walmart International. The U.S. operations (Walmart U.S. and Sam's Club U.S.) are the largest, generating approximately 82% of the company's consolidated net sales in fiscal 2025. The Walmart International segment, which accounted for about 18% of net sales, operates in Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India, and Mexico.

Sales and marketing summary

Walmart's core marketing strategy is built on its pricing philosophy of Everyday Low Prices (EDLP), which assures customers of consistently low prices without frequent promotional activity. This is supported by its commitment to Everyday Low Cost (EDLC), controlling expenses to pass savings to customers. The company markets a significant portion of brand name merchandise alongside its own private brands, such as "Great Value," "Mainstays," and "Equate." It reaches customers through its vast network of physical stores and a growing number of eCommerce websites and mobile apps, which are integrated to provide a seamless omni-channel experience, including pickup and delivery services.

Financial performance summary

Walmart has demonstrated consistent growth in recent years. Total revenues increased from $611.3 billion in fiscal 2023 to $681.0 billion in fiscal 2025. Over the same period, consolidated net income grew from $11.3 billion to $20.2 billion. In fiscal 2025, total revenues rose 5.1% to $681.0 billion, up from $648.1 billion in fiscal 2024. The increase was driven by a 5.0% rise in net sales, fueled by strong comparable sales across all segments, particularly in grocery, health and wellness, and eCommerce. This growth was partially offset by a negative currency exchange rate impact of $3.2 billion. Consolidated net income for fiscal 2025 was $20.2 billion, a significant increase from $16.3 billion in the prior year. The improvement was supported by a 40-basis-point increase in the gross profit rate, attributed to effective price management and growth in higher-margin businesses. Operating expenses as a percentage of sales saw a slight increase due to higher variable pay and marketing costs. The effective tax rate for the year was 23.4%. As of January 31, 2025, the company held $9.0 billion in cash and cash equivalents. Net cash provided by operating activities for fiscal 2025 was $36.4 billion. Investing activities used $21.4 billion, primarily for capital expenditures of $23.8 billion and the acquisition of VIZIO. Financing activities used $14.8 billion, which included $6.7 billion in dividend payments and $4.5 billion in share repurchases.

Strategy summary

Walmart's strategy is to make every day easier for busy families by being a people-led, technology-powered omni-channel retailer. Key pillars of this strategy include price leadership through its Everyday Low Price (EDLP) philosophy, enhancing customer convenience, and operating with discipline. The company is heavily investing in technology, supply chain automation, and its digital ecosystem to seamlessly integrate its physical stores and eCommerce offerings. A major focus is on diversifying its earnings streams by growing higher-margin businesses such as digital advertising, marketplace and fulfillment services, and financial services. The company's financial priorities are centered on growth in sales, improving operating income margin, and increasing its return on investment through disciplined capital spending.

Company historical background

Founded by Sam M. Walton in 1945 with a single franchise store, Walmart Inc. has grown into one of the world's largest retailers. The company opened its first discount store in 1962 and completed its initial public offering in 1970. Key expansions include the launch of Sam's Club in 1983, the first supercenter in 1988, and the first international venture in Mexico in 1991. Walmart began its eCommerce initiatives in 1996. Headquartered in Bentonville, Arkansas, the company employed approximately 2.1 million associates globally as of January 31, 2025. Its common stock trades on the New York Stock Exchange under the symbol "WMT."

Industry

NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM 2022
455219 - All Other General Merchandise Retailers

US STANDARD INDUSTRY CODE 1987 - 4 DIGIT
5331 - Variety store

D&B STANDARD MAJOR INDUSTRY CODE
G - Retail Sale

D&B HOOVERS INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION
54 - Department Stores

D&B STANDARD INDUSTRY CODE
53310000 - Variety stores

NACE REVISION 2
4719 - Other retail sale in non-specialised stores

Company identifiers

D-U-N-S NUMBER
051957769

FEDERAL TAXPAYER IDENTIFICATION NUMBER (US)
71-0415188

BUSINESS REGISTRATION NUMBER (US)
732109

Corporate highlights

TRADESTYLE
Walmart

YEAR FOUNDED
1945

Contacts

John R Furner
President, Chief Executive Officer

GREGORY B PENNER
Chairman of the Board

JOHN DAVID RAINEY Junior
Executive Vice President, Chief Financial Officer

DONNA MORRIS
Executive Vice President, Chief People Officer

SETH DALLAIRE
Executive Vice President, Officer

SURESH KUMAR
Executive Vice President, Chief Technology Officer, Officer

DWAYNE MILUM
Senior Vice President

Top competitors

The Kroger Co.
D-U-N-S NUMBER - 006999528

Amazon.com, Inc.
D-U-N-S NUMBER - 884745530

Source: Audit Analytics, D&B Hoovers

Corporate structure

Company name	City	State or province	Country/Region	Employees (Total)	Sales ($M)
Walmart Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	2,100,000	713,163.00M
Intersalt, S. de R.L. de C.V.	México	CIUDAD DE MEXICO	Mexico	213,780	72.79M
Wal-Mart de México, S.A.B. de C.V.	México	CIUDAD DE MEXICO	Mexico	231,271	55.14M
Sam's West, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	90,000	942.83M
Sam's East, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	10	27.45M
Sam's West, Inc.	Sanger	Texas	United States	6	2.75M
Wal-Mart Canada Corp	Mississauga	ONTARIO	Canada	90,000	13,689.72M
Walmart Canada Logistics ULC	Mississauga	ONTARIO	Canada	2,800	239.73M
Wal-Mart Associates, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	200	9.31M
Walmart B.C. Holding 2 ULC	Vancouver	BRITISH COLUMBIA	Canada	11	11.03M
Wal-Mart Puerto Rico, Inc	Caguas	Puerto Rico	United States	4,500	72.53M
MASSDISCOUNTERS (PTY) LTD	JOHANNESBURG	GAUTENG	South Africa	3,500	44.73M
Walmart Chile Mayorista Limitada	SANTIAGO	Santiago	Chile	3,115	11.27M
Wal-Mart International Holdings, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	2,600	4.06M
PHONEPE LIMITED	Bengaluru	Karnataka	India	9,159	727.79M
WM DIGITAL COMMERCE HOLDINGS PTE. LTD.	Singapore	-	Singapore	16	12.83M
WMT Brasilia S.à r.l.	Luxembourg	-	Luxembourg	11	0.00
WMGS (THAILAND) LIMITED	PHAYA THAI	BANGKOK	Thailand	10	1.88M
Jet.com, Inc.	Hoboken	New Jersey	United States	1,200	28.41M
Hayneedle, Inc.	Omaha	Nebraska	United States	1,000	23.21M
Wal-Mart Real Estate Business Trust	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	600	58.34M
Vizio Holding Corp.	Irvine	California	United States	527	1,680.00M
VIZIO, INC.	Irvine	California	United States	398	90.48M
Desarrolladora Internacional DCI, S.A.	Mixco	Guatemala	Guatemala	515	24.89M
Wal-Mart Far East Holdings, Inc.	Wilmington	Delaware	United States	495	0.29M
Wal-Mart (China) Investment Co., Ltd.	Shenzhen	Guangdong	China	2,893	360.84M
WAL-MART CHINA COMPANY LIMITED	Tsim Sha Tsui	Kowloon	Hong Kong	74	42.53M
Sam's (Shanghai) Investment Co., Ltd.	Shanghai	Shanghai	China	4	62.86M
MASSMART HOLDINGS LTD	JOHANNESBURG	GAUTENG	South Africa	409	5.21M
MASSMART WHOLESALE (PTY) LTD	SANDTON	GAUTENG	South Africa	248	37.75M
MASSMART INTERNATIONAL HOLDINGS LIMITED	Quatre Bornes	Plaines Wilhems	Mauritius	215	33.37M
MASSMART MANAGEMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY (PTY) LTD	SANDTON	GAUTENG	South Africa	38	7.46M
M PUPKEWITZ AND SONS PTY LTD	HOUGHTON EST	GAUTENG	South Africa	30	4.78M
Wal-Mart.com USA, LLC	San Bruno	California	United States	300	494.47M
Walmart Advanced Systems & Robotics Inc.	Andover	Massachusetts	United States	300	37.48M
Wmla Operations, S. de R.L.	México	CIUDAD DE MEXICO	Mexico	175	14.90M
Hortifruti Honduras SA	Tegucigalpa	Francisco Morazan	Honduras	160	6.08M
MASSMART RETAIL (PTY) LTD	SANDTON	GAUTENG	South Africa	130	35,699.28M

Wal-Mart Transportation, LLC	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	104	21.32M
Wal-Mart Stores East, LP	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	100	333.88M
BLUE KINGFISHER, LLC	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	2	17.35M
Comercial Brassavola SA	Tegucigalpa	-	Honduras	61	35.72M
Walmart Fulfillment Services, Llc	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	53	85.26M
Altitude Collection, LLC	New York	New York	United States	50	4.96M
WALMART CLAIMS SERVICES, INC.	Rogers	Arkansas	United States	37	2.15M
WILD DEVELOPMENTS (PTY) LTD	SANDTON	GAUTENG	South Africa	36	4.59M
ABBEVILLE INVESTMENTS (PTY) LTD	SANDTON	GAUTENG	South Africa	24	1.80M
Archer8, LLC	Redmond	Washington	United States	35	2.59M
Benchmark Resources, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	34	19.14M
Sam's Pw, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	34	0.76M
BUILDERS TRADE DEPOT (BOTSWANA) PTY LTD	GABORONE	-	Botswana	28	7.83M
Project Franklin, LLC	Brooklyn	New York	United States	25	8.95M
Spark Manufacturing Solutions LLC	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	22	26.63M
Red Kingfisher, LLC	Thomasville	Georgia	United States	19	10.13M
C C INVESTMENTS CC	ROODEPOORT	GAUTENG	South Africa	14	3.30M
Bounteous Company Limited	ROAD TOWN	TORTOLA	British Virgin Islands	12	0.00
Sam's Property Company	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	11	7.43M
WAL-MART STORES INC	New Delhi	Delhi	India	11	21.97M
Bodega Aurrera, S.A. de C.V.	Mexico	CIUDAD DE MEXICO	Mexico	10	5.88M
BOTSHEPEHI MOHAPI HOLDINGS (PTY) LTD	KWAXUMA	GAUTENG	South Africa	10	0.88M
Trafalgar, S.A. de C.V.	México	CIUDAD DE MEXICO	Mexico	10	11.00M
Walmart Apollo, LLC	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	10	8.05M
Wal-Mart Far East Holdings Co. Ltd.	ROAD TOWN	TORTOLA	British Virgin Islands	9	0.00
Walmart Data Exchange, LLC	Saint Louis	Missouri	United States	8	1.04M
Walmart And Sam's Club Retail Store LLC	Sheridan	Wyoming	United States	7	0.23M
Beaver Lake Aviation, Inc.	Rogers	Arkansas	United States	6	1.41M
Wal-Mart Stores Texas, LLC	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	6	6.00M
Walmart Claims Services, Inc.	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	6	0.34M
9942866 Canada Inc	Ottawa	ONTARIO	Canada	5	8.48M
Vibe Advertising Inc.	New York	New York	United States	5	4.09M
Wal-Mart Property Company	Bentonville	Arkansas	United States	4	1.66M
WM Latin American Holdings (BVI) III Corp.	ROAD TOWN	TORTOLA	British Virgin Islands	4	0.00
Walmart GSS Latin America, S.R.L.	Heredia	Heredia	Costa Rica	11,563	13.73M
Delivery Drivers, Inc.	Irvine	California	United States	3	1.53M
SAM'S REAL ESTATE BUSINESS TRUST	Phoenix	Arizona	United States	3	2.91M
Stylr Inc.	New York	New York	United States	3	0.48M
Torbit Inc.	San Mateo	California	United States	3	0.32M
WAL-MART REALTY COMPANY	Phoenix	Arizona	United States	3	0.98M
Walmart Automation LLC	Sheridan	Wyoming	United States	3	0.59M

Pasplore, Inc.	Monroe	Washington	United States	2	0.26M
AllsWell LLC	Hudson	New York	United States	1	1.00M
BANCO WAL MART DE MÉXICO ADELANTE BA PILARES TOLUCA	METEPEC	ESTADO DE MEXICO	Mexico	0	0.00
BANCO WAL MART DE MÉXICO ADELANTE S.C. SATELITE	NAUCALPAN DE JUÁREZ	ESTADO DE MEXICO	Mexico	0	0.00

Source: D&B Hoovers

General info

Company type	Public	Ticker symbol	WMT	Fiscal year end	01/31
Client program(s)	PLAT R | GCJR	Filer type	Large Accelerated Filer	Auditor	EY (since 1969)
Attest	No	IPO year	1970	Audit fees	$44,712,000
Company address	1 Customer Dr, Bentonville, AR, 72716	Fortune 1000 rank	2	Proxy filing date	04/23/2026
Website	corporate.walmart.com	Russell 3000 index	1000	Signing partner (Form AP)	David Cabral (EY)
Number of employees	2,100,000	NAICS industry	455211 Warehouse Clubs and Supercenters	Estimated partner rotation year	2029
Revenue (TTM)	$735,840,000,000			LCSP	Matt Birk
Market capital (as of 07/31/2026)	$1,013,298,069,901				

Source: Audit Analytics, D&B Hoovers, Deloitte Master Data Repository

C-suite and board members matrix

C-suite

Name	Role	Start date	Years in role	Age	Gender	Relationship strength	Deloitte or competitor alumni
John Furner	CEO (Chief Executive Officer)	02/01/2026	0.8	52	M		–
John Rainey	CFO (Chief Financial Officer)	06/06/2022	4.4	56	M		EY
Kyle Kinnard	COO (Chief Operating Officer)	07/17/2026	0.3	–	M		–

Source: BoardEx

Extended C-suite

Name	Role	Start date	Years in role	Age	Gender	Relationship strength	Deloitte or competitor alumni
Dawn Ptak	CAE (Chief Audit Executive)	03/01/2026	0.7	–	F		–
Elisebeth Collins	CCO (Chief Compliance Officer)	01/01/2025	1.8	51	F		–
Seth Dallaire	CGO (Chief Growth Officer)	02/01/2026	0.8	57	M		–
Maren Waggoner	CHRO (Chief Human Resource Officer)	10/01/2025	1.1	–	F		–
Mandy McDonald-Brashear	CHRO (Chief Human Resource Officer)	–	–	–	F		–
Donna Morris	CHRO (Chief Human Resource Officer)	02/01/2020	6.8	59	F		–
Jerry Geisler	CISO (Chief Information Security Officer)	01/01/2025	1.8	–	M		–
Erin Cox	CLO (Chief Legal Officer)	04/13/2026	0.6	56	F		–
Jarred Crabtree	CSecO (Chief Security Officer)	03/01/2026	0.7	–	M		–
Suresh Kumar	CSO (Chief Strategy Officer)	07/08/2019	7.3	56	M		–
Kathleen McLaughlin	CSustO (Chief Sustainability Officer)	10/01/2013	13.1	60	F		–
Suresh Kumar	CTO (Chief Technology Officer)	07/08/2019	7.3	56	M		–

Source: BoardEx

Board members

● Deloitte alumni ● Competitor alumni ● Deloitte board ● Competitor board

Name	Role	Start date	Years on board	Committees	Age/Gender	Total boards
Cesar Conde	Independent Director	02/07/2019	7.7	Audit Finance Planning Strategy	52/M	9
Sarah Friar	Independent Director	02/07/2018	8.7	Technology (Chair)	54/F	6
John Furner	President/CEO	02/01/2026	0.8	Executive (Chair)	52/M	3
Carla Harris	Independent Director	06/02/2017	9.4	Compensation (Chair) Finance Governance Management Development (Chair) Nomination Planning Strategy	64/F	8
Thomas Horton	Independent Director	06/05/2025	1.4	Audit Finance Governance Nomination Planning Strategy	65/M	6
Marissa Mayer	Independent Director	06/01/2012	14.4	Compensation Management Development Technology	51/F	5
Shishir Mehrotra	Independent Director	01/08/2026	0.8	Compensation Management Development Technology	48/M	7
Robert Moritz	Independent Director	08/15/2024	2.2	Audit (Chair) Technology	63/M	4
Gregory Penner	Chairman (Non-Executive)	06/05/2015	11.4	Executive	56/M	4
Randall Stephenson Jr	Lead Independent Director	06/05/2025	1.4	Compensation Executive Finance Governance (Chair) Management Development Nomination (Chair) Planning Strategy	66/M	1
Steuart Walton	Director - SD	06/03/2016	10.4	Finance (Chair) Planning (Chair) Strategy (Chair)	45/M	4

Source: BoardEx

Executive movement (last 12 months)

President, CEO C. Douglas McMillon has resigned

11/14/2025

Source: 8-K

Departure of Directors or Certain Officers; Election of Directors; Appointment of Certain Officers; Compensatory Arrangements of Certain Officers. (b) On November 11, 2025, C. Douglas McMillon, president and chief executive officer of Walmart Inc. (the “Company”), notified the Company that he will retire from his position as president and chief executive officer, effective on the close of business on January 31, 2026. On February 1, 2026, Mr. McMillon will continue in his capacity as an executive officer of the Company, he will report to the Chairman of the Board of Directors and he will continue to be employed as an associate of the Company through January 31, 2027. Mr. McMillon will also continue his service as a director on the Board until the June 2026 Annual Shareholders’ Meeting. (c) On November 13, 2025, the Board appointed Mr. John R. Furner, age 51, as president and chief executive officer of the Company, effective February 1, 2026. Mr. Furner was also elected to the Board on November 13, 2025. Since November 2019, Mr. Furner has served as the Company’s executive vice president and chief executive officer for Walmart U.S. and he will continue in that role through January 31, 2026. Prior to becoming the Company’s executive vice president and chief executive officer for Walmart U.S., Mr. Furner served as the executive vice president and president and chief executive officer of Sam’s Club beginning in February 2017. Mr. Furner joined the Company as an hourly associate in 1993 and over the years held leadership roles across merchandising, operations, and sourcing. No compensatory changes occurred to Mr. Furner’s compensation, with any such compensatory changes for his new position occurring in the ordinary course through the Company’s Compensation and Management Development Committee of the Board (the “CMDC”) prior to the effective date of the new position. The Company issued a press release on November 14, 2025 announcing Mr. McMillon’s new role, the appointment of Mr. Furner in his new role and the election of Mr. Furner to the Board. A copy of the press release is furnished as Exhibit 99.1 to this report. The following information indirectly involving Mr. Furner was also reported under Item 404(a) of Regulation S-K for the fiscal year ended January 31, 2025 (“fiscal 2025”) and was disclosed in the Company’s 2025 proxy statement filed on April 24, 2025. Jason Turner, a management associate in Walmart U.S., is the brother-in-law of Mr. Furner, an executive officer of Walmart. For fiscal 2025, Walmart paid Mr. Turner a salary of approximately $111,350, a payment pursuant to the cash incentive plan of approximately $26,600, and other benefits totaling approximately $7,300 (including Walmart’s matching contributions to Mr. Turner’s 401(k) Plan account and health insurance premiums). In fiscal 2025, Mr. Turner also received a grant of 505 restricted stock units with a calculated value of approximately $28,900 on the date of grant. Mr. Turner continues to be an Associate of the company, and, in fiscal 2026, he may receive compensation and other benefits in amounts similar to or greater than those he received during fiscal 2025. The Company entered into a covenant not to compete agreement with Mr. Furner in May 2011. This covenant not to compete agreement is substantially similar to the form of covenant not to compete agreement entered into with executive officers of the Company that is attached as Exhibit 10 (p) to the Company’s Form 10-K filed on March 30, 2011. The covenant not to compete agreement prohibits Mr. Furner, for a period of two years following his termination of employment with the Company for any reason, from participating in a business that competes with the Company and from soliciting the Company’s associates for employment. The covenant not to compete agreement also provides that, if Mr. Furner is terminated from the Company for any reason, other than his violation of the Company’s policies, the Company

President, CEO John R. Furner was appointed

11/14/2025

Source: 8-K

Departure of Directors or Certain Officers; Election of Directors; Appointment of Certain Officers; Compensatory Arrangements of Certain Officers. (b) On November 11, 2025, C. Douglas McMillon, president and chief executive officer of Walmart Inc. (the “Company”), notified the Company that he will retire from his position as president and chief executive officer, effective on the close of business on January 31, 2026. On February 1, 2026, Mr. McMillon will continue in his capacity as an executive officer of the Company, he will report to the Chairman of the Board of Directors and he will continue to be employed as an associate of the Company through January 31, 2027. Mr. McMillon will also continue his service as a director on the Board until the June 2026 Annual Shareholders’ Meeting. (c) On November 13, 2025, the Board appointed Mr. John R. Furner, age 51, as president and chief executive officer of the Company, effective February 1, 2026. Mr. Furner was also elected to the Board on November 13, 2025. Since November 2019, Mr. Furner has served as the Company’s executive vice president and chief executive officer for Walmart U.S. and he will continue in that role through January 31, 2026. Prior to becoming the Company’s executive vice president and chief executive officer for Walmart U.S., Mr. Furner served as the executive vice president and president and chief executive officer of Sam’s Club beginning in February 2017. Mr. Furner joined the Company as an hourly associate in 1993 and over the years held leadership roles across merchandising, operations, and sourcing. No compensatory changes occurred to Mr. Furner’s compensation, with any such compensatory changes for his new position occurring in the ordinary course through the Company’s Compensation and Management Development Committee of the Board (the “CMDC”) prior to the effective date of the new position. The Company issued a press release on November 14, 2025 announcing Mr. McMillon’s new role, the appointment of Mr. Furner in his new role and the election of Mr. Furner to the Board. A copy of the press release is furnished as Exhibit 99.1 to this report. The following information indirectly involving Mr. Furner was also reported under Item 404(a) of Regulation S-K for the fiscal year ended January 31, 2025 (“fiscal 2025”) and was disclosed in the Company’s 2025 proxy statement filed on April 24, 2025. Jason Turner, a management associate in Walmart U.S., is the brother-in-law of Mr. Furner, an executive officer of Walmart. For fiscal 2025, Walmart paid Mr. Turner a salary of approximately $111,350, a payment pursuant to the cash incentive plan of approximately $26,600, and other benefits totaling approximately $7,300 (including Walmart’s matching contributions to Mr. Turner’s 401(k) Plan account and health insurance premiums). In fiscal 2025, Mr. Turner also received a grant of 505 restricted stock units with a calculated value of approximately $28,900 on the date of grant. Mr. Turner continues to be an Associate of the company, and, in fiscal 2026, he may receive compensation and other benefits in amounts similar to or greater than those he received during fiscal 2025. The Company entered into a covenant not to compete agreement with Mr. Furner in May 2011. This covenant not to compete agreement is substantially similar to the form of covenant not to compete agreement entered into with executive officers of the Company that is attached as Exhibit 10 (p) to the Company’s Form 10-K filed on March 30, 2011. The covenant not to compete agreement prohibits Mr. Furner, for a period of two years following his termination of employment with the Company for any reason, from participating in a business that competes with the Company and from soliciting the Company’s associates for employment. The covenant not to compete agreement also provides that, if Mr. Furner is terminated from the Company for any reason, other than his violation of the Company’s policies, the Company

Executive VP Walmart US, CEO Walmart US John R. Furner has resigned

11/14/2025

Source: 8-K

Departure of Directors or Certain Officers; Election of Directors; Appointment of Certain Officers; Compensatory Arrangements of Certain Officers. (b) On November 11, 2025, C. Douglas McMillon, president and chief executive officer of Walmart Inc. (the “Company”), notified the Company that he will retire from his position as president and chief executive officer, effective on the close of business on January 31, 2026. On February 1, 2026, Mr. McMillon will continue in his capacity as an executive officer of the Company, he will report to the Chairman of the Board of Directors and he will continue to be employed as an associate of the Company through January 31, 2027. Mr. McMillon will also continue his service as a director on the Board until the June 2026 Annual Shareholders’ Meeting. (c) On November 13, 2025, the Board appointed Mr. John R. Furner, age 51, as president and chief executive officer of the Company, effective February 1, 2026. Mr. Furner was also elected to the Board on November 13, 2025. Since November 2019, Mr. Furner has served as the Company’s executive vice president and chief executive officer for Walmart U.S. and he will continue in that role through January 31, 2026. Prior to becoming the Company’s executive vice president and chief executive officer for Walmart U.S., Mr. Furner served as the executive vice president and president and chief executive officer of Sam’s Club beginning in February 2017. Mr. Furner joined the Company as an hourly associate in 1993 and over the years held leadership roles across merchandising, operations, and sourcing. No compensatory changes occurred to Mr. Furner’s compensation, with any such compensatory changes for his new position occurring in the ordinary course through the Company’s Compensation and Management Development Committee of the Board (the “CMDC”) prior to the effective date of the new position. The Company issued a press release on November 14, 2025 announcing Mr. McMillon’s new role, the appointment of Mr. Furner in his new role and the election of Mr. Furner to the Board. A copy of the press release is furnished as Exhibit 99.1 to this report. The following information indirectly involving Mr. Furner was also reported under Item 404(a) of Regulation S-K for the fiscal year ended January 31, 2025 (“fiscal 2025”) and was disclosed in the Company’s 2025 proxy statement filed on April 24, 2025. Jason Turner, a management associate in Walmart U.S., is the brother-in-law of Mr. Furner, an executive officer of Walmart. For fiscal 2025, Walmart paid Mr. Turner a salary of approximately $111,350, a payment pursuant to the cash incentive plan of approximately $26,600, and other benefits totaling approximately $7,300 (including Walmart’s matching contributions to Mr. Turner’s 401(k) Plan account and health insurance premiums). In fiscal 2025, Mr. Turner also received a grant of 505 restricted stock units with a calculated value of approximately $28,900 on the date of grant. Mr. Turner continues to be an Associate of the company, and, in fiscal 2026, he may receive compensation and other benefits in amounts similar to or greater than those he received during fiscal 2025. The Company entered into a covenant not to compete agreement with Mr. Furner in May 2011. This covenant not to compete agreement is substantially similar to the form of covenant not to compete agreement entered into with executive officers of the Company that is attached as Exhibit 10 (p) to the Company’s Form 10-K filed on March 30, 2011. The covenant not to compete agreement prohibits Mr. Furner, for a period of two years following his termination of employment with the Company for any reason, from participating in a business that competes with the Company and from soliciting the Company’s associates for employment. The covenant not to compete agreement also provides that, if Mr. Furner is terminated from the Company for any reason, other than his violation of the Company’s policies, the Company

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President, CEO John Robert Furner was appointed

11/12/2025

It has been announced that John Furner will join this role.

President, CEO Carl (Doug) Douglas McMillon has resigned

11/12/2025

C Douglas McMillon will step down as President/CEO and remain as Director.

President, CEO Carl (Doug) Douglas McMillon was dismissed

11/12/2025

It has been announced that Doug McMillon will leave this role.

Chief Communications Officer, Senior VP Allyson Park has resigned

09/01/2026

Allyson Park has stepped down as Chief Communications Officer, Senior VP. Current position: Advisor.

Executive VP, Chief Operating Officer - US Kyle Kinnard was appointed

07/17/2026

Kyle Kinnard has become Executive VP, Chief Operating Officer - US.

Executive VP - Global Governance, Chief Legal Officer, Corporate Secretary Erin Angela Cox was appointed

04/13/2026

Erin Cox has joined as Executive VP - Global Governance, Chief Legal Officer, Corporate Secretary.

Senior VP - Global Security, Chief Security Officer Jarred Crabtree was appointed

03/31/2026

Jarred Crabtree has become Senior VP - Global Security, Chief Security Officer.

Senior VP, Chief Audit Executive Dawn Marie Ptak was appointed

03/17/2026

Dawn Ptak has become Senior VP, Chief Audit Executive.

Executive VP - Global Governance, Chief Legal Officer, Corporate Secretary Erin Angela Cox was appointed

03/12/2026

Erin Angela Nealy Cox will become Executive VP of Global Governance/Chief Legal Officer/Corporate Secretary.

President, CEO John Robert Furner was appointed

02/01/2026

John Furner has become President, CEO.

Executive VP, Chief Growth Officer Seth Dallaire was appointed

01/16/2026

It has been announced that Seth Dallaire will join this role.

Executive VP Sam's Club US, President Sam's Club US, CEO Sam's Club US Christopher Nicholas has resigned

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

Departure of Directors or Certain Officers; Election of Directors; Appointment of Certain Officers; Compensatory Arrangements of Certain Officers. Walmart U.S. On January 16, 2026, David Guggina, age 40, was appointed Executive Vice President, President and Chief Executive Officer, Walmart U.S., effective February 1, 2026 (the "Effective Date"). Mr. Guggina will succeed John Furner in this role, whose promotion to President and Chief Executive Officer of Walmart Inc. (the "Company") as of the Effective Date was announced by the Company on November 14, 2025. Since January 2025, Mr. Guggina has served as Executive Vice President and Chief eCommerce Officer, Walmart U.S. Previously, Mr. Guggina served as Executive Vice President, Supply Chain from November 2022 to January 2025, as Senior Vice President, Innovation and Automation from April 2021 to November 2022, and as Senior Vice President, Product and Engineering from December 2019 to April 2021. Prior to joining the Company in 2019, Mr. Guggina served in a variety of roles at Amazon.com, Inc.

In connection with his new role, the Compensation and Management Development Committee (the "CMDC") of the Company's Board of Directors approved certain changes to Mr. Guggina's compensation. As of the Effective Date, Mr. Guggina's annualized base salary will be $975,000. For the fiscal year ending January 31, 2027 ("fiscal 2027"), Mr. Guggina's target annual cash incentive opportunity under the Company's Management Incentive Plan (the "MIP") will be 180% of his base salary, with a maximum possible payout of 225% of his base salary. For fiscal 2027, Mr. Guggina will be eligible to receive an annual equity award with a value of approximately $8,000,000, consisting of 75% performance-based restricted stock units and 25% restricted stock, and with the same grant date and vesting schedule as approved by the CMDC for all of the Company's executive officers.

Walmart International. On January 15, 2026, the Company announced that Kathryn McLay, the Company's Executive Vice President, President and Chief Executive Officer, Walmart International (the "Position"), will depart the Company. Ms. McLay will remain in her current position effective as of the close of business January 31, 2026 (the "Transition Date"), and will separate from employment with the Company on April 30, 2026 (the "Separation Date"). Beginning on the Transition Date, Ms. McLay will serve in a transitional role until the Separation Date, at which time her employment with the Company will end.

Executive VP, Chief Growth Officer Seth Dallaire was appointed

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

Departure of Directors or Certain Officers; Election of Directors; Appointment of Certain Officers; Compensatory Arrangements of Certain Officers. Walmart U.S. On January 16, 2026, David Guggina, age 40, was appointed Executive Vice President, President and Chief Executive Officer, Walmart U.S., effective February 1, 2026 (the "Effective Date"). Mr. Guggina will succeed John Furner in this role, whose promotion to President and Chief Executive Officer of Walmart Inc. (the "Company") as of the Effective Date was announced by the Company on November 14, 2025. Since January 2025, Mr. Guggina has served as Executive Vice President and Chief eCommerce Officer, Walmart U.S. Previously, Mr. Guggina served as Executive Vice President, Supply Chain from November 2022 to January 2025, as Senior Vice President, Innovation and Automation from April 2021 to November 2022, and as Senior Vice President, Product and Engineering from December 2019 to April 2021. Prior to joining the Company in 2019, Mr. Guggina served in a variety of roles at Amazon.com, Inc.

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Executive VP Walmart International, President Walmart International, CEO Walmart International Kathryn McLay has resigned

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

Departure of Directors or Certain Officers; Election of Directors; Appointment of Certain Officers; Compensatory Arrangements of Certain Officers. Walmart U.S. On January 16, 2026, David Guggina, age 40, was appointed Executive Vice President, President and Chief Executive Officer, Walmart U.S., effective February 1, 2026 (the "Effective Date"). Mr. Guggina will succeed John Furner in this role, whose promotion to President and Chief Executive Officer of Walmart Inc. (the "Company") as of the Effective Date was announced by the Company on November 14, 2025. Since January 2025, Mr. Guggina has served as Executive Vice President and Chief eCommerce Officer, Walmart U.S. Previously, Mr. Guggina served as Executive Vice President, Supply Chain from November 2022 to January 2025, as Senior Vice President, Innovation and Automation from April 2021 to November 2022, and as Senior Vice President, Product and Engineering from December 2019 to April 2021. Prior to joining the Company in 2019, Mr. Guggina served in a variety of roles at Amazon.com, Inc.

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Executive VP Sam's Club US, President Sam's Club US, CEO Sam's Club US Latriece Watkins was appointed

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

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President Walmart US, CEO Walmart US David Guggina was appointed

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

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Executive VP Walmart US, Chief Growth Officer Walmart US Seth Dallaire has resigned

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

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Executive VP Walmart International, President Walmart International, CEO Walmart International Christopher Nicholas was appointed

01/16/2026

Source: 8-K

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Source: BoardEx

Deloitte relationships

Top 10 Deloitte relationships

MM
Marco Monge Oviedo
mmongeoviedo@deloitte.com
L65 - Associate Vice President, Engineering Management
Consulting Services
Dallas
< 1m

RP
Robyn Peters
robynpeters@deloitte.com
LPP - Principal
Consulting Services
Dallas
< 1m

AF
Amber Franzen
afranzen@deloitte.com
L65 - PROJECT - Senior Manager, Program and Solution Management
Consulting Services
Tulsa
< 1m

KM
Kiran Mohan
kimohan@deloitte.com
LL - Delivery Senior Vice President
Consulting Services
Dallas
< 2m

MP
Maia Pang
mapang@deloitte.com
L55 - Manager, Business Process Controls Advisory, Audit and Assurance
Audit & Assurance
Tampa
< 1m

CB
Cate Brinker
cabrinker@deloitte.com
L65 - Senior Manager, Strategy, Growth, and Transformation
Consulting Services
Boston
< 1m

AQ
Adriana Quintana Diaz
aquintanadiaz@deloitte.com
L55 - Manager, Strategy, Growth, and Transformation
Consulting Services
New York
< 1m

JM
Jason Mcclain
jmcclain@deloitte.com
LMD - Managing Director
Consulting Services
Chicago
< 1m

CR
Chris Ray
cray@deloitte.com
L70 - Sales Vice President, Strategic Relationship Management
Clients, Strategy & Growth
Atlanta
< 1m

MF
Margaret Fletcher
margfletcher@deloitte.com
L65 - Senior Manager, Strategy, Growth, and Transformation
Consulting Services
New York
< 1m

Top 5 PPMD relationships

Less than 5 relationships found

No Deloitte relationships identified

See all relationships in IQ.

Source: Introhive

Cross-board relationships

Board member	Role	Start date	Years on board	Committees	Cross-board relationships			
					Other current board positions	Committees	Current auditor	Auditor tenure
Carla Ann Harris	Independent Director	06/02/2017	9.3	Compensation and Management Development (chair), Nominating and Governance, Strategic Planning and Finance	CUMMINS INC	Finance (chair), Compensation and Talent Management, Governance and Nominating	PWC	Since 2002
					METLIFE INC	Investments (chair), Corporate Responsibility and Governance, Executive	Deloitte	Since 1999
					MORGAN STANLEY (Non-board role)	–	Deloitte	Since 1997
					METROPOLITAN LIFE INSURANCE COMPANY (METLIFE INC)	–	Deloitte	Since 1968
					SESAME WORKSHOP INC (CHILDREN'S TELEVISION WORKSHOP PRIOR TO 2000)	–	Grant Thornton	–
Cesar R Conde Jr	Independent Director	02/07/2019	7.7	Audit, Strategic Planning and Finance	RALPH LAUREN CORP	–	EY	Since 2008
					COMCAST CORP (Non-board role)	–	Deloitte	Since 1963
					NBCUNIVERSAL MEDIA LLC (COMCAST CORP) (Non-board role)	–	–	–
Gregory (Greg) Boyd Penner	Chairman (Non-Executive)	06/05/2015	11.3	Executive	DENVER BRONCOS TEAM LLC (DENVER BRONCOS FOOTBALL CLUB) (Non-board role)	–	–	–
					MADRONE CAPITAL PARTNERS (Non-board role)	–	–	–
John Robert Furner	President/CEO	02/01/2026	0.7	Executive (chair)	–	–	–	–
Marissa Ann Mayer	Independent Director	06/01/2012	14.3	Compensation and Management Development, E-Commerce and Technology	HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS	Compensation	EY	Since 2002
					STARBUCKS CORP	Nominating and Corporate Governance	Deloitte	Since 1987
					AT&T INC	Audit, Corporate Development and Finance	EY	Since 1983
Randall Lynn Stephenson Jr	Lead Independent Director	06/05/2025	1.3	Nominating and Governance (chair), Compensation and Management Development, Executive, Strategic Planning and Finance	–	–	–	–
Robert (Bob) E Moritz	Independent Director	08/15/2024	2.2	Audit (chair), E-Commerce and Technology	NORTHERN TRUST CORP	Audit, Human Capital and Compensation	KPMG	Since 2002
					S&P GLOBAL INC	Audit, Nominating and Corporate Governance	EY	Since 1969
					NORTHERN TRUST CO	–	–	–
Sarah J Friar	Independent Director	02/07/2018	8.7	E-Commerce and Technology (chair)	ANTHEMIS GROUP SA (Non-board role)	–	–	–
					ILLUMINATE VENTURES (Non-board role)	–	–	–
					OPENAI INC (Non-board role)	–	Deloitte	–
					STATES TITLE HOLDING INC (DOMA HOLDINGS INC PRIOR TO 07/2021) (Non-board role)	–	–	–

Shishir Samir Mehrotra	Independent Director	01/08/2026	0.8	Compensation and Management Development, E-Commerce and Technology	SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY SA	People Experience & Compensation	EY	Since 2015
					ADVOCATE INC (NAVA BENEFITS) (Non-board role)	–	–	–
					SIGNALFIRE MANAGEMENT SERVICES LLC (Non-board role)	–	–	–
					SUPERHUMAN PLATFORM INC (FKA GRAMMARLY INC)	–	Deloitte	–
Steuart Lawrence Walton	Director - SD	06/03/2016	10.3	Strategic Planning and Finance (chair)	56QG LTD (GAME COMPOSITES LTD PRIOR TO 01/2023)	–	–	–
					RAPHA RACING LTD	–	–	–
					RZC INVESTMENTS LLC	–	–	–
Thomas (Tom) W Horton	Independent Director	06/05/2025	4.8	Audit, Nominating and Governance, Strategic Planning and Finance	GENERAL ELECTRIC CO (DBA GE AEROSPACE)	Governance and Public Affairs (chair), Classified Programs	Deloitte	Since 2021
					CHEVRON CORP	Audit	PWC	Since 1935
					BLOCKCHAIN LUXEMBOURG SA (BLOCKCHAIN LUXEMBOURG SARL PRIOR TO 2016)	–	–	–

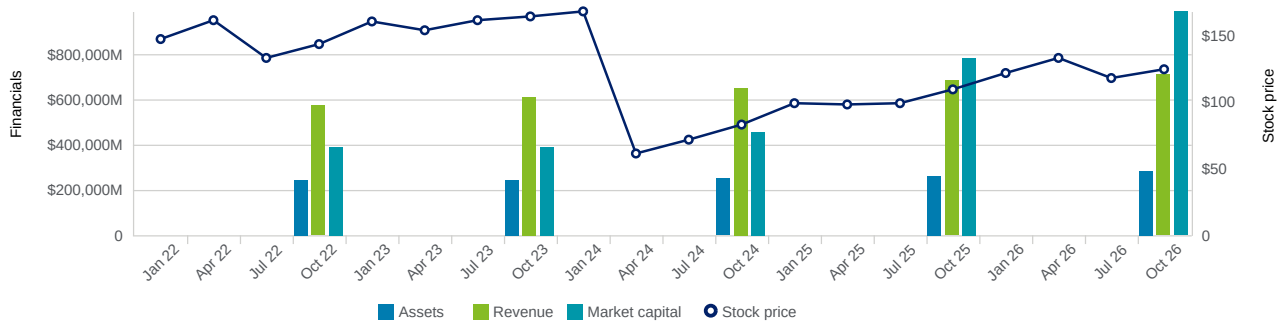
Source: BoardEx

Financials



Financial snapshot

Stock report chart



Market data

Quote symbol:	WMT	Currency:	USD	Stock price date:	10/31/2026
Exchange:	NASDAQ Global Select Market	Stock price:	$124.51	Market value:	$1,013,298.00M

Source: Refinitiv, S&P

Earnings estimate

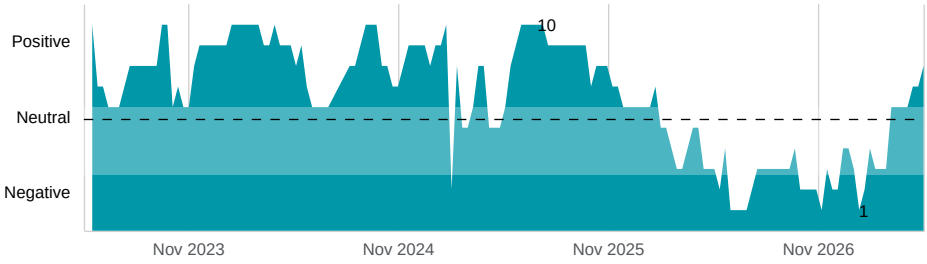
Earnings

8

Positive outlook

Strong earnings with recent analyst upgrades or a history of surpassing consensus estimates.

Earnings score trend



Earnings score average

Food & Drug Retailing group	4.8
Food & Drug Retailing sector	4.8
S&P 500 index	6.7
Mega market capital	7.1

As of 11/01/2026

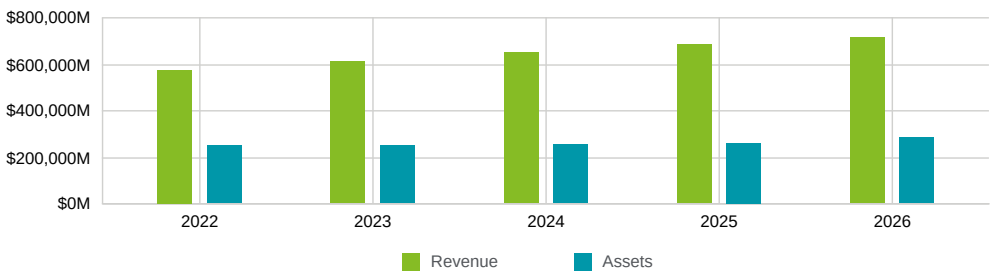
Peer comparison

Peers	-6M	-3M	-1M	-1W	Current	1 year trend
DG	8	6	8	10	10	
TGT	8	10	10	8	8	
WMT	3	3	6	7	8	
COST	8	4	9	7	7	
HD	6	3	3	7	7	

Source: Refinitiv

Financial info

Company financials



Info

Market capital:	$1,013,298.00M
Revenue (TTM):	$735,840.00M
Earnings:	$6,366.00M
Assets:	$293,914.00M
Fiscal year end:	01/31
Financials date (Latest FY):	07/31/2026

Source: Audit Analytics, Refinitiv

Corporate activity



Disclosure report

Disclosure controls over financial reporting - SOX 302 (last 5 years)

Auditor	Effective mgmt controls	Material weakness	Other deficiencies/ controls	Period end date	Filing	Filing date	Reasons
EY	Yes	No	No	01/31/2026	10-K	03/13/2026	–
EY	Yes	No	No	01/31/2025	10-K	03/14/2025	–
EY	Yes	No	Yes	01/31/2024	10-K	03/15/2024	• DC - Information technology, software, access/security issues
EY	Yes	No	Yes	01/31/2023	10-K	03/17/2023	• DC - Information technology, software, access/security issues
EY	Yes	No	No	01/31/2022	10-K	03/18/2022	–

Internal controls over financial reporting - SOX 404 (last 5 years)

Auditor	Fiscal year	Signature date	Auditor agrees with mgmt?	Internal controls effective	Filing	Filing date	Reasons
EY	2026	03/13/2026	Yes	Yes	10-K	03/13/2026	–
EY	2025	03/14/2025	Yes	Yes	10-K	03/14/2025	–
EY	2024	03/15/2024	Yes	Yes	10-K	03/15/2024	–
EY	2023	03/17/2023	Yes	Yes	10-K	03/17/2023	–
EY	2022	03/18/2022	Yes	Yes	10-K	03/18/2022	–

Audit opinions (last 5 years, if available)

Auditor	Fiscal Year	Going concern?	Opinion issues	Additional opinion	Integrated audit?	Critical audit matters (MR)	Filer status	Filing	Filing date	Signature date
EY	2026	No	–	No	Yes	1	Large Accelerated Filer	10-K	03/13/2026	03/13/2026
EY	2025	No	–	No	Yes	1	Large Accelerated Filer	10-K	03/14/2025	03/14/2025
EY	2024	No	–	No	Yes	1	Large Accelerated Filer	10-K	03/15/2024	03/15/2024
EY	2023	No	–	No	Yes	1	Large Accelerated Filer	10-K	03/17/2023	03/17/2023
EY	2022	No	–	No	Yes	1	Large Accelerated Filer	10-K	03/18/2022	03/18/2022

Cyber incident

Companies affected	Relationship to parent	Incident type	Information type	Information accessed	Awareness date	Disclosure date	Start date	End date	Cost to company ($M)	Records lost	Source
Walmart Inc.	Parent	Unauthorized Access	Personal	Address; Name; Other; Phone Number	02/16/2021	03/05/2021	01/20/2021	–	–	–	Office of the Attorney General: Delaware
Bonobos	Subsidiary / Affiliate	Unauthorized Access	Financial	Credit Card; Name; Other; Password; Phone Number	–	01/22/2021	–	–	–	7,000,000	Tomsguide
Art.com	Subsidiary / Affiliate	Unauthorized Access	Financial	Address; Bank Account; Email; Name; Other; Phone Number; SSN	09/12/2019	10/11/2019	07/05/2019	08/26/2019	–	–	Office of the Attorney General: Maryland
Sam's Club	Subsidiary / Affiliate	Not Disclosed	Personal	Email; Password	–	11/07/2016	–	–	–	14,600	ZDNet
Asda Stores Limited	Subsidiary / Affiliate	Not Disclosed	Financial	Credit Card	–	01/20/2016	–	–	–	–	IT Governance UK
Walmart Inc.	Parent	Unauthorized Access	Other	Not Disclosed	11/05/2006	10/13/2009	01/01/2005	12/31/2006	–	–	Wired
Sam's Club	Subsidiary / Affiliate	Not Disclosed	Financial	Credit Card	–	12/02/2005	09/21/2005	10/02/2005	–	–	Computer World

Form AP (last 5 years)

Engagement partner name	Audit firm	Audit report date
Cabral, David Alexander	EY	03/13/2026
Cabral, David Alexander	EY	03/14/2025
Marchini-Ellis, Barbara Ann	EY	03/15/2024
Marchini-Ellis, Barbara Ann	EY	03/17/2023
Marchini-Ellis, Barbara Ann	EY	03/18/2022

Impairments (last 5 years)

Impairment type	Impairment amount ($M)	Filing	Filing date
Other/unspecified/misc. impairment	(400,000,000)	10-K	03/17/2023
Other/unspecified/misc. impairment	(8,300,000,256)	10-K	03/18/2022

Management changes (last 2 years)

Name	Position	Incoming/Outgoing	Filing	Filing date	Reason
Christopher Nicholas	Other	Appointed	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Christopher Nicholas	Other	Resigned	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
David Guggina	Other	Appointed	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
David Guggina	Other	Resigned	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
John Furner	Other	Resigned	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Kathryn McLay	Other	Resigned	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Latriece Watkins	Other	Appointed	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Latriece Watkins	Other	Resigned	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Seth Dallaire	Other	Appointed	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Seth Dallaire	Other	Resigned	8-K	01/16/2026	Position Change within Company
Shishir Mehrotra	Director	Appointed	8-K	01/08/2026	None Given
C Douglas McMillon	CEO - Chief Executive Officer	Resigned	8-K	11/14/2025	Retired
C Douglas McMillon	Director	Retired	8-K	11/14/2025	Position Change within Company
John R Furner	CEO - Chief Executive Officer	Appointed	8-K	11/14/2025	Position Change within Company
John R Furner	Director	Appointed	8-K	11/14/2025	Assuming additional Position(s)
John R Furner	Other	Resigned	8-K	11/14/2025	Position Change within Company
David Chojnowski	Other	Appointed	8-K	10/22/2025	Position Change within Company
David Chojnowski	Other	Resigned	8-K	10/22/2025	Position Change within Company
Dwayne Milum	Other	Resigned	8-K	10/22/2025	Position Change within Company
Dwayne Milum	Principal Accounting Officer	Appointed	8-K	10/22/2025	Position Change within Company

Merges & Acquisitions (last 2 years)

Target	Acquiror	Close date	Transaction value ($M)	Current auditor
Vizio Holding Corp.	Walmart Inc.	12/03/2024	2,300,000,000.00	EY

Proxy fees increases greater than 30% (last 2 years)

Auditor	Proxy year	Audit fee percent increase (2 yr)	Audit + audit related total ($M)	Audit fees ($M)	Audit related fees ($M)	Filing	Filing date
EY	2026	43.44%	46.05	44.71	1.34	DEF 14A	04/23/2026
EY	2025		37.89	36.31	1.59	DEF 14A	04/24/2025
EY	2024		32.10	30.77	1.33	DEF 14A	04/25/2024

Proxy fee increases greater than 20% (last 1 year)

Auditor	Proxy year	Audit fee percent increase (1 yr)	Audit + audit related total ($M)	Audit fees ($M)	Audit related fees ($M)	Filing	Filing date
EY	2026	21.52%	46.05	44.71	1.34	DEF 14A	04/23/2026
EY	2025		37.89	36.31	1.59	DEF 14A	04/24/2025

"MR" = most recent data for selected proxy year

Source: Audit Analytics

Key developments (last 6 months)

Date	Headline	Length
10/30/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart & Base Power Announce Strategic Agreement To Bring Affordable Home Backup Power & Energy Savings To Customers** Oct 30 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART AND BASE POWER ANNOUNCE A STRATEGIC AGREEMENT TO BRING AFFORDABLE HOME BACKUP POWER AND ENERGY SAVINGS TO CUSTOMERS • Further company coverage:	50 words
10/29/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart+ Launches In Mexico With Shopping, Entertainment, Healthcare Benefits** Oct 29 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART - WALMART+ LAUNCHES IN MEXICO WITH SHOPPING, ENTERTAINMENT, CONNECTIVITY, REWARDS, AND HEALTHCARE BENEFITS • WALMART - WALMART+ MEMBERSHIP IN MEXICO PRICED AT MXN $89 MONTHLY OR MXN $890 ANNUALLY • WALMART - WALMART+ MEXICO OFFERS FREE SHIPPING AND DELIVERY WITH NO MINIMUM THROUGH NOVEMBER 30, 2026 • Further company coverage:	70 words
10/27/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart To Open 3 Clinical Trial Centers In Michigan, Nevada, Texas In H1 2027** Oct 27 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART - TO OPEN THREE CLINICAL TRIAL CENTERS IN MICHIGAN, NEVADA, TEXAS IN H1 2027 • Further company coverage: ;))	43 words
10/22/2026	**BRIEF-Affirm Holdings Announces Exclusive Multi-Year Pay-Over-Time Collaboration With Sam's Club** Oct 22 (Reuters) - Affirm Holdings, Inc.: • ANNOUNCES EXCLUSIVE MULTI-YEAR PAY-OVER-TIME COLLABORATION WITH SAM'S CLUB • TO LAUNCH ON SAMSCLUB.COM, PLANS EXPANSION TO CLUB LOCATIONS IN 2027 • Source text: • Further company coverage:	55 words
10/21/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Introduces Agent Profiles And Agent Gateway For AI-Enabled Shopping** Oct 21 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART - INTRODUCES AGENT PROFILES AND AGENT GATEWAY FOR AI-ENABLED SHOPPING • WALMART - TO LAUNCH AGENT PROFILES FOR AI AGENTS IN CUSTOMER ACCOUNTS NEXT MONTH • Further company coverage:	50 words
10/20/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart - Membership Program Change Not Expected To Impact Fiscal Q3 Or Full Year Guidance** Oct 20 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART - MEMBERSHIP PROGRAM CHANGE NOT EXPECTED TO IMPACT FISCAL Q3 OR FULL YEAR GUIDANCE • Source text: • Further company coverage:	45 words
10/19/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Files For Four-Part Canadian Dollar Denominated Notes Offering** Oct 19 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART INC FILES FOR FOUR-PART CANADIAN DOLLAR DENOMINATED NOTES OFFERING; SIZE NOT DISCLOSED- SEC FILING • Source text: • Further company coverage:	43 words
10/13/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Introduces Zero Dollar Prescription Tier For Associates In 2027** Oct 13 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART - INTRODUCES ZERO DOLLAR PRESCRIPTION TIER FOR ASSOCIATES IN 2027 • WALMART - TO ENHANCE U.S. ASSOCIATE BENEFITS PACKAGE STARTING JANUARY 1, 2027 • Further company coverage:	47 words

10/13/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Plans To Cover More Than 250 Prescription Drugs Without Charge For Its Employees- Bloomberg News** Oct 13 (Reuters) - Walmart : • WALMART INC. PLANS TO COVER MORE THAN 250 PRESCRIPTION DRUGS WITHOUT CHARGE FOR ITS EMPLOYEES- BLOOMBERG NEWS • WALMART'S LIST OF COVERED MEDICATIONS INCLUDE GLP1S LIKE NOVO'S OZEMPIC AND LILLY'S MOUNJARO, ALONGSIDE SOME INSULIN AND INHALERS- BLOOMBERG NEWS • Source text: • Further company coverage:	72 words
10/09/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart And SCAN Launch Co-Branded Medicare Advantage Plans** Oct 9 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART INC: WALMART AND SCAN LAUNCH CO-BRANDED MEDICARE ADVANTAGE PLANS • WALMART - WALMART-SCAN MEDICARE PLANS TO COVER TWO MILLION ENROLLEES IN TEXAS AND ARIZONA FROM JAN 2027 • WALMART INC: LAUNCHES TWO CO-BRANDED MA PLANS, SCAN WALMART HEALTH ADVANTAGE & SCAN WALMART MEDICARE COMPLETE CHRONIC SPECIAL NEEDS PLAN • Source text: • Further company coverage:	74 words
10/08/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Opens Next-Generation Fulfillment Center In Stockton, To Create Over 1,000 Jobs** Oct 8 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc.: • WALMART - OPENS NEXT-GENERATION FULFILLMENT CENTER IN STOCKTON, CREATING OVER 1,000 JOBS • Further company coverage:	42 words
09/24/2026	**BRIEF-PhonePe Plans To Hire More Than 20,000 Frontline Sales Personnel On Its Rolls Over Next Year** Sept 24 (Reuters) - PhonePe Ltd: • PHONEPE LTD: PLANS TO HIRE MORE THAN 20,000 FRONTLINE SALES PERSONNEL ON ITS ROLLS OVER THE NEXT YEAR • PHONEPE LTD: TO DEPLOY MORE THAN 50 LAKH PAYMENT DEVICES OVER NEXT 12 MONTHS IN RURAL INDIA • Further company coverage: ;))	68 words
09/22/2026	**BRIEF-Phonepe Secures In-Principle Approval From Central Bank Of UAE For Two Licenses- Statement** Sept 22 (Reuters) - PhonePe Ltd: • PHONEPE SECURES IN-PRINCIPLE APPROVAL FROM CENTRAL BANK OF UAE FOR RETAIL PAYMENT SERVICES AND CARD SCHEMES LICENSE AND STORED VALUE FACILITIES LICENSE- STATEMENT • IN-PRINCIPLE APPROVAL FROM CENTRAL BANK OF UAE WILL ENABLE PHONEPE TO WORK TOWARDS SECURING FINAL APPROVAL TO COMMENCE BUSINESS OPERATIONS- STATEMENT • Further company coverage:	74 words
08/28/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Without Admitting Liability, Settled Us DOJ's Opioid Civil Litigation Matter For An Immaterial Amount, Which Was Accrued As Of July 31** Aug 28 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc: • WALMART: WITHOUT ADMITTING LIABILITY, SETTLED US DOJ'S OPIOID CIVIL LITIGATION MATTER FOR AN IMMATERIAL AMOUNT, WHICH WAS ACCRUED AS OF JULY 31 Source text: Further company coverage:	63 words
07/24/2026	**BRIEF-Flipkart Internet Sold 33.7 Million Shares In Shadowfax Technologies At 204.45 Rupeesper Share Via Bulk Deal On NSE As Per Exchange Data** July 24 (Reuters) - Shadowfax Technologies Ltd: • FLIPKART INTERNET SOLD 33.7 MILLION SHARES IN SHADOWFAX TECHNOLOGIES AT 204.45 RUPEESPER SHARE VIA BULK DEAL ON NSE - EXCHANGE DATA Source text: Further company coverage:	61 words
07/17/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Says Kieran Shanahan Is Leaving Walmart, Shows Memo Seen By Reuters** July 17 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc: • WALMART INC: KIERAN SHANAHAN IS LEAVING WALMART- MEMO SEEN BY REUTERS • WALMART INC: KYLE KINNARD WILL STEP INTO ROLE OF EVP & CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER, WALMART U.S. - MEMO SEEN BY REUTERS • WALMART INC: JUAN GALARRAGA IS PROMOTED TO EVP, REGIONAL GENERAL MANAGER, LATIN AMERICA- MEMO SEEN BY REUTERS Source text: Further company coverage:	76 words

07/14/2026	**BRIEF-Shadowfax Technologies Clarifies On Report Flipkart Likely To Sell Stake On Co** July 14 (Reuters) - Shadowfax Technologies Ltd: • SHADOWFAX TECHNOLOGIES - CLARIFIES ON REPORT FLIPKART LIKELY TO SELL STAKE ON SHADOWFAX TECHNOLOGIES • SHADOWFAX TECHNOLOGIES - NOT AWARE OF ANY NEGOTIATIONS AS REFERRED TO IN NEWS ITEM Source text: Further company coverage:	56 words
06/11/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Opens Walmart.com To International Customers With Shipping Available To Mexico** June 11 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc: • WALMART OPENS WALMART.COM TO INTERNATIONAL CUSTOMERS, UNLOCKING ACCESS TO HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS OF ITEMS WITH SHIPPING AVAILABLE TO MEXICO • WALMART: RUNNING LIMITED TIME PROMOTION FOR ORDERS SHIPPING TO MEXICO, INCLUDING FREE SHIPPING ON ELIGIBLE ORDERS OF $35 OR MORE - WEBSITE • WALMART - PLANS TO EXPAND INTERNATIONAL SHIPPING TO ADDITIONAL MARKETS IN THE FUTURE	77 words
06/08/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Plans To Announce The Departure Of Diana Marshall, Who Is Currently Chief Experience Officer At Sam'S Club - WSJ** June 8 (Reuters) - • WALMART PLANS TO ANNOUNCE THE DEPARTURE OF DIANA MARSHALL, WHO IS CURRENTLY CHIEF EXPERIENCE OFFICER AT SAM'S CLUB - WSJ Source text: [ID: here Further company coverage:	57 words
06/04/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Announces 2026 Annual Shareholders' Meeting Voting Results** June 4 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc: • WALMART ANNOUNCES 2026 ANNUAL SHAREHOLDERS' MEETING VOTING RESULTS • WALMART - FOUR SHAREHOLDER PROPOSALS FAIL TO PASS AT WALMART ANNUAL MEETING Source text: Further company coverage:	44 words
06/03/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Says Steve Schrobilgen Promoted To Chief Operating Officer At Sam'S Club** June 3 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc: • WALMART: STEVE SCHROBILGEN PROMOTED TO EXECUTIVE VICE PRESIDENT CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER AT SAM'S CLUB Further company coverage:	43 words
05/28/2026	**BRIEF-Walmart Brings 30-Minute-Or-Less Delivery To 33 U.S. Markets** May 28 (Reuters) - Walmart Inc: • WALMART: BRINGS 30-MINUTE-OR-LESS DELIVERY TO 33 U.S. MARKETS • WALMART: 30-MINUTE-OR-LESS DELIVERY SERVICE IS AVAILABLE FOR $10 FEE FOR WALMART+ MEMBERS - WEBSITE Further company coverage: ;))	56 words
05/22/2026	**BRIEF-Senior Walmart Executives Depart In Reshuffling Under New CEO - WSJ** May 22 (Reuters) - • SENIOR WALMART EXECUTIVES DEPART IN RESHUFFLING UNDER NEW CEO - WSJ • WALMART'S SAM'S CLUB CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER TOM WARD, A VETERAN OF ALMOST TWO DECADES, AND CEDRIC CLARK, HEAD OF U.S. STORES, ARE DEPARTING - WSJ Source text: Further company coverage:	62 words

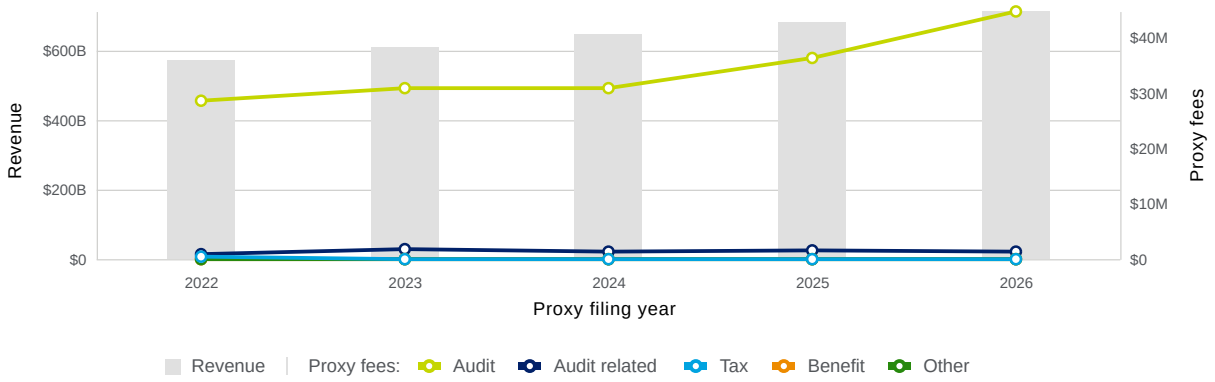
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Source: Factiva

Proxy fees

5 year trends



Revenue | Proxy fees: Audit Audit related Tax Benefit Other

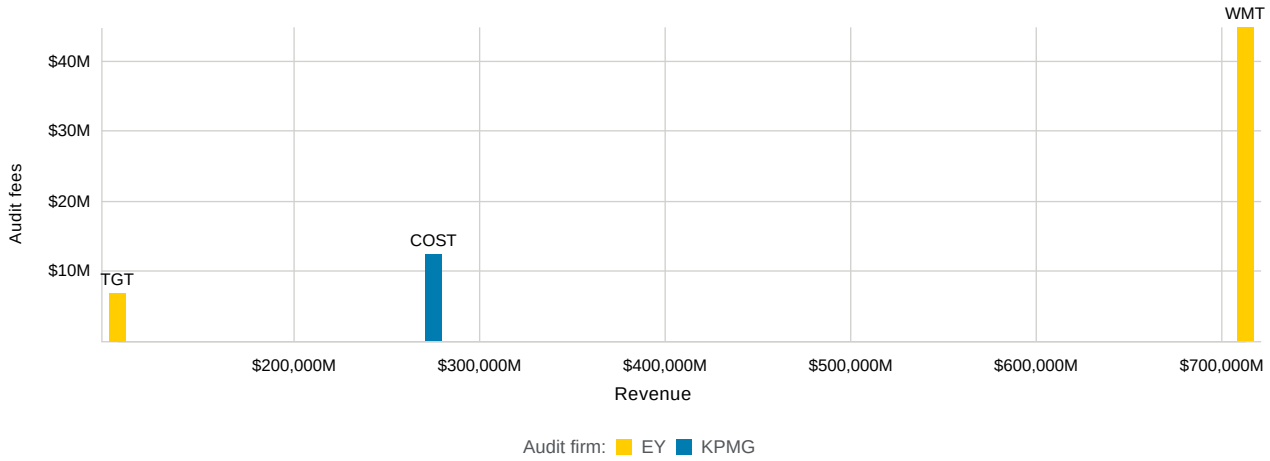
Year	Revenue ($M)	Audit fees ($M)	Audit related fees ($M)	Tax ($M)	Benefits ($M)	Other fees ($M)	Total fees ($M)	Auditor
2026	713,163.00	44.71	1.34	0.00	0.00	0.02	46.07	EY
2025	680,985.00	36.31	1.59	0.00	0.00	0.02	37.92	EY
2024	648,125.00	30.77	1.33	0.01	0.00	0.03	32.13	EY
2023	611,289.00	30.78	1.82	0.06	0.00	0.03	32.69	EY
2022	572,754.00	28.70	0.93	0.35	0.00	0.02	30.00	EY

Source: Audit Analytics

Peer comparison

WALMART INC

Companies below are the closest peers to the subject company based on industry and revenue size



Audit firm: EY KPMG

Company name	Ticker symbol	Proxy year	Audit fees ($M)	Total fees ($M)	Revenue ($M)	Assets ($M)	Market capital ($M)	Auditor
WALMART INC.	WMT	2026	44.71	46.07	713,163.00	284,668.00	988,778.92	EY
COSTCO WHOLESALE CORPORATION	COST	2025	12.29	12.76	275,235.00	77,099.00	416,345.16	KPMG
TARGET CORPORATION	TGT	2026	6.77	8.82	104,780.00	59,490.00	49,595.89	EY

Source: Audit Analytics

Mergers & acquisitions

Showing 5 most recent mergers and acquisitions

Synopsis

US - Walmart Inc acquired an undisclosed minority stake in Base Power Inc, an Austin based manufacturer of storage batteries, in a privately negotiated transaction.

Date announced	10/30/2026
Date effective/closed	10/30/2026
Deal status	Completed
Deal attitude	Friendly
Acquisition technique	Privately Negotiated Purchase
% Sought / % Acquired	0% / 0%
Deal value ($mil)	-

* Note: All values in USD

Company information

	Target ultimate parent	Target
Name	Base Power Inc	WALMART INC
Nationality	United States	United States
Public status	Priv.	Priv.
Ticker	-	-
Primary listing	-	-
Thomson financial macro industry	Energy and Power	Energy and Power
Thomson financial mid industry	Other Energy & Power	Other Energy & Power
NAICS	335911	335911
NAICS description	Storage Battery Manufacturing	Storage Battery Manufacturing

Target business description

Base Power Inc, located in Austin, Texas, is a manufacturer of storage batteries. It provides residential backup battery systems and electricity plans. It offers fixed-rate electricity plans with integrated battery backup systems, ensuring reliable power during outages. The Company was founded in 2023.

	Acquirer	Acquirer ultimate parent
Name	WALMART INC	WALMART INC
Nationality	United States	United States
Public status	Public	Public
Ticker	WMT	WMT
Primary listing	New York	New York
Thomson financial macro industry	Retail	Retail
Thomson financial mid industry	Internet and Catalog Retailing	Internet and Catalog Retailing
NAICS	445110	445110
NAICS description	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores

Acquirer business description

Walmart Inc, located in Bentonville, Arkansas, is a technology-powered omnichannel retailer. It is engaged in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, as well as eCommerce Websites and mobile applications, located throughout the United States (U.S.), Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India and Mexico. It operates in three reportable segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International and Sam's Club U.S. The Walmart U.S. segment includes the Company's mass merchandising concept in the U.S., as well as eCommerce, which includes omni-channel initiatives and certain other business offerings such as advertising services. The Walmart International segment consists of the Company's operations outside of the U.S. through its subsidiaries, as well as eCommerce and omni-channel initiatives. The Sam's Club U.S. segment includes the warehouse membership clubs in the U.S., as well as samsclub.com and omni-channel initiatives. The Company was founded on July 2, 1962.

Advisors

No content available

Deal data

Stake purchase

Held	–
Sought	–
Acquired	–
Final	–

Consideration cash & stock

Cash	–
Stock	–
Other	–
Unknown	–

Financials

	Target	Acquirer
Stock price on date announced	0.00	123.51
Stock price on day after announcement	0.00	127.69
Total assets	0.00	293,914.00
EPS	0.00	2.77

Other details

Cross border	No
Bankruptcy deals	No

Financials

Financials	Target LTM (actual – $mil)	Acquirer LTM (actual – $mil)
Net sales	131.50	735,840.00
EBITDA	0.00	44,873.00
EBIT	0.00	29,780.00
Pre-tax income	0.00	29,316.00
Net income	0.00	22,499.00
EPS	0.00	2.77

Note: All values in USD. Figures for last twelve months (LTM) are typically based on the most recent financial statements available prior to the announcement date.

Source: Refinitiv

Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd and Travclan Technology India Pvt Ltd

Synopsis

INDIA - Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd, a unit of Walmart Inc, planned to acquire an undisclosed minority stake in Travclan Technology India Pvt Ltd, a New Delhi-based provider of travel arrangement and reservation services, in a privately negotiated transaction.

Date announced	10/05/2026
Date effective/closed	-
Deal status	Pending
Deal attitude	Friendly
Acquisition technique	Privately Negotiated Purchase
% Sought / % Acquired	0% / 0%
Deal value ($mil)	-

* Note: All values in USD

Company information

	Target ultimate parent	Target
Name	Travclan Tech India Pvt Ltd	Travclan Technology India Pvt Ltd
Nationality	India	India
Public status	Priv.	Priv.
Ticker	-	-
Primary listing	-	-
Thomson financial macro industry	Consumer Products and Services	Consumer Products and Services
Thomson financial mid industry	Travel Services	Travel Services
NAICS	561599	561599
NAICS description	All Other Travel Arrangement and Reservation Services	All Other Travel Arrangement and Reservation Services

Target business description

Travclan Technology India Pvt Ltd is a provider of travel arrangement and reservation services. The Company was founded in July 2019 and is located in New Delhi, India.

	Acquirer	Acquirer ultimate parent
Name	Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd	WALMART INC
Nationality	India	United States
Public status	Sub.	Public
Ticker	-	WMT
Primary listing	-	New York
Thomson financial macro industry	Retail	Retail
Thomson financial mid industry	Internet and Catalog Retailing	Internet and Catalog Retailing
NAICS	454111	445110
NAICS description	Electronic Shopping	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores

Acquirer business description

Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd is an online retailer. The Company retails products in various categories, such as electronics, footwear, clothing, watches, accessories, bags, belts and wallets, fragrances and perfumes, grooming and wellness products, beauty and personal care products, jewelry, spectacle frames and contact lenses, sunglasses, toys, baby care products, home products and furniture, books and media products, and auto and sports products online. It serves women, men, babies, and kids. The Company was founded in October 2007 and is located in Bengaluru, India.

Acquirer ultimate parent business description

Walmart Inc, located in Bentonville, Arkansas, is a technology-powered omnichannel retailer. It is engaged in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, as well as eCommerce Websites and mobile applications, located throughout the United States (U.S.), Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India and Mexico. It operates in three reportable segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International and Sam's Club U.S. The Walmart U.S. segment includes the Company's mass merchandising concept in the U.S., as well as eCommerce, which includes omni-channel initiatives and certain other business offerings such as advertising services. The Walmart International segment consists of the Company's operations outside of the U.S. through its subsidiaries, as well as eCommerce and omni-channel initiatives. The Sam's Club U.S. segment includes the warehouse membership clubs in the U.S., as well as samsclub.com and omni-channel initiatives. The Company was founded on July 2, 1962.

Advisors

No content available

Deal data

Stake purchase

Held	–
Sought	–
Acquired	–
Final	–

Consideration cash & stock

Cash	–
Stock	–
Other	–
Unknown	–

Financials

	Target	Acquirer
Stock price on date announced	0.00	0.00
Stock price on day after announcement	0.00	0.00
Total assets	5.20	0.00
EPS	-0.05	0.00

Other details

Cross border	Yes
Bankruptcy deals	No

Financials

Financials	Target LTM (actual – $mil)	Acquirer LTM (actual – $mil)
Net sales	5.28	10,329.20
EBITDA	-0.98	0.00
EBIT	-0.99	-607.14
Pre-tax income	-1.00	0.00
Net income	-1.00	0.00
EPS	-0.05	0.00

Note: All values in USD. Figures for last twelve months (LTM) are typically based on the most recent financial statements available prior to the announcement date.

Source: Refinitiv

Synopsis

US - Walmart Inc agreed to acquire Vibe Advertising Inc, a New York-based advertising agency. Terms were not disclosed.

Date announced	06/23/2026
Date effective/closed	-
Deal status	Pending
Deal attitude	Friendly
Acquisition technique	Not Applicable
% Sought / % Acquired	100% / 0%
Deal value ($mil)	-

* Note: All values in USD

Company information

	Target ultimate parent	Target
Name	Vibe Advertising Inc	WALMART INC
Nationality	United States	United States
Public status	Priv.	Priv.
Ticker	-	-
Primary listing	-	-
Thomson financial macro industry	Media and Entertainment	Media and Entertainment
Thomson financial mid industry	Advertising & Marketing	Advertising & Marketing
NAICS	541810	541810
NAICS description	Advertising Agencies	Advertising Agencies

Target business description

Vibe Advertising Inc, located in New York, New York, is a self-serve, connected TV (CTV) advertising platform designed to simplify advertising for small and mid-sized businesses (SMB) and mid-market brands. The Company was founded in 2022.

	Acquirer	Acquirer ultimate parent
Name	WALMART INC	WALMART INC
Nationality	United States	United States
Public status	Public	Public
Ticker	WMT	WMT
Primary listing	New York	New York
Thomson financial macro industry	Retail	Retail
Thomson financial mid industry	Internet and Catalog Retailing	Internet and Catalog Retailing
NAICS	445110	445110
NAICS description	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores

Acquirer business description

Walmart Inc, located in Bentonville, Arkansas, is a technology-powered omnichannel retailer. It is engaged in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, as well as eCommerce Websites and mobile applications, located throughout the United States (U.S.), Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India and Mexico. It operates in three reportable segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International and Sam's Club U.S. The Walmart U.S. segment includes the Company's mass merchandising concept in the U.S., as well as eCommerce, which includes omni-channel initiatives and certain other business offerings such as advertising services. The Walmart International segment consists of the Company's operations outside of the U.S. through its subsidiaries, as well as eCommerce and omni-channel initiatives. The Sam's Club U.S. segment includes the warehouse membership clubs in the U.S., as well as samsclub.com and omni-channel initiatives. The Company was founded on July 2, 1962.

Advisors

Target advisors

Financial advisors	Role
–	–

Total target fees ($)
–

Legal advisors	Role
Latham & Watkins	Counsel to Target

Acquirer advisors

Financial advisors	Role
Barclays	Advisory
Lazard	Advisory

Total Acquirer fees ($)
–

Legal advisors	Role
Freshfields Bruckhaus Deringer	Counsel to Acquiror

Deal data

Stake purchase

Held	–
Sought	100%
Acquired	–
Final	–

Consideration cash & stock

Cash	–
Stock	–
Other	–
Unknown	–

Financials

	Target	Acquirer
Stock price on date announced	0.00	119.42
Stock price on day after announcement	0.00	119.00
Total assets	0.00	289,607.00
EPS	0.00	2.85

Other details

Cross border	No
Bankruptcy deals	No

Financials

Financials	Target LTM (actual – $mil)	Acquirer LTM (actual – $mil)
Net sales	5.00	725,305.00
EBITDA	0.00	45,038.00
EBIT	0.00	30,383.00
Pre-tax income	0.00	30,623.00
Net income	0.00	23,121.00
EPS	0.00	2.85

Note: All values in USD. Figures for last twelve months (LTM) are typically based on the most recent financial statements available prior to the announcement date.

Source: Refinitiv

Synopsis

US - On 19 February 2026, the board of Walmart Inc, a Bentonville-based owner and operator of retail stores and warehouse clubs, authorized the repurchase of up to USD 30 bil of the company's entire share capital, in open market transaction.

Date announced	02/19/2026
Date effective/closed	-
Deal status	Pending
Deal attitude	Not Appl.
Acquisition technique	Open Market Purchase
% Sought / % Acquired	0% / 0%
Deal value ($mil)	30,000.00

* Note: All values in USD

Company information

	Target ultimate parent	Target
Name	WALMART INC	WALMART INC
Nationality	United States	United States
Public status	Public	Public
Ticker	WMT	WMT
Primary listing	New York	New York
Thomson financial macro industry	Retail	Retail
Thomson financial mid industry	Internet and Catalog Retailing	Internet and Catalog Retailing
NAICS	445110	445110
NAICS description	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores

Target business description

Walmart Inc, located in Bentonville, Arkansas, is a technology-powered omnichannel retailer. It is engaged in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, as well as eCommerce Websites and mobile applications, located throughout the United States (U.S.), Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India and Mexico. It operates in three reportable segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International and Sam's Club U.S. The Walmart U.S. segment includes the Company's mass merchandising concept in the U.S., as well as eCommerce, which includes omni-channel initiatives and certain other business offerings such as advertising services. The Walmart International segment consists of the Company's operations outside of the U.S. through its subsidiaries, as well as eCommerce and omni-channel initiatives. The Sam's Club U.S. segment includes the warehouse membership clubs in the U.S., as well as samsclub.com and omni-channel initiatives. The Company was founded on July 2, 1962. 2, 1962.

	Acquirer	Acquirer ultimate parent
Name	WALMART INC	WALMART INC
Nationality	United States	United States
Public status	Public	Public
Ticker	WMT	WMT
Primary listing	New York	New York
Thomson financial macro industry	Retail	Retail
Thomson financial mid industry	Internet and Catalog Retailing	Internet and Catalog Retailing
NAICS	445110	445110
NAICS description	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores

Acquirer business description

Walmart Inc, located in Bentonville, Arkansas, is a technology-powered omnichannel retailer. It is engaged in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, as well as eCommerce Websites and mobile applications, located throughout the United States (U.S.), Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India and Mexico. It operates in three reportable segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International and Sam's Club U.S. The Walmart U.S. segment includes the Company's mass merchandising concept in the U.S., as well as eCommerce, which includes omni-channel initiatives and certain other business offerings such as advertising services. The Walmart International segment consists of the Company's operations outside of the U.S. through its subsidiaries, as well as eCommerce and omni-channel initiatives. The Sam's Club U.S. segment includes the warehouse membership clubs in the U.S., as well as samsclub.com and omni-channel initiatives. The Company was founded on July 2, 1962. 2, 1962.

Advisors

No content available

Deal data

Stake purchase

Held	–
Sought	–
Acquired	–
Final	–

Consideration cash & stock

Cash	100%
Stock	–
Other	–
Unknown	–

Financials

	Target	Acquirer
Stock price on date announced	0.00	0.00
Stock price on day after announcement	0.00	0.00
Total assets	284,668.00	284,668.00
EPS	2.74	2.74

Other details

Cross border	No
Bankruptcy deals	No

Financials

Financials	Target LTM (actual – $mil)	Acquirer LTM (actual – $mil)
Net sales	713,163.00	713,163.00
EBITDA	44,028.00	44,028.00
EBIT	29,825.00	29,825.00
Pre-tax income	29,469.00	29,469.00
Net income	22,270.00	22,270.00
EPS	2.74	2.74

Note: All values in USD. Figures for last twelve months (LTM) are typically based on the most recent financial statements available prior to the announcement date.

Source: Refinitiv

Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd and Minivet AI Labs Pvt Ltd

Synopsis

INDIA - Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd, a unit of Walmart Inc, planned to acquire an undisclosed majority interest in Minivet AI Labs Pvt Ltd, a Bengaluru-based provider of custom computer programming services.

Date announced	12/19/2025
Date effective/closed	-
Deal status	Pending
Deal attitude	Friendly
Acquisition technique	Financial Acquiror
% Sought / % Acquired	0% / 0%
Deal value ($mil)	-

* Note: All values in USD

Company information

	Target ultimate parent	Target
Name	Minivet AI Labs Pvt Ltd	Minivet AI Labs Pvt Ltd
Nationality	India	India
Public status	Priv.	Priv.
Ticker	-	-
Primary listing	-	-
Thomson financial macro industry	High Technology	High Technology
Thomson financial mid industry	IT Consulting & Services	IT Consulting & Services
NAICS	541511	541511
NAICS description	Custom Computer Programming Services	Custom Computer Programming Services

Target business description

Minivet AI Labs Pvt Ltd provides artificial intelligence software solutions for the e-commerce sector, specialising in generative video creation, semantic search, and conversational AI applications. The companys technology enables online retailers and digital marketplaces to convert product catalogues into video-led and interactive shopping experiences, reducing manual content production effort while improving customer engagement. The Company was founded in 2024 and is located in Bengaluru, India.

	Acquirer	Acquirer ultimate parent
Name	Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd	WALMART INC
Nationality	India	United States
Public status	Sub.	Public
Ticker	-	WMT
Primary listing	-	New York
Thomson financial macro industry	Retail	Retail
Thomson financial mid industry	Internet and Catalog Retailing	Internet and Catalog Retailing
NAICS	454111	445110
NAICS description	Electronic Shopping	Supermarkets and Other Grocery (except Convenience) Stores

Acquirer business description

Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd is an online retailer. The Company retails products in various categories, such as electronics, footwear, clothing, watches, accessories, bags, belts and wallets, fragrances and perfumes, grooming and wellness products, beauty and personal care products, jewelry, spectacle frames and contact lenses, sunglasses, toys, baby care products, home products and furniture, books and media products, and auto and sports products online. It serves women, men, babies, and kids. The Company was founded in October 2007 and is located in Bengaluru, India.

Acquirer ultimate parent business description

Walmart Inc, located in Bentonville, Arkansas, is a technology-powered omnichannel retailer. It is engaged in the operation of retail and wholesale stores and clubs, as well as eCommerce Websites and mobile applications, located throughout the United States (U.S.), Africa, Canada, Central America, Chile, China, India and Mexico. It operates in three reportable segments: Walmart U.S., Walmart International and Sam's Club U.S. The Walmart U.S. segment includes the Company's mass merchandising concept in the U.S., as well as eCommerce, which includes omni-channel initiatives and certain other business offerings such as advertising services. The Walmart International segment consists of the Company's operations outside of the U.S. through its subsidiaries, as well as eCommerce and omni-channel initiatives. The Sam's Club U.S. segment includes the warehouse membership clubs in the U.S., as well as samsclub.com and omni-channel initiatives. The Company was founded on July 2, 1962. 2, 1962.

Advisors

No content available

Deal data

Stake purchase

Held	–
Sought	–
Acquired	–
Final	–

Consideration cash & stock

Cash	–
Stock	–
Other	–
Unknown	–

Financials

	Target	Acquirer
Stock price on date announced	0.00	0.00
Stock price on day after announcement	0.00	0.00
Total assets	0.00	0.00
EPS	0.00	0.00

Other details

Cross border	Yes
Bankruptcy deals	No

Financials

Financials	Target LTM (actual – $mil)	Acquirer LTM (actual – $mil)
Net sales	0.00	10,329.20
EBITDA	0.00	0.00
EBIT	0.00	-607.14
Pre-tax income	0.00	0.00
Net income	0.00	0.00
EPS	0.00	0.00

Note: All values in USD. Figures for last twelve months (LTM) are typically based on the most recent financial statements available prior to the announcement date.

Source: Refinitiv

Perspectives



GOVERNANCE METRICS REPORT

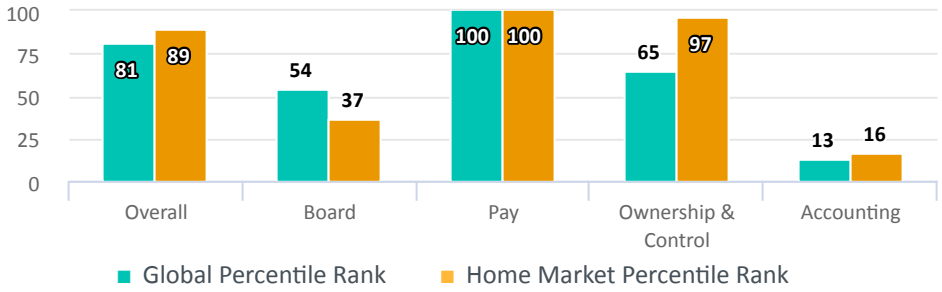
WALMART INC. (WMT)

Governance Score **7.8** / 10

Regulatory Disclosures

Industry:	Retail - Food & Staples	**Incorporated:**	US (DE)	**Last Data Update:**	Oct 07, 2026
Market Cap:	890,801,027,939 USD	**Home Market:**	United States	**Last Score Change:**	Oct 07, 2026

GOVERNANCE THEMES AND RANKINGS



SUMMARY

WALMART falls into the highest scoring range for all the companies we assess relative to global peers, indicating that the company's corporate governance practices are generally well aligned with shareholder interests.

KEY AREAS OF CONCERN*

SCORING DEDUCTIONS

Board Effectiveness **(-0.69)**

- Flagged Directors on Board
- Overboarded Non-Exec Directors

Board Skills & Diversity **(-0.30)**

- Risk Management Expertise
- Not 30% Female Directors

Auditor Independence **(-0.29)**

- Auditor Tenure

OWNERSHIP OVERVIEW

Capital Structure	Single Equity Class
Ownership Classification	Controlling Shareholder
Key Owner Types	Family Firm
Top Shareholders:	

Walton family - Walton Enterprises, LLC - 44.11 %(The Shares shown as beneficially owned by Walton Enterprises, LLC represent a) Shares held by Walton Enterprises, LLC and b)Shares held by Walton Family Holdings Trust)

KEY DATES

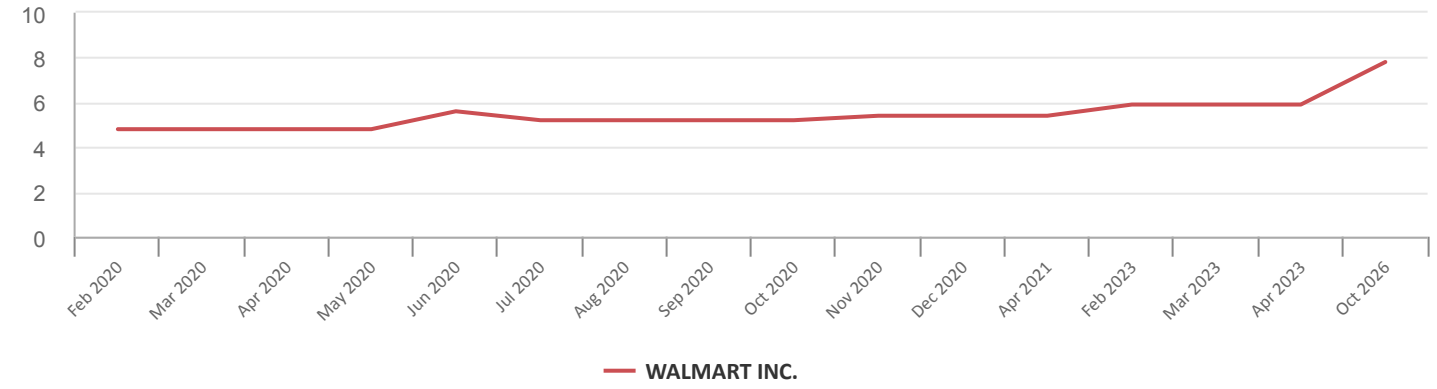
Financial Year End	January 31
Annual Filing Date	Apr 23, 2026
AGM Date	Jun 04, 2026

WEBSITE

https://corporate.walmart.com

**Key areas of concern include flagged key metrics within the three sub-issues that represent the largest scoring deductions. Please review the full report to see the complete set of flagged key metrics.*

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE SCORE HISTORY



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CHANGES TO FLAGGED KEY METRICS (SINCE JUNE 2025)

Key Metric	Key Metric Change	Date	Score Change	Change Notes
Leadership Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.30	
Controlling Shareholder Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.99	
Risk Management Expertise	**Flag Added**	Jun 04, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Realized	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
Severance Vesting	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.10	
CEO Equity Changes	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Perks & Other Comp	Flag Removed	Dec 11, 2025	0.20	
Overboarded Non-Exec Directors	**Flag Added**	Jul 17, 2025	**-0.49**	

Note: A full list of score changes (including where there is no Key Metric Change) is included in the Appendix.

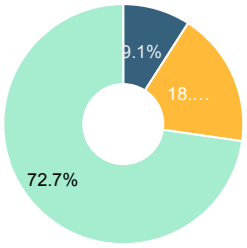
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BOARD OVERVIEW

Board Type: Unitary Board

Board of Directors

CEO	John Furner	Since: Feb 01, 2026
Chair	Gregory (Greg) Penner	Since: Jun 05, 2015
Lead Director	Randall Stephenson	Since: Jun 05, 2025



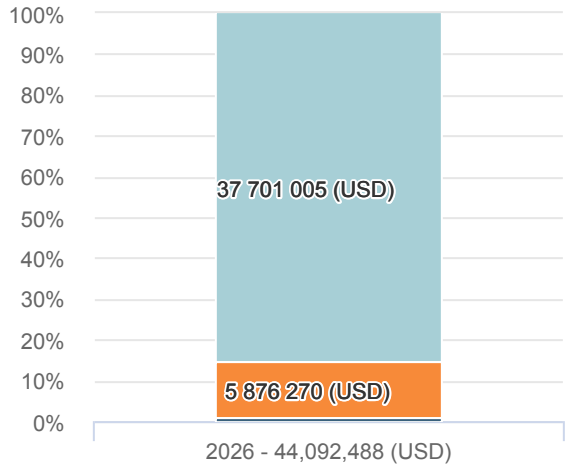
Executive Leadership

CFO	John Rainey	Since: Jun 06, 2022

■Executive ■Links to Management ■Independent of Management

PAY OVERVIEW

Highest Paid Executive - Daniel Danker



■Long Term Incentives Awarded	37,701,005 (USD)
■Short Term Incentives Awarded	5,876,270 (USD)
■Fixed Pay	515,213 (USD)

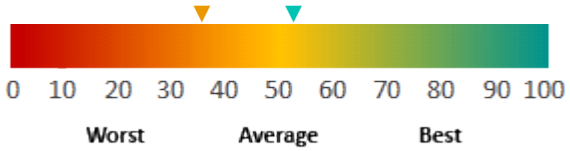
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BOARD

The policies and practices of the WALMART board fall within the average scoring range relative to global peers. We have flagged this board for potential concerns regarding the presence of certain related party transactions, the previous history of board service for certain directors and some non-executives may have too many other public board commitments.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
7.5	54th (Average)	37th (Average)

BOARD PERFORMANCE VS.



KEY METRICS SCORING

	Deduction
AUDIT OVERSIGHT	
Audit Committee Industry Expert	-0.10
BOARD EFFECTIVENESS	
Flagged Directors on Board	-0.20
Overboarded Non-Exec Directors	-0.49
BOARD INDEPENDENCE	
Related Party Transactions	-0.24
BOARD LEADERSHIP	
Independent Chair	-0.10
BOARD SKILLS & DIVERSITY	
Risk Management Expertise	-0.20
Not 30% Female Directors	-0.10

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LEADERSHIP

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

History	CEO Since	Until	Name	Gender	Age
Current	**Feb 2026**		**John Furner**	**M**	**52**
Former	*Feb 2014*	*Jan 2026*	*Carl (Doug) McMillon*	*M*	*59*

CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER

History	CFO Since	Until	Name	Gender	Age
Current	**Jun 2022**		**John Rainey**	**M**	**55**
Former	*Jan 2016*	*Jun 2022*	*M. Brett Biggs*	*M*	*57*

CHAIR

History	Chair Since	Until	Name	Gender	Age
Current	**Jun 2015**		**Gregory (Greg) Penner**	**M**	**56**

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BOARD OF DIRECTORS

The WALMART board currently has an independent majority, which enables it to more effectively fulfill its critical function of overseeing management on behalf of shareholders.

Number of Board Meetings: 5
Non-executives meet in absence of Executives: Yes

Name	M/F	Age	Tenure (Years)	Boards	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Management Link/ Designation Reason	Nationality
Carla Harris	F	63	9	4	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Cesar Conde	M	52	7	3	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Gregory (Greg) Penner COB I $	M	56	18	1	No	No	Executive of controlling shareholder; Former executive; Family Firm Director	United States of America
John Furner CEO I	**M**	**52**	**< 1**	**1**	**No**	**Yes**	**Executive**	**Not Disclosed**
Marissa Mayer	F	50	14	4	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Randall Stephenson LD $	M	66	5	1	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	M	62	2	2	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Sarah Friar $	F	53	8	1	Yes	Yes		United States of America
Shishir Mehrotra	M	46	< 1	2	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Steuart Walton	M	44	10	1	No	No	Executive of controlling shareholder; Material related party transaction; Family Firm Director	Not Disclosed
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	3	Yes	Yes		United States of America

	F	# >= 70	# >= 15 yrs	# >= 4			
Total (of 11)	3	0	1	2	8	9	
Percentage	27.3%	0%	9.1%	18.2%	72.7%	81.8%	

Note: Board count includes the membership of this board.

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (5) I - Industry Expert (2) CEO - Chief Executive Officer
COB - Chair of the Board LD - Lead Director

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RELATED PARTY TRANSACTIONS

The risk to minority shareholders arising from related party transactions is a function of the nature of the related party, the relative size of the transaction and the pricing of the transaction. The board, and in particular the independent directors or audit committee, play a key role in the protection of minority shareholders' interests, and monitoring and managing potential conflicts of interest of management, board members and shareholders. We note that the following circumstances which suggest elevated risk for independent shareholders:

The company is a family firm and there are related party transactions with the family.
There are related party transactions with the CEO.

Reported Transactions

The Company engaged in related party transactions during the current fiscal year 2025 , involving the Company's executives and members of the Walton family. The transactions are related to the sale of jet fuel and energy savings revenues, the purchase of sporting goods and related products, and fees received from third-party utility providers for energy savings services.

For the two most recently reported fiscal years, these value of these transactions can be summarised as follows :

Fiscal Year	Related Party Types	Aggregate Transaction Value		
		Value (CUR)	% of Total	Type
Jan 31, 2026	Non-executive director, Executive director, Controlling Owner, CEO, Family	2,194,100 USD	0.000% of Total Revenue	Recurring income from related party
		73,879,800 USD	0.011% of Expenses	Recurring purchases from related party
Jan 31, 2025	Non-executive director, Executive director, Controlling Owner, CEO, Family	3,068,800 USD	0.000% of Total Revenue	Recurring income from related party
		58,554,500 USD	0.009% of Expenses	Recurring purchases from related party

Sources : 2026 DEF 14A p. 42-44, 2025 DEF 14A p. 42

BOARD EFFECTIVENESS

We note that 20% of companies in United States are flagged for overboarded directors.

Nomination Committee - Number Of Meetings: 5

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Committee Status
Carla Harris	F	63	9	Yes	Yes	Member
Randall Stephenson $	M	66	5	Yes	Yes	Chair
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	Yes	Yes	Member

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (2)

Flagged Directors

Thomas (Tom) Horton

Mr. Horton is designated a 'flagged director' due to his involvement with the board of AMR Corporation, which filed for Chapter 11 Bankruptcy in November 2011.

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BOARD SKILLS & DIVERSITY

We have identified that this board includes at least one individual flagged as having been involved in one or more negative governance events in the course of their service at previous companies, as explained below. Additional factors, e.g. the lack of an independent chairman together with the high number of long-tenured directors, may raise some investors' concerns about the board's ability to provide an effective counterbalance to management.

We have flagged the WALMART board for gender diversity concerns.

A board with one or more active CEOs and overboarded directors may not be able to provide effective oversight of management. Their other roles may limit the time and attention required to fulfill their fiduciary duties.

AUDIT OVERSIGHT

Audit Committee - Number Of Meetings: 9

The WALMART board of directors includes a fully independent audit committee and at least one member of that committee meets our standards for financial expertise.

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Boards	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Committee Status
Cesar Conde	M	52	7	3	Yes	Yes	Member
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	M	62	2	2	Yes	Yes	Chair
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	3	Yes	Yes	Member

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (2)

Risk Committee - Number Of Meetings: 9

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Committee Status
Cesar Conde	M	52	7	Yes	Yes	Member
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	M	62	2	Yes	Yes	Chair
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	Yes	Yes	Member

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (2)

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PAY OVERSIGHT

Pay Committee - Number Of Meetings: 6

The WALMART board includes an independent pay committee, which is considered best practice for oversight of executive pay according to international corporate governance standards.

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	CEO Role?	Committee Status
Carla Harris	F	63	9	Yes	Yes		Chair
Marissa Mayer	F	50	14	Yes	Yes		Member
Randall Stephenson $	M	66	5	Yes	Yes	Former	Member
Shishir Mehrotra	M	46	< 1	Yes	Yes		Member

$ - Financial Expert

CONTROVERSIES & EVENTS

No major relevant controversies have been uncovered.

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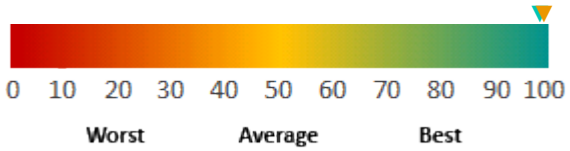
PAY

Executive pay practices of the WALMART board appear to be generally well aligned with sustainable shareholder interests.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
10.0	100th (Best In Class)	100th (Best In Class)

PAY PERFORMANCE VS.

▼ Global ▼ Home Market



PAY FIGURES

EXECUTIVE PAY - 2026

Executive	Title	Tenure (Years)	Total Awarded Pay (USD)	Total Realized Pay (USD)
Carl (Doug) McMillon I	Executive	N/A (Resigned)	29,240,930	78,235,120
Daniel Danker I	Executive		44,092,488	7,202,291
John Furner I	CEO	< 1	27,343,149	43,954,406
John Rainey I $	CFO	4	15,455,188	35,678,055
Suresh Kumar I	Executive		16,727,128	42,491,665

$ - Financial Expert I - Industry Expert (5)

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CEO PAY DETAILS - John Furner

Pay Awarded	2026
Fixed Pay	
Salary	1,313,000 USD
Fees	0 USD
Pension	520,028 USD
Perks & Other Pay	481,188 USD
Variable Pay	
Short-term incentives	
Annual Bonus	0 USD
Other Non-equity Incentive Plan	2,769,390 USD
Long-term incentives	
Grant date value of Stock Options	0 USD
Grant date value of Stock Awards	22,259,543 USD
Total Awarded Pay	**27,343,149 USD**

Pay Realized	
Fixed Pay	
Salary	1,313,000 USD
Fees	0 USD
Pension	520,028 USD
Perks & Other Pay	481,188 USD
Variable Pay	
Short-term incentives	
Annual Bonus	0 USD
Other Non-equity Incentive Plan	2,769,390 USD
Long-term incentives	
Options Exercised	0 USD
Stock Awards Vested	38,870,800 USD
Total Realized Pay	**43,954,406 USD**

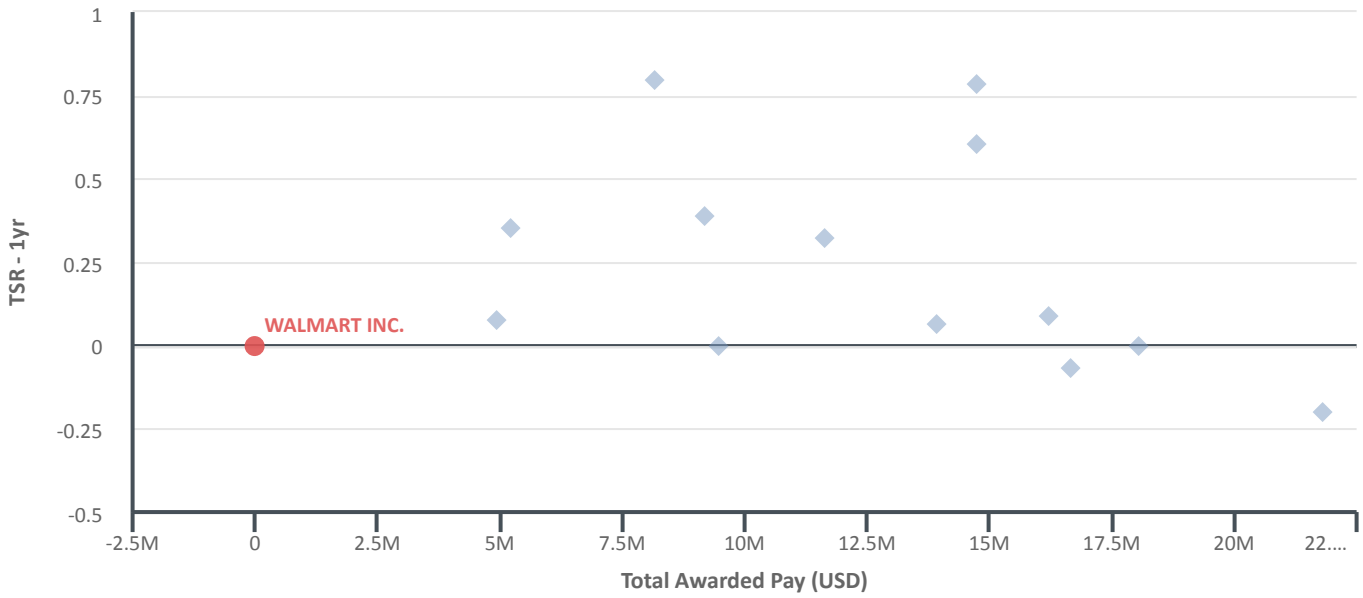
PAY PEER GROUP

LARGECAP - DEVELOPED AMERICAS - CONSUMER STAPLES DISTRIBUTION & RETAIL (14 COMPANIES)

Company	Home Market	Market Cap (USD m)	Pay Year	1 Yr TSR	Total CEO Annual Pay (USD)	CEO Name	CEO Since
DOLLAR GENERAL CORPORATION	United States	27,963	2025	0.80%	8,163,197	Vasos	Oct 2023
DOLLAR TREE, INC.	United States	23,752	2025	0.60%	5,332,060	Creedon	Nov 2024
CASEY'S GENERAL STORES, INC.	United States	28,065	2026	0.78%	5,093,310	Rebelez	Jun 2019
US FOODS HOLDING CORP.	United States	21,181	2025	0.00%	4,766,691	Flitman	Jan 2023
BJ'S WHOLESALE CLUB HOLDINGS, INC.	United States	11,450	2025	-0.07%	4,178,173	Eddy	Apr 2021
PERFORMANCE FOOD GROUP COMPANY	United States	14,939	2025	0.32%	3,660,955	Holm	Sep 2002
SYSCO CORPORATION	United States	38,845	2025	0.09%	3,641,709	Hourican	Feb 2020
ALIMENTATION COUCHE-TARD INC.	Canada	51,116	2026	0.00%	3,615,555	Miller	Sep 2024
LOBLAW COMPANIES LTD	Canada	52,171	2025	0.39%	3,584,456	Bank	Nov 2023
TARGET CORPORATION	United States	70,988	2025	-0.20%	3,274,808	Cornell	Aug 2014
METRO INC.	Canada	13,341	2025	0.08%	2,568,400	La Flèche	Apr 2008
GEORGE WESTON LIMITED	Canada	26,590	2025	0.35%	2,524,262	Weston	Jan 2017
COSTCO WHOLESALE CORPORATION	United States	419,608	2025	0.06%	1,895,797	Vachris	Jan 2024
WALMART INC.	**United States**	**890,801**		**0.00%**		**John Furner**	**Feb 2026**

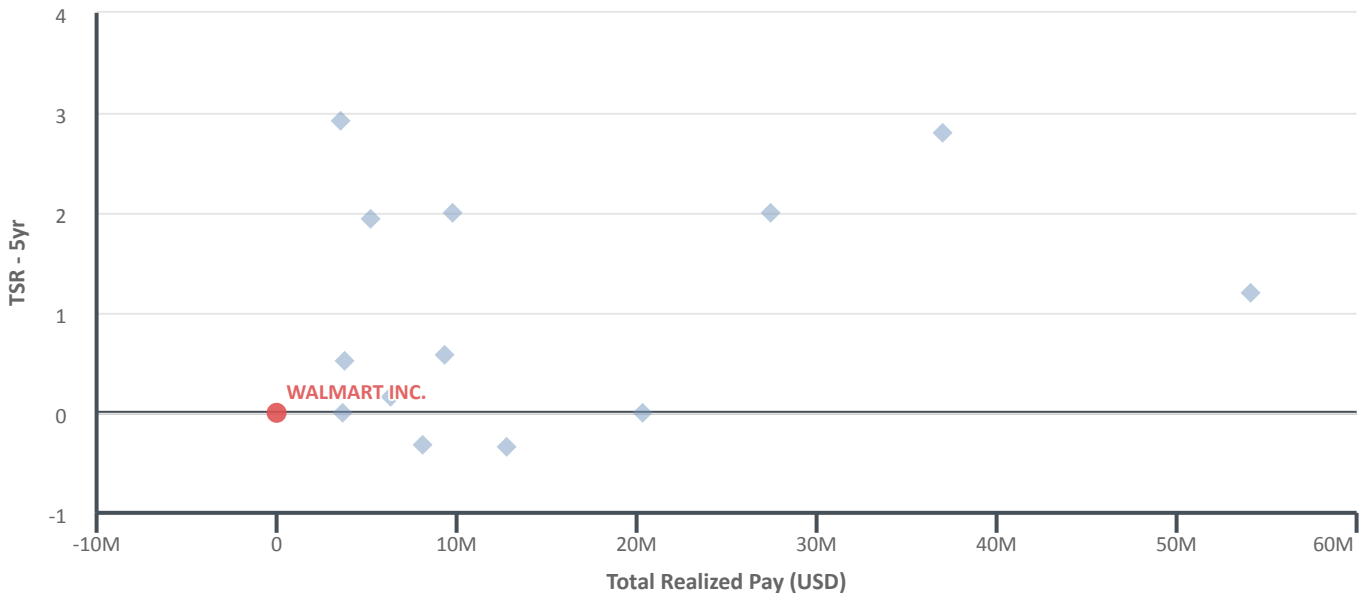
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CEO TOTAL AWARDED PAY VERSUS PAY PEER GROUP



Pay Peers (♦) are used in the calculation of the Key Metric CEO Pay Total Summary and selected as set out in the MSCI Governance Metrics Methodology Document.

CEO TOTAL REALIZED PAY VERSUS PAY PEER GROUP



Pay Peers (♦) are used in the calculation of the Key Metric CEO Pay Total Summary and selected as set out in the MSCI Governance Metrics Methodology Document.

PAY PERFORMANCE ALIGNMENT

CEO & EXECUTIVE EQUITY

CEO equity policy as a multiple of salary: **7.0**

Our senior officers have been subject to stock ownership guidelines since 2003. Our CEO and senior officers are subject to the following requirements:

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CEO : 7 times annual base salary

Executive	Tenure (Years)	Shares Held	YoY % Change	Shareholding As % of Salary
Carl (Doug) McMillon I	N/A (Resigned)	1,243,874	-69.27%	
Daniel Danker I		238,583		
John Furner I	< 1	342,311		
John Rainey I $	4	305,821		
Suresh Kumar I		1,472,417		

$ - Financial Expert I - Industry Expert (5)

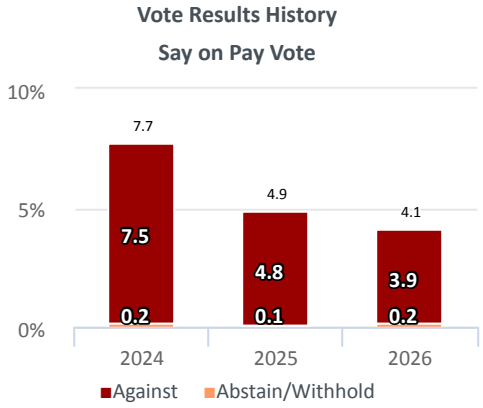
CLAWBACK & MALUS

Clawback or malus provisions are in place.

Clawback Type: **Performance Based**

LATEST PAY VOTES

Year	Vote Type	Votes For %	Votes Against %	Abstain %
2026	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	95.9%	3.9%	0.2%



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NON-EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR PAY

NON-EXECUTIVE EQUITY

Director	Tenure (Years)	Shares Held
Brian Niccol	N/A (Resigned)	9,631
Carla Harris	9	50,098
Cesar Conde	7	31,588
Gregory (Greg) Penner I $	18	259,257
Marissa Mayer	14	130,950
Randall Stephenson $	5	65,029
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	2	11,807
Sarah Friar $	8	60,007
Shishir Mehrotra	< 1	1,286
Steuart Walton	10	80,209
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	11	57,913
Timothy (Tim) Flynn R $	N/A (Resigned)	156,945

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (6) I - Industry Expert
R - Risk Management Expert

NON-EXECUTIVE PAY TABLES

Director	Tenure (Years)	Cash Fees	Other Comp	Stock Award	Total Pay	Total Pay (USD)
Brian Niccol	N/A (Resigned)	108,751 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	338,761 USD	338,761
Carla Harris	9	131,429 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	361,439 USD	361,439
Cesar Conde	7	108,571 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	338,581 USD	338,581
Gregory (Greg) Penner I $	18	221,071 USD	0 USD	342,468 USD	563,539 USD	563,539
Marissa Mayer	14	108,571 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	338,581 USD	338,581
Randall Stephenson $	5	156,429 USD	413 USD	230,010 USD	386,852 USD	386,852
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	2	108,751 USD	843 USD	230,010 USD	339,604 USD	339,604
Sarah Friar $	8	131,429 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	361,439 USD	361,439
Shishir Mehrotra	< 1	0 USD	0 USD	93,283 USD	93,283 USD	93,283
Steuart Walton	10	131,429 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	361,439 USD	361,439
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	11	138,571 USD	215 USD	230,010 USD	368,796 USD	368,796
Timothy (Tim) Flynn R $	N/A (Resigned)	141,429 USD	976 USD	230,010 USD	372,415 USD	372,415

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (6) I - Industry Expert R - Risk Management Expert

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CONTROVERSIES & EVENTS

No major relevant controversies have been uncovered.

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OWNERSHIP & CONTROL

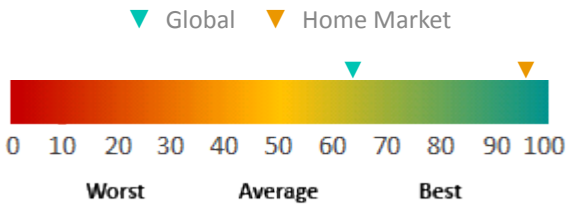
The company's ownership structure and shareholder rights at WALMART fall within the average scoring relative to global peers.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
8.3	65th (Average)	97th (Best In Class)

KEY METRICS SCORING

	Deduction
DIRECTOR ELECTIONS	
Majority Voting	-0.20
OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE	
Controlling Shareholder	0.00
SHAREHOLDER RIGHTS	
Bylaws Amendments	-0.10
TAKEOVER PROVISIONS	
Business Combination Provision	-0.10
Fair Bid Treatment Provisions	-0.10

OWNERSHIP & CONTROL PERFORMANCE VS.



CORPORATE STRUCTURE

Public Company

CAPITAL STRUCTURE

Capital Type	Votes Per Share	Shares Outstanding
Common Stock	1.0	7,970,990,515

OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE

OWNERSHIP CATEGORIES

- Controlling Shareholder
- Family Firm

NOTABLE SHAREHOLDERS

Walton family - Walton Enterprises, LLC - 44.11 %(The Shares shown as beneficially owned by Walton Enterprises, LLC represent a) Shares held by Walton Enterprises, LLC and b)Shares held by Walton Family Holdings Trust)	**44.1%**
Insider Voting Power	**44.1%**

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WALMART is a controlled company, where a single shareholder or shareholder block holds 30% or more of the voting shares or has effective control of the board. The controlling shareholder controls 44.11% of the voting power. We have identified this company as a 'family firm', where one or more families control the voting shares and are typically represented on the board. When assessing family firms, we consider the extent to which the family makes decisions that are in the best interests of non-family shareholders. At WALMART, there may be governance risks associated with related party transactions among the controlling founders/family. The company does not have a special capital structure, thus one vote right is afforded per common share. This principle of 'one share one vote' helps align economic and voting power and ensures that no class of shareholders has more voting power than economic exposure.

FAMILY FIRM

The Walton Family, comprising Alice Walton, Benjamin Walton, James Walton, Jim Walton, Lukas Walton, Rob Walton, Samuel Walton, Steuart Walton, and Thomas Walton, collectively holds 44.11% shares of the company through Walton Enterprises, LLC. Steuart Walton serve as Board member of the company.

TAKEOVER PROVISIONS

Fair Price Provision	Mandatory Bid Provision	Mandatory Bid Ownership Threshold
No	No	

State of Incorporation	Business Combination Provision
Delaware	Yes

% of Votes to Approve a Merger
51%

GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

MAJORITY REQUIREMENTS

	Bylaws	Charter
Default percentage of votes required to amend a provision	51%	51%

.Bylaws p. 23

These Bylaws may be altered, amended, or repealed, or new Bylaws may be adopted, by the stockholders or by the Board

COI p. 12

The Corporation reserves the right to amend, alter or repeal any provision contained in this Certificate of Incorporation in the manner now or hereafter prescribed by the statutes of the State of Delaware, and all rights and powers conferred on Directors and stockholders herein are granted subject to this reservation.

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SHAREHOLDER RIGHTS

There may be governance risks for investors in relation to shareholder rights and management-controlled takeover defense mechanisms at WALMART including:

- The board's ability to amend the company's charter without shareholder approval
- The board's ability to amend the company's bylaws without shareholder approval
- business combination provisions that fail to include protections of shareholder interests
- fair price provisions that fail to ensure that all shareholders are treated fairly
- Limits on the right of shareholders to take action by written consent

SHAREHOLDER MEETINGS & RESOLUTIONS

	Call Special Meeting	Requisition a Resolution at AGM	Act by Written Consent
Percentage of shares required	10%		N/A - no right exists

RESTRICTIONS ON LEGAL ACTION BY SHAREHOLDERS

An exclusive forum provision is in place.

SAY ON PAY

We note that shareholder votes on executive pay are mandatory in this market, affording shareholders the ability to review and approve executive pay practices at this company.

DIRECTOR ELECTIONS

BOARD RE-ELECTION PROVISIONS

Board Re-election Provisions	
Board Re-election Frequency (Years)	1
% of Board subject to re-election	100%

DIRECTOR ELECTION STANDARD

The company has not adopted a binding majority director election standard (with immediate resignation if the director does not receive a majority of the votes cast), which may limit shareholders' ability to hold members of the board accountable in uncontested elections.

Director Election Rules	
Vote Standard	Majority & Resignation Policy
Immediate Binding Resignation	No

2026 DEF 14A p. 8

They are voting to elect each nominee named below as a director of Walmart for a one-year term.

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2026 DEF 14A p. 114

Any incumbent director who is a director nominee and who does not receive a majority of the votes cast must promptly tender his or her offer of resignation as a director to the Chairman of the Board for consideration by the Board. Each director standing for election at the 2026 Annual Shareholders' Meeting has agreed to resign, effective upon acceptance of such resignation by the Board, if he or she does not receive a majority of the votes cast. The Board must accept or reject the resignation offer within 90 days following certification of the shareholder vote in accordance with the procedures established by the Bylaws.

PROXY ACCESS

A proxy access provision is in place.

Proxy Access Terms	
Ownership Duration (Years)	3
Ownership Threshold (% of shares)	3%
Min/Max % of Board Seats	20%
Min/Max Number of Board Seats	2

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ACCOUNTING

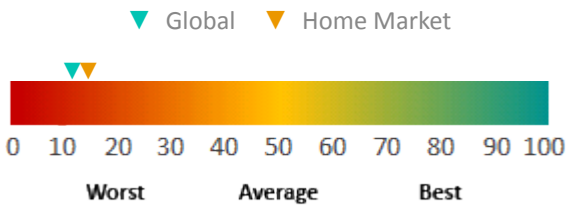
Based on the company's disclosures and other public information, accounting and financial reporting practices at WALMART may warrant close attention from shareholders. We have flagged this company for potential concerns regarding the length of tenure of the external audit firm.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
8.2	13th (Below Average)	16th (Below Average)

KEY METRICS SCORING

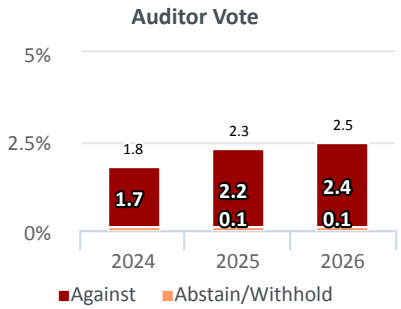
	Deduction
AUDITOR INDEPENDENCE	
Auditor Tenure	-0.29

ACCOUNTING PERFORMANCE VS.



EXTERNAL AUDITORS

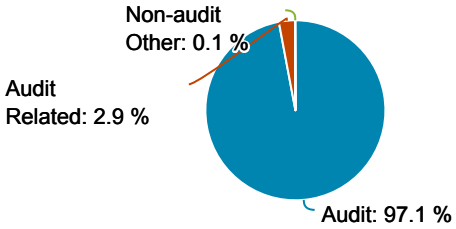
Type	Since	Firm	Most Recent Fiscal Year End Signed Off
Primary	1969	Ernst & Young LLP	2026



AUDITOR FEES

Fees paid to: Ernst & Young LLP (Primary)

Fee	Jan 31, 2026 (USD)	Jan 31, 2024 (USD)
Audit	44,712,000	36,306,000
Audit Related	1,335,000	1,586,000
Total Audit + Audit Related	**46,047,000**	**37,892,000**
Tax Compliance/Advice	0	0
Other Non-audit Services	24,000	24,000
Total Non-audit Fees	**24,000**	**24,000**
Total Fees	**46,071,000**	**37,916,000**



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AUDITOR'S REPORT

	Jan 31, 2026	Jan 31, 2025	Jan 31, 2024
Report Disclosed	Yes	Yes	Yes
Opinion	Unqualified Opinion	Unqualified Opinion	Unqualified Opinion
Emphasis of Matter	No	No	No

CONTROVERSIES & EVENTS

No major relevant controversies have been uncovered.

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APPENDIX

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DIRECTOR VOTES

Proxy Year	Name	Votes For %	Votes Against %	Votes Abstained / Withheld %
2026	Conde,Cesar	99.16%	0.77%	0.07%
2026	Friar,Sarah	99.75%	0.18%	0.07%
2026	Furner,John	99.31%	0.62%	0.07%
2026	Harris,Carla	97.27%	2.66%	0.07%
2026	Horton,Thomas	98.21%	1.71%	0.08%
2026	Mayer,Marissa	99.02%	0.91%	0.07%
2026	Mehrotra,Shishir	99.42%	0.50%	0.08%
2026	Moritz,Robert	99%	0.92%	0.08%
2026	Penner,Gregory	97.21%	2.71%	0.08%
2026	Stephenson,Randall	96.08%	3.79%	0.13%
2026	Walton,Steuart	99.29%	0.64%	0.07%
2025	Conde,Cesar	99.22%	0.71%	0.07%
2025	Friar,Sarah	99.42%	0.51%	0.06%
2025	Harris,Carla	96.85%	3.08%	0.06%
2025	Horton,Thomas	97.86%	2.08%	0.07%
2025	Mayer,Marissa	98.49%	1.45%	0.06%
2025	Moritz,Robert	99.48%	0.44%	0.07%
2025	Penner,Gregory	96.78%	3.15%	0.07%
2025	Stephenson,Randall	95.59%	4.33%	0.07%
2025	Walton,Steuart	99.20%	0.74%	0.06%
2024	Conde,Cesar	99.45%	0.44%	0.11%
2024	Friar,Sarah	99.48%	0.42%	0.10%
2024	Harris,Carla	96.75%	3.15%	0.10%
2024	Horton,Thomas	94.07%	5.79%	0.14%
2024	Mayer,Marissa	97.95%	1.95%	0.10%
2024	Penner,Gregory	98.50%	1.39%	0.11%
2024	Stephenson,Randall	97.31%	2.58%	0.11%
2024	Walton,Steuart	99.44%	0.46%	0.10%
2023	Conde,Cesar	98.83%	0.99%	0.19%
2023	Friar,Sarah	98.81%	1.02%	0.17%
2023	Harris,Carla	96.06%	3.82%	0.12%
2023	Horton,Thomas	95.56%	4.29%	0.15%
2023	Mayer,Marissa	97.14%	2.69%	0.17%

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Proxy Year	Name	Votes For %	Votes Against %	Votes Abstained / Withheld %
2023	Penner,Gregory	97.36%	2.51%	0.13%
2023	Stephenson,Randall	96.50%	3.37%	0.13%
2023	Walton,Steuart	98.09%	1.73%	0.18%
2022	Conde,Cesar	99.53%	0.37%	0.11%
2022	Friar,Sarah	96.02%	3.87%	0.11%
2022	Harris,Carla	97.28%	2.62%	0.10%
2022	Horton,Thomas	97.19%	2.71%	0.11%
2022	Mayer,Marissa	98.38%	1.52%	0.10%
2022	Penner,Gregory	96.58%	3.32%	0.11%
2022	Stephenson,Randall	97.68%	2.21%	0.11%
2022	Walton,Steuart	98.47%	1.44%	0.10%
2021	Conde,Cesar	99.40%	0.52%	0.08%
2021	Friar,Sarah	97.38%	2.54%	0.07%
2021	Harris,Carla	98.53%	1.39%	0.07%
2021	Horton,Thomas	98.57%	1.35%	0.09%
2021	Mayer,Marissa	99.06%	0.87%	0.08%
2021	Penner,Gregory	98.17%	1.75%	0.08%
2021	Stephenson,Randall	98.91%	1.01%	0.08%
2021	Walton,Steuart	99.37%	0.55%	0.08%
2020	Conde,Cesar	99.61%	0.27%	0.12%
2020	Friar,Sarah	99.63%	0.25%	0.12%
2020	Harris,Carla	99%	0.88%	0.12%
2020	Horton,Thomas	96.55%	3.33%	0.12%
2020	Mayer,Marissa	99.15%	0.73%	0.12%
2020	Penner,Gregory	96.37%	3.51%	0.12%
2020	Walton,Steuart	97%	2.88%	0.12%
2019	Conde,Cesar	99.77%	0.15%	0.08%
2019	Friar,Sarah	99.72%	0.15%	0.13%
2019	Harris,Carla	99.08%	0.79%	0.13%
2019	Horton,Thomas	99.62%	0.24%	0.14%
2019	Mayer,Marissa	99.07%	0.80%	0.13%
2019	Penner,Gregory	97.35%	2.51%	0.14%
2019	Walton,Steuart	97.82%	2.05%	0.13%
2018	Friar,Sarah	99.75%	0.17%	0.07%

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Proxy Year	Name	Votes For %	Votes Against %	Votes Abstained / Withheld %
2018	Harris,Carla	96.57%	3.35%	0.07%
2018	Horton,Thomas	99.22%	0.70%	0.08%
2018	Mayer,Marissa	96.05%	3.88%	0.07%
2018	Penner,Gregory	97.38%	2.54%	0.08%
2018	Walton,Steuart	97.70%	2.23%	0.07%
2017	Harris,Carla	98.10%	1.83%	0.07%
2017	Horton,Thomas	99.33%	0.60%	0.07%
2017	Mayer,Marissa	94.24%	5.69%	0.07%
2017	Penner,Gregory	97.09%	2.83%	0.07%
2017	Walton,Steuart	97.41%	2.52%	0.07%
2016	Horton,Thomas	99%	0.23%	0.07%
2016	Mayer,Marissa	94%	5.48%	0.07%
2016	Penner,Gregory	97%	2.15%	0.07%
2016	Walton,Steuart	97%	1.97%	0.06%
2015	Horton,Thomas	105%	-4.98%	-0.21%
2015	Mayer,Marissa	103%	-3.45%	-0.20%
2015	Penner,Gregory	103%	-3.58%	-0.21%

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SHAREHOLDER/MANAGEMENT PROPOSALS

MANAGEMENT PROPOSALS

Proxy Year	Proposal	Proposal Summary	Outcome	Votes For	Votes Against	Abstain/ Withheld%
2026	Auditor Ratification	Proposal No. 2: Ratification of Independent Accountants	Approved	97.5%	2.4%	0.1%
2026	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	Proposal No. 3: Advisory Vote to Approve Named Executive Officer Compensation	Approved	95.9%	3.9%	0.2%
2026	Amend Certificate of Incorporation	Proposal No. 4 Approve Amendment to our Restated Certificate of Incorporation	Approved	94.2%	5.7%	0.1%
2025	Auditor Ratification	2.Ratification of Independent Accountants. The Company's shareholders voted upon and approved the ratification of the appointment of Ernst & Young LLP to serve as the Company's independent registered accountants for the fiscal year ending January 31, 2026.	Approved	97.7%	2.2%	0.1%
2025	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	3.Advisory Vote to Approve Named Executive Officer Compensation. The Company's shareholders voted upon and approved, by nonbinding, advisory vote, the compensation of the Company's named executive officers, as described in the Company's proxy statement dated April 24, 2025.	Approved	95.1%	4.8%	0.1%
2025	Director & Employee Comp	4.Approval of the Walmart Inc. Stock Incentive Plan of 2025. The Company's shareholders voted upon, adopted, and approved the Walmart Inc. Stock Incentive Plan of 2025.	Approved	98.1%	1.7%	0.2%
2024	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	2.Advisory Vote to Approve Named Executive Officer Compensation.	Approved	92.3%	7.5%	0.2%
2024	Auditor Ratification	3.Ratification of Independent Accountants.	Approved	98.2%	1.7%	0.1%

**For Management Proposals at AGM's held more than three years ago, please refer to the Screener tool on ESG Manager.*

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SHAREHOLDER PROPOSALS

Proxy Year	Proposal	Proposal Summary	Proposal Proponent	Outcome	Votes For	Votes Against	Abstain/ Withheld%
2026	Board Elections - Cumulative Voting	Proposal No. 5 Request for Cumulative Voting for Board Elections	National Legal and Policy Center	Defeated	1.9%	97.9%	0.3%
2026	Health Care	Proposal No. 6 Report on Workplace Health and Safety Governance	Oxfam America, Inc.	Defeated	6.6%	92.1%	1.3%
2026	Other	Proposal No. 7 Report on Immigration Policy and Enforcement	SOC Investment Group	Defeated	4.3%	94.6%	1.2%
2026	Other	Proposal No. 8 Report on Workplace Impact of AI and Automation	United for Respect	Defeated	5%	94%	1.1%
2025	Other	5.The Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a third-party assessment of company policies regarding law enforcement information requests related to medication use by customers and employees.	Segal Marco Advisors on behalf of AFL-CIO Equity Index Funds	Defeated	4.1%	95.4%	0.5%
2025	Environmental - Land Use, Resources and Recycling	6.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on reduction of plastic packaging and recyclability claims.	Green Century Capital Management, Inc.	Defeated	5.8%	93.8%	0.3%
2025	Other	7.The Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal to revisit plastics packaging policies.	National Legal and Policy Center	Defeated	0.5%	99.1%	0.3%
2025	Employment Discrimination	8.Then, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a racial equity audit.	The Organization United for Respect (OUR)	Defeated	6.8%	92.3%	0.9%
2025	Employment Discrimination	9.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on delays in revising diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) Initiatives.	The National Center for Public Policy Research	Defeated	0.4%	99.3%	0.4%
2025	Health Care	10.The Company's shareholders also voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a review of health and safety governance.	Oxfam America, Inc. and its various co-filers	Defeated	7%	92.7%	0.4%
2025	Other	11.The Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting an evaluation of respect for civil liberties in advertising.	Bowyer Research Inc.	Defeated	0.4%	99.3%	0.4%
2024	Political Influence	Pursuant to the advance notice requirement of the Company's amended and restated bylaws, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal concerning limitations on political contributions made by WALPAC. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Not disclosed	Defeated	0%	100%	0%
2024	Animal Welfare	4.The Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting the publication of targets for transitioning from gestation crates in pork supply chain. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	The Accountability Board, Inc.	Defeated	12.5%	87%	0.5%

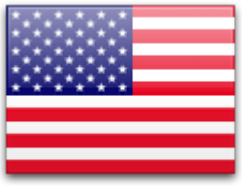
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Proxy Year	Proposal	Proposal Summary	Proposal Proponent	Outcome	Votes For	Votes Against	Abstain/ Withheld%
2024	Employment Discrimination	5.Then, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a racial equity audit. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	The Organization United for Respect (OUR) and its various co-filers	Defeated	15.4%	84.2%	0.4%
2024	Human Rights	6.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting human rights impact assessments. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Oxfam America, Inc.	Defeated	11.5%	87.5%	1%
2024	Other	7.The Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal to set compensation that optimizes portfolio value for Company shareholders. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Legal & General Investment Management America, Inc.	Defeated	4.4%	95.1%	0.5%
2024	Employment Discrimination	8.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on respecting workforce civil liberties. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Bowyer Research on behalf of The Bahnsen Family Trust	Defeated	0.5%	99.1%	0.4%
2024	Other	9.The Company's shareholders also voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a review of workplace safety and violence. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Cynthia Murray and her co-filer	Defeated	19.1%	80.6%	0.4%
2024	Other	11.Finally, the Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on corporate financial sustainability. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	The National Center for Public Policy Research	Defeated	0.4%	99.2%	0.4%

**For Shareholder Proposals at AGM's held more than three years ago, please refer to the Screener tool on ESG Manager.*

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DELAWARE



CURRENCY: UNITED STATES DOLLAR (USD)

In the United States, most governance principles are governed by state laws that are not uniform or nationally enforced. However, the majority of states have adopted the Model Business Corporation Act (MBCA) as the basis of their own laws by modifying some of the provisions of the MBCA. The MBCA is a body of laws designed to regulate corporate affairs uniformly across different states. It is the basis for business corporation statutes in 32 states and the District of Columbia and is the source of many provisions in the general corporation statutes of other states. Further, the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) regulates certain governance related matters on a federal level.

The majority of large U.S. businesses are listed on either the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) or the Nasdaq Stock Market (Nasdaq), and therefore are subject to their listing rules. The U.S. has not adopted a national corporate governance code.

Delaware's corporate governance is defined by the General Corporation Law of the State of Delaware (DGCL), with annual updates and revisions by the Delaware legislature based on the recommendations of the Council of the Corporation Law Section of the Delaware State Bar Association. Judicial decisions by the state's Court of Chancery also set governance practice, with appeals heard at the Delaware Supreme Court.

Companies adopt a unitary board structure in the U.S. The NYSE and Nasdaq listing rules require the majority of directors to be independent. The SEC rules require public companies to disclose and explain their chair-CEO structure and whether one or two people hold the roles. If the roles are combined, the company must further disclose whether it has a lead independent director and specify their role within the company leadership.

Unless stated otherwise in the articles of association, directors may appoint inspectors in advance of any shareholder meeting to determine the number of shares outstanding, voting rights, shares represented at the meeting, existence of a quorum, authenticity and validity of proxies, and take all other actions with regards to the annual shareholders' meeting.

Related party transactions (RPTs) are valid if the transaction was conducted on reasonable and fair terms when it was approved, and the RPT is approved in good faith by the majority of independent directors. If the number of independent directors is less than a quorum, then it must be approved by shareholders.

The board of directors may fix director and officer pay, although most companies delegate the responsibility for defining executive pay to independent directors, usually upon the recommendation of the pay or nominating/governance committee. Officers are executive directors that are responsible for the daily management of the company.

The Dodd-Frank Act requires listed companies to hold an advisory vote every three years on "say on pay" policies, as well as disclose additional information regarding "golden parachute" arrangements linked to merger transactions.

Listed companies must annually disclose the pay of directors and officers, including stock and option awards. Disclosure must be made in a tabular format, along with a descriptive summary of the information in the table. Companies listed on Nasdaq must also disclose pay arrangements between directors or nominees and third parties.

The U.S. market is known for having widely dispersed ownership, but founder-led companies are common. There are multiple share classes with unequal voting rights and voting right limits.

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Shareholders with at least 10% voting rights can request to convene a general meeting.

A notice of the meeting, specifying the date, time, place and purpose must be given no less than seven days and no more than 60 days in advance. Special meeting of shareholders may be convened by shareholders owning at least 10% of shares. Typically, each share is entitled to one vote and fractional shares are entitled to proportionate votes. Shareholders do not have preemptive rights unless specifically provided in the bylaws or articles. Dissenting shareholders are entitled to appraisal rights.

Unless otherwise stipulated in the articles, a corporation is not obligated to offer shareholders any shares, option rights or securities when issuing them.

There are no mandatory takeover bid provisions in the U.S.

In 2018, the Delaware enacted a Certification of Adoption of Transparency and Sustainability Standards Act which is a voluntary act broadly enabling entities registered in Delaware to craft a sustainability regime. The Act is primarily a disclosure regime which requires entities to disclose and provide reports regarding their standards and metrics. There are many provisions in the Federal Sarbanes-Oxley Act that govern the audit process. A public company's annual financial statements must be audited by a registered independent auditing firm. Listed companies prepare two annual reports, one for SEC (Form 10-K) and one for their shareholders. The reports to stockholders, as required by SEC, must contain certified financial statements of two-year audited balance sheets, and three-year audited statement of income and cash flows. Directors and officers of the corporation must also be identified. Interim financial statements are not audited, only reviewed by the company's auditors. If an auditor has not reviewed the interim report, it must be accompanied with a notice specifying that the report has not been reviewed by an auditor. Audit firm rotation is not required but lead audit partners are subject to rotation every five years.

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KEY METRIC & SCORE CHANGES

ALL KEY METRIC & SCORE CHANGES (SINCE JUNE 2025)

Key Metric	Key Metric Change	Date	Score Change	Change Notes
Leadership Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.30	
Controlling Shareholder Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.99	
Risk Management Expertise	**Flag Added**	Jun 04, 2026	**-0.20**	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	May 15, 2026	0.25	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	May 15, 2026	**-0.25**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Realized	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
Severance Vesting	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.10	
CEO Equity Changes	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Perks & Other Comp	Flag Removed	Dec 11, 2025	0.20	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	Jul 17, 2025	**-0.25**	
Overboarded Non-Exec Directors	**Flag Added**	Jul 17, 2025	**-0.49**	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	Jul 10, 2025	0.25	

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DIRECTOR PROFILES

CARLA HARRIS

Age:	63	Financial:	No
Gender:	F	Risk:	No
Nationality:	Not Disclosed	Industry:	Financial Services - Capital Markets

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Carla has served as vice chair of Wealth Management and head of Multicultural Client Strategy for Morgan Stanley from August 2013 to December 2021, and continues to serve as senior client advisor since June 2012. Her experience at Morgan Stanley includes increasing client connectivity and penetration to enhance revenue generation across the firm. Carla joined the mergers and acquisitions team at Morgan Stanley in 1987 and since then has held a number of positions during her tenure. Her experiences at Morgan Stanley range from investment banking, equity capital markets, equity private placements and initial public offerings in a number of industries such as technology, media, retail, telecommunications, transportation, health care and biotechnology. In August 2013, President Barack Obama appointed Carla to serve as chair of the National Women's Business Council. She was elected to the board of Cummins Inc. in May 2021 and was appointed to join the board of MetLife, Inc. to become effective in April 2022. She also currently serves on the boards of several nonprofit organizations, including the Mother Cabrini Health Foundation and the Morgan Stanley Foundation, as well as a member of the Board of Overseers for Harvard University. Carla holds an undergraduate degree and an MBA from Harvard University.

CUMMINS INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/02/2026

Ms Harris is Senior Client Advisor at Morgan Stanley a global financial services firm She is a coportfolio manager of the Next Level Fund an advisor to the Multicultural Innovation Lab the host of the podcast Access Opportunities and acts in various client coverage capacities She served as Vice Chair of Wealth Management from 20132021 and Chair of the Morgan Stanley Foundation from 20052014 She joined the merger and acquisitions team at Morgan Stanley in 1987 and had roles of increasing responsibility giving her broad experience in investment banking equity capital markets and equity private placements She covered a wide range of industries including technology media retail telecommunications transportation healthcare and biotechnology In August 2013 Ms Harris was appointed by President Barack Obama to chair the National Womens Business Council Ms Harris has served on the board of Walmart Inc since 2017 and serves on its Compensation and Management Development Nominating and Governance and Strategic Planning and Finance Committees Ms Harris has also served on the board of MetLife Inc since April 2022 and serves on its Investment and Governance and Corporate Responsibility Committees She also serves on the boards of several nonprofit organizations including Hackensack Meridian Health Sponsors for Educational Opportunity SEO Mother Cabrini Health Foundation Sesame Workshop and the Morgan Stanley Foundation Ms Harris holds an MBA from Harvard Business School and an AB from Harvard College Summary of Qualifications Skills and Experience Ms Harris brings senior leadership experience in finance strategy and risk management from her 38year career at a global investment banking firm Ms Harris contributes insights on highly regulated industries and international operations through her directorships at two Fortune 500 companies She offers perspectives gained from her career experience in increasing client connectivity and penetration to enhance revenue generation As an author of three books on leadership Ms Harris offers insights on talent development and retention

METLIFE, INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/29/2026

Carla A. Harris, Director since 2022; Independent With more than 30 years of experience as a senior leader of a global financial services firm, Ms. Harris has a keen understanding of both enhancing client connectivity and generating revenue through the capital markets. During her time at Morgan Stanley, Ms. Harris has gained insight into a wide-range of industries including the technology, media, retail, telecommunications, transportation, industrial, and healthcare sectors. Ms. Harris also brings critical portfolio management skills to the Board and the Company, which will support the Company in its commitment to accelerating growth in its asset management business. As a published author on leadership, award-winning podcaster on access and opportunity, public speaker and widely recognized leader of efforts to promote equity and inclusion, Ms. Harris contributes significant expertise to the Board's oversight of the Company's succession plans for the CEO and for the Company's other executive officers, as well as the Company's sustainability strategy. MetLife Board Committees:

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Executive Committee Governance and Corporate Responsibility Investment (Chair) Professional Highlights: Morgan Stanley, a multinational investment bank and financial services firm Senior Client Advisor (2021 – Present) Vice Chairman, Managing Director, Senior Client Advisor, Head of Multicultural Client Strategy (2012 – 2021) Other senior positions focused on mergers and acquisitions, equity capital markets, and asset management (1987 – 2012) Other U.S. Listed Public Company Directorships: Cummins Inc. (2021 - Present) Walmart, Inc. (2017 - Present) Education: A.B. and M.B.A., Harvard University

HACKENSACK MERIDIAN HEALTH, INC. - Board Member Source Date: 07/15/2024

Carla Harris is a Senior Client Advisor at Morgan Stanley. She was most recently a Vice Chairman responsible for increasing client connectivity and penetration to enhance revenue generation across the firm. She formerly headed the Emerging Manager Platform, the equity capital markets effort for the consumer and retail industries and was responsible for Equity Private Placements. In her 30+ year career, Ms. Harris has had extensive industry experiences in the technology, media, retail, telecommunications, transportation, industrial, and healthcare sectors. In August 2013, Carla Harris was appointed by President Barack Obama to chair the National Women's Business Council. For more than a decade, Ms. Harris was a senior member of the equity syndicate desk and executed such transactions as initial public offerings for UPS, Martha Stewart Living Omnimedia, Ariba, Redback, the General Motors sub-IPO of Delphi Automotive, and the $3.2 Billion common stock transaction for Immunex Corporation, one of the largest biotechnology common stock transactions in U.S. history.

Prior to joining Morgan Stanley, Carla received an MBA from Harvard Business School and an AB in economics from Harvard University. Carla has also received Honorary Doctorates of Laws, Humanities and Business from Marymount Manhattan College, Bloomfield College, Converse College, Jacksonville University, Simmons College, the College of New Rochelle, St. Thomas Aquinas College, Babson College and Fisk University, Wake Forest University and Felician University respectively. Carla Harris is actively involved in her community. She is the past Chair of the Board of the Morgan Stanley Foundation and of The Executive Leadership Council, and sits on the boards of Sponsors for Educational Opportunity (SEO), The Sesame Workshop, Mother Cabrini Health Foundation and is an active member of the St. Charles Gospelites of the St. Charles Borromeo Catholic Church and the Mark Howell Singers. She is a member of the board of overseers of Harvard University and of the board of directors of the Walmart Corporation, Cummins Corporation and MetLife.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
HACKENSACK MERIDIAN HEALTH, INC.	Board Member	1	Oct 09, 2024		Yes	Yes	
METLIFE, INC.	Board Member	4	Apr 27, 2022		Yes	Yes	
CUMMINS INC.	Board Member	5	May 11, 2021		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	9	Jun 02, 2017		Yes	Yes	

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BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
CUMMINS INC.	Pay	Member
CUMMINS INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
CUMMINS INC.	Nomination	Member
METLIFE, INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
METLIFE, INC.	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Pay	Chair
WALMART INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
WALMART INC.	Nomination	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
CUMMINS INC.	2026	93.9%	6.2%
METLIFE, INC.	2026	96.5%	3.5%
WALMART INC.	2026	97.3%	2.7%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
CUMMINS INC.	Non-Executive	5	2025	160,000	381,909	3,502
METLIFE, INC.	Non-Executive	4	2025	175,000	351,785	7,057
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	9	2026	131,429	361,439	50,098

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CESAR CONDE

Age:	52	Financial:	No
Gender:	M	Risk:	No
Nationality:	Not Disclosed	Industry:	Media & Entertainment - Media

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Cesar Conde iAs Chairman of NBCUniversal News Group, Cesar Conde oversees the nation's largest news media organization. It includes NBC News, NBC News NOW, NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises Group and NBCUniversal Local. Under Conde's leadership, the News Group reaches about seven in 10 American adults each month across its English and Spanish language broadcast, cable, streaming and digital platforms. It became the nation's number one digital news organization after making substantial investments in digital and streaming offerings. NBC News NOW, its 24/7streaming network, is the fastest-growing streaming news network in the United States and continues to achieve record-breaking viewership numbers, along with significant domestic and international distribution growth. Conde previously served as Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group and NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises. As Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group, he was responsible for the operations and international expansion of NBCUniversal businesses outside of North America. As Chairman of NBCU Telemundo Enterprises, Conde oversaw the leading media properties to serve Hispanics worldwide. He was instrumental in building NBCU Telemundo Enterprises into a world-class media company, producing and distributing high-quality Spanish-language content across a range of broadcast, cable and digital properties. Conde repositioned Telemundo to become the premier Spanish-language network, propelling the network to rank number one for the first time in its history in primetime among key consumer demographics. In 2013, Conde joined NBCUniversal as executive vice president of NBCU International and NBCU Digital Enterprises. He previously served as president of Univision Networks. He is credited with transforming the Spanish-language media company into a leading global, multi-platform media brand. Conde served as a White House fellow for Secretary of State Colin L. Powell from 2002 to 2003. He also worked for StarMedia Network, the first internet company focused on Spanish and Portuguese-speaking audiences globally, and in the Mergers & Acquisitions Group at Salomon Smith Barney. Conde serves on the board of directors of Walmart (NYSE: WMT) and PepsiCo (NASDAQ: PEP). He is a board member at the Council on Foreign Relations and a trustee of the Paley Center for Media. He holds a B.A. with honors from Harvard University and an M.B.A. from the Wharton School at the University of Pennsylvania.

PEPSICO, INC. - Board Member Source Date: 03/27/2026

Cesar Conde has served as Chairman of the NBCUniversal News Group part of a global media and entertainment company since 2020 In this role Mr Conde has oversight of NBC News MSNBC CNBC Telemundo and NBCU Local From 2015 to 2020 Mr Conde served as Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group and NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises From 2013 to 2015 he served as Executive Vice President at NBCUniversal where he oversaw NBCUniversal International and NBCUniversal Digital Enterprises From 2009 to 2013 Mr Conde served as President of Univision Networks a leading American media company with a portfolio of Spanish language television networks radio stations and digital platforms From 2003 to 2009 Mr Conde served in a variety of senior executive capacities at Univision Networks and is credited with transforming it into a leading global multiplatform media brand Prior to Univision Mr Conde served as the White House Fellow for Secretary of State Colin L Powell from 2002 to 2003 Mr Conde also currently serves on the boards of several nonprofit organizations including the Council on Foreign Relations and The Aspen Institute Other Public Company Directorships Current Walmart Inc Previous During Past 5 Years Owens Corning until 2019 Skills and Qualifications Mr Conde is an experienced global executive with a strong track record in business finance and media He provides our Board of Directors with diverse and actionable perspectives on todays consumer and media landscapes and his unique insights are particularly valuable as PepsiCo continues to build new omnichannel marketing capabilities and adapt to changing demographics around the world Mr Conde also brings his market and consumer insights developed through his experience at national and global media companies and his leadership of social and corporate responsibility initiatives worldwide

RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION - Board Member Source Date: 06/18/2026

Mr. Conde has been a director of the Company since January 2026. Mr. Conde has served as Chairman of the NBCUniversal News Group, part of a global media and entertainment company, since 2020. From 2015 to 2020, Mr. Conde served as Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group and NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises. From 2013 to 2015, he served as Executive Vice President at NBCUniversal, where he oversaw NBCUniversal International and NBCUniversal Digital Enterprises. From 2009 to 2013, Mr. Conde served as President of Univision Networks, a leading media company with a portfolio of Spanish language television networks, radio stations and digital platforms. From 2003 to 2009, Mr. Conde served in a variety of senior executive capacities at Univision Networks and is credited with transforming it into a leading global, multi-platform media brand. Prior to Univision, Mr. Conde served as the White House Fellow for Secretary of State

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Colin L. Powell from 2002 to 2003. Mr. Conde serves as a member of the Board of Directors of PepsiCo and Walmart, both public companies. Mr. Conde also currently serves on the boards of several non-profit organizations, including the Council on Foreign Relations. Mr. Conde holds a Bachelors of Arts from Harvard University and a Master of Business Administration from the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania. Mr. Conde is an experienced global executive with a strong track record in business, finance and media. Mr. Conde also brings his market and consumer insights developed through his experience at national and global media companies and his leadership of social and corporate responsibility initiatives worldwide

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION	Board Member		Jan 15, 2026		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	7	Jun 05, 2019		Yes	Yes	
PEPSICO, INC.	Board Member	10	May 04, 2016		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
PEPSICO, INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
PEPSICO, INC.	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Audit	Member
WALMART INC.	Risk	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
PEPSICO, INC.	2026	94.7%	5.3%
RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION	2026	100%	0%
WALMART INC.	2026	99.2%	0.8%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
PEPSICO, INC.	Non-Executive	10	2025	160,000	360,000	18,444
RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION	Non-Executive		2026	26,250	26,250	10
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	7	2026	108,571	338,581	31,588

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GREGORY (GREG) PENNER

Age: 56
Gender: M
Nationality: United States of America

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail - Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail,Financial Services - Capital Markets

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member, Chairman Source Date: 04/23/2026

Greg Penner is CEO and an owner of the Denver Broncos. He is a founder and general partner of Madrone Capital Partners, a private investment management firm. He is also chairman of the Walmart Board of Directors since 2015. Greg is only the third person, after his father-in-law, Rob Walton, and company founder, Sam Walton, to serve in this position. Prior to being elected chairman of the Board, Greg worked in several capacities at Walmart over a 20-year period, including as senior vice president and chief financial officer for the business in Japan, and senior vice president of finance and strategy for Walmart.com. He was first elected as a Walmart Board member in 2008, and in the years since, he served as a member on the Strategic Planning and Finance Committee and as chairman of the Technology and eCommerce Committee. Before joining Walmart, Greg was a financial analyst at Goldman Sachs & Co. and a general partner of Peninsula Capital. He also served as a member of the boards of directors of Baidu, Inc., from 2004 to 2017, and Hyatt Hotels Corporation from 2007 to 2014. Greg earned a Bachelor of Science in international economics from Georgetown University in 1992 and a Master of Business Administration from the Stanford Graduate School of Business in 1997.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member, Chairman	18	Jan 01, 2008		No	No	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	97.2%	2.8%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Chair	18	2026	221,071	563,539	259,257

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JOHN FURNER

Age: 52
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: No
Risk: No
Industry: Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail - Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Executive, Board Member, CEO Source Date: 04/23/2026

John Furner serves as president and chief executive officer of Walmart U.S., where he leads more than 1.5 million associates and is responsible for the strategic direction and performance of Walmart's 4,700 stores, as well as its website, app and supply chain. From 2017-2019, John served as president and chief executive officer of Sam's Club. During his time as CEO, Sam's Club had 11 consecutive quarters of positive sales comps, while increasing memberships. John started with Walmart as an hourly associate in 1993, at Store 100 in Bentonville, Arkansas. He has held important roles throughout the company, including assistant store manager, store manager, district manager, buyer, regional general manager, divisional merchandising manager, VP of global sourcing, general merchandise manager, head of marketing and merchandising for Walmart China based in Shenzhen, and chief merchant for Sam's Club. He serves on the board of directors for the National Retail Federation and was chairman from 2022 to 2025. John has a bachelor of science in marketing management from the University of Arkansas.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Executive, Board Member, CEO		Nov 13, 2025		No	Yes	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	99.3%	0.7%

EXECUTIVE PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Total Annual Pay	Total Awarded Pay	Total Realized Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	CEO		2026	5,083,606	27,343,149	43,954,406	342,311

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MARISSA MAYER

Age:	50
Gender:	F
Nationality:	Not Disclosed
Financial:	No
Risk:	No
Industry:	Software & Services - Internet Software & Services,Household & Personal Products - Personal Care Products

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Marissa A. Mayer is the co-founder and CEO of Sunshine Products (formerly Lumi Labs, Inc.), a technology startup focused on making everyday tasks, like contact management or scheduling, magical. From July 2012 through June 2017, she served as president, chief executive officer and a member of the board of directors of Yahoo Inc. (Yahoo,now Altaba, Inc.). At Yahoo, she led the internet giant's push to reinvent itself for the mobile era. With a renewed focus on user experience, Marissa grew Yahoo to serve over 1 billion people worldwide — with more than 600 million mobile users and transformed its advertising approach. Prior to her role at Yahoo, Marissa spent 13 years at Google, Inc.Google where she led various initiatives, including Google Search, for more than a decade and other products such as Google Maps, Gmail and Google News. She holds a bachelor's degree in symbolic systems and a master's degree in computer science from Stanford University. From March 2013 until October 2016, she served on the board of directors for AliphCom, which operates as Jawbone. She also serves on the boards of Go Forward, a company that combines virtual and in-person primary care practice, as well as Maisonette, an online company focused on providing customized shopping experiences in children’s luxury brands and boutique clothing, accessory, and home décor items. In addition, she serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet and previously served on the foundation board for the Forum of Young Global Leaders at the World Economic Forum.

AT&T INC. - Board Member Source Date: 03/23/2026

Ms. Mayer has served as Chief Executive Officer of Sunshine Products (a technology startup company based in Palo Alto, California that uses artificial intelligence to develop consumer-facing applications for automating everyday tasks) since she co-founded the company in 2018. She previously served as Chief Executive Officer, President and a member of the Board of Directors of Yahoo!, Inc. from 2012 to 2017. Before joining Yahoo!, Ms. Mayer spent 13 years at Google, Inc., from 1999 to 2012, where she held various roles of increasing responsibility including Vice President, Local, Maps and Locations Services, and Vice President, Search Products and User Experience. She has served on the board of Walmart Inc. since 2012 and Nextdoor, Inc. since May 2024. In addition, she serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet and previously served on the foundation board for the Forum of Young Global Leaders at the World Economic Forum. Ms. Mayer holds a bachelor’s degree in symbolic systems and a master’s degree in computer science with a specialization in artificial intelligence from Stanford University. Skills and Qualifications Ms. Mayer brings extensive expertise in technology and a deep understanding of the consumer Internet experience. She has senior leadership and human capital management experience through her CEO role at Yahoo!. As a long tenured director of Walmart Inc., she brings valuable experience in the oversight of a large publicly traded retail and ecommerce business.

STARBUCKS CORPORATION - Board Member Source Date: 01/26/2026

MARISSA MAYER is Chief Executive Officer of Dazzle Al a technology startup company based in Palo Alto California that uses artificial intelligence to develop consumer facing applications for automating everyday tasks She previously served as Chief Executive Officer at Sunshine Al from 2018 to 2025 She previously served as Chief Executive Officer President and a member of the Board of Directors of Yahoo Inc from 2012 to 2017 At Yahoo she led a transformation of the company rejuvenating its culture growing to more than 1 billion users worldwide and reinventing Yahoos business Before joining Yahoo Ms Mayer spent 13 years at Google Inc from 1999 to 2012 as an early employee and the first woman engineer For more than a decade she led product management for Google Search Google Maps Google News and other consumer products holding various roles of increasing responsibility including Vice President Local Maps and Location Services and Vice President Search Products and User Experience She is on the boards of Walmart Hilton ATT and Sunshine Products Inc and also serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet She previously served on the boards of Nextdoor private companies Maisonette and Forward Health and on the foundation board for the Forum of Young Global Leaders at the World Economic Forum Ms Mayer holds a bachelors degree in Symbolic Systems with a concentration in artificial intelligence and a masters degree in computer science with a focus on artificial intelligence both from Stanford University Committees Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee

HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/02/2026

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Marissa Mayer joined the Hilton board in May 2025. She is the CEO and Founder of Dazzle AI, a Palo Alto-based technology company focused in the consumer artificial intelligence space. Her leadership at Dazzle follows a seven-year tenure as CEO of Sunshine Products, which was acquired by Dazzle AI in 2025. A seasoned veteran of the technology industry, Ms. Mayer previously served as CEO, President, and Director of Yahoo!, Inc. (2012–2017). Prior to her time at Yahoo!, she was one of Google's earliest employees and its first female engineer. During her 13-year tenure at Google, she rose to Vice President of Search and User Experience, leading the search business for over a decade and overseeing the development of flagship products including Google Maps, Google News, and Gmail. She has served on the board of Walmart Inc. since 2012. At Walmart, she has served on the Compensation and Management Development Committee, the Strategic Planning and Finance Committee, and the Technology and E-Commerce Committee. She has served on the boards of AT&T Inc. since 2024 and Starbucks since 2025. She serves on AT&T's Audit Committee and the Corporate Development and Finance Committee as well as Starbucks' Nomination and Governance Committee. She also serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet. Ms. Mayer holds a bachelor's degree in Symbolic Systems with a concentration in artificial intelligence and a master's degree in Computer Science with a specialization in artificial intelligence, both from Stanford University.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Board Member	1	Jun 25, 2025		Yes	Yes	
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	Board Member	1	May 14, 2025		Yes	Yes	
AT&T INC.	Board Member	2	Mar 01, 2024		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	14	Apr 16, 2012		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
AT&T INC.	Audit	Member
AT&T INC.	Risk	Member
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	Pay	Member
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Corporate Governance	Member
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Pay	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
AT&T INC.	2026	98.4%	1.6%
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	2026	99.1%	0.9%
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	2026	99%	1%
WALMART INC.	2026	99%	1%

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DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
AT&T INC.	Non-Executive	2	2025	140,000	370,429	28,869
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	Non-Executive	1	2025	55,000	289,784	930
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Non-Executive	1	2025		220,784	2,359
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	14	2026	108,571	338,581	130,950

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RANDALL STEPHENSON

Age: 66
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Telecommunication Services - Diversified Telecommunication Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member, Lead Director Source Date: 04/23/2026

Randall retired in January of 2021 as executive chairman of the board of AT&T Inc. Prior to that he was chairman of the board and chief executive officer of AT&T and served in that capacity from 2007 until July 2020, having also served as president from 2007 through September 2019. He held a variety of high-level finance, operational and marketing positions with AT&T, including serving as chief operating officer from 2004 until his appointment as chief executive officer in 2007 and as chief financial officer from 2001 to 2004. He began his career with AT&T in 1982. Randall received his B.S. in accounting from Central State University (now known as the University of Central Oklahoma) and earned his Master of Accountancy degree from the University of Oklahoma. He has served on the board of directors of Boy Scouts of America since 2005, including as chairman of the board from 2016 to 2018, and the PGA Tour since 2012. He was chairman of the Business Roundtable from 2014 to 2016.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member, Lead Director	5	Mar 03, 2021		Yes	Yes	
AT&T INC.	Executive		Jun 01, 2005	Jan 21, 2020	No	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
WALMART INC.	Pay	Member
WALMART INC.	Corporate Governance	Chair
WALMART INC.	Nomination	Chair

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	96.1%	3.9%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Lead Director	5	2026	156,429	386,852	65,029

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ROBERT (BOB) MORITZ JR.

Age:	62
Gender:	M
Nationality:	Not Disclosed
Financial:	Yes
Risk:	No
Industry:	Commercial & Professional Services - Professional Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Bob Moritz is the former global chair of PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC), a professional services network providing audit, tax, consulting and deals services around the world. In his role, Bob led the international network's leadership teams, set strategy and enhanced the brand of PwC through quality service to their stakeholders. Bob spent 39 years with PwC, joining in 1985 and becoming a partner in 1995. He has an audit and assurance background, primarily dealing with financial services, banking and capital markets clients. During the course of his career, Bob spent three years with PwC Japan, working with European and U.S.-based financial services companies operating in Asia. Prior to taking on the global role, Bob led the U.S. firm of PwC as its chairman and senior partner for seven years. In addition to spending a career focused on the principles of shared value, Bob holds several board seats, including SUNY-Oswego College Foundation, his alma mater.

S&P GLOBAL INC. - Board Member Source Date: 03/31/2026

Robert Moritz Former Global Chairman PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP Robert Moritz was the Global Chairman of PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP PwC where he served from 2016 to 2024 Mr Moritz is currently a member of the Board of Directors of Walmart where he sits on the Audit and Technology and eCommerce Committees and Northern Trust Corporation where he sits on the Audit and Human Capital and Compensation Committees In his role as Global Chairman of PwC from 2016 2024 Mr Moritz led the international networks leadership teams set strategy and enhanced the brand of PwC through quality service to their stakeholders Mr Moritz spent 39 years with PwC joining in 1985 and becoming a partner in 1995 He has an audit and assurance background primarily dealing with financial services banking and capital markets clients During the course of his career Mr Moritz spent three years with PwC Japan working with European and US based financial services companies operating in Asia Prior to taking on the global role Mr Moritz led the US firm of PwC as its Chairman and Senior Partner for seven years In addition to spending a career focused on the principles of shared value Mr Moritz holds several not for profit board seats including Generation Unlimited and SUNY Oswego College Foundation his alma mater Committee Membership Audit Committee Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Board Member		Feb 01, 2026		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	2	Aug 15, 2024		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Audit	Member
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Nomination	Member
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Risk	Member
WALMART INC.	Audit	Chair
WALMART INC.	Risk	Chair

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VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
S&P GLOBAL INC.	2026	99.6%	0.4%
WALMART INC.	2026	99%	1%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	2	2026	108,751	339,604	11,807

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SARAH FRIAR

Age: 53
Gender: F
Nationality: United States of America

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Software & Services - Software,Media & Entertainment - Interactive Media & Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Sarah Friar is the chief financial officer of OpenAI, where she oversees the company's financial strategy and operations. From December 2018 to May 2024, Sarah was chief executive officer of Nextdoor, the neighborhood network that connects neighborhood stakeholders, including neighbors, businesses, and public services, online and in real life to build stronger, more vibrant, and resilient neighborhoods. She helped take Nextdoor public in 2021 under the ticker NYSE:KIND. Prior to Nextdoor, Sarah served as chief financial officer at Square (now known as Block, Inc.). Under Sarah's leadership, the company launched its initial public offering in 2015 and added $30 billion in market capitalization. Before her tenure at Square, Sarah served as senior vice president of finance & strategy at Salesforce. Sarah also held executive roles at Goldman Sachs, as well as leadership positions at McKinsey in both London and South Africa. Sarah currently also serves on the board of Consensys, a private company in the Web3 arena, and she previously served on the boards of Slack Technologies (from 2017 to 2021), Dragonneer Growth Opportunities Corp. (from 2020 to 2021), Dragonneer Growth Opportunities Corp. II (from 2020 to 2021), Dragonneer Growth Opportunities Corp. III (from 2021 to 2023), and New Relic (from 2013 to 2018). She is a Fellow of the inaugural class of the Finance Leaders Fellowship Program, a member of the Aspen Global Leadership Network, and serves on the advisory boards of Operation HOPE, the Blavatnik School of Government at Oxford and The Stanford Digital Economy Lab. She is co-founder of Ladies Who Launch, a network that mentors and inspires women entrepreneurs and business owners. She was named to the 2023 NACD Directorship 100 selection, an annual recognition of the leading corporate directors, corporate governance experts, policymakers, and influencers who significantly impact boardroom practices and performance. Sarah grew up in Northern Ireland and earned her MEng in Metallurgy, Economics, and Management from the University of Oxford and her MBA from the Stanford University Graduate School of Business, where she graduated as an Arjay Miller scholar.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
Nextdoor Holdings, Inc.	Executive		Nov 01, 2021	May 08, 2024	No	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	8	Feb 07, 2018		Yes	Yes	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	99.8%	0.2%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	8	2026	131,429	361,439	60,007

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SHISHIR MEHROTRA

Age: 46
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: No
Risk: No
Industry: Technology Hardware & Equipment - Electronic Equipment, Instruments & Components,Software & Services - Internet Software & Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Shishir Mehrotra is a 25+ year technology veteran with a track record of building category-defining platforms. Prior to joining Superhuman, he was the CEO and co-founder of Coda, a productivity and AI platform that grew to serve millions of users and tens of thousands of teams. Before founding Coda, Mehrotra served as YouTube's Chief Product Officer and Chief Technology Officer, helping grow YouTube into the world's largest video destination and one of Google's largest and fastest-growing businesses, as well as a platform of choice for a new generation of creators. He holds a dual bachelor of science degree in mathematics and computer science from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A. - Board Member Source Date: 02/10/2026

Shishir Mehrotra is a member of our board of directors. He has been a member of our board of directors since June 13, 2017, and his term will expire on the date of the general meeting of shareholders to be held to approve the annual accounts of 2024. Mr. Mehrotra previously served as our Strategic Advisor to the Chief Executive Officer from December 2015 to May 2017. Mr. Mehrotra is the CEO of Grammarly, Inc. Previously, he was the CEO and Co-Founder of Coda, Inc., which was acquired by Grammarly, Inc. Mr. Mehrotra has previously served as Chief Product and Technology Officer for YouTube at Google and Director of Program Management at Microsoft. Mr. Mehrotra holds a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and a Bachelor of Science in Mathematics from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member		Jan 08, 2026		Yes	Yes	
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	Board Member	9	Jun 13, 2017		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	Pay	Member
WALMART INC.	Pay	Member

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VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	2026	95.9%	4.1%
WALMART INC.	2026	99.4%	0.6%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	Non-Executive	9	2025	0	642,406	55,749
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive		2026	0	93,283	1,286

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STEUART WALTON

Age: 44
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: No
Risk: No
Industry: Capital Goods - Aerospace & Defense,Financial Services - Capital Markets

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Steuart Walton is the founder and chairman of RZC Investments, an investment business located in Bentonville, Arkansas. He is also founder and former chief executive officer of Game Composites, a U.S. manufacturer of carbon fiber aircraft and aircraft parts. He is also the co-founder of Runway Group, a holding company that makes investments in real estate, outdoor initiatives, and hospitality. Steuart serves as a director of Rapha Racing Limited, a cycling apparel business, and is active in the governance and operations of many of his family's enterprises. He is a board member of Crystal Bridges Museum of American Art, Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum and Leadership for Education Equity. He has a law degree from Georgetown and previously worked at Allen and Overy, and he also worked as a Walmart associate on the mergers and acquisitions team while living in London.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member	10	Jun 03, 2016		No	No	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	99.3%	0.7%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	10	2026	131,429	361,439	80,209

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THOMAS (TOM) HORTON

Age:	65	Financial:	Yes
Gender:	M	Risk:	No
Nationality:	United States of America	Industry:	Telecommunication Services - Diversified Telecommunication Services,Transportation - Passenger Airlines

FLAGGED DIRECTOR

Mr. Horton is designated a 'flagged director' due to his involvement with the board of AMR Corporation, which filed for Chapter 11 Bankruptcy in November 2011.

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Tom is a partner at Global Infrastructure Partners, a global infrastructure investment firm. He previously served as senior advisor at Warburg Pincus LLC, a private equity firm focused on growth investing. He was the chairman of American Airlines Group, Inc., from 2013 to 2014. He was chairman, president and chief executive officer of American Airlines, Inc., and AMR Corporation from 2011 to 2013, after being named president of American in 2010. During that time, he led American through a successful restructuring and turnaround that culminated in the merger with US Airways, creating the world's largest airline. Previously, he served as executive vice president of finance and planning of AMR and American from 2006 to 2010, and vice chairman and chief financial officer of AT&T Corporation from 2002 to 2005. Prior to joining AT&T, he was senior vice president and chief financial officer of AMR from 2000 to 2002 and served in numerous management positions with AMR since 1985. He joined American Airlines from international accounting partnership firm Peat Marwick & Company, which is now known as KPMG. He earned a master's degree in business administration from the Cox School of Business at Southern Methodist University and a bachelor's degree in accounting from Baylor University, where he graduated magna cum laude. He has served as a director of General Electric Company since April 2018, and he previously served on the boards of Qualcomm Incorporated (from 2008 to 2019) and EnLink Midstream (from 2019 to 2022). He also serves on the executive board of the Cox School of Business at SMU.

CHEVRON CORPORATION - Board Member Source Date: 04/07/2026

Thomas W. Horton, is a partner at Global Infrastructure Partners, a global infrastructure investment firm, a position he has held since April 2019. From 2015 to 2019, he was a senior advisor at Warburg Pincus. He was the chairman of American Airlines Group, Inc. from 2013 to 2014, and served as chairman, president, and chief executive officer of American Airlines, Inc. and AMR Corporation from 2011 to 2013, after being named president of American in 2010. Prior to that, he served as executive vice president of finance and planning of American Airlines and AMR Corporation from 2006 to 2010. He was vice chairman and chief financial officer of AT&T Corporation from 2002 to 2005. He has served as a director of Walmart Inc. since 2014 and as a director of General Electric Company (operating as GE Aerospace) since 2018.

GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY - Board Member, Lead Director Source Date: 03/12/2026

Thomas W. Horton - Partner, Global Infrastructure Partners, an infrastructure investment fund, New York, NY (since 2019). PRIOR BUSINESS EXPERIENCE: Senior Advisor, Warburg Pincus LLC, a private equity firm focused on growth investing (2015–2019); Chairman, American Airlines Group, one of the largest global airlines (formed following the merger of AMR Corporation and US Airways) (2013–2014); Chairman and CEO, American Airlines (2011–2014); Chairman and CEO, AMR (parent company of American Airlines) (2010–2013); EVP and CFO, AMR (2006–2010); Vice Chairman and CFO, AT&T (2002–2006); SVP and CFO, AMR (2000–2002); joined AMR in 1985, serving in various finance and management roles. CURRENT PUBLIC COMPANY BOARDS: General Electric; Walmart (lead director). PAST PUBLIC COMPANY BOARDS: Qualcomm; EnLink Midstream. OTHER POSITIONS: Executive Board Member, Cox School of Business, Southern Methodist University. EDUCATION: Baylor University; MBA, Southern Methodist University.

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CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
CHEVRON CORPORATION	Board Member		Jan 27, 2026		Yes	Yes	
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Board Member, Lead Director	8	Apr 25, 2018		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	11	Nov 21, 2014		Yes	Yes	
AMERICAN AIRLINES GROUP INC.	Executive		Nov 29, 2011	Jun 04, 2014	No	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
CHEVRON CORPORATION	Audit	Member
CHEVRON CORPORATION	Risk	Member
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Corporate Governance	Chair
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Nomination	Chair
WALMART INC.	Audit	Member
WALMART INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
WALMART INC.	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Risk	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
CHEVRON CORPORATION	2026	98.4%	1.6%
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	2026	95.7%	4.3%
WALMART INC.	2026	98.2%	1.8%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Lead Director	8	2025	191,467	393,392	1,172
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	11	2026	138,571	368,796	57,913

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REGULATORY DISCLOSURES

Factor	Value
Governance Metrics Score - Solicited Status (EU Reg. 2024/3005 disclosures)	No
Governance Metrics Score - Informed Status (EU Reg. 2024/3005 disclosures)	No
Governance Metrics - major new information status (EU Reg. 2024/3005 disclosures)	No

EU REGULATION 2024/3005 - DISCLOSURE INFORMATION

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

Retail - Food & Staples | US

MSCI ESG RATINGS

AA

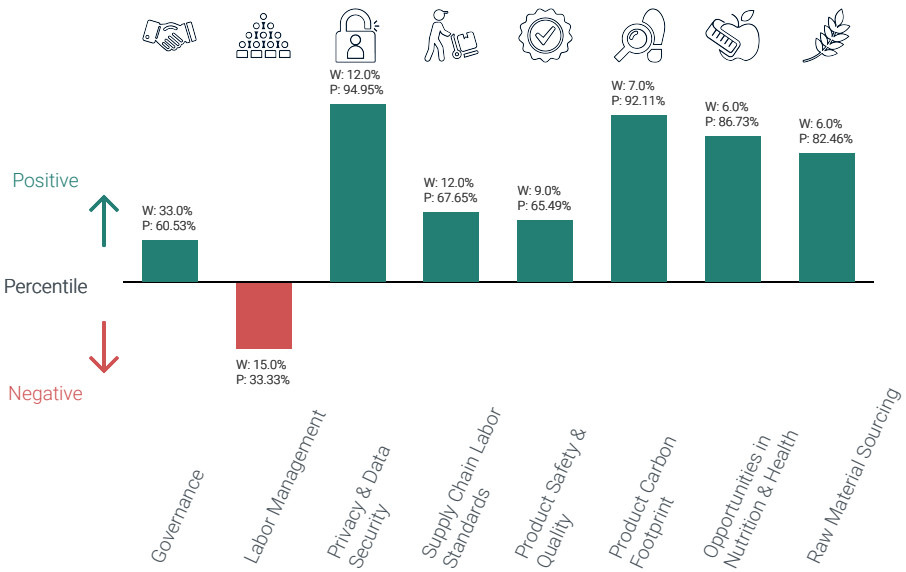
CCC	B	BB	BBB	A	AA	AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Regulatory Disclosures

Key issue scores vs ESG industry mean

This chart highlights the company's positioning relative to the ESG industry median (50%) for each Key Issue that contributed to its ESG Rating as of November 02, 2026.



50% Base line

W: Key Issue weight

P: Key Issue score percentile

Company-specific key issues without peer scores for comparison are not included in this chart.

Last ESG Rating action

Rating action date: October 29, 2026

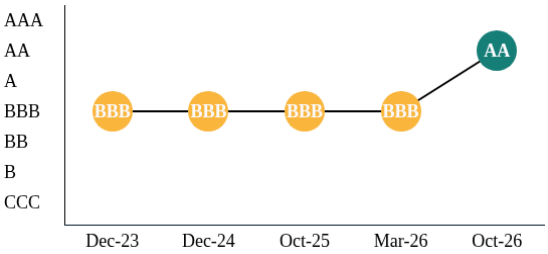
Walmart has been upgraded to 'AA' from 'BBB'.

Walmart's rating was revised in October 2026 after correcting data errors that resulted in an incorrect rating assessment in March 2026. Our recent assessment indicates that the current chairman did not previously serve as the company's CFO. Also, while it is a controlled company, it has implemented measures to support minority investors' representation. Further, we have reassessed the company's supply chain grievance mechanisms and data security practices. These factors drive the upgrade.

- Walmart outsources private-label production to third-party manufacturers in regions where our model suggests a high incidence of labor rights issues. Our recent assessment indicates that it has a supplier-accessible grievance mechanism with safeguards. Aso, it conducts labor audits of key suppliers and monitors corrective actions. Yet, it continues to face allegations of sourcing from suppliers potentially using forced labor.
- Walmart leads peers in managing risks linked to customer data protection. Aside from vulnerability assessments and periodic audits, we note that the company's data protection policy covers all relevant business lines and it has data protection programs covering suppliers.
- Walmart's large workforce may pose potential labor management challenges, per our model. It offers career advancement opportunities to both part- and full-time employees. Yet, we note that it continues to face allegations of low pay, inadequate benefits, and gender discrimination, unlike leading peers.

Disclaimer: The ESG Rating action and ESG Rating summary highlight key elements of the company's ESG Rating. AI tools were used in drafting the ESG Rating action and ESG Rating summary. While efforts are made to ensure accuracy, such tools may introduce errors

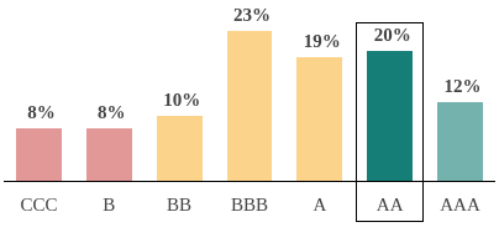
ESG Rating history



ESG Rating history shows five most recent rating actions

ESG Rating distribution

Universe: MSCI ESG Ratings, Retail - Food & Staples, n=115



Key scores

	Weight	Score (0-10)
Industry-Adjusted Score (Last Updated: October 29, 2026)		7.87
Weighted-Average Key Issue Score (Last updated: October 29, 2026)		5.5
Environmental Pillar Score	13%	6.6
Social Pillar Score	54%	4.9
Governance Pillar Score	33%	6.1

Report table of contents

ESG Rating tearsheet		Data report	
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Corporate governance summary	P05	Key issue details	P36
ESG Rating drill down	P06	Appendix	P66
		Glossary	P116

What is an ESG Rating? MSCI ESG Ratings aim to measure a company's resilience to long-term ESG risks. Companies are scored on an industry-relative AAA-CCC scale across the most relevant Key Issues based on a company's business model.

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or omissions. In the event of any discrepancies between the ESG Rating action or ESG Rating summary and the underlying ESG Rating, the underlying ESG Rating prevails.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

ESG Rating scorecard

As of November 02, 2026

KEY ISSUE	WEIGHT	INDUSTRY AVERAGE	SCORE (0-10)	CHANGE
Weighted-Average Key Issue Score		**4.7**	**5.5**	
ENVIRONMENT	**13%**	**3.5**	**6.6**	
Product Carbon Footprint	7%	3.6	7.8	
Raw Material Sourcing	6%	3.3	5.2	
SOCIAL	**54%**	**4.6**	**4.9**	
Labor Management	15%	3.8	2.6	
Privacy & Data Security	12%	4.6	7.0	
Supply Chain Labor Standards	12%	3.8	4.6	
Product Safety & Quality	9%	6.3	6.8	
Opportunities in Nutrition & Health	6%	3.1	4.2	
GOVERNANCE	**33%**	**5.6**	**6.1**	
Corporate Governance		6.3	7.8	
Corporate Behavior		6.2	4.6	

* denotes company-specific Key Issue
This table shows the Key Issue scores and weights contributing to the company's ESG Rating and any changes to those scores since the last ESG Rating action. The range of possible scores is 0-10, where 10 is best and 0 is worst.

Rating model details

Walmart was rated based on the Retail - Food & Staples ESG Rating model.

MODEL VERSION: 5.0.2

Represents the MSCI ESG Ratings model version used to assess the company. Please refer to the "ESG Ratings Methodology" document for more details on the model versions.

EU Regulation 2024/3005 - Disclosure Information

Information on whether the rated entity solicited an ESG rating from MSCI Sustainability & Climate and whether the rated entity was informed in accordance with MSCI's Prior Notification Policy by MSCI Sustainability & Climate that it would be rated for the first time under the ESG Ratings methodology.

ESG Ratings - solicited status (EU Reg. 2024/3005 disclosures): No
ESG Ratings - informed status (EU Reg. 2024/3005 disclosures): No

Ratings-related data feedback in last 12 months

Data feedback in last 12 months? No
Date of last feedback Sep 2025

This section only captures inputs provided by companies through our online issuer portal that may have an impact on the weighted Key Issues for the company — regardless of whether they were accepted per our rules-based review. Issuers are welcome to share data feedback at any time throughout the year.

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Most recent controversies

Last update	Headline	Assessment	Type
Oct-26	Taiwan: Investigation revealed alleged labor rights abuses involving migrant workers in electronics and automotive manufacturing sectors; recruitment fees up to USD 6,400 and debt bondage risks reported	Moderate	Supply Chain Labor Standards
Oct-26	Georgetown, US: Alleged arson and theft incident at local supermarket; no injuries reported, investigation ongoing	Minor	Health & Safety
Oct-26	Frozen Berry Products [Recall, US]: Expanded recall due to potential E. coli O145:H28 contamination; no illnesses reported	Minor	Product Safety & Quality
Oct-26	Flipkart, India: Regulatory INR 10 lakh fine imposed by Central Consumer Protection Authority on e-commerce platforms for allegedly advertising and selling unregistered Cyclosinone herbicide	Moderate	Marketing & Advertising
Oct-26	Flipkart India, India: Penal action by the FSSAI over alleged regulatory non-compliance related to misleading claims and food safety	Moderate	Marketing & Advertising

This table shows the most recently updated controversies facing the company. Controversies are considered alongside other factors when assessing a company and may or may not impact the company's ESG Rating. For further details, See Controversies Detail section in full ESG Rating report appendix.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

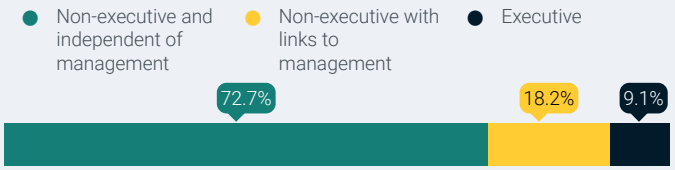
Corporate governance summary

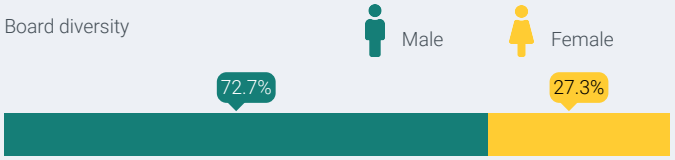
81st global percentile

89th home market percentile

Board of directors

Board type: Unitary Board





Ownership summary

Capital structure	Single Equity Class
Ownership classification	Controlling Shareholder
Key Owner Types	Family Firm

Top shareholders

Walton family - Walton Enterprises, LLC - 44.11 %(The Shares shown as beneficially owned by Walton Enterprises, LLC represent a) Shares held by Walton Enterprises, LLC and b)Shares held by Walton Family Holdings Trust)

CEO

Name: John Furner

Tenure: <1 Year

Total realized pay*:
USD 78,235,120.00

Total summary pay*:
USD 29,240,930.00

*CEO pay figures are sourced from listed company annual reports and proxy filings. When a new CEO is named the pay figures for the previous CEO will be displayed until this information has been updated for the new CEO

Peer benchmarking

	Raw Material Sourcing	Product Carbon Footprint	Labor Management	Supply Chain Labor Standards	Opportunities in Nutrition & Health	Privacy & Data Security	Product Safety & Quality	Corporate Governance	Corporate Behaviour	Rating & Trend
TARGET CORPORATION	●●●●	●●●●	●	●●	●●●	●●	●●●●	●●	●●●	AA ◄►
ALIMENTATION COUCHE-TARD INC.	●●	●●●●	●●●	N/A	●●	●●	●●●●	●●	●●●●	AA ◄►
WALMART INC.	●●●●	●●●●	●●	●●●	●●●●	●●●●	●●●	●●●●	●	AA ▲▲
Wal-Mart de Mexico, S.A.B. de C.V.	●●●●	●●●	●●	●●●●	●●	●●	●●●●	●●	●●	A ◄►
LOBLAW COMPANIES LTD	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	A ◄►
COSTCO WHOLESALE CORPORATION	●●●	●●●●	●	●	●	●●●	●●●	●●●	●	BBB ◄►

QUARTILE KEY : Bottom Quartile ● Top Quartile ●●●●

RATING TREND KEY : Maintain ◄► Upgrade ▲ Upgrade by two or more notches ▲▲ Downgrade ▼ Downgrade by two or more notches ▼▼

The five industry peers are companies in the Retail - Food & Staples ESG Rating Industry, as of November 02, 2026, selected based on similarities in four attributes (ESG Key Issue weights, industry classification, region, and size), sorted by ESG Rating (best to worst).

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

ESG Rating drill down

Description	As of prior rating action date: Mar 23, 2026		As of last rating action date: Oct 29, 2026		As of last report update date: Nov 02, 2026		Difference	
	Score	Weight	Score	Weight	Score	Weight	Score	Weight
ESG Rating Letter Grade	BBB		AA		AA		-	-
Industry Adjusted Score	5.7		7.87		7.87		-	-
Industry Minimum Score	2.7		2.7		2.7		-	-
Industry Maximum Score	6.3		6.3		6.3		-	-
Weighted Average Key Issue Score	4.8		5.5		5.5		-	-
Environmental Pillar Score	6.8	13.0%	6.6	13.0%	6.6	13.0%	-	-
Raw Material Sourcing Key Issue Score	5.8	6.0%	5.2	6.0%	5.2	6.0%	-	-
Exposure Score	7.5		7.5		7.5		-	-
Company-Specific Exposure Score	7.5		7.5		7.5		-	-
Management Score	6.3		5.6		5.6		-	-
Management Score - Excluding Controversies	7.1		6.4		6.4		-	-
Practices Score	7.1		6.4		6.4		-	-
Commitments towards responsible timber and/or paper sourcing	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Commitments towards responsible seafood sourcing	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Commitments towards responsible palm oil sourcing	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Commitments towards responsible cotton sourcing	7.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Commitments towards responsible beef and/or dairy sourcing	10.0	4.0%	10.0	4.0%	10.0	4.0%	-	-
Extent of supply chain initiatives - timber/paper	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of supply chain initiatives - seafood	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of supply chain initiatives - palm oil	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of supply chain initiatives - cotton	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of supply chain initiatives - beef/ dairy	8.0	4.0%	8.0	4.0%	8.0	4.0%	-	-
Percentage certified - timber/paper	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Percentage certified - seafood	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Percentage certified - palm oil	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	8.0	3.5%	-	-
Percentage certified - cotton	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Percentage certified - beef/dairy	3.0	4.0%	3.0	4.0%	3.0	4.0%	-	-
Future targets for timber/paper sourcing	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Future targets for seafood sourcing	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Future targets for palm oil sourcing	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	10.0	3.5%	-	-
Future targets for cotton sourcing	5.0	3.5%	5.0	3.5%	5.0	3.5%	-	-
Future targets for beef/dairy sourcing	5.0	4.0%	10.0	4.0%	10.0	4.0%	-	-
Extent of traceability - timber/paper	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of traceability - seafood	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of traceability - palm oil	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of traceability - cotton	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of traceability - beef/dairy	3.0	4.0%	3.0	4.0%	3.0	4.0%	-	-
Extent of stringent certification - timber	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-

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Description	As of prior rating action date: Mar 23, 2026 Score	Weight	As of last rating action date: Oct 29, 2026 Score	Weight	As of last report update date: Nov 02, 2026 Score	Weight	Difference Score	Weight
Extent of stringent certification - seafood	7.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Extent of stringent certification - palm oil	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	3.0	3.5%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	-0.8		-0.8		-0.8		-	-
Product Carbon Footprint Key Issue Score	**7.6**	**7.0%**	**7.8**	**7.0%**	**7.8**	**7.0%**	**-**	**-**
Exposure Score	7.6		7.6		7.6		-	-
Business Segment Exposure Score	7.6		7.6		7.6		-	-
Management Score	8.2		8.4		8.4		-	-
Practices Score	8.2		8.4		8.4		-	-
Targets to reduce Scope 3 upstream carbon emissions	10.0	20.0%	10.0	20.0%	10.0	20.0%	-	-
Reduction programs in transportation and logistics	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	-	-
Reduction programs in raw materials sourcing	6.0	5.0%	6.0	5.0%	6.0	5.0%	-	-
Reduction programs in manufacturing operations	6.0	5.0%	6.0	5.0%	6.0	5.0%	-	-
Reduction programs in distribution and store operations	6.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	-	-
Energy or carbon assessment of transportation and logistics	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	-	-
Energy or carbon assessment of raw materials sourcing	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	-	-
Energy or carbon assessment of manufacturing operations	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	-	-
Energy or carbon assessment of distribution and store operations	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	10.0	5.0%	-	-
Assessment of energy consumption and/or carbon emissions of suppliers	6.0	20.0%	6.0	20.0%	6.0	20.0%	-	-
Extent of product carbon footprint assessments	8.0	20.0%	8.0	20.0%	8.0	20.0%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	0.0		0.0		0.0		-	-
Social Pillar Score	**4.5**	**54.0%**	**4.9**	**54.0%**	**4.9**	**54.0%**	**-**	**-**
Labor Management Key Issue Score	**2.3**	**15.0%**	**2.6**	**15.0%**	**2.6**	**15.0%**	**-**	**-**
Exposure Score	9.1		9.1		9.1		-	-
Business Segment Exposure Score	7.8		7.8		7.8		-	-
Geographic Exposure Score	5.3		5.3		5.3		-	-
Company-Specific Exposure Score	10.0		10.0		10.0		-	-
Management Score	4.4		4.7		4.7		-	-
Management Score - Excluding Controversies	6.9		7.2		7.2		-	-
Practices Score	6.9		7.2		7.2		-	-
Scope of workforce eligibility for variable performance-based component to pay	5.0	16.7%	5.0	16.7%	5.0	16.7%	-	-
Workforce eligible for paid parental leave policy	7.0	16.7%	7.0	16.7%	7.0	16.7%	-	-
Support for degree programs or certifications for employees	5.0	12.5%	10.0	8.3%	10.0	8.3%	-	-
Restructuring policies and programs			7.0	16.6%	7.0	16.6%	-	-

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Description	As of prior rating action date: Mar 23, 2026 Score	Weight	As of last rating action date: Oct 29, 2026 Score	Weight	As of last report update date: Nov 02, 2026 Score	Weight	Difference Score	Weight
Skills and knowledge development training	5.0	12.5%	5.0	8.3%	5.0	8.3%	-	-
Employee satisfaction survey frequency	10.0	25.0%	10.0	16.6%	10.0	16.6%	-	-
Employee equity programs	7.0	16.7%	7.0	16.7%	7.0	16.7%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	-2.5		-2.5		-2.5		-	-
Privacy & Data Security Key Issue Score	**6.0**	**12.0%**	**7.0**	**12.0%**	**7.0**	**12.0%**	**-**	**-**
Exposure Score	6.8		6.7		6.7		-	-
Business Segment Exposure Score	5.1		5.1		5.1		-	-
Geographic Exposure Score	8.3		8.2		8.2		-	-
Company-Specific Exposure Score	10.0		10.0		10.0		-	-
Management Score	5.8		6.7		6.7		-	-
Management Score - Excluding Controversies	5.8		6.8		6.8		-	-
Practices Score	5.8		6.7		6.7		-	-
Responsibility for privacy and data security	10.0	11.7%	10.0	11.7%	10.0	11.7%	-	-
Scope of data protection policy	5.0	11.7%	10.0	11.7%	10.0	11.7%	-	-
Rights provided to consumers regarding the control of their data	5.0	11.7%	5.0	11.7%	5.0	11.7%	-	-
Privacy enhancing technologies and initiatives	10.0	7.5%	10.0	7.5%	10.0	7.5%	-	-
Data protection programs covering suppliers and business partners	5.0	7.5%	10.0	7.5%	10.0	7.5%	-	-
Scope of employee training on privacy and data security	5.0	11.7%	5.0	11.7%	5.0	11.7%	-	-
Measures to address data breaches	10.0	11.7%	10.0	11.7%	10.0	11.7%	-	-
Consent policy for use of consumer data for secondary purposes	0.0	7.5%	0.0	7.5%	0.0	7.5%	-	-
Scope of information security management system certifications	0.0	7.5%	0.0	7.5%	0.0	7.5%	-	-
Frequency of audits of information security system	5.0	11.7%	5.0	11.7%	5.0	11.7%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	0.0		0.0		0.0		-	-
Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Key Issue Score	**4.6**	**6.0%**	**4.2**	**6.0%**	**4.2**	**6.0%**	**-**	**-**
Exposure Score	5.8		5.8		5.8		-	-
Business Segment Exposure Score	4.3		4.3		4.3		-	-
Geographic Exposure Score	8.5		8.4		8.4		-	-
Management Score	4.5		4.0		4.0		-	-
Management Score - Excluding Controversies	5.3		5.3		5.3		-	-
Practices Score	5.3		5.3		5.3		-	-
Strategy to develop natural and healthy products	5.0	33.3%	5.0	33.3%	5.0	33.3%	-	-
In-house innovation capacity to develop healthier products	5.0	33.3%	5.0	33.3%	5.0	33.3%	-	-
Food & beverage nutrition enhancement programs score	6.0	33.3%	6.0	33.3%	6.0	33.3%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	-0.8		-1.3		-1.3		-	-
Supply Chain Labor standards Key Issue Score	**3.5**	**12.0%**	**4.6**	**12.0%**	**4.6**	**12.0%**	**-**	**-**
Exposure Score	8.6		8.6		8.6		-	-

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Description	As of prior rating action date: Mar 23, 2026		As of last rating action date: Oct 29, 2026		As of last report update date: Nov 02, 2026		Difference	
	Score	Weight	Score	Weight	Score	Weight	Score	Weight
Business Segment Exposure Score	7.1		7.1		7.1		-	-
Company-Specific Exposure Score	10.0		10.0		10.0		-	-
Business Segment Exposure Score	7.1		7.1		7.1		-	-
Management Score	5.1		6.2		6.2		-	-
Management Score - Excluding Controversies	6.8		7.9		7.9		-	-
Practices Score	6.8		7.9		7.9		-	-
Trains suppliers on labor related social issues	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	-	-
Supplier selection based on labor management performance	5.0	11.1%	5.0	11.1%	5.0	11.1%	-	-
Evidence of supplier audits	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	-	-
Scope of supplier audits	6.0	11.1%	6.0	11.1%	6.0	11.1%	-	-
Scope of supplier code of conduct	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	-	-
Action taken to address supplier misconduct	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	-	-
Effectiveness of Grievance Mechanisms	0.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	-	-
Extent of disclosure on instances of supplier misconduct	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	10.0	11.1%	-	-
Commitment to pay living wage for workers in supply chains	0.0	11.1%	0.0	11.1%	0.0	11.1%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	-1.7		-1.7		-1.7		-	-
Product Safety & Quality Key Issue Score	**7.1**	**9.0%**	**6.8**	**9.0%**	**6.8**	**9.0%**	**-**	**-**
Exposure Score	4.9		4.9		4.9		-	-
Business Segment Exposure Score	4.9		4.9		4.9		-	-
Management Score	5.0		4.7		4.7		-	-
Management Score - Excluding Controversies	6.3		6.0		6.0		-	-
Practices Score	6.3		6.3		6.3		-	-
Existence of contingency plans/ mitigation control systems to ensure products are in stock	6.0	6.3%	6.0	6.3%	6.0	6.3%	-	-
Scope of supplier training on quality standards	6.0	6.3%	6.0	6.3%	6.0	6.3%	-	-
Measures and reports quantitative indicators related to service quality performance or customer protection	1.0	6.3%	1.0	6.3%	1.0	6.3%	-	-
Extent of product testing capacity	6.0	6.3%	6.0	6.3%	6.0	6.3%	-	-
Membership in recognized industry-wide partnership on supply chain risk evaluation	10.0	6.3%	10.0	6.3%	10.0	6.3%	-	-
Scope of employee training on product quality	3.0	6.3%	3.0	6.3%	3.0	6.3%	-	-
Supplier certification level	8.0	6.3%	8.0	6.3%	8.0	6.3%	-	-
Certification to product safety or quality standard	10.0	6.3%	10.0	6.3%	10.0	6.3%	-	-
Performance Score	6.3		5.7		5.7		-	-
Product recall performance relative to peers	6.3	50.0%	5.7	50.0%	5.7	50.0%	-	-
Controversy Deduction	-1.3		-1.3		-1.3		-	-
Governance Pillar Score*	**4.5**	**33.0%**	**6.1**	**33.0%**	**6.1**	**33.0%**	**-**	**-**

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Description	As of prior rating action date: Mar 23, 2026		As of last rating action date: Oct 29, 2026		As of last report update date: Nov 02, 2026		Difference	
	Score	Weight	Score	Weight	Score	Weight	Score	Weight
Corporate Governance Key Issue Score	5.8		7.8		7.8		-	-
Board	7.3		7.5		7.5		-	-
Pay	5.9		10.0		10.0		-	-
Ownership & Control	4.8		8.3		8.3		-	-
Accounting	8.2		8.2		8.2		-	-
Corporate Behavior Score	4.3		4.6		4.6		-	-
Business Ethics	4.2		4.5		4.5		-	-
Tax Transparency	10.0		10.0		10.0		-	-

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

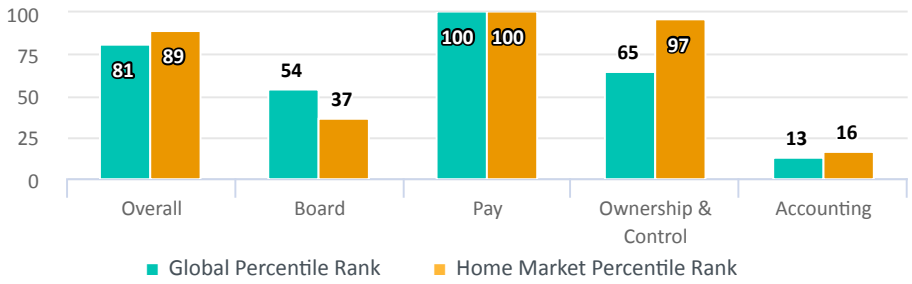
RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Corporate Governance

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Last score change date
7.8	0.0	●●●●	Oct 29, 2026

Market Cap: 942,291,041,044 USD **Home Market:** United States **Last Data Update:** Oct 07, 2026

GOVERNANCE THEMES AND RANKINGS



SUMMARY

WALMART falls into the highest scoring range for all the companies we assess relative to global peers, indicating that the company's corporate governance practices are generally well aligned with shareholder interests.

KEY AREAS OF CONCERN* — SCORING DEDUCTIONS

Board Effectiveness **(-0.69)**
- Flagged Directors on Board
- Overboarded Non-Exec Directors

Board Skills & Diversity **(-0.30)**
- Risk Management Expertise
- Not 30% Female Directors

Auditor Independence **(-0.29)**
- Auditor Tenure

KEY DATES

Financial Year End	January 31
Annual Filing Date	Apr 23, 2026
AGM Date	Jun 04, 2026

WEBSITE

https://corporate.walmart.com

**Key areas of concern include flagged key metrics within the three sub-issues that represent the largest scoring deductions. Please review the full report to see the complete set of flagged key metrics.*

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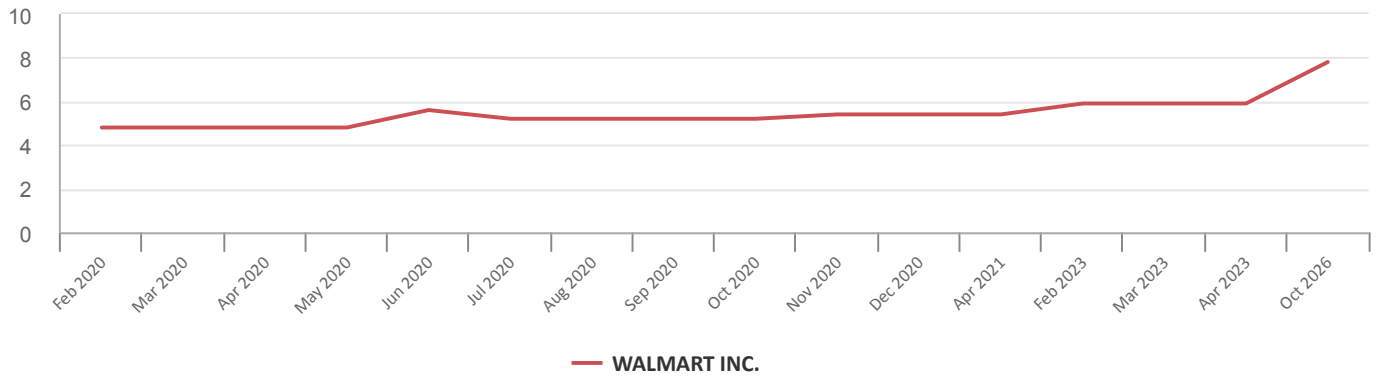
WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE SCORE HISTORY



CHANGES TO FLAGGED KEY METRICS (SINCE JUNE 2025)

Key Metric	Key Metric Change	Date	Score Change	Change Notes
Leadership Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.30	
Controlling Shareholder Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.99	
Risk Management Expertise	**Flag Added**	Jun 04, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Realized	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
Severance Vesting	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.10	
CEO Equity Changes	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Perks & Other Comp	Flag Removed	Dec 11, 2025	0.20	
Overboarded Non-Exec Directors	**Flag Added**	Jul 17, 2025	**-0.49**	

Note: A full list of score changes (including where there is no Key Metric Change) is included in the Appendix.

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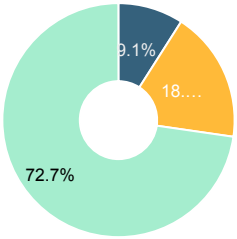
RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

BOARD OVERVIEW

Board Type: Unitary Board

Board of Directors

CEO	John Furner	Since: Feb 01, 2026
Chair	Gregory (Greg) Penner	Since: Jun 05, 2015
Lead Director	Randall Stephenson	Since: Jun 05, 2025



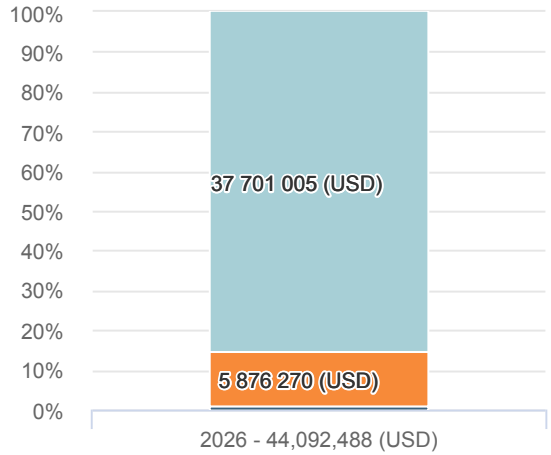
Executive Leadership

CFO	John Rainey	Since: Jun 06, 2022

■Executive ■Links to Management ■Independent of Management

PAY OVERVIEW

Highest Paid Executive - Daniel Danker



■ Long Term Incentives Awarded	37,701,005 (USD)
■ Short Term Incentives Awarded	5,876,270 (USD)
■ Fixed Pay	515,213 (USD)

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

BOARD

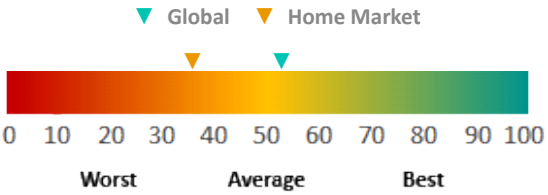
The policies and practices of the WALMART board fall within the average scoring range relative to global peers. We have flagged this board for potential concerns regarding the presence of certain related party transactions, the previous history of board service for certain directors and some non-executives may have too many other public board commitments.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
7.5	54th (Average)	37th (Average)

KEY METRICS SCORING

	Deduction
AUDIT OVERSIGHT	
Audit Committee Industry Expert	-0.10
BOARD EFFECTIVENESS	
Flagged Directors on Board	-0.20
Overboarded Non-Exec Directors	-0.49
BOARD INDEPENDENCE	
Related Party Transactions	-0.24
BOARD LEADERSHIP	
Independent Chair	-0.10
BOARD SKILLS & DIVERSITY	
Risk Management Expertise	-0.20
Not 30% Female Directors	-0.10

BOARD PERFORMANCE VS.



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

LEADERSHIP

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

History	CEO Since	Until	Name	Gender	Age
Current	**Feb 2026**		**John Furner**	**M**	**52**
Former	*Feb 2014*	*Jan 2026*	*Carl (Doug) McMillon*	*M*	*59*

CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER

History	CFO Since	Until	Name	Gender	Age
Current	**Jun 2022**		**John Rainey**	**M**	**55**
Former	*Jan 2016*	*Jun 2022*	*M. Brett Biggs*	*M*	*57*

CHAIR

History	Chair Since	Until	Name	Gender	Age
Current	**Jun 2015**		**Gregory (Greg) Penner**	**M**	**56**

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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BOARD OF DIRECTORS

The WALMART board currently has an independent majority, which enables it to more effectively fulfill its critical function of overseeing management on behalf of shareholders.

Number of Board Meetings: 5

Non-executives meet in absence of Executives: Yes

Name	M/F	Age	Tenure (Years)	Boards	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Management Link/ Designation Reason	Nationality
Carla Harris	F	63	9	4	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Cesar Conde	M	52	7	3	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Gregory (Greg) Penner COB I $	M	56	18	1	No	No	Executive of controlling shareholder; Former executive; Family Firm Director	United States of America
John Furner CEO I	**M**	**52**	**< 1**	**1**	**No**	**Yes**	**Executive**	**Not Disclosed**
Marissa Mayer	F	50	14	4	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Randall Stephenson LD $	M	66	5	1	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	M	62	2	2	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Sarah Friar $	F	53	8	1	Yes	Yes		United States of America
Shishir Mehrotra	M	46	< 1	2	Yes	Yes		Not Disclosed
Steuart Walton	M	44	10	1	No	No	Executive of controlling shareholder; Material related party transaction; Family Firm Director	Not Disclosed
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	3	Yes	Yes		United States of America

	F	# >= 70	# >= 15 yrs	# >= 4			
Total (of 11)	3	0	1	2	8	9	
Percentage	27.3%	0%	9.1%	18.2%	72.7%	81.8%	

Note: Board count includes the membership of this board.

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (5) I - Industry Expert (2) CEO - Chief Executive Officer
COB - Chair of the Board LD - Lead Director

RELATED PARTY TRANSACTIONS

The risk to minority shareholders arising from related party transactions is a function of the nature of the related party, the relative size of the transaction and the pricing of the transaction. The board, and in particular the independent directors or audit committee, play a key role in the protection of minority shareholders' interests, and monitoring and managing potential conflicts of interest of management, board members and shareholders. We note that the following circumstances which suggest elevated risk for independent shareholders:

The company is a family firm and there are related party transactions with the family.
There are related party transactions with the CEO.

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Reported Transactions

The Company engaged in related party transactions during the current fiscal year 2025 , involving the Company's executives and members of the Walton family. The transactions are related to the sale of jet fuel and energy savings revenues, the purchase of sporting goods and related products, and fees received from third-party utility providers for energy savings services.

For the two most recently reported fiscal years, these value of these transactions can be summarised as follows :

Fiscal Year	Related Party Types	Aggregate Transaction Value Value (CUR)	% of Total	Type
Jan 31, 2026	Non-executive director, Executive director, Controlling Owner, CEO, Family	2,194,100 USD	0.000% of Total Revenue	Recurring income from related party
		73,879,800 USD	0.011% of Expenses	Recurring purchases from related party
Jan 31, 2025	Non-executive director, Executive director, Controlling Owner, CEO, Family	3,068,800 USD	0.000% of Total Revenue	Recurring income from related party
		58,554,500 USD	0.009% of Expenses	Recurring purchases from related party

Sources : 2026 DEF 14A p. 42-44, 2025 DEF 14A p. 42

BOARD EFFECTIVENESS

We note that 20% of companies in United States are flagged for overboarded directors.

Nomination Committee - Number Of Meetings: 5

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Committee Status
Carla Harris	F	63	9	Yes	Yes	Member
Randall Stephenson $	M	66	5	Yes	Yes	Chair
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	Yes	Yes	Member

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (2)

Flagged Directors

Thomas (Tom) Horton

Mr. Horton is designated a 'flagged director' due to his involvement with the board of AMR Corporation, which filed for Chapter 11 Bankruptcy in November 2011.

BOARD SKILLS & DIVERSITY

We have identified that this board includes at least one individual flagged as having been involved in one or more negative governance events in the course of their service at previous companies, as explained below. Additional factors, e.g. the lack of an independent chairman together with the high number of long-tenured directors, may raise some investors' concerns about the board's ability to provide an effective counterbalance to management.

We have flagged the WALMART board for gender diversity concerns.

A board with one or more active CEOs and overboarded directors may not be able to provide effective oversight of management. Their other roles may limit the time and attention required to fulfill their fiduciary duties.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

AUDIT OVERSIGHT

Audit Committee - Number Of Meetings: 9

The WALMART board of directors includes a fully independent audit committee and at least one member of that committee meets our standards for financial expertise.

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Boards	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Committee Status
Cesar Conde	M	52	7	3	Yes	Yes	Member
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	M	62	2	2	Yes	Yes	Chair
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	3	Yes	Yes	Member

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (2)

Risk Committee - Number Of Meetings: 9

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	Committee Status
Cesar Conde	M	52	7	Yes	Yes	Member
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	M	62	2	Yes	Yes	Chair
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	M	65	11	Yes	Yes	Member

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (2)

PAY OVERSIGHT

Pay Committee - Number Of Meetings: 6

The WALMART board includes an independent pay committee, which is considered best practice for oversight of executive pay according to international corporate governance standards.

Name	M/F	Age	Board Tenure (Years)	Independent of Mgmt	Independent of Other Interests	CEO Role?	Committee Status
Carla Harris	F	63	9	Yes	Yes		Chair
Marissa Mayer	F	50	14	Yes	Yes		Member
Randall Stephenson $	M	66	5	Yes	Yes	Former	Member
Shishir Mehrotra	M	46	< 1	Yes	Yes		Member

$ - Financial Expert

CONTROVERSIES & EVENTS

No major relevant controversies have been uncovered.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS

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CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

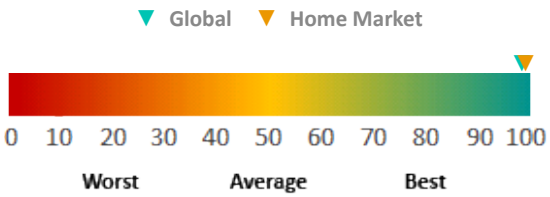
RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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PAY

Executive pay practices of the WALMART board appear to be generally well aligned with sustainable shareholder interests.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
10.0	100th (Best In Class)	100th (Best In Class)

PAY PERFORMANCE VS.



PAY FIGURES

EXECUTIVE PAY - 2026

Executive	Title	Tenure (Years)	Total Awarded Pay (USD)	Total Realized Pay (USD)
Carl (Doug) McMillon I	Executive	N/A (Resigned)	29,240,930	78,235,120
Daniel Danker I	Executive		44,092,488	7,202,291
John Furner I	CEO	< 1	27,343,149	43,954,406
John Rainey I $	CFO	4	15,455,188	35,678,055
Suresh Kumar I	Executive		16,727,128	42,491,665

$ - Financial Expert I - Industry Expert (5)

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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CEO PAY DETAILS - John Furner

Pay Awarded	2026
Fixed Pay	
Salary	1,313,000 USD
Fees	0 USD
Pension	520,028 USD
Perks & Other Pay	481,188 USD
Variable Pay	
Short-term incentives	
Annual Bonus	0 USD
Other Non-equity Incentive Plan	2,769,390 USD
Long-term incentives	
Grant date value of Stock Options	0 USD
Grant date value of Stock Awards	22,259,543 USD
Total Awarded Pay	**27,343,149 USD**

Pay Realized	
Fixed Pay	
Salary	1,313,000 USD
Fees	0 USD
Pension	520,028 USD
Perks & Other Pay	481,188 USD
Variable Pay	
Short-term incentives	
Annual Bonus	0 USD
Other Non-equity Incentive Plan	2,769,390 USD
Long-term incentives	
Options Exercised	0 USD
Stock Awards Vested	38,870,800 USD
Total Realized Pay	**43,954,406 USD**

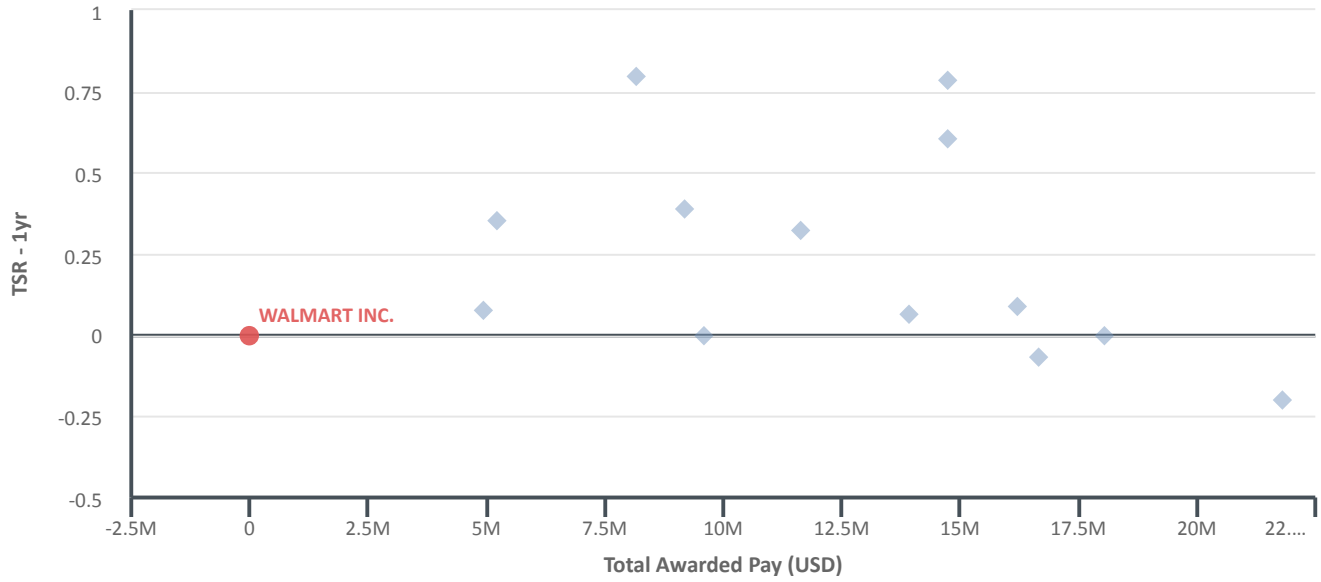
PAY PEER GROUP

LARGECAP - DEVELOPED AMERICAS - CONSUMER STAPLES DISTRIBUTION & RETAIL (14 COMPANIES)

Company	Home Market	Market Cap (USD m)	Pay Year	1 Yr TSR	Total CEO Annual Pay (USD)	CEO Name	CEO Since
DOLLAR GENERAL CORPORATION	United States	29,538	2025	0.80%	8,163,197	Vasos	Oct 2023
DOLLAR TREE, INC.	United States	23,752	2025	0.60%	5,332,060	Creedon	Nov 2024
CASEY'S GENERAL STORES, INC.	United States	28,065	2026	0.78%	5,093,310	Rebelez	Jun 2019
US FOODS HOLDING CORP.	United States	22,051	2025	0.00%	4,766,691	Flitman	Jan 2023
BJ'S WHOLESALE CLUB HOLDINGS, INC.	United States	12,961	2025	-0.07%	4,178,173	Eddy	Apr 2021
PERFORMANCE FOOD GROUP COMPANY	United States	15,185	2025	0.32%	3,660,955	Holm	Sep 2002
ALIMENTATION COUCHE-TARD INC.	Canada	51,116	2026	0.00%	3,660,841	Miller	Sep 2024
SYSCO CORPORATION	United States	38,845	2025	0.09%	3,641,709	Hourican	Feb 2020
LOBLAW COMPANIES LTD	Canada	52,171	2025	0.39%	3,584,456	Bank	Nov 2023
TARGET CORPORATION	United States	70,988	2025	-0.20%	3,274,808	Cornell	Aug 2014
METRO INC.	Canada	14,193	2025	0.08%	2,568,400	La Flèche	Apr 2008
GEORGE WESTON LIMITED	Canada	26,590	2025	0.35%	2,524,262	Weston	Jan 2017
COSTCO WHOLESALE CORPORATION	United States	419,608	2025	0.06%	1,895,797	Vachris	Jan 2024
WALMART INC.	**United States**	**942,291**		**0.00%**		**John Furner**	**Feb 2026**

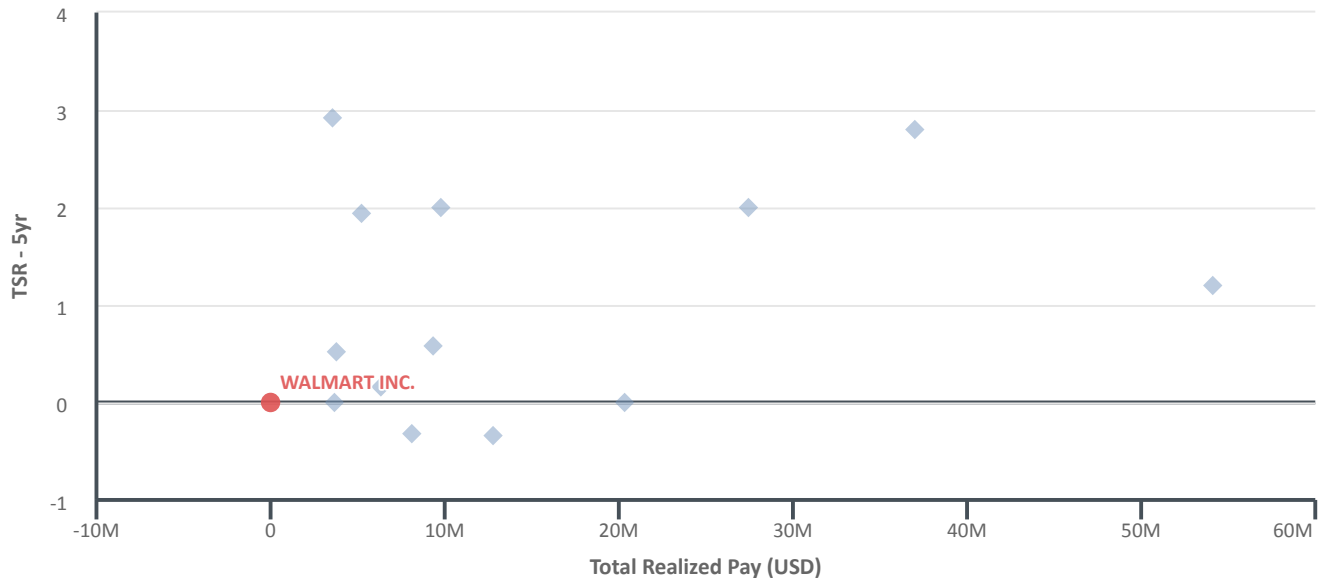
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CEO TOTAL AWARDED PAY VERSUS PAY PEER GROUP



Pay Peers (♦) are used in the calculation of the Key Metric CEO Pay Total Summary and selected as set out in the MSCI Governance Metrics Methodology Document.

CEO TOTAL REALIZED PAY VERSUS PAY PEER GROUP



Pay Peers (♦) are used in the calculation of the Key Metric CEO Pay Total Summary and selected as set out in the MSCI Governance Metrics Methodology Document.

PAY PERFORMANCE ALIGNMENT

CEO & EXECUTIVE EQUITY

CEO equity policy as a multiple of salary: **7.0**

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



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Our senior officers have been subject to stock ownership guidelines since 2003. Our CEO and senior officers are subject to the following requirements:

CEO : 7 times annual base salary

Executive	Tenure (Years)	Shares Held	YoY % Change	Shareholding As % of Salary
Carl (Doug) McMillon I	N/A (Resigned)	1,243,874	-69.27%	
Daniel Danker I		238,583		
John Furner I	< 1	342,311		
John Rainey I $	4	305,821		
Suresh Kumar I		1,472,417		

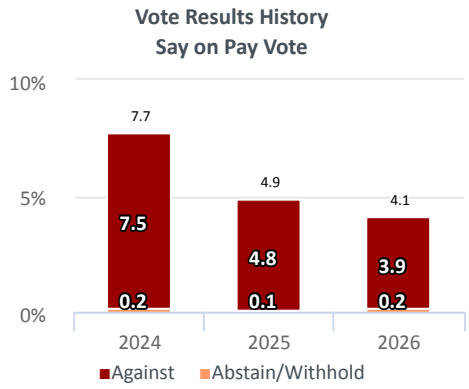
$ - Financial Expert I - Industry Expert (5)

CLAWBACK & MALUS

Clawback or malus provisions are in place.
Clawback Type: **Performance Based**

LATEST PAY VOTES

Year	Vote Type	Votes For %	Votes Against %	Abstain %
2026	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	95.9%	3.9%	0.2%



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NON-EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR PAY

NON-EXECUTIVE EQUITY

Director	Tenure (Years)	Shares Held
Brian Niccol	N/A (Resigned)	9,631
Carla Harris	9	50,098
Cesar Conde	7	31,588
Gregory (Greg) Penner I $	18	259,257
Marissa Mayer	14	130,950
Randall Stephenson $	5	65,029
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	2	11,807
Sarah Friar $	8	60,007
Shishir Mehrotra	< 1	1,286
Steuart Walton	10	80,209
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	11	57,913
Timothy (Tim) Flynn R $	N/A (Resigned)	156,945

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (6) I - Industry Expert
R - Risk Management Expert

NON-EXECUTIVE PAY TABLES

Director	Tenure (Years)	Cash Fees	Other Comp	Stock Award	Total Pay	Total Pay (USD)
Brian Niccol	N/A (Resigned)	108,751 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	338,761 USD	338,761
Carla Harris	9	131,429 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	361,439 USD	361,439
Cesar Conde	7	108,571 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	338,581 USD	338,581
Gregory (Greg) Penner I $	18	221,071 USD	0 USD	342,468 USD	563,539 USD	563,539
Marissa Mayer	14	108,571 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	338,581 USD	338,581
Randall Stephenson $	5	156,429 USD	413 USD	230,010 USD	386,852 USD	386,852
Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr. $	2	108,751 USD	843 USD	230,010 USD	339,604 USD	339,604
Sarah Friar $	8	131,429 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	361,439 USD	361,439
Shishir Mehrotra	< 1	0 USD	0 USD	93,283 USD	93,283 USD	93,283
Steuart Walton	10	131,429 USD	0 USD	230,010 USD	361,439 USD	361,439
Thomas (Tom) Horton X $	11	138,571 USD	215 USD	230,010 USD	368,796 USD	368,796
Timothy (Tim) Flynn R $	N/A (Resigned)	141,429 USD	976 USD	230,010 USD	372,415 USD	372,415

X - Flagged Director 1x $ - Financial Expert (6) I - Industry Expert R - Risk Management Expert

CONTROVERSIES & EVENTS

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No major relevant controversies have been uncovered.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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OWNERSHIP & CONTROL

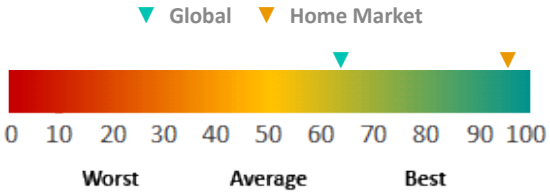
The company's ownership structure and shareholder rights at WALMART fall within the average scoring relative to global peers.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
8.3	65th (Average)	97th (Best In Class)

KEY METRICS SCORING

	Deduction
DIRECTOR ELECTIONS	
Majority Voting	-0.20
OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE	
Controlling Shareholder	0.00
SHAREHOLDER RIGHTS	
Bylaws Amendments	-0.10
TAKEOVER PROVISIONS	
Business Combination Provision	-0.10
Fair Bid Treatment Provisions	-0.10

OWNERSHIP & CONTROL PERFORMANCE VS.



CORPORATE STRUCTURE

Public Company

CAPITAL STRUCTURE

Capital Type	Votes Per Share	Shares Outstanding
Common Stock	1.0	7,970,990,515

OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE

OWNERSHIP CATEGORIES

- Controlling Shareholder
- Family Firm

NOTABLE SHAREHOLDERS

Walton family - Walton Enterprises, LLC - 44.11 %(The Shares shown as beneficially owned by Walton Enterprises, LLC represent a) Shares held by Walton Enterprises, LLC and b)Shares held by Walton Family Holdings Trust)	**44.1%**
Insider Voting Power	**44.1%**

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



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WALMART is a controlled company, where a single shareholder or shareholder block holds 30% or more of the voting shares or has effective control of the board. The controlling shareholder controls 44.11% of the voting power. We have identified this company as a 'family firm', where one or more families control the voting shares and are typically represented on the board. When assessing family firms, we consider the extent to which the family makes decisions that are in the best interests of non-family shareholders. At WALMART, there may be governance risks associated with related party transactions among the controlling founders/family. The company does not have a special capital structure, thus one vote right is afforded per common share. This principle of 'one share one vote' helps align economic and voting power and ensures that no class of shareholders has more voting power than economic exposure.

FAMILY FIRM

The Walton Family, comprising Alice Walton, Benjamin Walton, James Walton, Jim Walton, Lukas Walton, Rob Walton, Samuel Walton, Steuart Walton, and Thomas Walton, collectively holds 44.11% shares of the company through Walton Enterprises, LLC. Steuart Walton serve as Board member of the company.

TAKEOVER PROVISIONS

Fair Price Provision	Mandatory Bid Provision	Mandatory Bid Ownership Threshold
No	No	

State of Incorporation	Business Combination Provision
Delaware	Yes

% of Votes to Approve a Merger
51%

GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

MAJORITY REQUIREMENTS

	Bylaws	Charter
Default percentage of votes required to amend a provision	51%	51%

.Bylaws p. 23

These Bylaws may be altered, amended, or repealed, or new Bylaws may be adopted, by the stockholders or by the Board

COI p. 12

The Corporation reserves the right to amend, alter or repeal any provision contained in this Certificate of Incorporation in the manner now or hereafter prescribed by the statutes of the State of Delaware, and all rights and powers conferred on Directors and stockholders herein are granted subject to this reservation.

SHAREHOLDER RIGHTS

There may be governance risks for investors in relation to shareholder rights and management-controlled takeover defense mechanisms at WALMART including:

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- The board's ability to amend the company's charter without shareholder approval
- The board's ability to amend the company's bylaws without shareholder approval
- business combination provisions that fail to include protections of shareholder interests
- fair price provisions that fail to ensure that all shareholders are treated fairly
- Limits on the right of shareholders to take action by written consent

SHAREHOLDER MEETINGS & RESOLUTIONS

	Call Special Meeting	Requisition a Resolution at AGM	Act by Written Consent
Percentage of shares required	10%		N/A - no right exists

RESTRICTIONS ON LEGAL ACTION BY SHAREHOLDERS

An exclusive forum provision is in place.

SAY ON PAY

We note that shareholder votes on executive pay are mandatory in this market, affording shareholders the ability to review and approve executive pay practices at this company.

DIRECTOR ELECTIONS

BOARD RE-ELECTION PROVISIONS

Board Re-election Provisions	
Board Re-election Frequency (Years)	1
% of Board subject to re-election	100%

DIRECTOR ELECTION STANDARD

The company has not adopted a binding majority director election standard (with immediate resignation if the director does not receive a majority of the votes cast), which may limit shareholders' ability to hold members of the board accountable in uncontested elections.

Director Election Rules	
Vote Standard	Majority & Resignation Policy
Immediate Binding Resignation	No

2026 DEF 14A p. 8

They are voting to elect each nominee named below as a director of Walmart for a one-year term.

2026 DEF 14A p. 114

Any incumbent director who is a director nominee and who does not receive a majority of the votes cast must promptly tender his or her offer of resignation as a director to the Chairman of the Board for consideration by the Board. Each director standing for election at the 2026 Annual Shareholders' Meeting has agreed to resign, effective upon acceptance of such resignation by the Board, if he or she does not receive a majority of the votes cast. The Board must accept or reject the resignation offer within 90 days following certification of the shareholder vote in accordance with the procedures established by the Bylaws.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



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PROXY ACCESS

A proxy access provision is in place.

Proxy Access Terms	
Ownership Duration (Years)	3
Ownership Threshold (% of shares)	3%
Min/Max % of Board Seats	20%
Min/Max Number of Board Seats	2

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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ACCOUNTING

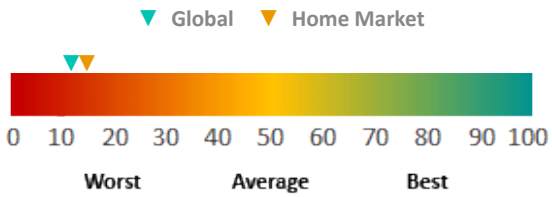
Based on the company's disclosures and other public information, accounting and financial reporting practices at WALMART may warrant close attention from shareholders. We have flagged this company for potential concerns regarding the length of tenure of the external audit firm.

0-10 Score	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
8.2	13th (Below Average)	16th (Below Average)

KEY METRICS SCORING

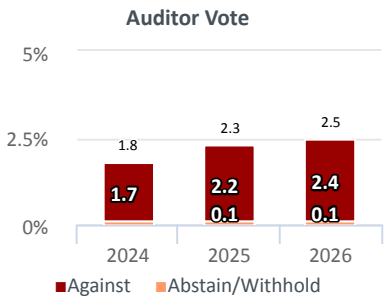
	Deduction
AUDITOR INDEPENDENCE	
Auditor Tenure	-0.29

ACCOUNTING PERFORMANCE VS.



EXTERNAL AUDITORS

Type	Since	Firm	Most Recent Fiscal Year End Signed Off
Primary	1969	Ernst & Young LLP	2026



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

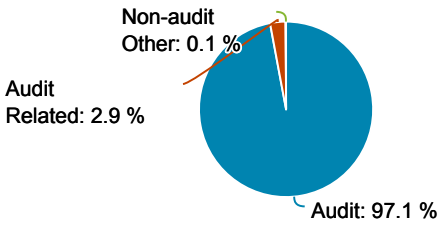


RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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AUDITOR FEES

Fees paid to: Ernst & Young LLP (Primary)

Fee	Jan 31, 2026 (USD)	Jan 31, 2024 (USD)
Audit	44,712,000	36,306,000
Audit Related	1,335,000	1,586,000
Total Audit + Audit Related	**46,047,000**	**37,892,000**
Tax Compliance/ Advice	0	0
Other Non-audit Services	24,000	24,000
Total Non-audit Fees	**24,000**	**24,000**
Total Fees	**46,071,000**	**37,916,000**



AUDITOR'S REPORT

	Jan 31, 2026	Jan 31, 2025	Jan 31, 2024
Report Disclosed	Yes	Yes	Yes
Opinion	Unqualified Opinion	Unqualified Opinion	Unqualified Opinion
Emphasis of Matter	No	No	No

CONTROVERSIES & EVENTS

No major relevant controversies have been uncovered.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

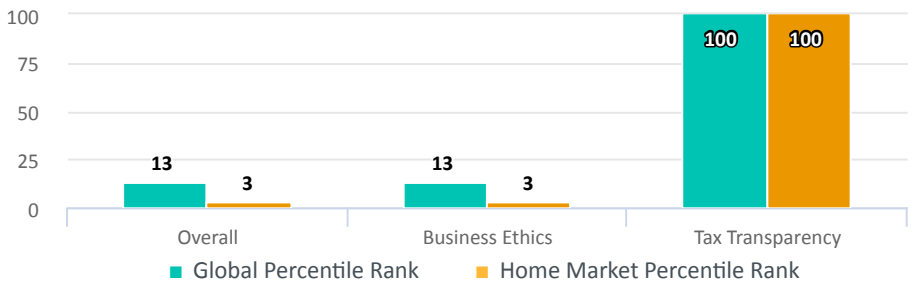
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Corporate Behavior

0-10 Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Last score change date
4.6	0.0	•	Oct 29, 2026

CORPORATE BEHAVIOR THEME AND KEY ISSUE RANKINGS



METHODOLOGY NOTE

This theme evaluates the extent to which companies may face ethics issues such as fraud, executive misconduct, corruption scandals, money laundering, anti-trust violations, or tax-related controversies.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

KEY AREAS OF CONCERN* — SCORING DEDUCTIONS

Business Ethics Policies & Practices	**(-1.40)**
Regular Audits of Ethical Standards	
Employee Training on Ethical Standards	
Business Ethics Risk & Controversies	**(-4.00)**
Business Ethics Controversies	

**Key areas of concern include flagged key metrics that represent the largest scoring deductions. Please review the full report to see a complete set of flagged key metrics.*

CORPORATE BEHAVIOR SCORE HISTORY



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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BUSINESS ETHICS

KEY METRICS SCORING

	Deduction
BUSINESS ETHICS POLICIES & PRACTICES	**-1.40**
Regular Audits of Ethical Standards	-0.70
Employee Training on Ethical Standards	-0.70
BUSINESS ETHICS RISK & CONTROVERSIES	**-4.00**
Business Ethics Controversies	-4.00

Note: Business Ethics Policies & Practices deductions as well as Business Ethics Risk & Controversies are capped at a maximum of -7.0. Cumulative deductions are capped at 10.

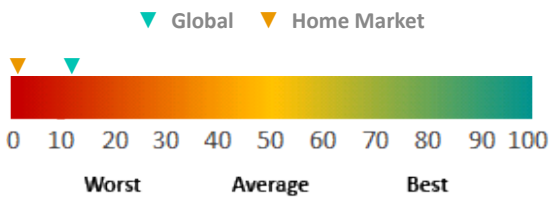
0-10 Score	Change (since rating)	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
4.5	0.0	13th (Below Average)	3rd (Worst In Class)

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on their oversight and management of business ethics issues such as fraud, executive misconduct, corrupt practices, money laundering, or anti-trust violations.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

BUSINESS ETHICS VS.



BUSINESS ETHICS POLICIES & PRACTICES

Indicators	Company Practice	Best Practice	Deduction
Responsibility for ethics issues	Board-level committee	Board-level committee or C-suite or Executive committee	0.00
Policy against bribery and corruption	Detailed formal policy on bribery and anti-corruption	Detailed formal policy on bribery and anti-corruption	0.00
Regular Audits of Ethical Standards	Evidence of audits but no specific details / Audits conducted but not on a regular schedule	Audits of all operations at least once every three years	-0.70
Whistleblower protection	Policy provides whistleblowers with protection from retaliation	Policy provides whistleblowers with protection from retaliation	0.00
Employee training on ethical standards	Programs covering all permanent employees (excluding part-time and contractors)	Programs covering all employees (including part-time) and contractors	-0.70
Policy against bribery and corruption for suppliers	NA	All suppliers are required to have anti-corruption policies and programs to verify compliance	0.00
Anti-money laundering policy	NA	Policy and implementation strategy articulated	0.00

**Business Ethics Policies & Practices deductions are capped at a maximum of -7.0.*

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CORRUPTION RISK EXPOSURE

Exposure to: Regulatory risks or lost market access due to corruption scandals or political and social instability
Business Types : Percentage of operations in business segments perceived most likely to pay or receive bribes



Source: Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA) enforcement actions, U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC); EU public procurement data, Opentender.eu; State Capture Analysis, World Bank; Lobbying data, OpenSecrets.org; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Business Locations : Percentage of operations in countries with high/moderate/low level of corruption and political instability, violence or terrorism



Source: Corruption Perception Index, Transparency International; Control of Corruption Index, World Governance Indicator; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

CORRUPTION RISK EXPOSURE SCORING DEDUCTION KEY

% of operations in medium and high risk geographies	% of operations in high risk business segments	>=20% government ownership	<20% government ownership	No evidence of government ownership
20% or more	50% or more	-4.00	-2.60	-2.00
	Less than 50%	-1.20	-1.20	-1.20
Less than 20%	50% or more	-0.60	-0.60	-0.60
	Less than 50%	0.00	0.00	0.00

**The Corruption Risk and Controversies Deduction is based on the maximum of deductions from the corruption risk exposure and corruption controversies category listed below*

BUSINESS ETHICS CONTROVERSIES

Controversy Cases

Category	Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated	Deduction
Business Ethics & Fraud	Severe	**US: State and local government lawsuits over alleged failure to monitor and report questionable opioid orders; settlements reached for some lawsuits; USD 50 million settlement with DOJ reached**	Partially Concluded	September 2026	-2.2
	Moderate	**US: Federal appeals court revived portions of litigation comprising approximately 100 lawsuits over alleged misleading claims involving oral phenylephrine decongestants**	Ongoing	August 2026	

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Category	Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated	Deduction
	Moderate	**India: Central Consumer Protection Authority imposed INR 1 million penalty over illegal sale listings of walkie-talkies with undisclosed operating frequencies**	Concluded	February 2026	
	Moderate	**Flipkart, India: Compounding option offered by the ED following investigation into alleged FEMA violations**	Ongoing	October 2025	
	Moderate	**Canada: Class action lawsuit filed over alleged misrepresentation of imported products as Canadian, seeking consumer compensation**	Ongoing	September 2025	
	Minor	**US: Allegations of misleading marketing over purported Thanksgiving meal cost reduction; scrutiny over product substitutions and item count differences**	Concluded	November 2025	
Anticompetitive Practices	Moderate	**United States: DOJ reportedly expanded antitrust investigation into alleged price manipulation in the beef supply chain involving major grocery retailers**	Ongoing	September 2026	-1.8
	Moderate	**California, US: Allegations of algorithmic price fixing at gas stations through AI-powered software lead to proposed class action lawsuit**	Ongoing	July 2026	
	Moderate	**California, US: Class action lawsuit filed alleging use of AI to coordinate gas price increases in violation of antitrust laws**	Ongoing	July 2026	
	Moderate	**Flipkart, India: CCI investigation into alleged antitrust violations related to discounting practices and relationships with preferred sellers**	Concluded	January 2026	
	Moderate	**Mexico: Appeal against MXN 93 million penalty Federal Economic Competition Commission over alleged monopolistic behavior in relation to the supply, distribution, and marketing of consumer goods**	Concluded	January 2026	
	Moderate	**US: Class action lawsuit filed over alleged price-fixing scheme involving wholesale soft drink prices; antitrust violations cited**	Ongoing	January 2026	
Corruption	--	**No ongoing controversies.**	--	--	--

**The maximum deductions from the Anticompetitive Practices and Business Ethics & Fraud categories are summed to arrive at the overall Business Ethics Controversies deduction, which is capped at a maximum of -7.0.*

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TAX TRANSPARENCY

TAX GAP ASSESSMENT

Indicators

Tax Gap

Estimated Effective Tax Rate	26.5%
Estimated Corporate Income Tax Rate	26.9%
Estimated Tax Gap	(0.4%)
Tax Gap Assessment	Low Gap

Revenue

Foreign Revenue	18.5%

Confidence

Confidence Level of Estimation	

Involvement in Controversies 0.0

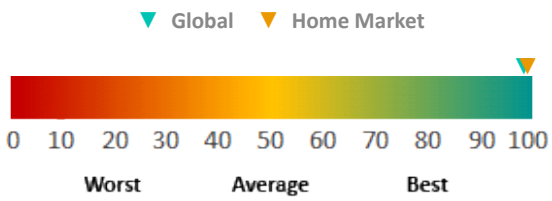
0-10 score	Change (since rating)	Global Percentile Rank	Home Market Percentile Rank
10.0	0.0	100th (Best In Class)	100th (Best In Class)

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on their estimated corporate tax gap (i.e. gap between estimated effective tax rate and estimated corporate income tax rate) and their involvement in tax-related controversies.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

TAX TRANSPARENCY VS.



TAX CONTROVERSIES

Controversy Cases

Category	Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated	Deduction
Tax Transparency	--	**No ongoing controversies.**	--	--	--

TAX CONTROVERSIES SCORING DEDUCTION KEY

Involvement in tax controversies	Estimated tax gap	Tax gap assessment	Deduction
Yes	Below 5%	Low	-0.80
	5-10%	Moderate	-1.40
	Above 10%	High	-2.00
No	Below 5%	Low	0.00
	5-10%	Moderate	0.00
	Above 10%	High	0.00

Tax related controversies are not considered for companies in Real Estate Management services or Mortgage REITs industries. Tax gap assessment is effectively low for companies with less than 5% of total revenue categorized as foreign.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

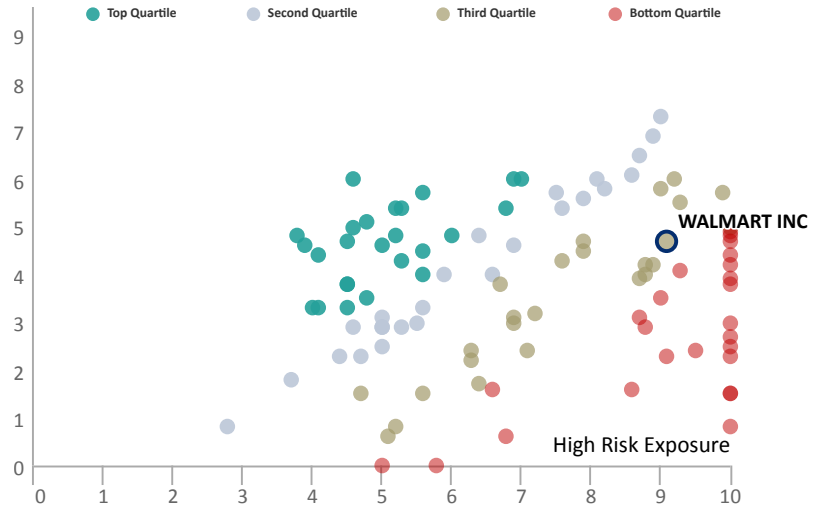
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

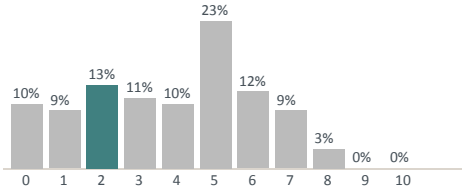
Labor Management

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
2.6	0.0	●●	15.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

Berli Jucker Public Company Limited	8.4
Axfood AB	8.0
Hagar hf.	7.9
ECO-SHOP MARKETING BERHAD	7.7
BID CORPORATION LIMITED	7.4

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

Grupo Mateus S.A.	0.0
LABEL'VIE SA	0.0
METRO INC.	0.0
Sendas Distribuidora S.A.	0.0
WOOLWORTHS GROUP LIMITED	0.0

KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT

Company 2.6
Industry 3.8

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company 9.1
Industry 7.0

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company 4.7
Industry 3.8

Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types
Company 7.8

Business Locations
Company 5.3

Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score
Company 7.2

Controversy Deduction
Company - 2.5

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the complexity of their workforce (size, labor intensity, and regions of operation), employee relations, strength of worker protections, and employee engagement efforts.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

EXPOSURE

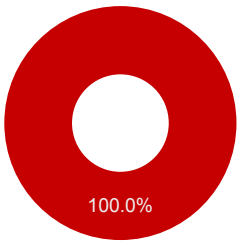
RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risk of workflow disruptions due to labor unrest, or reduced productivity due to poor job satisfaction

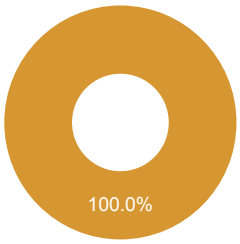
Business Types : Percentage of operations in business segments with high/moderate/low labor intensities, as measured by average sales per employee of industries



- Retail groceries, General stores
- No exposure to medium risk segments
- No exposure to low risk segments

Source: MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Business Locations : Percentage of operations in countries with high/moderate/low likelihood of labor unrest (based on historic precedent)



- No operations in markets with high risks
- other countries, USA
- No operations in markets with low risks

Source: International Labour Organization (ILO); MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Additional Drivers of Exposure

Size and Composition of Workforce

Number of Employees

Year	Number of employees
2025	2,100,000
2024	2,100,000
2023	2,100,000
2022	2,100,000
2021	2,300,000

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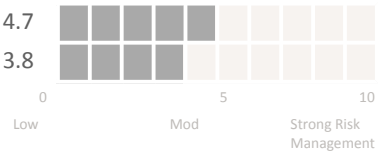
Layoffs Events

Major Layoffs:	**No**

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	4.7
Industry	3.8



Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Scope of workforce eligibility for variable performance-based component to pay	Selective performance-based incentive pay for non-officer staff	Strong performance-based incentive pay structure covers all employees	LOW 5 TOP	2
Workforce eligible for paid parental leave policy	Benefits cover selected employees	Benefits cover all employees	LOW 7 TOP	3
Employee equity programs	Only select number of employees eligible for ESOP and/or ESPP	Sector-leading number of employees eligible for ESOP and/or ESPP	LOW 7 TOP	4
Support for degree programs or certifications for employees	Program covers all employees (including part-time and contractors)	Program covers all employees (including part-time and contractors)	LOW MID 10	2
Restructuring policies and programs	Evidence of assistance with outplacement, reemployment or retraining	Evidence of severance pay and assistance with outplacement, reemployment or retraining	LOW 7 TOP	6
Employee satisfaction survey frequency	Surveys conducted annually	Surveys conducted annually	LOW MID 10	6
Skills and knowledge development training	Program exists but no indication of scope	Program covers all employees (including part-time and contractors)	LOW 5 TOP	5

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Controversy Cases

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Severe	**Asda, UK: Gender discrimination claims against Asda; claim under final stage of the Employment Tribunal process**	Ongoing	April 2026
Severe	**Massmart Holdings Limited, South Africa: Strikes by employees over wages, commissions, and working conditions**	Partially Concluded	November 2025
Moderate	**US: Allegations of wrongful termination and discrimination following mistaken identity incident involving a tall cisgender woman**	Ongoing	April 2025
Minor	**Washington, US: Lawsuit over alleged retaliation and unlawful termination following workplace harassment complaints; jury award reduced to statutory cap**	Concluded	August 2026
Minor	**Texas, US: USD 13 million settlement over alleged misrepresentation of wages and tips to delivery drivers under grocery delivery program**	Concluded	July 2026
Minor	**Ontario, Canada: Unifor Settles Walmart Wage Freeze Complaint as Workers Secure Historic First Collective Agreement**	Concluded	June 2026
Minor	**California, US: Employee lawsuit over alleged violation of consumer reporting law through deficient background check form and certification process**	Ongoing	April 2026
Minor	**New York, US: USD 60,000 settlement of disability discrimination lawsuit over alleged failure to accommodate employee with hearing, speech, and cognitive impairments**	Concluded	January 2026
Minor	**India: Nationwide protests by gig workers over alleged unsafe working conditions, unfair pay, and denial of social security**	Ongoing	January 2026

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

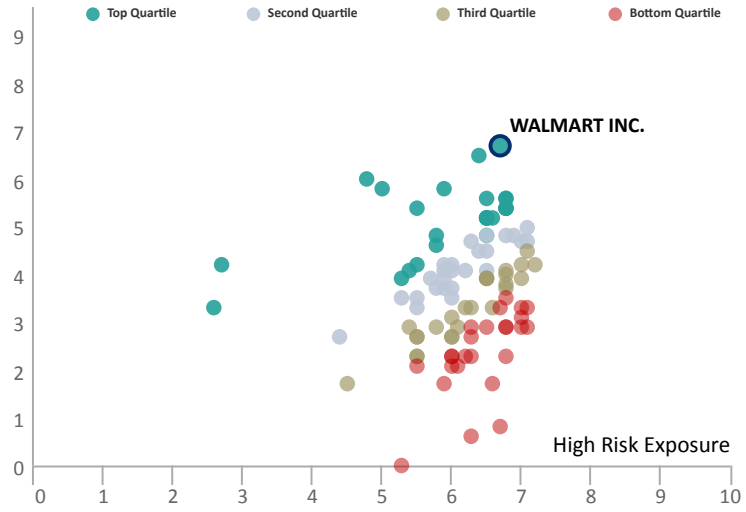
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

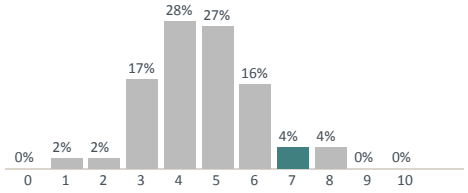
Privacy & Data Security

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
7.0	0.0	●●●●	12.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

SYSCO CORPORATION	8.5
Berli Jucker Public Company Limited	8.2
CP All Public Company Limited	7.8
BID CORPORATION LIMITED	7.7
DOLLARAMA INC.	7.1

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

ESSELUNGA SPA	2.0
Villars Holding SA	1.7
Genky DrugStores Co., Ltd.	1.3
Al Meera Consumer Goods Company QPSC	1.1
VILLAGE SUPER MARKET, INC.	0.7

KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT

Company 7.0
Industry 4.6
0 5 10
Low Mod High

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company 6.7
Industry 6.2
0 5 10
Low Mod High Risk

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company 6.7
Industry 3.7
0 5 10
Low Mod Strong Risk Management

Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types
Company 5.1
0 5 10

Business Locations
Company 8.2
0 5 10

Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score
Company 6.7
0 5 10

Controversy Deduction
Company 0.0
-5.0 -2.5 0

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the amount of personal data they collect, their exposure to evolving or increasing privacy regulations, their vulnerability to potential data breaches, and their systems for protecting personal data.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

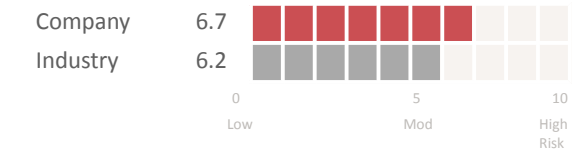
MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

EXPOSURE

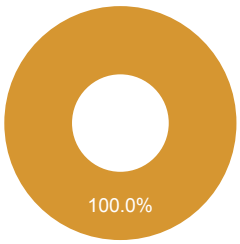
RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risk of compliance cost increase or reputational damage from data breaches or controversial use of personal data

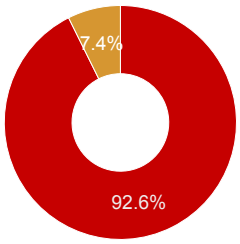
Business Types : Percentage of revenue derived from business segments that · require collection and/or handling of sensitive personal data · have witnessed high cost and frequency of data breaches



- No exposure to high risk segments
- Retail groceries, General stores, Gas stations
- No exposure to low risk segments

Source: Ponemon Institute and IBM's Cost of a Data Breach report series; Verizon's Data Breach Investigations Report; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Business Locations : Percentage of operations in countries with strengthening or evolving data and privacy regulations, with high cost of data breaches

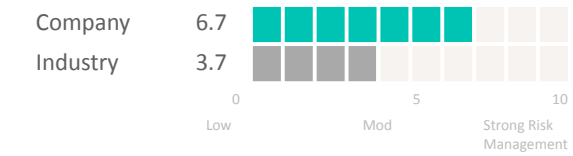


- other countries, USA, China, Canada
- Latin America
- No operations in markets with low risks

Source: Ponemon Institute and IBM's Cost of a Data Breach report series; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Data protection programs covering suppliers and business partners	Yes - inspections are conducted to verify their compliance	Yes - inspections are conducted to verify their compliance	LOW MID **10**	3
Privacy enhancing technologies and initiatives	Data protection safeguards integrated into product & service development	Data protection safeguards integrated into product & service development	LOW MID **10**	0
Consent policy for use of consumer data for secondary purposes	Opt-out for providing personal data to third parties for purposes other than completing transactions/services	Company does not rent, sell, or provide personal data to third parties for purposes other than completing transactions/ services	**0** MID TOP	1
Scope of information security management system certifications	No evidence	Most (over 80%) owned operations are certified to widely accepted standards	**0** MID TOP	1
Rights provided to consumers regarding the control of their data	Right of access and rectification of individuals' data	Right of access, rectification and deletion of individuals' data	LOW **5** TOP	4
Scope of data protection policy	Policy governs all relevant business lines/subsidiaries	Policy governs all relevant business lines/subsidiaries	LOW MID **10**	5
Responsibility for privacy and data security	Board-level committee	Board-level committee	LOW MID **10**	5
Scope of employee training on privacy and data security	Training is provided to selected employees or scope unclear	Training is provided to all employees, including contractors	LOW **5** TOP	5
Measures to address data breaches	Both proactive and reactive measures are in place	Both proactive and reactive measures are in place	LOW MID **10**	6
Frequency of audits of information security system	General statements on conducting information security audits	External independent audits are conducted at least once every two years	LOW **5** TOP	3

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS

AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Controversy Cases

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Minor	**California, US: Settlement of approximately USD 908,815 over alleged unauthorized sharing of customer data with third-party advertisers; restitution fund established for affected customers**	Concluded	August 2026

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

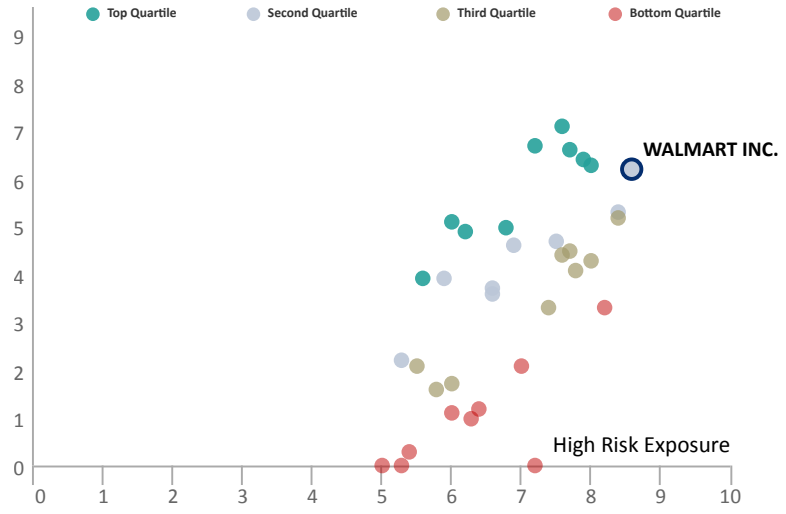
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

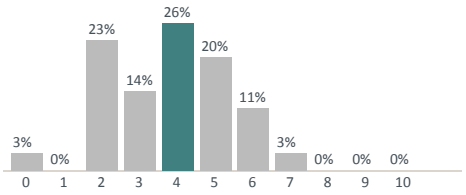
Supply Chain Labor Standards

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
4.6	0.0	●●●	12.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



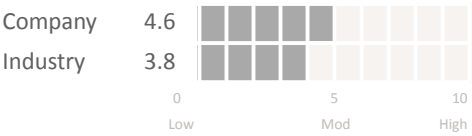
TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

WOOLWORTHS HOLDINGS LIMITED	6.5
Wal-Mart de Mexico, S.A.B. de C.V.	6.4
DOLLARAMA INC.	6.2
MARKS AND SPENCER GROUP P.L.C.	6.0
Berli Jucker Public Company Limited	5.7

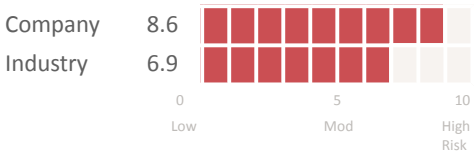
BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

PRICESMART, INC.	1.8
Grupo Mateus S.A.	1.7
KUSURI NO AOKI HOLDINGS CO., LTD.	1.7
TRIAL Holdings, Inc.	0.5
ALBERTSONS COMPANIES, INC.	0.0

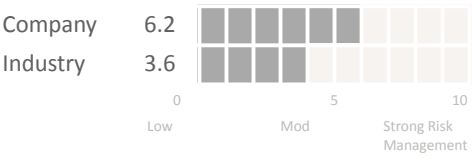
KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT



RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT



RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT



Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types



Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score



Controversy Deduction



METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the management and transparency of their supply chain and the working standards in the regions in which their suppliers are located.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company	8.6
Industry	6.9



Additional Exposure Indicators

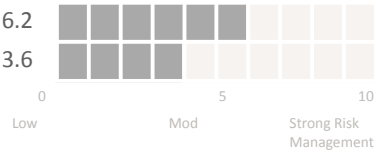
Footprint

Private label as percentage of sales (est.):	**30.00%**

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	6.2
Industry	3.6



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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Supplier selection based on labor management performance	General statement that labor management performance is a factor in awarding and extending contracts	Preference shown for suppliers demonstrating superior labor management performance (e.g. factor is included in supplier "scorecard" along with price and quality)	LOW 5 TOP	2
Scope of supplier audits			6	4
Tier 1 supplier audits (direct suppliers)	Yes - Almost all Tier 1 suppliers or "high risk" suppliers identified through rigorous systematic analysis	Yes - Almost all Tier 1 suppliers or "high risk" suppliers identified through rigorous systematic analysis	—	—
Tier 3 suppliers audits (raw materials)	No	Yes - Includes at least some Tier 3 suppliers	—	—
Action taken to address supplier misconduct	Detailed action plan to correct specified issues	Detailed action plan to correct specified issues	LOW MID 10	4
Effectiveness of Grievance Mechanisms	Comprehensive grievance mechanism available in local languages, with channels of communication specified and full safeguards	Comprehensive grievance mechanism available in local languages, with channels of communication specified and full safeguards	LOW 10	4
Extent of disclosure on instances of supplier misconduct	Reports detailed instances of non-compliance including types and frequency of violations	Reports detailed instances of non-compliance including types and frequency of violations	LOW MID 10	3
Trains suppliers on labor related social issues	Yes	Yes	LOW 10	5
Evidence of supplier audits	Yes - Both internal and third-party auditors	Yes - Both internal and third-party auditors	LOW MID 10	5
Scope of supplier code of conduct			10	8

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Supply chain code of conduct covers forced labor	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers child labor	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers working hours	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers paid overtime	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers minimum wage	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers anti-discrimination	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers freedom of association	Yes	Yes	—	—
Supply chain code of conduct covers health and safety	Yes	Yes	—	—

Commitment to pay living wage for workers in supply chains	No evidence	Commitment for its suppliers to pay a living wage to their workers, and detailed initiatives	0	TOP	2

Controversy Cases

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Severe	**China: Allegations of forced labor related to suppliers employing ethnic minorities through coercive state-sponsored labor-transfer programs**	Ongoing	November 2025
Moderate	**Taiwan: Investigation revealed alleged labor rights abuses involving migrant workers in electronics and automotive manufacturing sectors; recruitment fees up to USD 6,400 and debt bondage risks reported**	Partially Concluded	October 2026
Moderate	**New York, US: Investigation reportedly uncovered exploitation, unsafe conditions, and sexual harassment of migrant workers on J-1 visas**	Ongoing	January 2026
Moderate	**India, Indonesia, Vietnam: Allegations of the presence of child labor in suppliers' shrimp farms**	Ongoing	March 2025

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

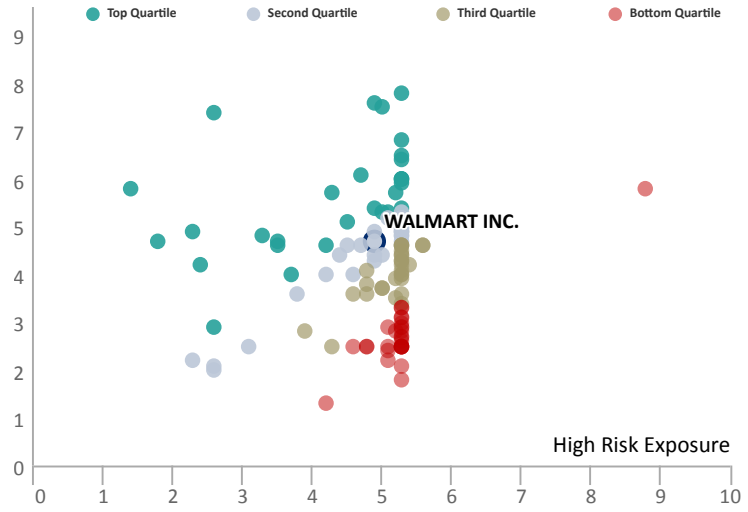
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

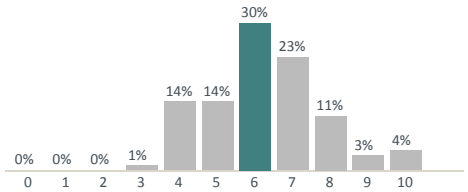
Product Safety & Quality

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
6.8	0.0	●●●	9.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

ARKO CORP.	10.0
CASEY'S GENERAL STORES, INC.	10.0
ALIMENTATION COUCHE-TARD INC.	9.7
PRESIDENT CHAIN STORE CORPORATION	9.7
East Buy Holding Ltd	9.6

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

BJ'S WHOLESALE CLUB HOLDINGS, INC.	4.1
WOOLWORTHS GROUP LIMITED	4.1
OLAM GROUP LIMITED	4.0
GROCERY OUTLET HOLDING CORP.	3.8
KOBE BUSSAN CO., LTD.	3.5

KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT

Company 6.8
Industry 6.3
0 5 10
Low Mod High

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company 4.9
Industry 4.8
0 5 10
Low Mod High Risk

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company 4.7
Industry 4.2
0 5 10
Low Mod Strong Risk Management

Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types
Company 4.9
0 5 10

Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score
Company 6.3
0 5 10

Performance Score
Company 5.7
0 5 10

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on their exposure to possible recalls or product safety concerns, the strength of their supply chain and sourcing systems, their quality management efforts in manufacturing and their responsible marketing practices.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Controversy Deduction

Company - 1.3

-5.0 -2.5 0

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company	4.9
Industry	4.8

0 Low 5 Mod 10 High Risk

Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risk of increased costs of implementing large scale product recalls, fulfill warranties; potential damage to brand value from loss of consumer trust, negative publicity

Business Types : Percentage of revenue from business segments facing elevated product and service quality risks: · Segments focusing on products that carry health risks (e.g., through injury, contamination, intoxication) · Segments targeting vulnerable populations (minors, low-income) · Segments providing public services such as education and healthcare · Segments relying heavily on government spending as a source of revenue



Source: Jayant R. Kale, et al., 2013, "Contracting with Nonfinancial Stakeholders and Corporate Capital Structure: The Case of Product Warranties," Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, 48, no. 3: 699-727; Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC); U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA); Department of Agriculture; National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA); Federal Trade Commission (FTC); Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC); MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	4.7
Industry	4.2

0 Low 5 Mod 10 Strong Risk Management

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Scope of supplier training on quality standards	Most suppliers, or all 'high risk suppliers'	All suppliers	LOW 6 TOP	2
Measures and reports quantitative indicators related to service quality performance or customer protection	Yes	Detailed, quantitative information on outcomes	LOW 1 TOP	2
Extent of product testing capacity	Third-party testing	In-house testing	LOW 6 TOP	6
Membership in recognized industry-wide partnership(s) on supply chain risk evaluation and mitigation	Formal participant	Formal participant	LOW MID 10	3
Scope of employee training on product quality	Some employees	All employees are trained	LOW 3 TOP	2
Existence of contingency plans/mitigation control systems to ensure that products are in stock, reliable and safe	Mitigation systems in place for key products only	Comprehensive and systematic risk mitigation process (e.g. dual sourcing, back-up manufacturing sites)	LOW 6 TOP	1
Supplier certification level			8	5
Tier 1 - Direct supplier facilities and processes certified by company employees or third-party auditors	Yes	Yes	—	—
Tier 3 - Ingredients / raw materials checked for quality on a regular basis	Yes	Yes	—	—
Certification to product safety or quality standard			10	4
Extent of certification to a widely accepted product safety/quality standard	Most (over 80%) owned facilities are certified to widely accepted standards	Most (over 80%) owned facilities are certified to widely accepted standards	—	—
Extent of certification to an internally developed product safety/quality standard	Most (over 80%) owned facilities are certified to an internally developed standard	Most (over 80%) owned facilities are certified to an internally developed standard	—	—

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Description	Company Performance	Best Practice	Performance Score	Industry Average

Performance

Product recall performance relative to peers			6	6

Product Recalls

Year	Severe (Class I)	Moderate (Class II)	Minor (Class III)	Number of units	Details
2026	8	1	0		
2025	3	1			August 2025 - Walmart rec walmart-recalls-its-frozen-shrimp-in-13-states-citing-potential-radioactive-contamination#:~:text=FDA%2C May 2025 - Walmart https://www.fda.gov/safety/recalls-market-withdrawals-safety-alerts/walmart-inc- April 2025 -Wa https://www.fda.gov/safety/recalls-market-withdrawals-safety-alerts/duda-farm-fresh
2024	4	2			Recall of Wa
2023	1				https://www.fda.gov/safety/recalls-market-withdrawals-safety-alerts/willamette-valley-fruit-co-recall
2020	3				Watermelon chunks as well as sliced grapes, apples, m

Controversy Cases

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Moderate	**Flipkart, India: Regulatory INR 10 lakh fine imposed by Central Consumer Protection Authority on e-commerce platforms for allegedly advertising and selling unregistered Cyclosinone herbicide**	Concluded	October 2026

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Moderate	**Flipkart India, India: Penal action by the FSSAI over alleged regulatory non-compliance related to misleading claims and food safety**	Ongoing	October 2026
Moderate	**US: Allegations of retailer involvement in lawsuits over purported autism and ADHD risks linked to acetaminophen use during pregnancy**	Ongoing	July 2026
Moderate	**Parent's Choice, US: Multidistrict litigation over the alleged presence of toxic heavy metals in baby food products, which reportedly resulted in brain injuries, autism spectrum disorder diagnoses, and other health concerns**	Ongoing	June 2026
Moderate	**Florida, US: Court dismissed lawsuit over alleged negligence in slip-and-fall incident involving ruptured gel pack; plaintiff claimed severe injuries**	Concluded	March 2026
Moderate	**Missouri, US: Premises liability lawsuit over alleged permanent injuries from falling display case; jury reportedly awarded USD 470,000 in damages**	Concluded	February 2026
Moderate	**US: FDA sent warning letters after recalled ByHeart Whole Nutrition infant formula reportedly linked to 51 infant botulism cases remained on store shelves**	Ongoing	January 2026
Moderate	**US: Reportedly thousands faced temporary disruption in app and website access; services restored**	Concluded	January 2026
Moderate	**US: Reportedly thousands faced temporary disruption in app and website access; services restored**	Concluded	January 2026
Moderate	**Marketside Linguine with Beef Meatballs & Marinara Sauce and Marketside Grilled Chicken Alfredo with Fettuccine [Recall, US]: 12 oz, 12.3 oz, and 32.8 oz variants; six deaths and 27 illnesses reported linked to an alleged listeria outbreak; federal investigations ongoing**	Partially Concluded	November 2025
Moderate	**US: Allegations of price tag removal reportedly linked to tariff-driven price hikes caused customer dissatisfaction**	Ongoing	September 2025
Moderate	**US: Allegations of consumer boycotts over social and political controversies, including price hikes and political affiliations**	Ongoing	August 2025
Moderate	**Flipkart, India: BIS raided multiple warehouses over alleged sale of non-certified products**	Ongoing	July 2025
Moderate	**Ozark Trail 64-ounce Stainless Steel Insulated Water Bottles [Recall, US]: 850,000 units; three injuries reported**	Ongoing	July 2025
Moderate	**US: Widespread outage reportedly disrupted mobile application services for delivery drivers**	Ongoing	May 2025
Moderate	**Montreal, Canada: Allegations of negligence after elderly woman left injured in parking lot for over an hour**	Ongoing	March 2025
Minor	**Frozen Berry Products [Recall, US]: Expanded recall due to potential E. coli O145:H28 contamination; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	October 2026
Minor	**California, US: USD 16 million settlement over alleged sale of expired infant formula and OTC drugs; compliance program implemented**	Concluded	October 2026
Minor	**New Jersey, US: Hazardous fumes exposure at retail store reportedly led to 19 hospitalizations; store reopened after safety measures implemented**	Ongoing	September 2026
Minor	**Alabama, US: Fire reportedly caused by freezer malfunction led to grocery area evacuation; no injuries reported**	Concluded	September 2026
Minor	**China: Regulatory sampling reportedly found excessive coliform bacteria in salmon slices, prompting company apology and quality control measures**	Concluded	September 2026
Minor	**Marketside Tomato Bisque Soup Kit 14 oz [Recall, US]: Certain lots; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	August 2026
Minor	**EnHomee 9-Drawer Fabric Dressers [Recall, US]: Approximately 16,809 units; no injuries reported**	Concluded	August 2026
Minor	**Mainstays 9-Drawer Fabric Dressers [Recall, US]: Approximately 165,000 units; no injuries reported**	Concluded	June 2026
Minor	**Florida, US: Lawsuit filed over alleged contamination of canned pasta with worms or parasites; illnesses reportedly linked**	Ongoing	June 2026
Minor	**Blackstone Parmesan Ranch Seasoning [Recall, US]: Certain lots; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	May 2026
Minor	**California, US: Alleged arson incident caused significant damage and indefinite closure of local retail store, no injuries reported**	Ongoing	May 2026
Minor	**Frozen Pizzas [Recall, US]: Two products; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	May 2026
Minor	**FitRx SmartBell Adjustable Dumbbells [Recall, US]: Approximately 50,000 units recalled; six injuries reported**	Concluded	May 2026
Minor	**Dino Shaped Chicken Nuggets [Recall, US]: Lead contamination found; no injuries reported**	Concluded	April 2026

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Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Minor	**Pennsylvania, US: Negligence lawsuit over alleged slip-and-fall incident dismissed due to insufficient evidence of hazardous condition**	Concluded	March 2026
Minor	**Great Value Cottage Cheese [Recall, US]: Multiple batches; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	March 2026
Minor	**Great Value Cottage Cheese [Recall, US]: Multiple batches; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	March 2026
Minor	**US: Allegations of overcharging customers due to incorrect meat weights**	Ongoing	February 2026
Minor	**Grated Pecorino Romano Cheese [Class I Recall, US]: Multiple batches; no illnesses reported**	Concluded	January 2026
Minor	**Florida, US: Alleged health and safety violations at grocery store following failed inspection; multiple food items discarded**	Ongoing	January 2026
Minor	**Great Value 100% Grape Juice 1.82L bottles [Class III Recall, Canada]: Certain batches; no injuries reported**	Concluded	January 2026
Minor	**Mississippi, US: Razor blades reportedly found in bread loaves; suspect arrested amid food tampering investigation**	Ongoing	January 2026
Minor	**Shredded Cheese Products [Class II Recall, US]: Over 1 million bags; no injuries reported**	Concluded	December 2025
Minor	**Ozark Trail Tabletop 1-Burner Butane Camping Stoves BG2247A1 [Recall, US]: 201,000 units; 16 injuries reported**	Ongoing	December 2025
Minor	**Organic Moringa Leaf Powder and Super Greens Powder Mix [Recall, US]: Four products; 11 illnesses and 3 hospitalizations reported**	Concluded	November 2025
Minor	**Great Value Pear Halves in Pear Juice from Concentrate [Class II Recall, US]: certain units; no injuries reported**	Concluded	October 2025

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

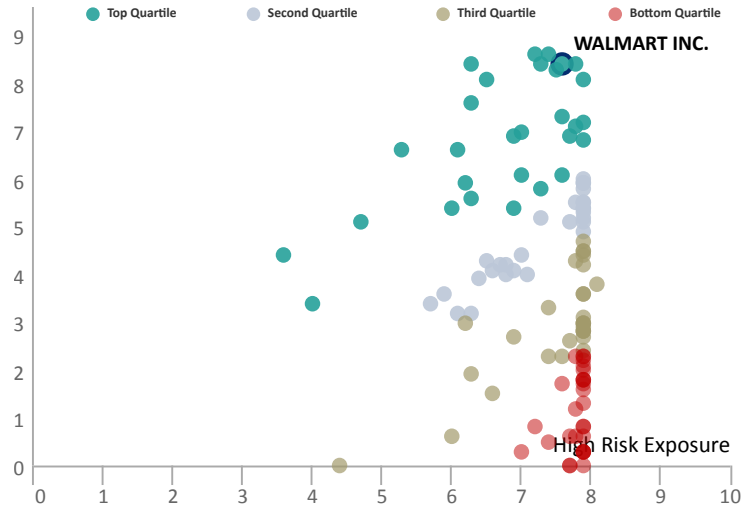
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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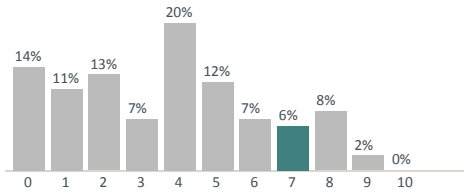
Product Carbon Footprint

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
7.8	0.0	●●●●	7.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



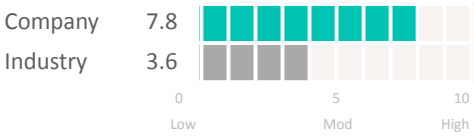
TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

TARGET CORPORATION	9.1
B&M EUROPEAN VALUE RETAIL PLC	8.6
MARKS AND SPENCER GROUP P.L.C.	8.4
DOLLAR TREE, INC.	8.3
Kesko Oyj	8.3

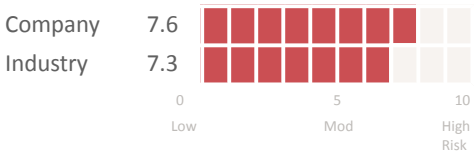
BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

SHUFERSAL LTD	0.0
Spinneys 1961 Holding PLC	0.0
The North West Company Inc.	0.0
VILLAGE SUPER MARKET, INC.	0.0
Yonghui Superstores Co., Ltd.	0.0

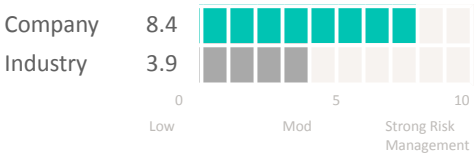
KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT



RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT



RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT



Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types

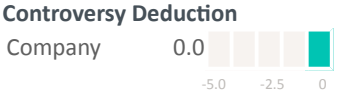


Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score



Controversy Deduction



METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the carbon intensity of their products and their ability to reduce the carbon footprint in their supply chains or in the use of their products and services.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

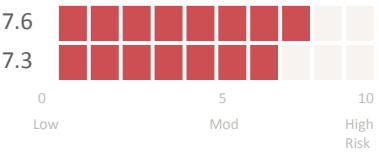
MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

EXPOSURE

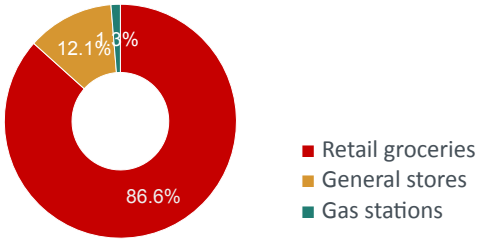
RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risk of having to pay increased product purchasing costs (cost of goods sold) due to aggregate increase in input costs (primarily energy) throughout the upstream stages

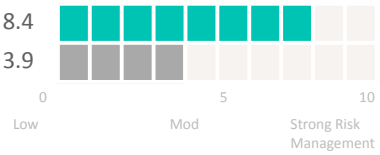
Business Types : Percent of total revenue from products with large/moderate/low carbon footprint (carbon emissions attributed to upstream supply chain per economic value of output) For Automobile: Composition of product portfolio (as percent of total revenue) by vehicle type based on regulatory requirements for vehicle carbon emissions or fuel efficiency, (expressed as fleet average gCO2/km or mpg)



Source: IERS' Comprehensive Environmental Data Archive (CEDA); MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT



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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Targets to reduce Scope 3 upstream carbon emissions	The company has already calculated the carbon footprint of its core products and production stages and has a plan for impact reduction	The company has already calculated the carbon footprint of its core products and production stages and has a plan for impact reduction	LOW MID **10**	4
Extent of energy consumption or carbon emissions reduction programs in transportation and logistics	Improvements in fleet, routes, AND load/ packaging optimization	Improvements in fleet, routes, AND load/ packaging optimization	LOW MID **10**	6
Extent of energy consumption or carbon emissions reduction programs in raw materials sourcing	Some products (anecdotal cases)	All or core products	LOW **6** TOP	3
Extent of energy consumption or carbon emissions reduction programs in manufacturing operations (including suppliers)	Some facilities (anecdotal cases)	All or core production facilities	LOW **6** TOP	2
Extent of energy consumption or carbon emissions reduction programs in distribution centers or store operations	All or most stores and distribution centers	All or most stores and distribution centers	LOW MID **10**	6
Energy consumption or carbon emissions assessment of transportation and logistics	Yes	Yes	LOW **10**	5
Energy consumption or carbon emissions assessment of raw materials sourcing	Yes	Yes	LOW **10**	3
Energy consumption or carbon emissions assessment of manufacturing operations (including suppliers)	Yes	Yes	LOW **10**	3
Energy consumption or carbon emissions assessment of distribution and store operations	Yes	Yes	LOW **10**	6
Assessment of energy consumption and/ or carbon emissions of suppliers	Only a few direct suppliers submit carbon and/or	All suppliers submit carbon and/or energy use data	LOW **6** TOP	2

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	energy data (anecdotal cases)			
Extent of product carbon footprint assessments	Carbon footprint is calculated for core products	Carbon footprint is calculated for all products	LOW 8 TOP	5

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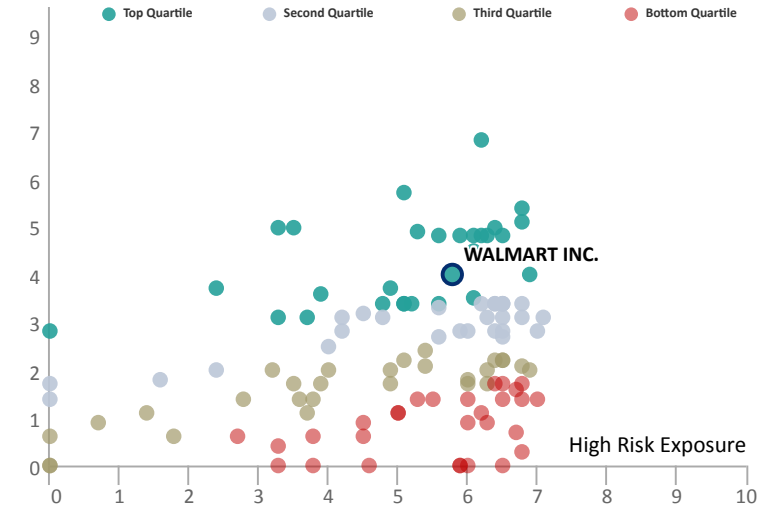
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

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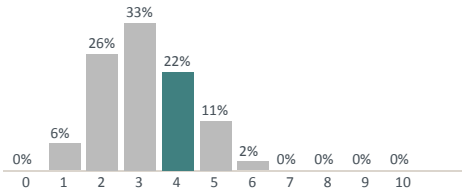
Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
4.2	0.0	●●●●	6.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

CP All Public Company Limited	6.5
PRESIDENT CHAIN STORE CORPORATION	5.5
SPROUTS FARMERS MARKET, INC.	5.4
Natural Grocers by Vitamin Cottage Inc	5.1
Colruyt Group NV	5.0

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

GROCERY OUTLET HOLDING CORP.	1.0
PT Sumber Alfaria Trijaya Tbk	1.0
Sok Marketler Ticaret A.S.	1.0
Yonghui Superstores Co., Ltd.	1.0
SAN-A CO.,LTD.	0.9

KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT

Company 4.2
Industry 3.1
0 5 10
Low Mod High

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company 5.8
Industry 5.1
0 5 10
Low Mod High Risk

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company 4.0
Industry 2.4
0 5 10
Low Mod Strong Risk Management

Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types
Company 4.3
0 5 10

Business Locations
Company 8.4
0 5 10

Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score
Company 5.3
0 5 10

Controversy Deduction
Company - 1.3
-5.0 -2.5 0

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the nutritional content of their food products and their efforts to introduce products with an improved nutritional or health profile.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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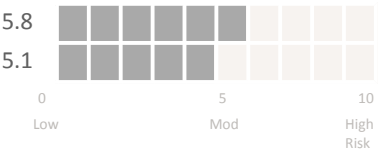
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

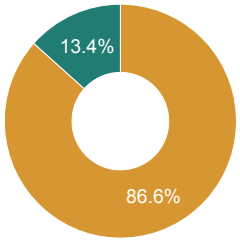
Company	5.8
Industry	5.1



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Opportunities for growth in underserved markets and demographics and potential for strengthening brand positioning in the market for healthier and more nutritious products

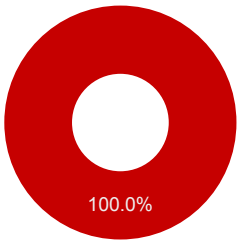
Business Types : Percentage of revenue from product segments with high/moderate/low levels of fat and sugar content and segments for nutritional and healthier products that are projected to grow



- No exposure to high opportunity segments
- Retail groceries
- General stores, Gas stations

Source: The EAT-Lancet Commission on Food, Planet, Health, Sustainable Food Systems: Summary Report; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Business Locations : Percentage of revenue from countries with high rates of obesity or high malnutrition rates



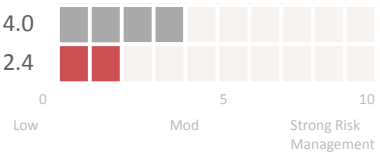
- other countries, USA, Latin America, China, Canada
- No operations in markets with medium opportunities
- No operations in markets with low opportunities

Source: World Business Council for Sustainable Development's FReSH insights report on "Consumption Behavior and Trends;" Obesity Evidence Hub; the Organic Trade Association's consumption estimates data for organic packaged foods and beverages; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	4.0
Industry	2.4



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
In-house innovation capacity to develop healthier products	Limited	Extensive in-house research	LOW 5 TOP	1
Strategy to develop natural and healthy products	Some initiatives	Yes	LOW 5 TOP	3
Food & beverage nutrition enhancement programs score			6	4

Controversy Cases

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Moderate	**US: Federal appeals court revived portions of litigation comprising approximately 100 lawsuits over alleged misleading claims involving oral phenylephrine decongestants**	Ongoing	August 2026
Moderate	**India: Central Consumer Protection Authority imposed INR 1 million penalty over illegal sale listings of walkie-talkies with undisclosed operating frequencies**	Concluded	February 2026
Moderate	**Canada: Class action lawsuit filed over alleged misrepresentation of imported products as Canadian, seeking consumer compensation**	Ongoing	September 2025
Minor	**US: Allegations of misleading marketing over purported Thanksgiving meal cost reduction; scrutiny over product substitutions and item count differences**	Concluded	November 2025

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

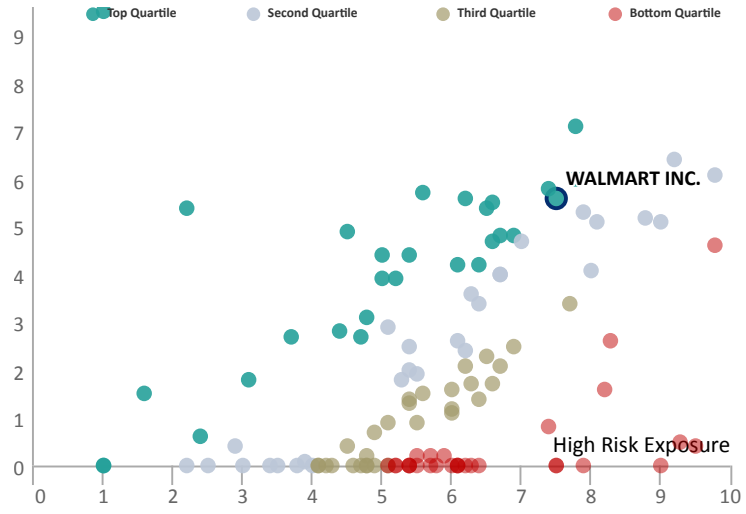
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

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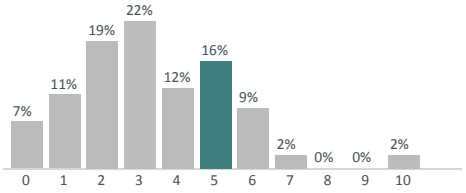
Raw Material Sourcing

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
5.2	0.0	●●●●	6.0%	Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



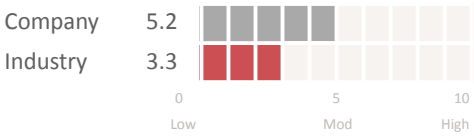
TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

ACOMO N.V.	10.0
Natural Grocers by Vitamin Cottage Inc	10.0
Zabka Group SA	7.4
Kesko Oyj	7.1
Villars Holding SA	6.5

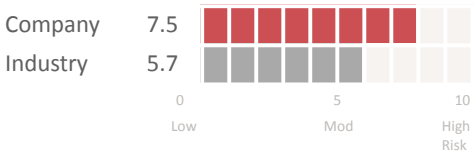
BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

B&M EUROPEAN VALUE RETAIL PLC	0.0
BIM BIRLESIK MAGAZALAR ANONIM SIRKETI	0.0
DOLLAR GENERAL CORPORATION	0.0
DOLLARAMA INC.	0.0
GROCERY OUTLET HOLDING CORP.	0.0

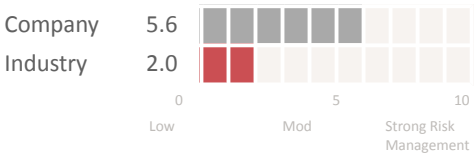
KEY ISSUE ASSESSMENT



RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT



RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT



Drivers of Risk Exposure

Business Types



Drivers of Risk Management

Practices Score



Controversy Deduction



METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the environmental impacts of the raw materials used in their products and their efforts around supply chain traceability and certification.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

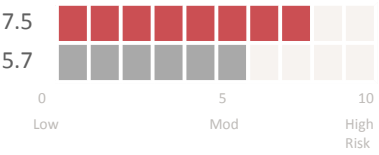
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Company	7.5
Industry	5.7



Additional Exposure Indicators

Risk: Dependency on Raw Material

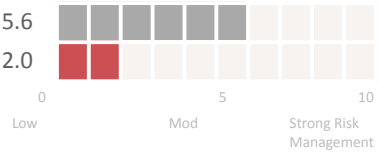
Estimated percent of sales reliant on material (private label where applicable)

Seafood:	**5.00%**
Timber and/or Paper:	**2.00%**
Palm Oil:	**20.00%**
Beef and/or Dairy:	**20.00%**
Cotton:	**2.00%**

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	5.6
Industry	2.0



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of timber and/or paper production	In process of implementing sustainable timber purchasing requirements at core suppliers	Requires all suppliers to produce or purchase sustainable timber/paper and verifies compliance	LOW 8 TOP	5
Percentage of timber or paper third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	4
Future targets for timber and/or paper sourcing	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	LOW MID 10	5
Extent of timber and/or paper traceability to place of origin	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	2
Extent of timber certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	3
Commitments towards responsible timber and/or paper sourcing	Publicly stated formal policy	Publicly stated formal policy	LOW MID 10	6
Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of seafood production	In process of implementing sustainable seafood/ aquaculture production or purchasing requirements at core suppliers	Requires all suppliers to produce or purchase sustainable seafood/ aquaculture and verifies compliance	LOW 8 TOP	4
Percentage of seafood third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	2
Future targets for seafood sourcing	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	LOW MID 10	3
Extent of seafood traceability to place of origin	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	2

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Extent of seafood certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	2
Commitments towards responsible seafood sourcing	Publicly stated formal policy	Publicly stated formal policy	LOW MID 10	4
Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of palm oil production	In process of implementing sustainable palm oil purchasing requirements at core suppliers	Requires all suppliers to produce or purchase sustainable palm oil and verifies compliance	LOW 8 TOP	3
Percentage of palm oil third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard	More than 60%	All Products	LOW 8 TOP	3
Future targets for palm oil sourcing	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	LOW MID 10	3
Extent of palm oil traceability to place of origin	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	1
Extent of palm oil certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	1
Commitments towards responsible palm oil sourcing	Publicly stated formal policy	Publicly stated formal policy	LOW MID 10	4
Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of cotton production	In process of implementing water and pesticide reduction programs with major cotton suppliers	Requires all suppliers to produce or purchase sustainable cotton and verifies compliance	LOW 8 TOP	2
Percentage of cotton third-party certified to an environmental standard	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	2
Future targets for cotton sourcing	General target of continuous improvement (e.g. development of tracking programs)	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	LOW 5 TOP	3

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Extent of cotton traceability to place of origin	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	1
Commitments towards responsible cotton sourcing	Publicly stated formal policy	Publicly stated formal policy	LOW MID 10	4
Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of beef and/or dairy production	In process of implementing sustainable beef/dairy production requirements with core farmers or suppliers	Requires all farmers or suppliers to produce or purchase sustainable beef/ dairy and verifies compliance	LOW 8 TOP	1
Percentage of beef and/or dairy third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	0
Future targets for beef and/or dairy sourcing	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	The company has clear measurable targets or all products are already certified or traced	LOW MID 10	1
Extent of beef and/or dairy traceability to place of origin	Up to 30%	All Products	LOW 3 TOP	1
Commitments towards responsible beef and/or dairy sourcing	Publicly stated formal policy	Publicly stated formal policy	LOW MID 10	2

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

APPENDIX

CONTENTS

ADDITIONAL ESG ISSUES

CONTROVERSIES DETAIL

ADDITIONAL CORPORATE GOVERNANCE CONTENT

KEY METRIC & SCORE CHANGES

CEO PAY CHARTS

DIRECTOR VOTES

SHAREHOLDER/MANAGEMENT PROPOSALS

GOVERNANCE STANDARDS

DIRECTOR PROFILES

EU REGULATION 2024/3005 DISCLOSURES

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

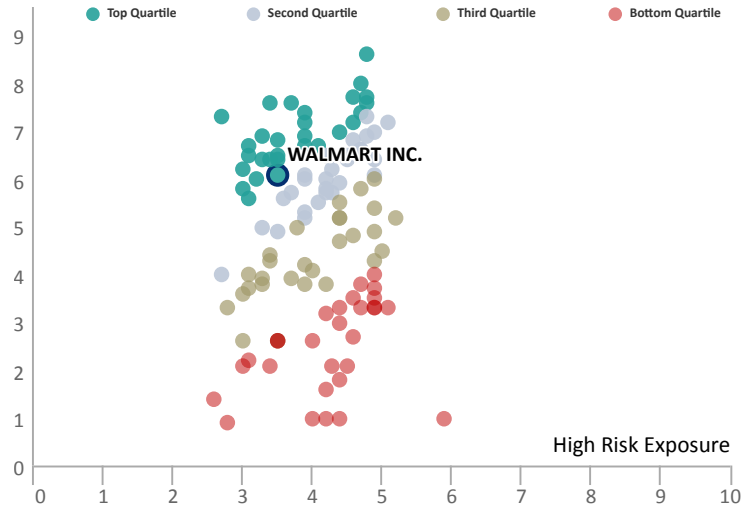
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

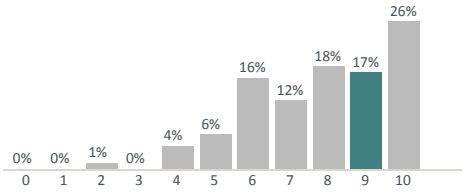
Carbon Emissions

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
9.6	0.0	●●●●		Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



This issue does not present significant risks or opportunities to the company and with the assigned weight of 0% does not contribute to the overall ESG rating for the company.

MSCI Research provides additional scores on a select set of Key Issues for all companies on the MSCI ACWI Index and MSCI ACWI IMI Index. Every company on the index receives scores for the following Key Issues, regardless of whether they contribute to the overall Company ESG Rating.

The additional key issue scores and data available by index are as follows:

- MSCI ACWI: Water Stress, Labor Management, Privacy and Data Security
- MSCI ACWI IMI: Carbon Emissions and Human Capital Development

TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

ALBERTSONS COMPANIES, INC.	10.0
Axfood AB	10.0
BELLIS FINCO PLC	10.0
COSTCO WHOLESALE CORPORATION	10.0
DFI Retail Group Holdings Limited	10.0

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

RAMI LEVI CHAIN STORES HASHIKMA MARKETING 2006 LTD	4.0
M.YOCHANANOF AND SONS (1988) LTD	3.8
Genky DrugStores Co., Ltd.	3.6
EROSKI SOCIEDAD COOPERATIVA	3.1
DONG SUH COMPANIES INC.	2.1

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the carbon intensity of their operations and their efforts to manage climate-related risks and opportunities.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

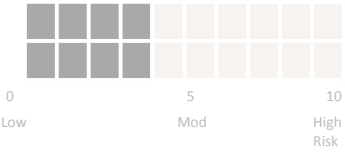
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

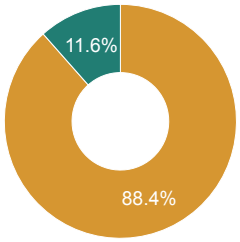
Company	3.5
Industry	4.1



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risks of having to pay increased compliance costs tied to carbon emissions regulations

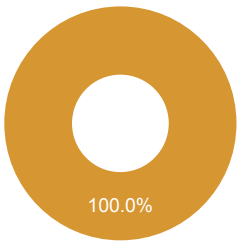
Business Types : Percentage of operations in business segments with high/moderate/low carbon intensity



- No exposure to high risk segments
- Retail groceries
- General stores

Source: GHG emissions intensities compiled by MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Business Locations : Percentage of operations in countries with strengthening or pending carbon emissions regulation



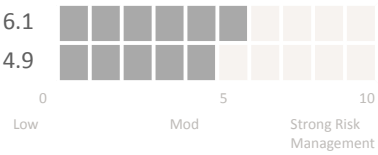
- No operations in markets with high risks
- other countries, USA
- No operations in markets with low risks

Source: International Monetary Fund (IMF) Implied Mitigation Targets; Net Zero Tracker; Carbon Pricing Dashboard, IMF Fossil Fuel subsidies data; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	6.1
Industry	4.9



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Carbon emissions target verification			10	10
Carbon emissions target progress			0	3
Carbon emissions target comprehensiveness			8	5
Use of cleaner sources of energy	Some efforts	Aggressive efforts	LOW 7 TOP	6
Energy Consumption Management & Operational Efficiency	Some efforts	Aggressive efforts	LOW 7 TOP	6

Description	Company Performance	Best Practice	Performance Score	Industry Average
Performance				
Carbon emissions performance relative to peers			6	5

GHG Emissions - metric tons CO2e

Year	Scope 1 Disclosed	Scope 1 Estimate Key	Scope 2 Disclosed	Scope 2 Estimate Key	Scope 1+2 Disclosed	Scope 3 (upstream)	Scope 3 (downstream)	Scope 3 (undefined)	Scope 1 Estimated	Scope 2 Estimated	Scope 1+2 Estimated	Scope 1+2 Estimate Key	GHG Emissions Details
2024	9,031,550	Reported	9,674,115	Reported	18,705,665							Reported	
2023	8,114,452	Reported	9,783,886	Reported	17,898,338							Reported	
2022	7,880,866	Reported	9,981,536	Reported	17,862,402							Reported	
2021	7,312,245	Reported	9,475,167	Reported	16,787,412							Reported	
2020	7,236,499	Reported	11,031,800	Reported	18,268,299							Reported	

GHG Emissions Intensity - metric tons CO2e / USD million sales

Year	GHG Intensity	GHG Intensity Details	GHG Intensity - Reported	GHG Intensity - Reported Details
2024	27.47		22.98	mt CO2e per $M revenue
2023	27.62		0.00	
2022	29.22		0.00	tCO2e per unit total revenue
2021	29.31		29.38	mt CO2e per $M revenue
2020	32.67		33.52	mt CO2e per $M revenue

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Water Stress

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
9.2	0.0	●●●		Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management

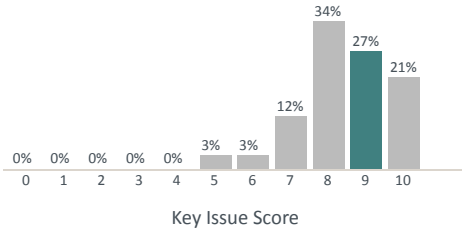


This issue does not present significant risks or opportunities to the company and with the assigned weight of 0% does not contribute to the overall ESG rating for the company.

MSCI Research provides additional scores on a select set of Key Issues for all companies on the MSCI ACWI Index and MSCI ACWI IMI Index. Every company on the index receives scores for the following Key Issues, regardless of whether they contribute to the overall Company ESG Rating.

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- MSCI ACWI: Water Stress, Labor Management, Privacy and Data Security
- MSCI ACWI IMI: Carbon Emissions and Human Capital Development

KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

BID CORPORATION LIMITED	10.0
J SAINSBURY PLC	10.0
Jeronimo Martins, SGPS, S.A.	10.0
TARGET CORPORATION	10.0
SHOPRITE HOLDINGS LIMITED	9.9

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

DINO POLSKA SPOLKA AKCYJNA	6.7
Zabka Group SA	6.7
DOLLAR TREE, INC.	6.6
CASEY'S GENERAL STORES, INC.	6.3
Cencosud S.A.	4.9

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on the water intensity of their operations, levels of water stress in their areas of operation and their efforts to manage water-related risks and opportunities.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

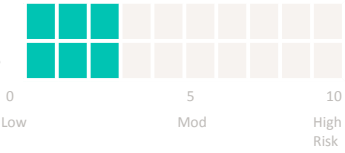
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

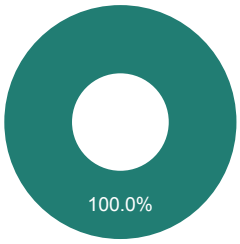
Company	2.9
Industry	2.8



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risk of increased cost of input, disputes around access rights to key resources or operational disruptions to production processes requiring water as a critical input

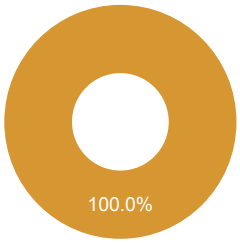
Business Types : Percentage of operations in business segments with high/moderate/low water intensity



- No exposure to high risk segments
- No exposure to medium risk segments
- Retail groceries, General stores

Source: The International Earth Rotation Service's Comprehensive Environmental Data Archive; M.M. Mekonnen and A.Y. Hoekstra, "The green, blue and grey water footprint of crops and derived crop products," Hydrology and Earth System Sciences 15, no. 5 (2011): 1,577-1,600.; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

Business Locations : Percentage of operations in countries or regions with high/moderate/low percent of territory affected by oversubscription to water resources



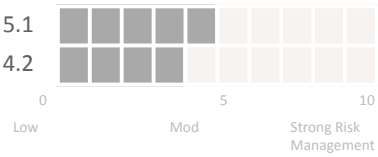
- No operations in markets with high risks
- other countries, USA
- No operations in markets with low risks

Source: Hofste, R., S. Kuzma, S. Walker, E.H. Sutanudjaja, et. al., 2019, "Aqueduct 4.0: Updated Decision- Relevant Global Water Risk Indicators," Technical Note, Washington, DC: World Resources Institute; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	5.1
Industry	4.2



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Executive body responsible for water management strategy and performance			10	10
Executive body responsible for company's environmental management strategy and performance	Board-level committee	Board-level committee	—	—
Scope of water reduction programs at own operations	No evidence	Multiple water use-reduction programs implemented across all water-stressed areas	0 TOP	0
Water recycling rate score			3	3
Use of alternative water			7	4
Evidence of using alternative water sources	Yes	Yes	—	—
Water stress target comprehensiveness			0	3
Water stress target progress			0	1

Water Consumption/ Withdrawal Targets

Baseline Year	Target Year	Target Description	Target Reduction (%)
2013	2014	Reduce water consumption	7.00%

Description	Company Performance	Best Practice	Performance Score	Industry Average
Performance				
Freshwater withdrawal performance relative to peers			8	5

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Water Withdrawal Performance

Year	Freshwater Withdrawal (m3)	Freshwater Withdrawal Intensity (m3/ USD million sales)
2023	43,313,000	66.83
2018	54,217,000	105.40

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Human Capital Development

Score	Change (since rating)	Quartile	Weight	Last score change date
9.2	0.0	●●●		Oct 29, 2026

Strong Risk Management



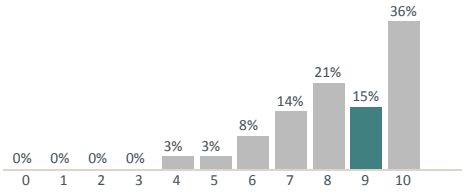
This issue does not present significant risks or opportunities to the company and with the assigned weight of 0% does not contribute to the overall ESG rating for the company.

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- MSCI ACWI IMI: Carbon Emissions and Human Capital Development

KEY ISSUE SCORE DISTRIBUTION*



TOP 5 INDUSTRY LEADERS

ALIMENTATION COUCHE-TARD INC.	10.0
Axfood AB	10.0
B&M EUROPEAN VALUE RETAIL PLC	10.0
BJ'S WHOLESALE CLUB HOLDINGS, INC.	10.0
Berli Jucker Public Company Limited	10.0

BOTTOM 5 INDUSTRY LAGGARDS

LA COMER, S.A.B. DE C.V.	5.4
DONG SUH COMPANIES INC.	4.7
RAMI LEVI CHAIN STORES HASHIKMA MARKETING 2006 LTD	4.4
THE CHEFS' WAREHOUSE, INC.	4.3
Almunajem Foods Company SJSC	4.2

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Companies are evaluated on their workforce talent requirements and their ability to attract, retain, and develop a highly skilled workforce.

*[For symbols and terms used in this report, refer to the Glossary section at the end of the report]

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS **AA**

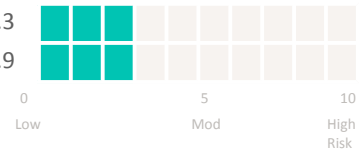
CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | **AA** | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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EXPOSURE

RISK EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

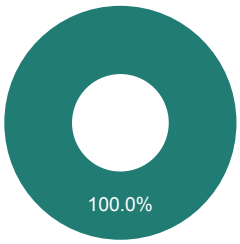
Company	3.3
Industry	2.9



Key Drivers of Risk Exposure

Exposure to: Risk of increased turnover and associated costs of rehiring, loss of intellectual and human capital through attrition, reduced ability to attract talent

Business Types : Percentage of operations in business segments with high/moderate/low levels of employee qualification needs and compensation per employee



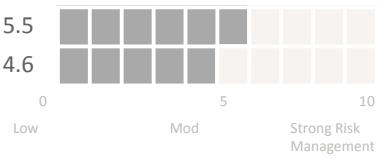
- No exposure to high risk segments
- No exposure to medium risk segments
- Retail groceries, General stores

Source: Employment Projections Program, Bureau of Labor Statistics; Occupational Employment Statistics, Bureau of Labor Statistics; MSCI Sustainability & Climate; Refinitiv; company disclosures.

MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT

Company	5.5
Industry	4.6



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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Description	Company Practice	Best Practice	Practices Score	Industry Average
Practice				
Skills and knowledge development training	General statements on leadership training with unknown scope or achieved results	Comprehensive succession planning & development programs at multiple levels	LOW 5 TOP	5
Employee equity programs	Only select number of employees eligible for ESOP and/or ESPP	Sector-leading number of employees eligible for ESOP and/or ESPP	LOW 7 TOP	4
Workforce eligible for paid parental leave policy	Benefits cover selected employees	Benefits cover all employees	LOW 7 TOP	3
Employee satisfaction survey frequency	Surveys conducted annually	Surveys conducted annually	LOW MID 10	6

Workforce Diversity

Year (YYYY)	Annual employee turnover
2025	
2024	
2023	
2022	
2021	

Controversy Cases

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Severe	**Massmart Holdings Limited, South Africa: Strikes by employees over wages, commissions, and working conditions**	Partially Concluded	November 2025
Moderate	**US: Allegations of wrongful termination and discrimination following mistaken identity incident involving a tall cisgender woman**	Ongoing	April 2025
Minor	**Washington, US: Lawsuit over alleged retaliation and unlawful termination following workplace harassment complaints; jury award reduced to statutory cap**	Concluded	August 2026
Minor	**Texas, US: USD 13 million settlement over alleged misrepresentation of wages and tips to delivery drivers under grocery delivery program**	Concluded	July 2026
Minor	**Ontario, Canada: Unifor Settles Walmart Wage Freeze Complaint as Workers Secure Historic First Collective Agreement**	Concluded	June 2026
Minor	**California, US: Employee lawsuit over alleged violation of consumer reporting law through deficient background check form and certification process**	Ongoing	April 2026
Minor	**New York, US: USD 60,000 settlement of disability discrimination lawsuit over alleged failure to accommodate employee with hearing, speech, and cognitive impairments**	Concluded	January 2026

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Assessment	Headline	Status	Last Updated
Minor	**India: Nationwide protests by gig workers over alleged unsafe working conditions, unfair pay, and denial of social security**	Ongoing	January 2026

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

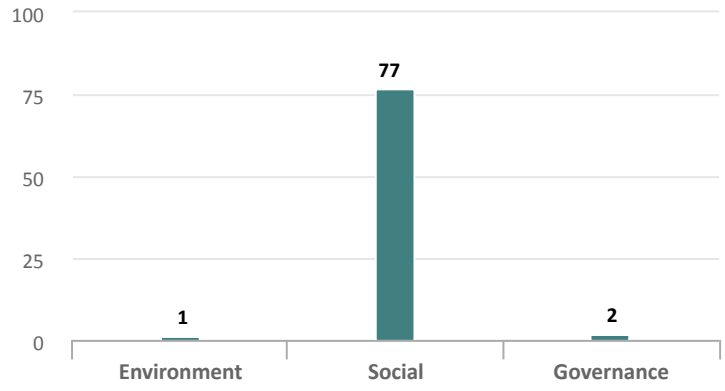
CONTROVERSIES DETAIL

Here you will find the narratives for all controversies relevant to the company. Please note while every controversy case may signal reputational risk, not every controversy is judged to pose material risks; therefore, not every controversy affects the company's overall rating.

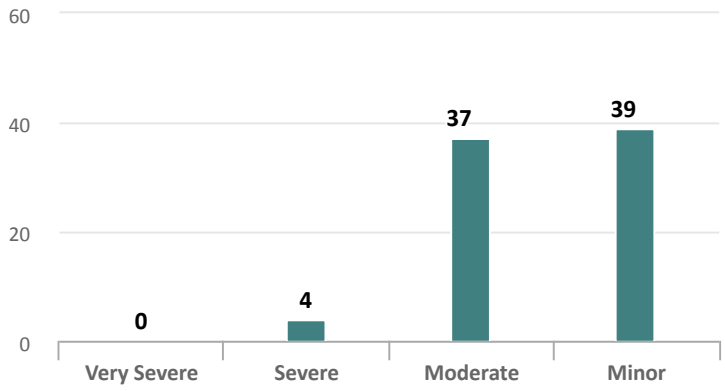
CONTROVERSY CARD

	ASSESSMENT				
	VERY SEVERE	SEVERE	MODERATE	MINOR	CONTROVERSY COUNT
Environment					
Product Carbon Footprint	0	0	0	0	0
Carbon Emissions	0	0	0	0	0
Raw Material Sourcing	0	0	0	0	0
Water Stress	0	0	0	0	0
Social					
Opportunities in Nutrition & Health	0	0	3	1	4
Supply Chain Labor Standards	0	1	3	0	4
Human Capital Development	0	1	1	6	8
Labor Management	0	2	1	6	9
Privacy & Data Security	0	0	0	1	1
Product Safety & Quality	0	0	16	26	42
Governance					
Corporate Governance	0	0	0	0	0
Corporate Behavior	0	1	10	1	12

NUMBER OF CONTROVERSIES BY PILLAR



NUMBER OF CONTROVERSIES BY ASSESSMENT



CONTROVERSIES

- ***Very Severe:*** Indicates an action by a company that results in a very large impact on society and/or the environment.
- ***Severe:*** Indicates an action by a company that results in a large impact on society and/or the environment.
- ***Moderate:*** Indicates an action by a company that results in a moderate impact on society and/or the environment.
- ***Minor:*** Indicates an action by a company that results in a low impact on society and/or the environment.
- ***None:*** There is no evidence that a company is involved in any controversy.

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ENVIRONMENTAL CONTROVERSIES

Moderate Controversies

Date: March 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Mexico: Allegations of avocado sourcing allegedly linked to illegal deforestation

UPDATES: 21 Aug 2024: In Mexico, avocado suppliers continue sourcing from illegally deforested land. (Mongabay)

08 Aug 2024: US Avocado Demand Drives Mass Deforestation in Mexico. (BNN Bloomberg)

Source: 21 Aug 2024 (Mongabay)

SOCIAL CONTROVERSIES

Severe Controversies

Date: April 2026
Assessment: Severe
Status: Ongoing

Asda, UK: Gender discrimination claims against Asda; claim under final stage of the Employment Tribunal process

In its quarterly report filed in June 2018, Walmart Inc. (Walmart) disclosed that its ASDA Stores Ltd (Asda) subsidiary in the U.K. was a respondent in approximately 10,000 "equal value" claims filed by female employees in an employment tribunal in Manchester. The plaintiffs claimed that the disparity between their compensation and that of male counterparts was not justified, and that the work they performed in retail stores was of "equal value" compared with the duties performed by male employees in Asda's warehouse and distribution centers. claimants sought differential back pay based on higher wage rates.

LATEST CASE UPDATES In March 2026, the tribunal panel in Manchester ruled that 24 additional non-lead roles, including female shop floor assistants at pharmacies and fuel stations, delivery drivers, and security staff, perform work of equal value to their male counterparts in depots. BACKGROUND (FROM LEAST TO MOST RECENT) In October 2016, the Employment Tribunal ruled that shop employees, who were mostly women and worked at check-out counters or stacked shelves, could compare themselves with staff, mainly men, who worked at warehouses. Asda's appeal to the ruling was denied by the U.K. Court of Appeals in January 2019. Following this, the company filed an appeal with the U.K. Supreme Court, which upheld the ruling in March 2021. In February 2021, Walmart announced the completion of the sale of Asda. In its March 2021 annual report, the company stated that it would continue to conduct the defense of 40,000 "equal value" claims filed against Asda. The company added that it would provide indemnification for related liabilities up to a contractually determined amount. In January 2025, the Employment Tribunal decided that most of the lead claimants' roles in Asda stores were of equal value to those in distribution centers. The ruling applied to roles such as checkout staff and shop assistants in departments such as bakery and clothing. However, it excluded two positions involving online packing and handling packaged goods, purportedly affecting around 11,000 workers. The case has entered its final phase, where Asda reportedly needed to show that the pay gap is due to non-gender-related factors.

UPDATES: 26 Mar 2026: 'Victory' for more female Asda workers in £1.2bn equal pay claim. (The Grocer)

18 Mar 2026: More Asda jobs ruled comparable in £1.2bn equal pay claim. (Personnel Today)

14 Mar 2025: 10-K, 2025. (Walmart, Inc.)

06 Feb 2025: Thousands of Asda workers win latest stage in decade-long equal pay case. (The Guardian)

18 Mar 2022: 10-K, 2022. (Walmart Inc.)

26 Mar 2021: Asda workers win key appeal in equal pay fight. (BBC)

19 Mar 2021: 10-K, 2021. (Walmart Inc.)

18 Feb 2021: 8-K. (Walmart Inc.)

02 Dec 2020: 10-Q, 2020. (Walmart Inc.)

02 Sep 2020: 10-Q, 2020. (Walmart Inc.)

04 Dec 2019: 10-Q, 2019. (Walmart Inc.)

31 Jan 2019: Equal pay: Asda loses appeal in court case. (BBC News)

Source: 26 Mar 2026 (The Grocer)

Date: November 2025
Assessment: Severe
Status: Partially Concluded

Massmart Holdings Limited, South Africa: Strikes by employees over wages, commissions, and working conditions

Since at least 2021, Massmart Holdings Ltd. (Massmart), a subsidiary of Walmart, faced labor strikes and industrial action issues.

LATEST CASE UPDATES In May 2025, the Congress of South African Trade Unions (COSATU) released a statement supporting the South African Commercial, Catering and Allied Workers Union (SACCAWU) in its legal proceedings against Massmart over the company's alleged dismissal of nearly 600 workers after a strike by union members in 2021. Massmart reportedly claimed that the strike turned violent. In relation to this incident, SACCAWU was also appealing a 2024 ruling by the Constitutional Court of South Africa which had ordered the union to pay ZAR 9.4 million (approximately USD 512,930) in damages to Massmart.

BACKGROUND (FROM LEAST TO MOST RECENT) In December 2021, thousands of workers ended a strike against Massmart after the company reached an agreement over labor disputes with the SACCAWU.

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In October 2022, the SACCAWU undertook a three-day strike at 22 Makro stores, owned by Massmart. The workers went on strike after four months of negotiations reportedly came to a standstill. SACCAWU's demands included a minimum wage of ZAR 8,000 (approximately USD 436) or a wage increase of 12% or ZAR 900 (approximately USD 49) depending on which was higher, a 20% sales commission, additional wages beyond the December salary, and a suspension on retrenchments. In contrast, Makro offered a 4.5% wage increase, which the union stated was insufficient to meet rising costs due to inflation. After the strike, SACCAWU submitted a memorandum of demands and warned of further action- including an indefinite nationwide strike- if the demands were not met. Furthermore, the union's head of research alleged that 249 management-level members resigned from their union membership because Massmart forced them to. Employees also claimed there were threats that they would not receive their December bonuses and wages if they went on a strike. In November 2022, SACCAWU planned a strike at all Massmart stores from Black Friday until Saturday the next day. During the first day of the strike, the police reportedly attempted to disperse striking workers in front of Makro Germiston using tear gas and pyrotechnics.

In January 2023, SACCAWU alleged that Makro had issued a memo asking workers to accept the 4.5% wage increase and resign from the union. Makro denied these allegations. After unsuccessful negotiations over its wage demands before the Commission for Conciliation, Mediation, and Arbitration later that month, SACCAWU members went on a 10-day strike. Massmart's corporate affairs executive estimated that 1,300 SACCAWU members took part in the demonstration.

UPDATES: 06 May 2025: COSATU stands in solidarity with SACCAWU against Massmart. (Congress of South African Trade Unions)

02 May 2024: Saccawu liable for R9.4m bill over violent strike at Massmart during riots. (IOL BusinessReport)

03 Feb 2023: Walmart-owned Massmart and Saccawu trade barbs over latest Makro Strike. (News24)

25 Jan 2023: Saccawu to strike at Makro over wages. (Times Live South Africa)

02 Jan 2023: Saccawu urges members not to accept Massmart's 4,5% wage offer. (IOL)

25 Nov 2022: Tear gas comes out at Makro Germiston. (Business Insider)

24 Nov 2022: Union plans picket at Makro warehouses on Black Friday. (News24)

31 Oct 2022: Three-day strike at Makro ends, but union warns of further action. (News24)

27 Oct 2022: Makro faces indefinite strike as union demands 12% wage hike. (News24)

17 Oct 2022: Union to strike at Makro as wage dispute drags on. (News24)

07 Dec 2021: So. Africa: Massmart workers end strike after agreement reached over wages, restructuring & changes to working conditions. (Business & Human Rights Resource Centre)

Source: 06 May 2025 (Congress of South African Trade Unions)

Date: November 2025

Assessment: Severe
Status: Ongoing

China: Allegations of forced labor related to suppliers employing ethnic minorities through coercive state-sponsored labor-transfer programs

Latest: In June 2025, several media outlets reported that a non-governmental organization, Global Rights Compliance (GRC), published an investigation linking multiple Western companies to the critical minerals industry in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region (XUAR). GRC alleged that these companies were at risk of having forced labor in their supply chains due to their use of minerals or mineral-based products from suppliers sourcing from XUAR. The products reportedly included commercial paints, insulated cups, and components used in the aerospace, auto, and defense industries.

Citing GRC, Forbes reported that several brands, including Walmart, Inc. (Walmart), were listed as "cooperative partners" of Wujo Group, which also identifies itself as the supplier of the company. According to the report, Wujo International (Wujo Group's trading company) sourced from XUAR and was responsible for the import and export of Wujo Group’s products.

Background: The report follows multiple investigations by the media and human rights organizations, which claim that since 2017, more than one million Uyghurs, Kazakhs and other ethnic minorities have been arbitrarily detained in ‘re-education camps’ or ‘Vocational Education and Training Centres’ (VETCs), held under constant electronic and in-person surveillance, and subjected to abuse. In a June 2021 report by Amnesty International titled “Like we were enemies in a war”, 55 former detainees provided detailed accounts of the conditions inside the VETCs and factories they were later transferred to.

In March 2020, the Australian Strategic Policy Institute (ASPI) released a policy brief entitled “Uyghurs for sale” in which it identified 82 foreign and Chinese companies “potentially directly or indirectly benefiting from the use of Uyghur workers outside Xinjiang through coercive labor transfer programs,” including Walmart Inc.

According to the ASPI, Walmart was listed by a U.S.-based international textiles business platform as one of the customers supplied by Jiangsu Guotai Guosheng Co., Ltd., which owned Shandong Zoucheng Guosheng. The report claimed that a satellite factory of Shandong Zoucheng Guosheng had allegedly brought thousands of jobs to Xinjiang. Furthermore, the report stated that Walmart was linked to Qingdao Jifa Huajin Garment Co. Ltd., a shirt and apparel manufacturer which was alleged to be 'training' employees at its Shule County industrial park and planning to engage thousands of Xinjiang workers.

The ASPI report claimed that since 2017 more than one million Uyghurs, Kazakhs and other ethnic minorities have been arbitrarily detained in ‘re-education camps’ or ‘Vocational Education and Training Centres’ (VETCs), held under constant electronic and in-person surveillance, and subjected to abuse. In a June 2021 report by Amnesty International entitled “Like we were enemies in a war”, 55 former detainees were interviewed offering first-hand accounts of the conditions inside these centers and factories they were later transferred to.

In January 2022, CNN reported that Walmart received criticisms from the Chinese social media and the ruling Communist Party’s Central Commission for Discipline Inspection (CCDI) after Walmart allegedly removed Xinjiang-sourced products from Sam's Club- a warehouse retailer owned by Walmart. According to the report, Sam's Club's customer service representatives stated that the products were not available due to storage concerns.

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In August 2022, the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) published its "Assessment of human rights concerns in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region, People's Republic of China" and considered the legal framework justifying these re-education camps to be discriminatory in nature and posed a serious risk of human rights violations.

The OHCHR report also claimed to have found a link between the VETCs and (state-sponsored) labor transfer schemes, where companies both local and international were incentivized to absorb labor from the camps.

The OHCHR report has reiterated concerns raised in the February 2022 report published by the International Labor Organization (ILO) that claimed to have found evidence of coercive measures and forced labor practices targeting Uyghurs and other ethnic minorities. According to the ILO, practices included "government-led mobilization of rural households, organizing forced transfers in accordance with labor export quotas; the relocation or transfer of workers under security escort; onsite management and retention of workers under strict surveillance; the threat of internment in vocational education and training centers if workers do not accept 'government administration' and the inability of placed workers to freely change employers."

In response to the OHCHR report, the People's Republic of China (PRC) has defended VETCs as tools for poverty alleviation and countering terrorism and religious extremism, and claims "trainees who have completed their studies in education and training centers have gone on to find employment in factories and enterprises."

In August 2023, Al Jazeera reported that the Canadian Ombudsperson for Responsible Enterprise (CORE) launched an investigation into three companies, including Walmart, over the alleged involvement of the companies' suppliers in forced labor in XUAR.

In July 2023, the Business & Human Rights Resource Centre reported that Walmart had discontinued selling Milwaukee Tool-branded gloves on its online platforms due to the alleged link between the product's manufacturing and forced labor in a Chinese prison.

In February 2024, Forbes published a report alleging that canned tomato products linked to Hebei Tomato Industry, which claimed in its website that its "raw materials come from Xinjiang," were being sold by third-party sellers in online marketplaces such as Walmart.

UPDATES: 15 Jun 2025: Western Supply Chains Tainted By Uyghur Forced Labor. (Forbes.com)

12 Jun 2025: Report: Western Supply Chains Tied to Uyghur Forced Labor in China's Critical Minerals Boom. (The Diplomat)

11 Jun 2025: Rights group says global brands are at risk of links to forced labor in China's minerals industry. (The Independent)

06 Feb 2024: The U.S. Banned Xinjiang Tomatoes Over Uyghur Forced Labor Fears. Amazon and Walmart Still Sell Them. (Forbes.com)

24 Aug 2023: Canada probing Walmart, Hugo Boss over allegations of forced labor in supply chains. (THIS IS MONEY)

17 Jul 2023: USA: Walmart pulls Milwaukee Tool gloves over alleged use of Chinese prison labour. (Business & Human Rights)

22 Dec 2022: Human rights advocates raise concerns that Milwaukee Tool gloves are made with forced labour in a Chinese prison; incl. co. responses. (Business & Human Rights)

Dec 2022: "Driving Force - Automotive Supply Chains and Forced Labor in the Uyghur Region." (Helena Kennedy Center for International Justice, the Sheffield Hallam University)

31 Aug 2022: OHCHR Assessment of human rights concerns in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region, People's Republic of China. (Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights)

26 July 2022: Note Verbale in response to the OHCHR Assessment of human rights concerns in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region (The Permanent Mission of the People's Republic of China to the United Nations Office at Geneva; GJ/56/2022)

04 Jan 2022: China denounces Walmart for 'stupidity' after Sam's Club was accused of pulling Xinjiang products. (CNN Business)

31 Dec 2021: China warns Walmart and Sam's Club over Xinjiang products. (Reuters)

10 Jul 2021: Like We Were Enemies in a War. (Amnesty International)

02 Mar 2021: Civil society coalition calls on fashion and home-furnishing industries to end links to Uyghur forced labor. (Business & Human Rights Resource Centre)

02 Mar 2021: An Open Letter to the Fashion and Home-Furnishing Industries. (Coalition to End Forced Labour in the Uyghur Region)

03 Jul 2020: State Dept warns top U.S. firms over supply chain risks linked to China's Xinjiang. (Reuters)

01 Mar 2020: Uyghurs for Sale: 'Re-education', forced labour and surveillance beyond Xinjiang. (Australian Strategic Policy Institute, revised 11 October 2022)

02 Jan 2020: China conscripts Xinjiang Muslim minorities into army of workers. (The Irish Times)

11 May 2017: Walmart looking into note found recounting forced labor in China. (Reuters)

Source: 15 Jun 2025 (Forbes.com)

Moderate Controversies

Date: October 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Partially Concluded

Taiwan: Investigation revealed alleged labor rights abuses involving migrant workers in electronics and automotive manufacturing sectors; recruitment fees up to USD 6,400 and debt bondage risks reported

UPDATES: 01 Oct 2026: Debt Before Day One: New Factory Evidence of Migrant Worker Recruitment Fees in Taiwan. (Transparentem)

30 Sep 2026: Taiwan: migrants making electronic & car products for global brands allegedly subjected to labour rights abuse, finds investigation. (Business & Human Rights)

Source: 01 Oct 2026 (Transparentem)

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Date: October 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

Flipkart, India: Regulatory INR 10 lakh fine imposed by Central Consumer Protection Authority on e-commerce platforms for allegedly advertising and selling unregistered Cyclosinone herbicide
UPDATES: 26 Sep 2026: Amazon, flipkart & jiomart fined for illegal herbicide sale. (Times Of India (electronic Edition))

Source: 26 Sep 2026 (Times Of India (electronic Edition))

Date: October 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Flipkart India, India: Penal action by the FSSAI over alleged regulatory non-compliance related to misleading claims and food safety
UPDATES: 23 Sep 2026: Fssai starts penal action against amazon, swiggy, bigbasket, others for various non-compliances. (New Indian Express)

Source: 23 Sep 2026 (New Indian Express)

Date: September 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

United States: DOJ reportedly expanded antitrust investigation into alleged price manipulation in the beef supply chain involving major grocery retailers
UPDATES: 05 Sep 2026: Why is beef so expensive in america? doj expands price probe to walmart and amazon. (Ibtimes Singapore)

Source: 05 Sep 2026 (Ibtimes Singapore)

Date: August 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Federal appeals court revived portions of litigation comprising approximately 100 lawsuits over alleged misleading claims involving oral phenylephrine decongestants
UPDATES: 30 Jul 2026: Drugmakers, retailers must face 'maximum strength' claim in decongestant false ad litigation in us. (Miami Herald)

Source: 30 Jul 2026 (Miami Herald)

Date: July 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Allegations of retailer involvement in lawsuits over purported autism and ADHD risks linked to acetaminophen use during pregnancy
UPDATES: 13 Jul 2026: Us appeals court revives hundreds of private lawsuits linking tylenol to autism. (Miami Herald)

Source: 13 Jul 2026 (Miami Herald)

Date: July 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

California, US: Allegations of algorithmic price fixing at gas stations through AI-powered software lead to proposed class action lawsuit
UPDATES: 01 Jul 2026: Gas giants use ai to raise prices, lawsuit says, another algorithmic hit to the cost of living. (Aol.com)

Source: 01 Jul 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: July 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

South Carolina, US: Investigation into fatal incident during retail store remodeling
UPDATES: 25 Jun 2026: Construction worker killed in incident at upstate walmart. (AOL.com)

Source: 25 Jun 2026 (AOL.com)

Date: July 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

California, US: Class action lawsuit filed alleging use of AI to coordinate gas price increases in violation of antitrust laws
UPDATES: 22 Jun 2026: Bp, marathon, 7-eleven, walmart sued for allegedly using ai to boost california gas prices. (Channel Newsasia)

Source: 22 Jun 2026 (Channel Newsasia)

Date: June 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Parent's Choice, US: Multidistrict litigation over the alleged presence of toxic heavy metals in baby food products, which reportedly resulted in brain injuries, autism spectrum disorder diagnoses, and other health concerns
UPDATES: 04 Jun 2026: New lawsuit alleges popular baby food products are contaminated with toxic heavy metals. (AOL.com)

01 May 2025: MDL Statistics Report - Distribution of Pending MDL Dockets by District. (United States Judicial Panel on Multidistrict Litigation)

03 Apr 2025: Several companies must face lawsuit over tainted baby food, us judge rules. (THIS IS MONEY)

11 Apr 2024: Gerber, Beech Nut to face MDL over claims of tainted baby food. (REUTERS)

29 Nov 2022: N.C., a minor v. Hain Celestial Group, Inc. et al., 21STcv22822. (Superior Court for the State of California for the County of Los Angeles)

27 Jun 2022: Cullors et al. v. Nurture Inc., 4:2022cv03778. (US District Court, Northern District of California)

24 May 2022: N.C., a minor v. Hain Celestial Group, Inc. et al., 21STcv22822. (Superior Court for the State of California for the County of Los Angeles)

29 Sep 2021: New Disclosures Show Dangerous Levels of Toxic Heavy Metals in Even More Baby Foods. (Subcommittee on Economic and Consumer Policy Committee on Oversight and Reform U.S. House of Representatives)

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09 Sep 2021: Abbott et al. v. Walmart Inc., 3:2021cv00188. (US District Court, Eastern District of Arkansas)

08 Jun 2021: JPML Won't Lump Baby Food Suits Together. (LAW360)

19 Feb 2021: Johnson et al. v. Beech-Nut Nutrition Company et al., 2:2021cv02096. (US District Court, Kansas)

05 Feb 2021: New government report finds "toxic heavy metals" like arsenic and mercury in popular baby foods. (CBS News)

Source: 04 Jun 2026 (AOL.com)

Date: April 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Arkansas, US: Investigation launched into fatal incident involving employee in alleged random act of violence

UPDATES: 03 Apr 2026: Walmart employee fatally stabbed in random attack by man who allegedly believed victim was a 'demon': police. (AOL.com)

Source: 03 Apr 2026 (AOL.com)

Date: March 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

Florida, US: Court dismissed lawsuit over alleged negligence in slip-and-fall incident involving ruptured gel pack; plaintiff claimed severe injuries

UPDATES: 22 Mar 2026: Florida court refuses to hold walmart liable for “squashed” gel pack injury. (Aol.com)

Source: 22 Mar 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: February 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

Missouri, US: Premises liability lawsuit over alleged permanent injuries from falling display case; jury reportedly awarded USD 470,000 in damages

UPDATES: 26 Jan 2026: Man injured by falling display case wins $470k verdict against walmart. (MISSOURI LAWYERS MEDIA)

Source: 26 Jan 2026 (MISSOURI LAWYERS MEDIA)

Date: February 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

India: Central Consumer Protection Authority imposed INR 1 million penalty over illegal sale listings of walkie-talkies with undisclosed operating frequencies

UPDATES: 16 Jan 2026: Meta, Amazon, Flipkart fined as govt cracks down on illegal walkie-talkie sales on e-commerce platforms. (BUSINESS TODAY ONLINE)

Source: 16 Jan 2026 (BUSINESS TODAY ONLINE)

Date: January 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

Flipkart, India: CCI investigation into alleged antitrust violations related to discounting practices and relationships with preferred sellers

UPDATES: 06 Jan 2026: No new information available.

06 Jan 2025: Amazon-Flipkart antitrust probe: Supreme Court steps in, transfers all cases to Karnataka High Court; None. (INDIAN EXPRESS)

09 Dec 2024: CCI asks Supreme Court for hearing to fast-track Amazon, Flipkart antitrust cases. (THE TIMES OF INDIA (TOI))

13 Sep 2024: India probe finds Amazon, Walmart's Flipkart breached antitrust laws. (CNBC)

28 Apr 2022: India's antitrust raids target sellers on Amazon, Walmart's Flipkart -sources. (REUTERS)

09 Aug 2021: SC quashes Amazon, Flipkart's plea against CCI probe. (UNI (UNITED NEWS OF INDIA))

04 Aug 2021: EXCLUSIVE India enforcement agency threatens Flipkart, founders with $1.35 bln fine -sources. (REUTERS)

23 Jul 2021: India court quashes Amazon, Flipkart plea against antitrust probe. (REUTERS)

17 Jun 2021: UPDATE 3-Walmarts Flipkart, Amazon challenge India court order on antitrust probe. (REUTERS)

07 Apr 2020: Indian traders ask court for Amazon, Flipkart antitrust probe restart. (REUTERS CANADA)

14 Feb 2020: India Court Stalls Amazon, Flipkart Antitrust Probes: Lawyers. (US NEWS & WORLD REPORT)

10 Feb 2020: Amazon challenges India antitrust probe in court: filing. (Reuters)

17 Jan 2020: India to investigate Flipkart, Amazon over smartphone sales. (SNL KAGAN MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS REPORT)

14 Jan 2020: CCI to probe Amazon, Flipkart for deep discounts, preferred sellers model. (Business Standard)

Source: 06 Jan 2025 (INDIAN EXPRESS)

Date: January 2026

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

Mexico: Appeal against MXN 93 million penalty Federal Economic Competition Commission over alleged monopolistic behavior in relation to the supply, distribution, and marketing of consumer goods

UPDATES: 13 Dec 2025: No new information available.

13 Dec 2024: Mexican regulator fines local Walmart unit for monopolistic practice. (Reuters)

07 Oct 2023: Walmart's Mexico unit to face anti-trust panel after three-year investigation. (Reuters)

Source: 13 Dec 2024 (REUTERS)

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Date: January 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Class action lawsuit filed over alleged price-fixing scheme involving wholesale soft drink prices; antitrust violations cited

UPDATES: 07 Jan 2026: Customers say pepsi and walmart schemed to raise prices at every store except the big box retailer. (YAHOO! NEWS UK AND IRELAND)

Source: 07 Jan 2026 (YAHOO! NEWS UK AND IRELAND)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

New York, US: Investigation reportedly uncovered exploitation, unsafe conditions, and sexual harassment of migrant workers on J-1 visas

UPDATES: 06 Jan 2026: Usa: investigation finds workers on j-1 visas allegedly subjected to exploitation in new york, incl. sexual harassment, threats & unsafe conditions; incl. cos. non-responses. (BUSINESS & HUMAN RIGHTS)

Source: 06 Jan 2026 (BUSINESS & HUMAN RIGHTS)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: FDA sent warning letters after recalled ByHeart Whole Nutrition infant formula reportedly linked to 51 infant botulism cases remained on store shelves

UPDATES: 15 Dec 2025: US FDA sends warning letters to Walmart, Target for selling recalled baby formula. (AOL.COM)

Source: 15 Dec 2025 (AOL.COM)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

US: Reportedly thousands faced temporary disruption in app and website access; services restored

UPDATES: 30 Dec 2025: Walmart outage impacts thousands of shoppers using app and website. (MSN UK)

Source: 30 Dec 2025 (MSN UK)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Concluded

US: Reportedly thousands faced temporary disruption in app and website access; services restored

UPDATES: 30 Dec 2025: Walmart outage impacts thousands of shoppers using app and website. (MSN UK)

Source: 30 Dec 2025 (MSN UK)

Date: November 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Partially Concluded

Marketside Linguine with Beef Meatballs & Marinara Sauce and Marketside Grilled Chicken Alfredo with Fettuccine [Recall, US]: 12 oz, 12.3 oz, and 32.8 oz variants; six deaths and 27 illnesses reported linked to an alleged listeria outbreak; federal investigations ongoing

UPDATES: 18 Jun 2025: Pasta Dish Sold at Walmart and Kroger Recalled for Possible Listeria Contamination as Outbreak Involves Multiple Deaths. (AOL.COM)

Source: 30 Oct 2025 (CNN)

Date: September 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Canada: Class action lawsuit filed over alleged misrepresentation of imported products as Canadian, seeking consumer compensation

UPDATES: 18 Sep 2025: Some grocery stores are being accused of 'maple washing'. (BNN BLOOMBERG)

Source: 18 Sep 2025 (BNN BLOOMBERG)

Date: September 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Allegations of price tag removal reportedly linked to tariff-driven price hikes caused customer dissatisfaction

UPDATES: 02 Sep 2025: Walmart and target accused of sneakily removing price tags amid tariff-driven price hikes — leaving customers furious. (NEW YORK POST)

Source: 02 Sep 2025 (NEW YORK POST)

Date: August 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Allegations of consumer boycotts over social and political controversies, including price hikes and political affiliations

UPDATES: 04 Aug 2025: Walmart has an alarming consumer boycott problem. (CHARLOTTE OBSERVER)

Source: 04 Aug 2025 (CHARLOTTE OBSERVER)

Date: July 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Flipkart, India: BIS raided multiple warehouses over alleged sale of non-certified products

UPDATES: 21 Mar 2025: Non-certified goods seized from godowns of Amazon, Flipkart by BIS officials in Tamil Nadu. (NEW INDIAN EXPRESS)

15 Mar 2025: Indian standards authority raids Amazon, Flipkart warehouses in multiple cities, seizes unsafe products. (NEW INDIAN EXPRESS)

Source: 21 Mar 2025 (NEW INDIAN EXPRESS)

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Date: July 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Ozark Trail 64-ounce Stainless Steel Insulated Water Bottles [Recall, US]: 850,000 units; three injuries reported
UPDATES: 11 Jul 2025: Walmart Issues Nationwide Recall on 850,000 Water Bottles After 2 People Blinded. (CHARLOTTE OBSERVER)
Source: 11 Jul 2025 (CHARLOTTE OBSERVER)

Date: May 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Nationwide boycott over alleged economic corruption and rollback of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion efforts
UPDATES: 21 May 2025: Walmart boycott: america's largest retailer to protestors, 'we remain ...'. (THE TIMES OF INDIA (TOI))
Source: 21 May 2025 (THE TIMES OF INDIA (TOI))

Date: May 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Widespread outage reportedly disrupted mobile application services for delivery drivers
UPDATES: 03 May 2025: Spark driver app down: users report log in troubles amid mass outage. (TIMES NOW)
Source: 03 May 2025 (TIMES NOW)

Date: May 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Canada: Allegations of chemical burns from sunscreen product led to lawsuit involving retailer and manufacturer
UPDATES: 27 Apr 2025: Winnipeg family claims 'excruciating' skin wounds linked to sunscreen, sues manufacturer. (CBC (NEWS))
Source: 27 Apr 2025 (CBC (NEWS))

Date: April 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Georgia, US: Employee allegedly targeted co-workers in fatal shooting incident; 2 dead, 1 injured
UPDATES: 11 Apr 2025: Walmart employee in georgia kills 2 co-workers, injures another in after-hours shooting spree. (ABC NEWS)
Source: 11 Apr 2025 (ABC NEWS)

Date: April 2025

Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

US: Allegations of wrongful termination and discrimination following mistaken identity incident involving a tall cisgender woman
UPDATES: 01 Apr 2025: “i was extremely shaken”: customer confronts tall woman thinking she was trans, gets her fired. (AOL.COM)
Source: 01 Apr 2025 (AOL.COM)

Date: March 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

India, Indonesia, Vietnam: Allegations of the presence of child labor in suppliers' shrimp farms
UPDATES: 30 Sep 2024: Shrimp farmers, peelers in Asia exploited by U.S. supermarkets, analysis finds. (CBS News)
Source: 30 Sep 2024 (CBS News)

Date: March 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Mexico: Allegations of adverse impacts to local communities due to avocado sourcing
UPDATES: 21 Aug 2024: In Mexico, avocado suppliers continue sourcing from illegally deforested land. (Mongabay)
08 Aug 2024: US Avocado Demand Drives Mass Deforestation in Mexico. (BNN Bloomberg)
Source: 21 Aug 2024 (Mongabay)

Date: March 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Montreal, Canada: Allegations of negligence after elderly woman left injured in parking lot for over an hour
UPDATES: 20 Feb 2025: Montreal family distraught after walmart employees leave injured grandmother lying in the parking lot. (CTV NEWS)
Source: 20 Feb 2025 (CTV NEWS)

Minor Controversies

Date: October 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

Georgetown, US: Alleged arson and theft incident at local supermarket; no injuries reported, investigation ongoing
UPDATES: 13 Oct 2026: Maximum alert in walmart woman is accused of causing a terrible fire in the supermarket: was seriously injured reported?. (Larepública.pe)
Source: 13 Oct 2026 (Larepública.pe)

Date: October 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Frozen Berry Products [Recall, US]: Expanded recall due to potential E. coli O145:H28 contamination; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 06 Oct 2026: These berries sold at walmart, trader joe’s could contain a dangerous e. coli strain. (San Antonio Express-news (tx))
Source: 06 Oct 2026 (San Antonio Express-news (tx))

Date: October 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

California, US: USD 16 million settlement over alleged sale of expired infant formula and OTC drugs; compliance program implemented
UPDATES: 25 Sep 2026: Walmart agrees to pay $16m over expired goods on california shelves. (Aol.com)

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Source: 25 Sep 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: October 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

Summerville, US: Shooting incident reportedly followed altercation at supermarket; one injury reported
UPDATES: 25 Sep 2026: Maximum alert in walmart a simple fight generated a shooting in the u.s. walmart: one injured person reported. (Larepública.pe)

Source: 25 Sep 2026 (Larepública.pe)

Date: September 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

New York, US: Lawsuit filed over alleged sale of air freshener containing cancer-causing benzene without adequate warning.
UPDATES: 12 Sep 2026: Walmart continues stocking air freshener packed with cancer-causing benzene: lawsuit. (New York Post)

Source: 12 Sep 2026 (New York Post)

Date: September 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

New Jersey, US: Hazardous fumes exposure at retail store reportedly led to 19 hospitalizations; store reopened after safety measures implemented
UPDATES: 02 Sep 2026: 19 people went to the hospital after being sickened by fumes at a n.j. walmart. (Aol.com)

Source: 02 Sep 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: September 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

New Jersey, US: Hazardous fumes exposure at retail store reportedly led to 19 hospitalizations; store reopened after safety measures implemented
UPDATES: 02 Sep 2026: 19 people went to the hospital after being sickened by fumes at a n.j. walmart. (Aol.com)

Source: 02 Sep 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: September 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Alabama, US: Fire reportedly caused by freezer malfunction led to grocery area evacuation; no injuries reported
UPDATES: 08 Sep 2026: Horror in walmart u.s. authorities force customers to evacuate by fire in a freezer: was anyone injured?. (Larepública.pe)

Source: 08 Sep 2026 (Larepública.pe)

Date: September 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

China: Regulatory sampling reportedly found excessive coliform bacteria in salmon slices, prompting company apology and quality control measures
UPDATES: 30 Aug 2026: Walmart apologized. (East Money)

Source: 30 Aug 2026 (East Money)

Date: August 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Washington, US: Lawsuit over alleged retaliation and unlawful termination following workplace harassment complaints; jury award reduced to statutory cap
UPDATES: 11 Aug 2026: 300,000 reasons why workplace investigations matter. (National Law Review)

Source: 11 Aug 2026 (National Law Review)

Date: August 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Marketside Tomato Bisque Soup Kit 14 oz [Recall, US]: Certain lots; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 15 Aug 2026: Walmart soup kits recalled for possible listeria contamination in texas. (San Antonio Express-news (tx))

Source: 15 Aug 2026 (San Antonio Express-news (tx))

Date: August 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

California, US: Settlement of approximately USD 908,815 over alleged unauthorized sharing of customer data with third-party advertisers; restitution fund established for affected customers
UPDATES: 04 Aug 2026: Laco reaches nearly $1m settlement in consumer protection spat vs. walmart. (City News Service)

Source: 04 Aug 2026 (City News Service)

Date: August 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

EnHomee 9-Drawer Fabric Dressers [Recall, US]: Approximately 16,809 units; no injuries reported
UPDATES: 23 Jul 2026: Over 16,000 dressers sold by walmart recalled. see affected products. (Usa Today)

Source: 23 Jul 2026 (Usa Today)

Date: July 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Texas, US: USD 13 million settlement over alleged misrepresentation of wages and tips to delivery drivers under grocery delivery program
UPDATES: 09 Jul 2026: Walmart to pay $13 million to settle texas delivery driver investigation::description::. (Arkansas Democrat-gazette)

Source: 09 Jul 2026 (Arkansas Democrat-gazette)

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Date: June 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Ontario, Canada: Unifor Settles Walmart Wage Freeze Complaint as Workers Secure Historic First Collective Agreement
UPDATES: 06 Jun 2026: 'historic': canadian warehouse workers sign first-ever union deal with walmart. (The Guardian (london))
28 Sep 2025: Unifor accuses walmart of violating labour laws, following historic vote to unionize. (THE CANADIAN PRESS)
Source: 06 Jun 2026 (The Guardian (london)); 28 Sep 2025 (THE CANADIAN PRESS)

Date: June 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Mainstays 9-Drawer Fabric Dressers [Recall, US]: Approximately 165,000 units; no injuries reported
UPDATES: 29 May 2026: Walmart recalls 165,000 mainstays dressers over tip-over risk. (Houston Chronicle)
Source: 29 May 2026 (Houston Chronicle)

Date: June 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

Florida, US: Lawsuit filed over alleged contamination of canned pasta with worms or parasites; illnesses reportedly linked
UPDATES: 03 Jun 2026: Family claims spaghettios infested with 'actively moving' worms or parasites in campbell's, walmart suit. (New York Post)
Source: 03 Jun 2026 (New York Post)

Date: May 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Blackstone Parmesan Ranch Seasoning [Recall, US]: Certain lots; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 16 May 2026: Salmonella fears prompt recall of seasoning sold at walmart stores nationwide. (Aol.com)
Source: 16 May 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: May 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

California, US: Alleged arson incident caused significant damage and indefinite closure of local retail store, no injuries reported
UPDATES: 15 May 2026: Suisun city walmart closed indefinitely after 'significant' damage, arson. (Sfgate)
Source: 15 May 2026 (Sfgate)

Date: May 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Frozen Pizzas [Recall, US]: Two products; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 04 May 2026: Frozen pizzas sold at walmart pulled into dairy ingredient salmonella health alert. (Houston Chronicle)
Source: 04 May 2026 (Houston Chronicle)

Date: May 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

FitRx SmartBell Adjustable Dumbbells [Recall, US]: Approximately 50,000 units recalled; six injuries reported
UPDATES: 24 Apr 2026: Dumbbells sold at walmart recalled. see affected product. (Usa Today)
Source: 24 Apr 2026 (Usa Today)

Date: April 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

California, US: Employee lawsuit over alleged violation of consumer reporting law through deficient background check form and certification process
UPDATES: 07 Apr 2026: Employer that violates consumer reporting act is liable for at least $10,000 per violation. (Jd Supra)
Source: 07 Apr 2026 (Jd Supra)

Date: April 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Dino Shaped Chicken Nuggets [Recall, US]: Lead contamination found; no injuries reported
UPDATES: 02 Apr 2026: Dangerous levels of lead found in walmart dinosaur-shaped nuggets. (Usa Today)
Source: 02 Apr 2026 (Usa Today)

Date: March 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Pennsylvania, US: Negligence lawsuit over alleged slip-and-fall incident dismissed due to insufficient evidence of hazardous condition
UPDATES: 28 Feb 2026: Federal court grants summary judgment to retailer in slip-and-fall case for lack of evidence of notice. (Jd Supra)
Source: 28 Feb 2026 (Jd Supra)

Date: March 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Great Value Cottage Cheese [Recall, US]: Multiple batches; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 25 Feb 2026: Cottage cheese recalled from walmart stores in 24 states may be health danger. (Miami Herald)
Source: 25 Feb 2026 (Miami Herald)

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

Date: March 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Great Value Cottage Cheese [Recall, US]: Multiple batches; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 25 Feb 2026: Cottage cheese recalled from walmart stores in 24 states may be health danger. (Miami Herald)
Source: 25 Feb 2026 (Miami Herald)

Date: February 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

US: Allegations of overcharging customers due to incorrect meat weights
UPDATES: 13 Feb 2026: Walmart accused of overcharging for meat in viral tiktoks: 'that's just straight up theft isn't it?'. (Aol.com)
Source: 13 Feb 2026 (Aol.com)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Grated Pecorino Romano Cheese [Class I Recall, US]: Multiple batches; no illnesses reported
UPDATES: 12 Jan 2026: Cheese sold at walmart and target in texas now part of fda's highest-risk recall. (HOUSTON CHRONICLE (TX))
Source: 12 Jan 2026 (HOUSTON CHRONICLE (TX))

Date: January 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

Florida, US: Alleged health and safety violations at grocery store following failed inspection; multiple food items discarded
UPDATES: 14 Jan 2026: Dirty equipment, unsafe chicken and deli meat found at a doral walmart. (MIAMI HERALD)
Source: 14 Jan 2026 (MIAMI HERALD)

Date: January 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

New York, US: USD 60,000 settlement of disability discrimination lawsuit over alleged failure to accommodate employee with hearing, speech, and cognitive impairments
UPDATES: 14 Jan 2026: Walmart inc. to pay $60,000 in new york disability settlement::headline2::::headline3::. (ARKANSAS DEMOCRAT-GAZETTE)
Source: 14 Jan 2026 (ARKANSAS DEMOCRAT-GAZETTE)

Date: January 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

India: Delhi High Court reportedly issues injunction over alleged unauthorized use of celebrity personality rights by e-commerce platforms and tech companies
UPDATES: 02 Jan 2026: Delhi HC finds prima facie evidence of violation of Pawan Kalyan's personality rights (The Hindu)
Source: 02 Jan 2026 (THE HINDU)

Date: January 2026

Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

India: Nationwide protests by gig workers over alleged unsafe working conditions, unfair pay, and denial of social security
UPDATES: 25 Dec 2025: Flash strike by platform, gig workers receives lukewarm response; mega strike on new year's eve. (NEW INDIAN EXPRESS)
Source: 25 Dec 2025 (NEW INDIAN EXPRESS)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Great Value 100% Grape Juice 1.82L bottles [Class III Recall, Canada]: Certain batches; no injuries reported
UPDATES: 16 Dec 2025: Walmart just recalled a popular drink in canada—here's what to know. (AOL.COM)
Source: 16 Dec 2025 (AOL.COM)

Date: January 2026
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

Mississippi, US: Razor blades reportedly found in bread loaves; suspect arrested amid food tampering investigation
UPDATES: 17 Dec 2025: Suspect arrested after walmart customers report finding hidden razor blades in purchased bread. (AOL.COM)
Source: 17 Dec 2025 (AOL.COM)

Date: December 2025
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Shredded Cheese Products [Class II Recall, US]: Over 1 million bags; no injuries reported
UPDATES: 03 Dec 2025: Massive cheese recall affects major grocers including walmart, target, publix. (MIAMI HERALD)
Source: 03 Dec 2025 (MIAMI HERALD)

Date: December 2025
Assessment: Minor
Status: Ongoing

Ozark Trail Tabletop 1-Burner Butane Camping Stoves BG2247A1 [Recall, US]: 201,000 units; 16 injuries reported
UPDATES: 30 Nov 2025: 16 people burned by exploding camping stoves, sparking massive recall. (AOL.COM)
Source: 30 Nov 2025 (AOL.COM)

Date: November 2025

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Organic Moringa Leaf Powder and Super Greens Powder Mix [Recall, US]: Four products; 11 illnesses and 3 hospitalizations reported
UPDATES: 16 Nov 2025: Dietary supplements recalled nationwide after 11 people sickened with salmonella. (THE INDEPENDENT (UNITED KINGDOM))
Source: 16 Nov 2025 (THE INDEPENDENT (UNITED KINGDOM))

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Date: November 2025

Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

US: Allegations of misleading marketing over purported Thanksgiving meal cost reduction; scrutiny over product substitutions and item count differences

UPDATES: 08 Nov 2025: Fact focus: trump says thanksgiving dinner will cost 25% less this year. his numbers are misleading. (THE INDEPENDENT (UNITED KINGDOM))

Source: 08 Nov 2025 (THE INDEPENDENT (UNITED KINGDOM))

Date: October 2025
Assessment: Minor
Status: Concluded

Great Value Pear Halves in Pear Juice from Concentrate [Class II Recall, US]: certain units; no injuries reported

UPDATES: 22 Oct 2025: Walmart just recalled canned fruit due to high levels of lead. (AOL.COM)

Source: 22 Oct 2025 (AOL.COM)

GOVERNANCE CONTROVERSIES

Severe Controversies

Date: September 2026

Assessment: Severe
Status: Partially Concluded

US: State and local government lawsuits over alleged failure to monitor and report questionable opioid orders; settlements reached for some lawsuits; USD 50 million settlement with DOJ reached

Since at least 2017, Walmart Inc. (Walmart) and other pharmaceutical distributors and retail companies have faced lawsuits filed by local and state governments over the companies' alleged failure to control the prescription of opioids in the United States.

LATEST CASE UPDATES In August 2026, Miami Herald reported that Walmart agreed to pay USD 50 million to settle the DOJ civil lawsuit filed in December 2020, which alleged that the company violated the Controlled Substances Act by failing to identify and report suspicious opioid prescriptions from its pharmacies. Walmart did not admit liability and described the settlement amount as "immaterial" in a regulatory filing. The settlement required Walmart to implement tighter oversight of its pharmacists and establish a hotline for employees and patients to report suspected illegal dispensing of opioids.

BACKGROUND (FROM LEAST TO MOST RECENT) In March 2017, A lawsuit filed by the Cabell County Commission in West Virginia detailed that from 2007 to 2012, the defendants, including Walmart, distributed approximately 40 million doses of oxycodone and hydrocodone in various pharmacies within the county. In April 2017, the Cherokee Nation filed a lawsuit against Walgreens and other companies in Cherokee tribal court over the companies' alleged failure to control the distribution of prescription painkillers in Oklahoma. The lawsuit alleged that the companies ignored the opioid epidemic and disclosed that at least 350 Cherokee Indians died from opioid-related abuse from 2003 to 2014.

In December 2017, the United States Judicial Panel on Multidistrict Litigation decided to place multiple pending civil lawsuits filed across the country in a consolidated lawsuit called the National Prescription Opiate Litigation to be heard in the U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Ohio. The plaintiffs alleged that the manufacturers failed to adequately address the risks of using opioid medications over the long term for chronic pain while distributors did not keep track of suspicious opioid orders. As of March 2022, the consolidated litigation had over 2,150 cases.

In July 2019, The Guardian reported that statistics by the U.S. Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA) indicated that pharmaceutical companies, distributors, and pharmaceutical chains involved in opioid manufacturing and distribution released approximately 75 billion opioid pills in the U.S. market, allegedly during the height of the opioid epidemic.

In December 2020, the U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) filed a civil lawsuit against Walmart in the U.S. District Court in Delaware over its alleged violations of the Controlled Substances Act (CSA). According to the DOJ, Walmart did not report thousands of suspicious opioid prescriptions and implement DEA protocols on the sale and distribution of controlled medication during the height of the opioid epidemic.

In July 2021, Reuters reported that Walmart and other pharmaceutical companies agreed to pay a combined amount of USD 26 million to settle claims filed by two counties in New York.

In November 2021, jurors of a Cleveland court ruled that the companies failed to properly monitor the opioid prescriptions in the state. The companies involved, including Walmart, stated they would appeal the verdict.

In March 2022, Walmart disclosed in its 2021 annual report that it remained a defendant in a consolidated securities class action lawsuit filed in May 2021 and two shareholder derivative lawsuits filed in the U.S. District Court in Delaware in February and August 2021, respectively. The consolidated lawsuit alleged securities laws violations in relation to opioid-related disclosures while the derivative lawsuits alleged a breach of fiduciary duty.

In November 2022, Walmart announced that it agreed to a nationwide opioid settlement framework worth USD 1.3 billion. The company's press release further stated that the settlement framework was not an admission of guilt. The deal, which was negotiated by Attorney Generals from different states, sought to settle state, local, and tribal government lawsuits, pending approval by each entity. Meanwhile, the December 2020 lawsuit by the DOJ was reportedly not covered by this settlement.

In April 2023, Cobb County of the state of Georgia announced a settlement of USD 15.2 million with three companies, including Walmart, regarding the opioid lawsuits. In the same month, Seattle in Washington State approved the settlement of USD 14 million with companies including Walmart. According to a report by The Center Square, the fund allocation agreement amounted to USD 434 million.

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In July 2023, the Office of the Attorney General of Texas announced a final settlement of USD 168 million with Walmart over the company's alleged negligent practices as stated by Opioid lawsuits. The settlement further included provisions that restricted the company in terms of opioid marketing, selling and dispensing opioid

Walmart stated in its July 2023 Form 10-Q that the settlement administrator found that enough political subdivisions had agreed to join the Settlement Framework in August 2023, which then became effective in September 2023.

In March 2024, a federal judge ruled in favor of Walmart's motion to dismiss a claim that its pharmacists failed to document the resolution of "red flags" in opioid prescriptions. This claim was part of a wider DOJ lawsuit filed in December 2020.

In October 2024, Walmart disclosed that it had reached a proposed settlement agreement to address three lawsuits filed by shareholders.

In August 2025, a U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals in Philadelphia ruled in favor of Walmart in a shareholder lawsuit alleging that the company had defrauded the group by failing to disclose a federal prosecution into opioid prescriptions.

In November 2025, Daily Business Review reported that closing arguments had begun in a lawsuit by 15 hospitals against multiple companies, including Walmart, for allegedly violating the Florida Racketeer Influenced Corruption Organizations Act. According to the report, a lawyer for the plaintiffs asked the jury for USD 1.5 billion for the alleged role of the defendants in the opioid epidemic.

In May 2026, Reuters and Daily Business Review reported that the Seventeenth Judicial Circuit of Florida had ruled in favor of pharmacy operators CVS, Walgreens, and Walmart in a lawsuit filed in 2019 by 16 Florida hospitals, including Broward Health, Tampa General Hospital, and Good Samaritan Medical Center. The ruling eliminated the need for a retrial scheduled for August 2026 following a mistrial in late 2025. According to the report, the presiding judge had found that no reasonable jury could rule in favor of the hospitals because claims under Florida's anti-racketeering statute required proof of direct injury. The judge reportedly determined that the trial evidence had instead established that any increase in opioid sales had directly harmed individual patients who had become dependent on painkillers, while the hospitals experienced only secondary financial impact through the elevated costs of treating patients with opioid use disorder.

Other companies allegedly involved in the controversy include Allergan, AmerisourceBergen, Cardinal Health, CVS Health, Endo International, Johnson and Johnson, Mallinckrodt, Teva Pharmaceutical, and Walgreens Boots Alliance.

UPDATES: 28 Aug 2026: Walmart settles us government's opioid lawsuit, which sought billions, for $50 million. (Miami Herald)

28 May 2026: CVS, Walgreens and Walmart defeat Florida hospitals' opioid lawsuit. (Reuters)

27 May 2026: 'this result was shocking': judge grants directed verdict for pharmacies in florida opioid trial. (Daily Business Review)

13 Nov 2025: Lawyer Asks FL Jury For $1.5B in Opioid Damages Against Walgreens, Walmart, CVS. (DAILY BUSINESS REVIEW)

30 Aug 2025: Walmart defeats shareholder lawsuit over opioid probe disclosures. (Reuters)

10 Dec 2024: Pharmacies prevail in appeal of $650-million opioid award in Ohio. (Reuters)

19 Oct 2024: Walmart reaches settlement deal for shareholder lawsuits over its handling of opioids. (AP News)

12 Mar 2024: Judge trims US Justice Department lawsuit against Walmart over opioids. (Reuters)

29 Feb 2024: Maryland announces $238 million in new opioid settlements with Walgreens, Walmart, two drugmakers. (Miami Herald)

01 Sep 2023: Form 10-Q. (Walmart Inc.)

19 Jul 2023: Office of the Attorney General reaches $168 million settlement with Walmart over company's role in national opioid crisis and encourages local areas to sign on to receive funds. (Office of the Attorney General of Texas)

03 May 2023: Wisconsin legislators approve opioid settlement payout. (AP News)

21 Apr 2023: Seattle city attorney signs $14M settlement with companies providing opioids. (THE CENTER SQUARE)

16 Apr 2023: Cobb County to receive $15M in opioid lawsuit settlement. (THE ATLANTA JOURNAL-CONSTITUTION)

15 Nov 2022: Walmart to Pay $3.1 Billion to Settle Opioid Lawsuits. (The Wall Street Journal)

15 Nov 2022: Press Release- Walmart Announces Nationwide Opioid Settlement Framework. (Walmart, Inc.)

18 Mar 2022: 10-K, 2022. (Walmart, Inc.)

23 Dec 2021: 5th Circ. Won't Revive Walmart's Opioid Suit Against Feds. (LAW360)

09 Dec 2021: MDL 2804: Prescription Opioids Product Row transferred to N.D. Ohio. (The United States Judicial Panel on Multidistrict Litigation)

01 Dec 2021: Ohio Opioid Verdict Brings Focus To Role Of Pharmacists. (LAW360)

15 Nov 2021: Pharmacy chains defend actions as landmark U.S. opioid trial nears its end. (REUTERS)

11 Nov 2021: Opioid trial jurors ask witnesses questions as judiciary reviews practice. (REUTERS)

06 Oct 2021: CVS, Walmart Opioid Trial Defense Hazy On Pharmacists' Role. (LAW360)

04 Oct 2021: Trial against pharmacy chains' opioid sales set to begin. (AP ASSOCIATED PRESS STATE & REGIONAL WIRES (EMBARGOED DATA))

28 Sep 2021: Drug distributors strike 1st opioid settlement with Native American tribe for $75 million. (REUTERS)

10 Aug 2021: Russell, KY et al. v. Abbott Laboratories et al., 3:21-cv-00030. (US District Court, Eastern District of Kentucky)

23 Jul 2021: Russell, KY et al. v. Abbott Laboratories et al., 3:21-cv-00030. (US District Court, Eastern District of Kentucky)

15 Jul 2021: Map to Health d/b/a Recovery Unplugged v. AmerisourceBergen Drug Corporation et al., 1:2021-op-45093. (US District Court, Northern District of Ohio)

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13 Jul 2021: U.S. pharmacies strike first deals with counties over opioids. (REUTERS)

01 Jul 2021: Okla. Judge Won't Certify Midcase Appeal In Opioid Bellwether. (LAW360)

17 Jun 2021: Walmart CEO Faces Opioid MDL Grilling Despite Protest. (LAW360)

04 Jun 2021: 10-Q, 2021. (Walmart Inc.)

12 May 2021: Walmart Wants 5th Circ. To Revive Opioid Suit Against Feds. (LAW360)

08 May 2021: Pharmacies Seek Appeal On Opioid Duties In Tribal Bellwether. (LAW360)

19 Apr 2021: Walmart Punished In Opioid MDL For Discovery Defiance. (LAW360) The MDL proceedings in Ohio awarded sanctions to Walmart for alleged intentional non-compliance to discovery duties.

29 Mar 2021: THE CHEROKEE NATION, Plaintiff, v. MCKESSON CORPORATION et al., CIV-18-056. (US District Court, Eastern District of Oklahoma) The opioid-related lawsuit filed by the Cherokee Nation against several companies including Walmart was still ongoing.

19 Mar 2021: 10-K, 2021. (Walmart Inc.)

05 Feb 2021: Walmart lawsuit against US over opioids is dismissed. (CHANNEL NEWSASIA)

21 Jan 2021: Walmart Hit With Investor Suit Over DOJ Opioid Crisis Probe. (LAW360)

27 Jan 2021: Judge Doubts Walmart's Preemptive Opioid Suit Can Prevail. (LAW360)

30 Dec 2020: Shepard v. McKesson Corporation et al, 1:2020op45301. (US District Court, Northern District of Ohio) A lawsuit was filed against the company over an infant's alleged exposure to opioids in the Northern District of Ohio.

23 Dec 2020: U.S. sues Walmart saying pharmacies fueled opioid crisis, retailer rejects allegations. (Reuters)

22 Dec 2020: Department of Justice Files Nationwide Lawsuit Against Walmart Inc. for Controlled Substances Act Violations. (U.S. Department of Justice)

28 Sep 2020: Walmart Beats Ex-Pharmacist's Bid To Revive Opioid FCA Suit. (LAW360)

19 Aug 2020: West Virginia AG sues Walmart, CVS over opioid pill flood. (CBS News) The Attorney General of Pittsburgh filed a lawsuit against Walmart over alleged failure to monitor questionable orders of prescription opioid painkillers.

18 Aug 2020: West Virginia AG sues Walmart, CVS over opioid pill flood. (AP ASSOCIATED PRESS)

07 Jul 2020: Haag et al. v. McKesson Corporation et al., 1:20-op-45195. (US District Court, Northern District of Ohio)

18 Jun 2020: Walmart News: Shareholders Accuse Retailer Of Turning Pharmacies Into Illegal Opioid Distribution Centers. (INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS TIMES) Several shareholders of Walmart have filed a lawsuit against the company over its alleged role in the proliferation of opioids. 29 May 2020: Suits accuse retail chains of flooding Ohio with painkillers. (AP ASSOCIATED PRESS) Two counties in Ohio, Lake and Trumbull, filed lawsuits against several companies over their alleged role in the opioid crisis.

24 Mar 2020: Foundation on the Rock Ministries et al. v. AmerisourceBergen Drug Corporation, et al. (US District Court, Northern District of Ohio) Rehabilitation and therapy treatment facilities filed a lawsuit seeking compensation on alleged financial and operational damages related to the opioid crisis.

30 Jan 2020: Opioid MDL's Pharmacy Bellwether Trial Nudged To November. (LAW360) The US District judge moved the Bellwether trial related to the opioid litigation to November 2020.

27 Jan 2020: Pharmacies Can't Escape Public Nuisance In Opioid MDL. (LAW360) An Ohio judge dismissed the attempts of several companies, including Walmart, to dismiss claims of creating a public nuisance from alleged failure to monitor opioid prescriptions.

04 Dec 2019: 10-Q 2019. (Walmart, Inc.) Walmart stated in its 10-Q report for the period ended September 2019 that the company has factual and legal defenses to various lawsuits including those pending in the National Prescription Opiate Litigation (MDL 2804).

26 Sep 2019: U.S. judge refuses to disqualify himself from opioid litigation. (REUTERS) The United States judge rejected a request from companies, including Walmart, to disqualify himself from overseeing the nationwide litigation related to opioids, amounting to at least 2,000 lawsuits.

20 Sep 2019: Trent Bryant et al v. Purdue Pharma L.P., et al., 1:19-op-45805. (US District Court, Northern District of Ohio) Walmart, along with other companies, were named as defendants in a lawsuit over alleged misleading marketing of opioid medications.

17 Jul 2019: Drug makers flooded US with billions of opioid pills as epidemic surged, data shows. (The Guardian)

12 Jul 2019: County of Kauai v. CVS Health Corporation et al. (US District Court, District of Hawaii) The opioid-related suit, against several drug manufacturers and distributors, filed by the Kauai County in Hawaii was moved to the United States District Court for the District of Hawaii.

17 Jun 2019: Attorney General Ford Announces Expanded Lawsuit Against Opioid Conspirators. (Office of the Attorney General - Nevada, website)

06 Jun 2019: Town of Randolph v. Purdue Pharma L.P., Case No. 19-cv-10813-ADB. (US District Court, District of Massachusetts)

26 Jul 2018: Another opioids lawsuit lines up California county faults distributors. (ARKANSAS DEMOCRAT-GAZETTE)

11 Jan 2018: Cherokee Can’t Sue Opioid Distributors in Tribal Court, Judge Rules. (The New York Times)

12 Dec 2017: Case No. 17-md-2804. (US District Court, Northern District of Ohio)

21 Apr 2017: USA: Cherokee Nation sues 6 of the largest drug companies over alleged "epidemic" of prescription painkiller abuse leading to deaths. (Business & Human Rights Resource Centre (Main))

14 Mar 2017: Drug Distributors' Responses to Cabell County, WV Lawsuit. (MSNBC)

Source: 28 Aug 2026 (Miami Herald)

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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Moderate Controversies

Date: October 2025
Assessment: Moderate
Status: Ongoing

Flipkart, India: Compounding option offered by the ED following investigation into alleged FEMA violations
UPDATES: 12 Oct 2025: ED asks Flipkart to 'admit mistake, pay fine' for closing FEMA probe: Report. (FINANCIAL EXPRESS)

Source: 12 Oct 2025 (FINANCIAL EXPRESS)

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KEY METRIC & SCORE CHANGES

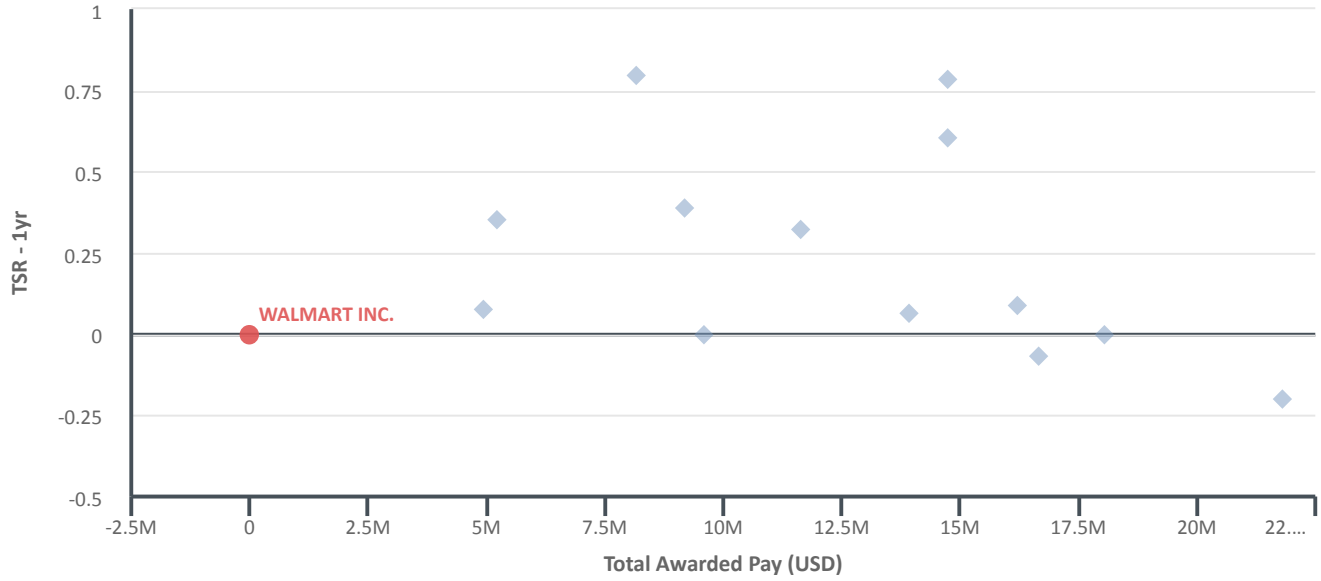
ALL KEY METRIC & SCORE CHANGES (SINCE JUNE 2025)

Key Metric	Key Metric Change	Date	Score Change	Change Notes
Leadership Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.30	
Controlling Shareholder Concerns	Flag Removed	Oct 15, 2026	0.99	
Risk Management Expertise	**Flag Added**	Jun 04, 2026	**-0.20**	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	May 15, 2026	0.25	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	May 15, 2026	**-0.25**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	May 15, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Realized	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	**Flag Added**	Mar 26, 2026	**-0.20**	
CEO Pay Total Fixed	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Realized	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Total Awarded	Flag Removed	Mar 12, 2026	0.20	
Severance Vesting	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.10	
CEO Equity Changes	Flag Removed	Feb 04, 2026	0.20	
CEO Pay Perks & Other Comp	Flag Removed	Dec 11, 2025	0.20	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	Jul 17, 2025	**-0.25**	
Overboarded Non-Exec Directors	**Flag Added**	Jul 17, 2025	**-0.49**	
Related Party Transactions	Score Change	Jul 10, 2025	0.25	

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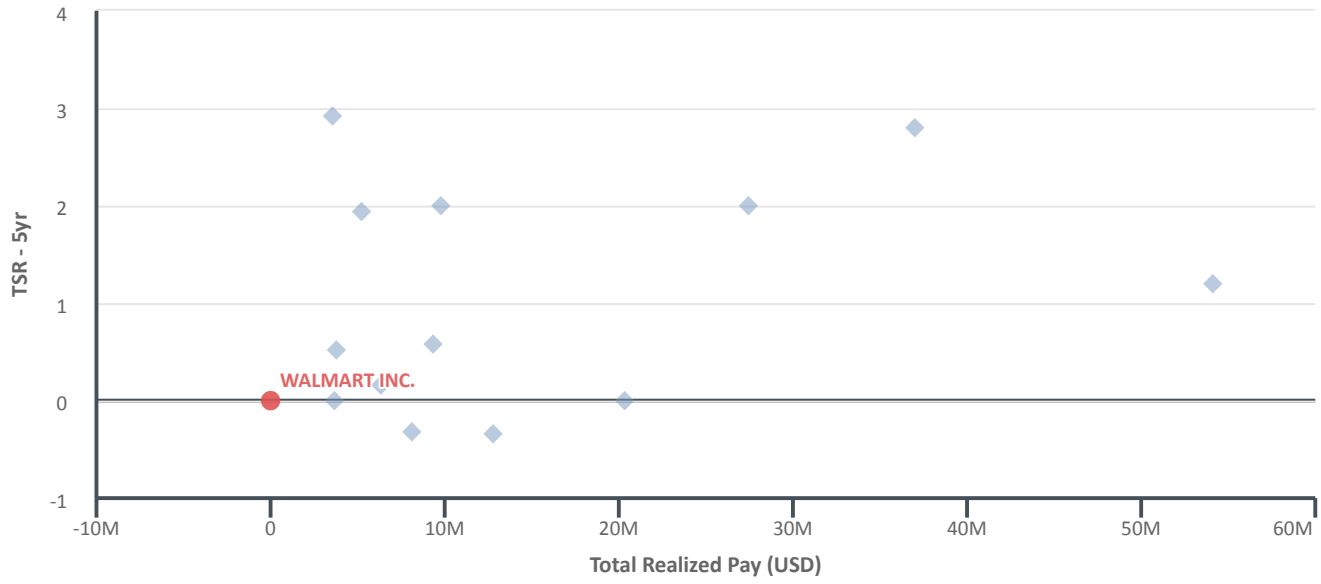
CEO PAY CHARTS

CEO TOTAL AWARDED PAY VERSUS PAY PEER GROUP



Pay Peers (♦) are used in the calculation of the Key Metric CEO Pay Total Summary and selected as set out in the MSCI Governance Metrics Methodology Document.

CEO TOTAL REALIZED PAY VERSUS PAY PEER GROUP



Pay Peers (♦) are used in the calculation of the Key Metric CEO Pay Total Summary and selected as set out in the MSCI Governance Metrics Methodology Document.

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DIRECTOR VOTES

Proxy Year	Name	Age	Tenure	Votes For	Votes Against, Withheld and / or Abstained
2026	Carla Harris	63	9	97.3%	2.7%
2026	Cesar Conde	52	7	99.2%	0.8%
2026	Gregory (Greg) Penner	56	18	97.2%	2.8%
2026	John Furner	52	0.74196	99.3%	0.7%
2026	Marissa Mayer	50	14	99%	1%
2026	Randall Stephenson	66	5	96.1%	3.9%
2026	Robert (Bob) Moritz Jr.	62	2	99%	1%
2026	Sarah Friar	53	8	99.8%	0.2%
2026	Shishir Mehrotra	46	0.80767	99.4%	0.6%
2026	Steuart Walton	44	10	99.3%	0.7%
2026	Thomas (Tom) Horton	65	11	98.2%	1.8%

SHAREHOLDER/MANAGEMENT PROPOSALS

MANAGEMENT PROPOSALS

Proxy Year	Proposal	Proposal Summary	Outcome	Votes For	Votes Against	Abstain/ Withheld%
2026	Auditor Ratification	Proposal No. 2: Ratification of Independent Accountants	Approved	97.5%	2.4%	0.1%
2026	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	Proposal No. 3: Advisory Vote to Approve Named Executive Officer Compensation	Approved	95.9%	3.9%	0.2%
2026	Amend Certificate of Incorporation	Proposal No. 4 Approve Amendment to our Restated Certificate of Incorporation	Approved	94.2%	5.7%	0.1%
2025	Auditor Ratification	2.Ratification of Independent Accountants. The Company's shareholders voted upon and approved the ratification of the appointment of Ernst & Young LLP to serve as the Company's independent registered accountants for the fiscal year ending January 31, 2026.	Approved	97.7%	2.2%	0.1%
2025	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	3.Advisory Vote to Approve Named Executive Officer Compensation. The Company's shareholders voted upon and approved, by nonbinding, advisory vote, the compensation of the Company's named executive officers, as described in the Company's proxy statement dated April 24, 2025.	Approved	95.1%	4.8%	0.1%
2025	Director & Employee Comp	4.Approval of the Walmart Inc. Stock Incentive Plan of 2025. The Company's shareholders voted upon, adopted, and approved the Walmart Inc. Stock Incentive Plan of 2025.	Approved	98.1%	1.7%	0.2%
2024	Advisory Vote on Executive Compensation	2.Advisory Vote to Approve Named Executive Officer Compensation.	Approved	92.3%	7.5%	0.2%
2024	Auditor Ratification	3.Ratification of Independent Accountants.	Approved	98.2%	1.7%	0.1%

**For Management Proposals at AGM's held more than three years ago, please refer to the Screener tool on ESG Manager.*

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SHAREHOLDER PROPOSALS

Proxy Year	Proposal	Proposal Summary	Proposal Proponent	Outcome	Votes For	Votes Against	Abstain/ Withheld%
2026	Board Elections - Cumulative Voting	Proposal No. 5 Request for Cumulative Voting for Board Elections	National Legal and Policy Center	Defeated	1.9%	97.9%	0.3%
2026	Health Care	Proposal No. 6 Report on Workplace Health and Safety Governance	Oxfam America, Inc.	Defeated	6.6%	92.1%	1.3%
2026	Other	Proposal No. 7 Report on Immigration Policy and Enforcement	SOC Investment Group	Defeated	4.3%	94.6%	1.2%
2026	Other	Proposal No. 8 Report on Workplace Impact of AI and Automation	United for Respect	Defeated	5%	94%	1.1%
2025	Other	5.The Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a third-party assessment of company policies regarding law enforcement information requests related to medication use by customers and employees.	Segal Marco Advisors on behalf of AFL-CIO Equity Index Funds	Defeated	4.1%	95.4%	0.5%
2025	Environmental - Land Use, Resources and Recycling	6.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on reduction of plastic packaging and recyclability claims.	Green Century Capital Management, Inc.	Defeated	5.8%	93.8%	0.3%
2025	Other	7.The Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal to revisit plastics packaging policies.	National Legal and Policy Center	Defeated	0.5%	99.1%	0.3%
2025	Employment Discrimination	8.Then, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a racial equity audit.	The Organization United for Respect (OUR)	Defeated	6.8%	92.3%	0.9%
2025	Employment Discrimination	9.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on delays in revising diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) Initiatives.	The National Center for Public Policy Research	Defeated	0.4%	99.3%	0.4%
2025	Health Care	10.The Company's shareholders also voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a review of health and safety governance.	Oxfam America, Inc. and its various co-filers	Defeated	7%	92.7%	0.4%
2025	Other	11.The Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting an evaluation of respect for civil liberties in advertising.	Bowyer Research Inc.	Defeated	0.4%	99.3%	0.4%
2024	Political Influence	Pursuant to the advance notice requirement of the Company's amended and restated bylaws, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal concerning limitations on political contributions made by WALPAC. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Not disclosed	Defeated	0%	100%	0%
2024	Animal Welfare	4.The Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting the publication of targets for transitioning from gestation crates in pork supply chain. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	The Accountability Board, Inc.	Defeated	12.5%	87%	0.5%
2024	Employment Discrimination	5.Then, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a racial equity audit. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	The Organization United for Respect (OUR) and its various co-filers	Defeated	15.4%	84.2%	0.4%
2024	Human Rights	6.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting human rights impact assessments. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Oxfam America, Inc.	Defeated	11.5%	87.5%	1%
2024	Other	7.The Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal to set compensation that optimizes portfolio value for Company shareholders. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Legal & General Investment Management America, Inc.	Defeated	4.4%	95.1%	0.5%

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



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Proxy Year	Proposal	Proposal Summary	Proposal Proponent	Outcome	Votes For	Votes Against	Abstain/ Withheld%
2024	Employment Discrimination	8.Next, the Company's shareholders voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on respecting workforce civil liberties. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Bowyer Research on behalf of The Bahnsen Family Trust	Defeated	0.5%	99.1%	0.4%
2024	Other	9.The Company's shareholders also voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a review of workplace safety and violence. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	Cynthia Murray and her co-filer	Defeated	19.1%	80.6%	0.4%
2024	Other	11.Finally, the Company's shareholders then voted upon and rejected a shareholder proposal requesting a report on corporate financial sustainability. The votes on this proposal were as follows:	The National Center for Public Policy Research	Defeated	0.4%	99.2%	0.4%

**For Shareholder Proposals at AGM's held more than three years ago, please refer to the Screener tool on ESG Manager.*

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DELAWARE



CURRENCY: UNITED STATES DOLLAR (USD)

In the United States, most governance principles are governed by state laws that are not uniform or nationally enforced. However, the majority of states have adopted the Model Business Corporation Act (MBCA) as the basis of their own laws by modifying some of the provisions of the MBCA. The MBCA is a body of laws designed to regulate corporate affairs uniformly across different states. It is the basis for business corporation statutes in 32 states and the District of Columbia and is the source of many provisions in the general corporation statutes of other states. Further, the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) regulates certain governance related matters on a federal level.

The majority of large U.S. businesses are listed on either the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) or the Nasdaq Stock Market (Nasdaq), and therefore are subject to their listing rules. The U.S. has not adopted a national corporate governance code.

Delaware's corporate governance is defined by the General Corporation Law of the State of Delaware (DGCL), with annual updates and revisions by the Delaware legislature based on the recommendations of the Council of the Corporation Law Section of the Delaware State Bar Association. Judicial decisions by the state's Court of Chancery also set governance practice, with appeals heard at the Delaware Supreme Court.

Companies adopt a unitary board structure in the U.S. The NYSE and Nasdaq listing rules require the majority of directors to be independent. The SEC rules require public companies to disclose and explain their chair-CEO structure and whether one or two people hold the roles. If the roles are combined, the company must further disclose whether it has a lead independent director and specify their role within the company leadership.

Unless stated otherwise in the articles of association, directors may appoint inspectors in advance of any shareholder meeting to determine the number of shares outstanding, voting rights, shares represented at the meeting, existence of a quorum, authenticity and validity of proxies, and take all other actions with regards to the annual shareholders' meeting.

Related party transactions (RPTs) are valid if the transaction was conducted on reasonable and fair terms when it was approved, and the RPT is approved in good faith by the majority of independent directors. If the number of independent directors is less than a quorum, then it must be approved by shareholders.

The board of directors may fix director and officer pay, although most companies delegate the responsibility for defining executive pay to independent directors, usually upon the recommendation of the pay or nominating/governance committee. Officers are executive directors that are responsible for the daily management of the company.

The Dodd-Frank Act requires listed companies to hold an advisory vote every three years on "say on pay" policies, as well as disclose additional information regarding "golden parachute" arrangements linked to merger transactions.

Listed companies must annually disclose the pay of directors and officers, including stock and option awards. Disclosure must be made in a tabular format, along with a descriptive summary of the information in the table. Companies listed on Nasdaq must also disclose pay arrangements between directors or nominees and third parties.

The U.S. market is known for having widely dispersed ownership, but founder-led companies are common. There are multiple share classes with unequal voting rights and voting right limits.

Shareholders with at least 10% voting rights can request to convene a general meeting.

A notice of the meeting, specifying the date, time, place and purpose must be given no less than seven days and no more than 60 days in advance. Special meeting of shareholders may be convened by shareholders owning at least 10% of shares. Typically, each share is entitled to one vote and fractional shares are entitled to proportionate votes. Shareholders do not have preemptive rights unless specifically provided in the bylaws or articles. Dissenting shareholders are entitled to appraisal rights.

Unless otherwise stipulated in the articles, a corporation is not obligated to offer shareholders any shares, option rights or securities when issuing them.

There are no mandatory takeover bid provisions in the U.S.

In 2018, the Delaware enacted a Certification of Adoption of Transparency and Sustainability Standards Act which is a voluntary act broadly enabling entities registered in Delaware to craft a sustainability regime. The Act is primarily a disclosure regime which requires entities to disclose and provide reports regarding their standards and metrics. There are many provisions in the Federal Sarbanes-Oxley Act that govern the audit process. A public company's annual financial statements must be audited by a registered independent auditing firm. Listed companies prepare two annual reports, one for SEC (Form 10-K) and one for their shareholders. The reports to stockholders, as required by SEC, must contain certified financial statements of two-year audited balance sheets, and three-year audited statement of income and cash flows. Directors and officers of the corporation must also be identified. Interim financial statements are not audited, only reviewed by the company's auditors. If an auditor has not reviewed the interim report, it must be accompanied with a notice specifying that the report has not been reviewed by an auditor. Audit firm rotation is not required but lead audit partners are subject to rotation every five years.

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DIRECTOR PROFILES

CARLA HARRIS

Age:	63	Financial:	No
Gender:	F	Risk:	No
Nationality:	Not Disclosed	Industry:	Financial Services - Capital Markets

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Carla has served as vice chair of Wealth Management and head of Multicultural Client Strategy for Morgan Stanley from August 2013 to December 2021, and continues to serve as senior client advisor since June 2012. Her experience at Morgan Stanley includes increasing client connectivity and penetration to enhance revenue generation across the firm. Carla joined the mergers and acquisitions team at Morgan Stanley in 1987 and since then has held a number of positions during her tenure. Her experiences at Morgan Stanley range from investment banking, equity capital markets, equity private placements and initial public offerings in a number of industries such as technology, media, retail, telecommunications, transportation, health care and biotechnology. In August 2013, President Barack Obama appointed Carla to serve as chair of the National Women's Business Council. She was elected to the board of Cummins Inc. in May 2021 and was appointed to join the board of MetLife, Inc. to become effective in April 2022. She also currently serves on the boards of several nonprofit organizations, including the Mother Cabrini Health Foundation and the Morgan Stanley Foundation, as well as a member of the Board of Overseers for Harvard University. Carla holds an undergraduate degree and an MBA from Harvard University.

CUMMINS INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/02/2026

Ms Harris is Senior Client Advisor at Morgan Stanley a global financial services firm She is a coportfolio manager of the Next Level Fund an advisor to the Multicultural Innovation Lab the host of the podcast Access Opportunities and acts in various client coverage capacities She served as Vice Chair of Wealth Management from 20132021 and Chair of the Morgan Stanley Foundation from 20052014 She joined the merger and acquisitions team at Morgan Stanley in 1987 and had roles of increasing responsibility giving her broad experience in investment banking equity capital markets and equity private placements She covered a wide range of industries including technology media retail telecommunications transportation healthcare and biotechnology In August 2013 Ms Harris was appointed by President Barack Obama to chair the National Womens Business Council Ms Harris has served on the board of Walmart Inc since 2017 and serves on its Compensation and Management Development Nominating and Governance and Strategic Planning and Finance Committees Ms Harris has also served on the board of MetLife Inc since April 2022 and serves on its Investment and Governance and Corporate Responsibility Committees She also serves on the boards of several nonprofit organizations including Hackensack Meridian Health Sponsors for Educational Opportunity SEO Mother Cabrini Health Foundation Sesame Workshop and the Morgan Stanley Foundation Ms Harris holds an MBA from Harvard Business School and an AB from Harvard College Summary of Qualifications Skills and Experience Ms Harris brings senior leadership experience in finance strategy and risk management from her 38year career at a global investment banking firm Ms Harris contributes insights on highly regulated industries and international operations through her directorships at two Fortune 500 companies She offers perspectives gained from her career experience in increasing client connectivity and penetration to enhance revenue generation As an author of three books on leadership Ms Harris offers insights on talent development and retention

METLIFE, INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/29/2026

Carla A. Harris, Director since 2022; Independent With more than 30 years of experience as a senior leader of a global financial services firm, Ms. Harris has a keen understanding of both enhancing client connectivity and generating revenue through the capital markets. During her time at Morgan Stanley, Ms. Harris has gained insight into a wide-range of industries including the technology, media, retail, telecommunications, transportation, industrial, and healthcare sectors. Ms. Harris also brings critical portfolio management skills to the Board and the Company, which will support the Company in its commitment to accelerating growth in its asset management business. As a published author on leadership, award-winning podcaster on access and opportunity, public speaker and widely recognized leader of efforts to promote equity and inclusion, Ms. Harris contributes significant expertise to the Board's oversight of the Company's succession plans for the CEO and for the Company's other executive officers, as well as the Company's sustainability strategy. MetLife Board Committees: Executive Committee Governance and Corporate Responsibility Investment (Chair) Professional Highlights: Morgan Stanley, a multinational investment bank and financial services firm Senior Client Advisor (2021 – Present) Vice Chairman, Managing Director, Senior Client Advisor, Head of Multicultural Client Strategy (2012 – 2021) Other senior positions focused on mergers and acquisitions, equity capital markets, and asset management (1987 – 2012) Other U.S. Listed Public Company Directorships: Cummins Inc. (2021 - Present) Walmart, Inc. (2017 - Present) Education: A.B. and M.B.A., Harvard University

HACKENSACK MERIDIAN HEALTH, INC. - Board Member Source Date: 07/15/2024

Carla Harris is a Senior Client Advisor at Morgan Stanley. She was most recently a Vice Chairman responsible for increasing client connectivity and penetration to enhance revenue generation across the firm. She formerly headed the Emerging Manager Platform, the equity capital markets effort for the consumer and retail industries and was responsible for Equity Private Placements. In her 30+ year career, Ms. Harris has had extensive industry experiences in the technology, media, retail, telecommunications, transportation, industrial, and healthcare sectors. In August 2013, Carla Harris was appointed by President Barack Obama to chair the National Women's Business Council. For more than a decade, Ms. Harris was a senior member of the equity syndicate desk and executed such transactions as initial public offerings for UPS, Martha Stewart Living Omnimedia, Ariba, Redback, the General Motors sub-IPO of Delphi Automotive, and the $3.2 Billion common stock transaction for Immunex Corporation, one of the largest biotechnology common stock transactions in U.S. history.

Prior to joining Morgan Stanley, Carla received an MBA from Harvard Business School and an AB in economics from Harvard University. Carla has also received Honorary Doctorates of Laws, Humanities and Business from Marymount Manhattan College, Bloomfield College, Converse College, Jacksonville University, Simmons College, the College of New Rochelle, St. Thomas Aquinas College, Babson College and Fisk University, Wake Forest University and Felician University respectively. Carla Harris is actively involved in her community. She is the past Chair of the Board of the Morgan Stanley Foundation and of The Executive Leadership Council, and sits on the boards of Sponsors for Educational Opportunity (SEO), The Sesame Workshop, Mother Cabrini Health Foundation and is an active member of the St. Charles Gospelites of the St. Charles Borromeo Catholic Church and the Mark Howell Singers. She is a member of the board of overseers of Harvard University and of the board of directors of the Walmart Corporation, Cummins Corporation and MetLife.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
HACKENSACK MERIDIAN HEALTH, INC.	Board Member	2	Oct 09, 2024		Yes	Yes	
METLIFE, INC.	Board Member	4	Apr 27, 2022		Yes	Yes	
CUMMINS INC.	Board Member	5	May 11, 2021		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	9	Jun 02, 2017		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
CUMMINS INC.	Pay	Member
CUMMINS INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
CUMMINS INC.	Nomination	Member
METLIFE, INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
METLIFE, INC.	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Pay	Chair
WALMART INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
WALMART INC.	Nomination	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
CUMMINS INC.	2026	93.9%	6.2%
METLIFE, INC.	2026	96.5%	3.5%
WALMART INC.	2026	97.3%	2.7%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
CUMMINS INC.	Non-Executive	5	2025	160,000	381,909	3,502
METLIFE, INC.	Non-Executive	4	2025	175,000	351,785	7,057
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	9	2026	131,429	361,439	50,098

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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CESAR CONDE

Age:	52	Financial:	No
Gender:	M	Risk:	No
Nationality:	Not Disclosed	Industry:	Media & Entertainment - Media

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Cesar Conde iAs Chairman of NBCUniversal News Group, Cesar Conde oversees the nation's largest news media organization. It includes NBC News, NBC News NOW, NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises Group and NBCUniversal Local. Under Conde's leadership, the News Group reaches about seven in 10 American adults each month across its English and Spanish language broadcast, cable, streaming and digital platforms. It became the nation's number one digital news organization after making substantial investments in digital and streaming offerings. NBC News NOW, its 24/7streaming network, is the fastest-growing streaming news network in the United States and continues to achieve record-breaking viewership numbers, along with significant domestic and international distribution growth. Conde previously served as Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group and NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises. As Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group, he was responsible for the operations and international expansion of NBCUniversal businesses outside of North America. As Chairman of NBCU Telemundo Enterprises, Conde oversaw the leading media properties to serve Hispanics worldwide. He was instrumental in building NBCU Telemundo Enterprises into a world-class media company, producing and distributing high-quality Spanish-language content across a range of broadcast, cable and digital properties. Conde repositioned Telemundo to become the premier Spanish-language network, propelling the network to rank number one for the first time in its history in primetime among key consumer demographics. In 2013, Conde joined NBCUniversal as executive vice president of NBCU International and NBCU Digital Enterprises. He previously served as president of Univision Networks. He is credited with transforming the Spanish-language media company into a leading global, multi-platform media brand. Conde served as a White House fellow for Secretary of State Colin L. Powell from 2002 to 2003. He also worked for StarMedia Network, the first internet company focused on Spanish and Portuguese-speaking audiences globally, and in the Mergers & Acquisitions Group at Salomon Smith Barney. Conde serves on the board of directors of Walmart (NYSE: WMT) and PepsiCo (NASDAQ: PEP). He is a board member at the Council on Foreign Relations and a trustee of the Paley Center for Media. He holds a B.A. with honors from Harvard University and an M.B.A. from the Wharton School at the University of Pennsylvania.

PEPSICO, INC. - Board Member Source Date: 03/27/2026

Cesar Conde has served as Chairman of the NBCUniversal News Group part of a global media and entertainment company since 2020 In this role Mr Conde has oversight of NBC News MSNBC CNBC Telemundo and NBCU Local From 2015 to 2020 Mr Conde served as Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group and NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises From 2013 to 2015 he served as Executive Vice President at NBCUniversal where he oversaw NBCUniversal International and NBCUniversal Digital Enterprises From 2009 to 2013 Mr Conde served as President of Univision Networks a leading American media company with a portfolio of Spanish language television networks radio stations and digital platforms From 2003 to 2009 Mr Conde served in a variety of senior executive capacities at Univision Networks and is credited with transforming it into a leading global multiplatform media brand Prior to Univision Mr Conde served as the White House Fellow for Secretary of State Colin L Powell from 2002 to 2003 Mr Conde also currently serves on the boards of several nonprofit organizations including the Council on Foreign Relations and The Aspen Institute Other Public Company Directorships Current Walmart Inc Previous During Past 5 Years Owens Corning until 2019 Skills and Qualifications Mr Conde is an experienced global executive with a strong track record in business finance and media He provides our Board of Directors with diverse and actionable perspectives on todays consumer and media landscapes and his unique insights are particularly valuable as PepsiCo continues to build new omnichannel marketing capabilities and adapt to changing demographics around the world Mr Conde also brings his market and consumer insights developed through his experience at national and global media companies and his leadership of social and corporate responsibility initiatives worldwide

RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION - Board Member Source Date: 06/18/2026

Mr. Conde has been a director of the Company since January 2026. Mr. Conde has served as Chairman of the NBCUniversal News Group, part of a global media and entertainment company, since 2020. From 2015 to 2020, Mr. Conde served as Chairman of NBCUniversal International Group and NBCUniversal Telemundo Enterprises. From 2013 to 2015, he served as Executive Vice President at NBCUniversal, where he oversaw NBCUniversal International and NBCUniversal Digital Enterprises. From 2009 to 2013, Mr. Conde served as President of Univision Networks, a leading media company with a portfolio of Spanish language television networks, radio stations and digital platforms. From 2003 to 2009, Mr. Conde served in a variety of senior executive capacities at Univision Networks and is credited with transforming it into a leading global, multi-platform media brand. Prior to Univision, Mr. Conde served as the White House Fellow for Secretary of State Colin L. Powell from 2002 to 2003. Mr. Conde serves as a member of the Board of Directors of PepsiCo and Walmart, both public companies. Mr. Conde also currently serves on the boards of several non-profit organizations, including the Council on Foreign Relations. Mr. Conde holds a Bachelors of Arts from Harvard University and a Master of Business Administration from the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania. Mr. Conde is an experienced global executive with a strong track record in business, finance and media. Mr. Conde also brings his market and consumer insights developed through his experience at national and global media companies and his leadership of social and corporate responsibility initiatives worldwide

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION	Board Member		Jan 15, 2026		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	7	Jun 05, 2019		Yes	Yes	
PEPSICO, INC.	Board Member	10	May 04, 2016		Yes	Yes	

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
PEPSICO, INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
PEPSICO, INC.	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Audit	Member
WALMART INC.	Risk	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
PEPSICO, INC.	2026	94.7%	5.3%
RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION	2026	100%	0%
WALMART INC.	2026	99.2%	0.8%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
PEPSICO, INC.	Non-Executive	10	2025	160,000	360,000	18,444
RALPH LAUREN CORPORATION	Non-Executive		2026	26,250	26,250	10
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	7	2026	108,571	338,581	31,588

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

GREGORY (GREG) PENNER

Age: 56
Gender: M
Nationality: United States of America

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail - Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail,Financial Services - Capital Markets

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member, Chairman Source Date: 04/23/2026

Greg Penner is CEO and an owner of the Denver Broncos. He is a founder and general partner of Madrone Capital Partners, a private investment management firm. He is also chairman of the Walmart Board of Directors since 2015. Greg is only the third person, after his father-in-law, Rob Walton, and company founder, Sam Walton, to serve in this position. Prior to being elected chairman of the Board, Greg worked in several capacities at Walmart over a 20-year period, including as senior vice president and chief financial officer for the business in Japan, and senior vice president of finance and strategy for Walmart.com. He was first elected as a Walmart Board member in 2008, and in the years since, he served as a member on the Strategic Planning and Finance Committee and as chairman of the Technology and eCommerce Committee. Before joining Walmart, Greg was a financial analyst at Goldman Sachs & Co. and a general partner of Peninsula Capital. He also served as a member of the boards of directors of Baidu, Inc., from 2004 to 2017, and Hyatt Hotels Corporation from 2007 to 2014. Greg earned a Bachelor of Science in international economics from Georgetown University in 1992 and a Master of Business Administration from the Stanford Graduate School of Business in 1997.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member, Chairman	18	Jan 01, 2008		No	No	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	97.2%	2.8%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Chair	18	2026	221,071	563,539	259,257

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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JOHN FURNER

Age: 52
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: No
Risk: No
Industry: Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail - Consumer Staples Distribution & Retail

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Executive, Board Member, CEO Source Date: 04/23/2026

John Furner serves as president and chief executive officer of Walmart U.S., where he leads more than 1.5 million associates and is responsible for the strategic direction and performance of Walmart's 4,700 stores, as well as its website, app and supply chain. From 2017-2019, John served as president and chief executive officer of Sam's Club. During his time as CEO, Sam's Club had 11 consecutive quarters of positive sales comps, while increasing memberships. John started with Walmart as an hourly associate in 1993, at Store 100 in Bentonville, Arkansas. He has held important roles throughout the company, including assistant store manager, store manager, district manager, buyer, regional general manager, divisional merchandising manager, VP of global sourcing, general merchandise manager, head of marketing and merchandising for Walmart China based in Shenzhen, and chief merchant for Sam's Club. He serves on the board of directors for the National Retail Federation and was chairman from 2022 to 2025. John has a bachelor of science in marketing management from the University of Arkansas.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Executive, Board Member, CEO		Nov 13, 2025		No	Yes	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	99.3%	0.7%

EXECUTIVE PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Total Annual Pay	Total Awarded Pay	Total Realized Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	CEO		2026	5,083,606	27,343,149	43,954,406	342,311

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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MARISSA MAYER

Age:	50
Gender:	F
Nationality:	Not Disclosed
Financial:	No
Risk:	No
Industry:	Software & Services - Internet Software & Services,Household & Personal Products - Personal Care Products

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Marissa A. Mayer is the co-founder and CEO of Sunshine Products (formerly Lumi Labs, Inc.), a technology startup focused on making everyday tasks, like contact management or scheduling, magical. From July 2012 through June 2017, she served as president, chief executive officer and a member of the board of directors of Yahoo Inc. (Yahoo,now Altaba, Inc.). At Yahoo, she led the internet giant's push to reinvent itself for the mobile era. With a renewed focus on user experience, Marissa grew Yahoo to serve over 1 billion people worldwide — with more than 600 million mobile users and transformed its advertising approach. Prior to her role at Yahoo, Marissa spent 13 years at Google, Inc.Google where she led various initiatives, including Google Search, for more than a decade and other products such as Google Maps, Gmail and Google News. She holds a bachelor's degree in symbolic systems and a master's degree in computer science from Stanford University. From March 2013 until October 2016, she served on the board of directors for AliphCom, which operates as Jawbone. She also serves on the boards of Go Forward, a company that combines virtual and in-person primary care practice, as well as Maisonette, an online company focused on providing customized shopping experiences in children’s luxury brands and boutique clothing, accessory, and home décor items. In addition, she serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet and previously served on the foundation board for the Forum of Young Global Leaders at the World Economic Forum.

AT&T INC. - Board Member Source Date: 03/23/2026

Ms. Mayer has served as Chief Executive Officer of Sunshine Products (a technology startup company based in Palo Alto, California that uses artificial intelligence to develop consumer-facing applications for automating everyday tasks) since she co-founded the company in 2018. She previously served as Chief Executive Officer, President and a member of the Board of Directors of Yahoo!, Inc. from 2012 to 2017. Before joining Yahoo!, Ms. Mayer spent 13 years at Google, Inc., from 1999 to 2012, where she held various roles of increasing responsibility including Vice President, Local, Maps and Locations Services, and Vice President, Search Products and User Experience. She has served on the board of Walmart Inc. since 2012 and Nextdoor, Inc. since May 2024. In addition, she serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet and previously served on the foundation board for the Forum of Young Global Leaders at the World Economic Forum. Ms. Mayer holds a bachelor’s degree in symbolic systems and a master’s degree in computer science with a specialization in artificial intelligence from Stanford University. Skills and Qualifications Ms. Mayer brings extensive expertise in technology and a deep understanding of the consumer Internet experience. She has senior leadership and human capital management experience through her CEO role at Yahoo!. As a long tenured director of Walmart Inc., she brings valuable experience in the oversight of a large publicly traded retail and ecommerce business.

STARBUCKS CORPORATION - Board Member Source Date: 01/26/2026

MARISSA MAYER is Chief Executive Officer of Dazzle AI a technology startup company based in Palo Alto California that uses artificial intelligence to develop consumer facing applications for automating everyday tasks She previously served as Chief Executive Officer at Sunshine AI from 2018 to 2025 She previously served as Chief Executive Officer President and a member of the Board of Directors of Yahoo Inc from 2012 to 2017 At Yahoo she led a transformation of the company rejuvenating its culture growing to more than 1 billion users worldwide and reinventing Yahoos business Before joining Yahoo Ms Mayer spent 13 years at Google Inc from 1999 to 2012 as an early employee and the first woman engineer For more than a decade she led product management for Google Search Google Maps Google News and other consumer products holding various roles of increasing responsibility including Vice President Local Maps and Location Services and Vice President Search Products and User Experience She is on the boards of Walmart Hilton ATT and Sunshine Products Inc and also serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet She previously served on the boards of Nextdoor private companies Maisonette and Forward Health and on the foundation board for the Forum of Young Global Leaders at the World Economic Forum Ms Mayer holds a bachelors degree in Symbolic Systems with a concentration in artificial intelligence and a masters degree in computer science with a focus on artificial intelligence both from Stanford University Committees Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee

HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/02/2026

Marissa Mayer joined the Hilton board in May 2025. She is the CEO and Founder of Dazzle AI, a Palo Alto-based technology company focused in the consumer artificial intelligence space. Her leadership at Dazzle follows a seven-year tenure as CEO of Sunshine Products, which was acquired by Dazzle AI in 2025. A seasoned veteran of the technology industry, Ms. Mayer previously served as CEO, President, and Director of Yahoo!, Inc. (2012–2017). Prior to her time at Yahoo!, she was one of Google’s earliest employees and its first female engineer. During her 13-year tenure at Google, she rose to Vice President of Search and User Experience, leading the search business for over a decade and overseeing the development of flagship products including Google Maps, Google News, and Gmail. She has served on the board of Walmart Inc. since 2012. At Walmart, she has served on the Compensation and Management Development Committee, the Strategic Planning and Finance Committee, and the Technology and E-Commerce Committee. She has served on the boards of AT&T Inc. since 2024 and Starbucks since 2025. She serves on AT&T's Audit Committee and the Corporate Development and Finance Committee as well as Starbucks' Nomination and Governance Committee. She also serves on the board of the San Francisco Ballet. Ms. Mayer holds a bachelor’s degree in Symbolic Systems with a concentration in artificial intelligence and a master’s degree in Computer Science with a specialization in artificial intelligence, both from Stanford University.

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Board Member	1	Jun 25, 2025		Yes	Yes	
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	Board Member	1	May 14, 2025		Yes	Yes	
AT&T INC.	Board Member	2	Mar 01, 2024		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	14	Apr 16, 2012		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
AT&T INC.	Audit	Member
AT&T INC.	Risk	Member
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	Pay	Member
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Corporate Governance	Member
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Pay	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
AT&T INC.	2026	98.4%	1.6%
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	2026	99.1%	0.9%
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	2026	99%	1%
WALMART INC.	2026	99%	1%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
AT&T INC.	Non-Executive	2	2025	140,000	370,429	28,869
HILTON WORLDWIDE HOLDINGS INC.	Non-Executive	1	2025	55,000	289,784	930
STARBUCKS CORPORATION	Non-Executive	1	2025		220,784	2,359
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	14	2026	108,571	338,581	130,950

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

RANDALL STEPHENSON

Age: 66
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Telecommunication Services - Diversified Telecommunication Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member, Lead Director Source Date: 04/23/2026

Randall retired in January of 2021 as executive chairman of the board of AT&T Inc. Prior to that he was chairman of the board and chief executive officer of AT&T and served in that capacity from 2007 until July 2020, having also served as president from 2007 through September 2019. He held a variety of high-level finance, operational and marketing positions with AT&T, including serving as chief operating officer from 2004 until his appointment as chief executive officer in 2007 and as chief financial officer from 2001 to 2004. He began his career with AT&T in 1982. Randall received his B.S. in accounting from Central State University (now known as the University of Central Oklahoma) and earned his Master of Accountancy degree from the University of Oklahoma. He has served on the board of directors of Boy Scouts of America since 2005, including as chairman of the board from 2016 to 2018, and the PGA Tour since 2012. He was chairman of the Business Roundtable from 2014 to 2016.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member, Lead Director	5	Mar 03, 2021		Yes	Yes	
AT&T INC.	Executive		Jun 01, 2005	Jan 21, 2020	No	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
WALMART INC.	Pay	Member
WALMART INC.	Corporate Governance	Chair
WALMART INC.	Nomination	Chair

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	96.1%	3.9%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Lead Director	5	2026	156,429	386,852	65,029

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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ROBERT (BOB) MORITZ JR.

Age: 62
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Commercial & Professional Services - Professional Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Bob Moritz is the former global chair of PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC), a professional services network providing audit, tax, consulting and deals services around the world. In his role, Bob led the international network's leadership teams, set strategy and enhanced the brand of PwC through quality service to their stakeholders. Bob spent 39 years with PwC, joining in 1985 and becoming a partner in 1995. He has an audit and assurance background, primarily dealing with financial services, banking and capital markets clients. During the course of his career, Bob spent three years with PwC Japan, working with European and U.S.-based financial services companies operating in Asia. Prior to taking on the global role, Bob led the U.S. firm of PwC as its chairman and senior partner for seven years. In addition to spending a career focused on the principles of shared value, Bob holds several board seats, including SUNY-Oswego College Foundation, his alma mater.

S&P GLOBAL INC. - Board Member Source Date: 03/31/2026

Robert Moritz Former Global Chairman PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP Robert Moritz was the Global Chairman of PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP PwC where he served from 2016 to 2024 Mr Moritz is currently a member of the Board of Directors of Walmart where he sits on the Audit and Technology and eCommerce Committees and Northern Trust Corporation where he sits on the Audit and Human Capital and Compensation Committees In his role as Global Chairman of PwC from 2016 2024 Mr Moritz led the international networks leadership teams set strategy and enhanced the brand of PwC through quality service to their stakeholders Mr Moritz spent 39 years with PwC joining in 1985 and becoming a partner in 1995 He has an audit and assurance background primarily dealing with financial services banking and capital markets clients During the course of his career Mr Moritz spent three years with PwC Japan working with European and US based financial services companies operating in Asia Prior to taking on the global role Mr Moritz led the US firm of PwC as its Chairman and Senior Partner for seven years In addition to spending a career focused on the principles of shared value Mr Moritz holds several not for profit board seats including Generation Unlimited and SUNY Oswego College Foundation his alma mater Committee Membership Audit Committee Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Board Member		Feb 01, 2026		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	2	Aug 15, 2024		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Audit	Member
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Nomination	Member
S&P GLOBAL INC.	Risk	Member
WALMART INC.	Audit	Chair
WALMART INC.	Risk	Chair

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
S&P GLOBAL INC.	2026	99.6%	0.4%
WALMART INC.	2026	99%	1%

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WALMART INC. (WMT)



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DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	2	2026	108,751	339,604	11,807

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

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RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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SARAH FRIAR

Age: 53
Gender: F
Nationality: United States of America

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Software & Services - Software,Media & Entertainment - Interactive Media & Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Sarah Friar is the chief financial officer of OpenAI, where she oversees the company's financial strategy and operations. From December 2018 to May 2024, Sarah was chief executive officer of Nextdoor, the neighborhood network that connects neighborhood stakeholders, including neighbors, businesses, and public services, online and in real life to build stronger, more vibrant, and resilient neighborhoods. She helped take Nextdoor public in 2021 under the ticker NYSE:KIND. Prior to Nextdoor, Sarah served as chief financial officer at Square (now known as Block, Inc.). Under Sarah's leadership, the company launched its initial public offering in 2015 and added $30 billion in market capitalization. Before her tenure at Square, Sarah served as senior vice president of finance & strategy at Salesforce. Sarah also held executive roles at Goldman Sachs, as well as leadership positions at McKinsey in both London and South Africa. Sarah currently also serves on the board of Consensys, a private company in the Web3 arena, and she previously served on the boards of Slack Technologies (from 2017 to 2021), Dragonneer Growth Opportunities Corp. (from 2020 to 2021), Dragonneer Growth Opportunities Corp. II (from 2020 to 2021), Dragonneer Growth Opportunities Corp. III (from 2021 to 2023), and New Relic (from 2013 to 2018). She is a Fellow of the inaugural class of the Finance Leaders Fellowship Program, a member of the Aspen Global Leadership Network, and serves on the advisory boards of Operation HOPE, the Blavatnik School of Government at Oxford and The Stanford Digital Economy Lab. She is co-founder of Ladies Who Launch, a network that mentors and inspires women entrepreneurs and business owners. She was named to the 2023 NACD Directorship 100 selection, an annual recognition of the leading corporate directors, corporate governance experts, policymakers, and influencers who significantly impact boardroom practices and performance. Sarah grew up in Northern Ireland and earned her MEng in Metallurgy, Economics, and Management from the University of Oxford and her MBA from the Stanford University Graduate School of Business, where she graduated as an Arjay Miller scholar.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
Nextdoor Holdings, Inc.	Executive		Nov 01, 2021	May 08, 2024	No	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	8	Feb 07, 2018		Yes	Yes	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	99.8%	0.2%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	8	2026	131,429	361,439	60,007

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
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SHISHIR MEHROTRA

Age: 46
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: No
Risk: No
Industry: Technology Hardware & Equipment - Electronic Equipment, Instruments & Components,Software & Services - Internet Software & Services

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Shishir Mehrotra is a 25+ year technology veteran with a track record of building category-defining platforms. Prior to joining Superhuman, he was the CEO and co-founder of Coda, a productivity and AI platform that grew to serve millions of users and tens of thousands of teams. Before founding Coda, Mehrotra served as YouTube's Chief Product Officer and Chief Technology Officer, helping grow YouTube into the world's largest video destination and one of Google's largest and fastest-growing businesses, as well as a platform of choice for a new generation of creators. He holds a dual bachelor of science degree in mathematics and computer science from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology

SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A. - Board Member Source Date: 02/10/2026

Shishir Mehrotra is a member of our board of directors. He has been a member of our board of directors since June 13, 2017, and his term will expire on the date of the general meeting of shareholders to be held to approve the annual accounts of 2024. Mr. Mehrotra previously served as our Strategic Advisor to the Chief Executive Officer from December 2015 to May 2017. Mr. Mehrotra is the CEO of Grammarly, Inc. Previously, he was the CEO and Co-Founder of Coda, Inc., which was acquired by Grammarly, Inc. Mr. Mehrotra has previously served as Chief Product and Technology Officer for YouTube at Google and Director of Program Management at Microsoft. Mr. Mehrotra holds a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and a Bachelor of Science in Mathematics from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member		Jan 08, 2026		Yes	Yes	
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	Board Member	9	Jun 13, 2017		Yes	Yes	

BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	Pay	Member
WALMART INC.	Pay	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	2026	95.9%	4.1%
WALMART INC.	2026	99.4%	0.6%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
SPOTIFY TECHNOLOGY S.A.	Non-Executive	9	2025	0	642,406	55,749
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive		2026	0	93,283	1,286

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WALMART INC. (WMT)

MSCI ESG RATINGS AA

CCC | B | BB | BBB | A | AA | AAA

RATING ACTION DATE: October 29, 2026
LAST REPORT UPDATE: November 02, 2026

STEUART WALTON

Age: 44
Gender: M
Nationality: Not Disclosed

Financial: No
Risk: No
Industry: Capital Goods - Aerospace & Defense,Financial Services - Capital Markets

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Steuart Walton is the founder and chairman of RZC Investments, an investment business located in Bentonville, Arkansas. He is also founder and former chief executive officer of Game Composites, a U.S. manufacturer of carbon fiber aircraft and aircraft parts. He is also the co-founder of Runway Group, a holding company that makes investments in real estate, outdoor initiatives, and hospitality. Steuart serves as a director of Rapha Racing Limited, a cycling apparel business, and is active in the governance and operations of many of his family's enterprises. He is a board member of Crystal Bridges Museum of American Art, Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum and Leadership for Education Equity. He has a law degree from Georgetown and previously worked at Allen and Overy, and he also worked as a Walmart associate on the mergers and acquisitions team while living in London.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
WALMART INC.	Board Member	10	Jun 03, 2016		No	No	

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
WALMART INC.	2026	99.3%	0.7%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	10	2026	131,429	361,439	80,209

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THOMAS (TOM) HORTON

Age: 65
Gender: M
Nationality: United States of America

Financial: Yes
Risk: No
Industry: Telecommunication Services - Diversified Telecommunication Services,Transportation - Passenger Airlines

FLAGGED DIRECTOR

Mr. Horton is designated a 'flagged director' due to his involvement with the board of AMR Corporation, which filed for Chapter 11 Bankruptcy in November 2011.

BIOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

WALMART INC. - Board Member Source Date: 04/23/2026

Tom is a partner at Global Infrastructure Partners, a global infrastructure investment firm. He previously served as senior advisor at Warburg Pincus LLC, a private equity firm focused on growth investing. He was the chairman of American Airlines Group, Inc., from 2013 to 2014. He was chairman, president and chief executive officer of American Airlines, Inc., and AMR Corporation from 2011 to 2013, after being named president of American in 2010. During that time, he led American through a successful restructuring and turnaround that culminated in the merger with US Airways, creating the world's largest airline. Previously, he served as executive vice president of finance and planning of AMR and American from 2006 to 2010, and vice chairman and chief financial officer of AT&T Corporation from 2002 to 2005. Prior to joining AT&T, he was senior vice president and chief financial officer of AMR from 2000 to 2002 and served in numerous management positions with AMR since 1985. He joined American Airlines from international accounting partnership firm Peat Marwick & Company, which is now known as KPMG. He earned a master's degree in business administration from the Cox School of Business at Southern Methodist University and a bachelor's degree in accounting from Baylor University, where he graduated magna cum laude. He has served as a director of General Electric Company since April 2018, and he previously served on the boards of Qualcomm Incorporated (from 2008 to 2019) and EnLink Midstream (from 2019 to 2022). He also serves on the executive board of the Cox School of Business at SMU.

CHEVRON CORPORATION - Board Member Source Date: 04/07/2026

Thomas W. Horton, is a partner at Global Infrastructure Partners, a global infrastructure investment firm, a position he has held since April 2019. From 2015 to 2019, he was a senior advisor at Warburg Pincus. He was the chairman of American Airlines Group, Inc. from 2013 to 2014, and served as chairman, president, and chief executive officer of American Airlines, Inc. and AMR Corporation from 2011 to 2013, after being named president of American in 2010. Prior to that, he served as executive vice president of finance and planning of American Airlines and AMR Corporation from 2006 to 2010. He was vice chairman and chief financial officer of AT&T Corporation from 2002 to 2005. He has served as a director of Walmart Inc. since 2014 and as a director of General Electric Company (operating as GE Aerospace) since 2018.

GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY - Board Member, Lead Director Source Date: 03/12/2026

Thomas W. Horton - Partner, Global Infrastructure Partners, an infrastructure investment fund, New York, NY (since 2019). PRIOR BUSINESS EXPERIENCE: Senior Advisor, Warburg Pincus LLC, a private equity firm focused on growth investing (2015–2019); Chairman, American Airlines Group, one of the largest global airlines (formed following the merger of AMR Corporation and US Airways) (2013–2014); Chairman and CEO, American Airlines (2011–2014); Chairman and CEO, AMR (parent company of American Airlines) (2010–2013); EVP and CFO, AMR (2006–2010); Vice Chairman and CFO, AT&T (2002–2006); SVP and CFO, AMR (2000–2002); joined AMR in 1985, serving in various finance and management roles. CURRENT PUBLIC COMPANY BOARDS: General Electric; Walmart (lead director). PAST PUBLIC COMPANY BOARDS: Qualcomm; EnLink Midstream. OTHER POSITIONS: Executive Board Member, Cox School of Business, Southern Methodist University. EDUCATION: Baylor University; MBA, Southern Methodist University.

CORPORATE BOARDS

Company	Role	Tenure	Appointed	Resigned	Independent of Management	Independent of Other Interests	Attendance
CHEVRON CORPORATION	Board Member		Jan 27, 2026		Yes	Yes	
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Board Member, Lead Director	8	Apr 25, 2018		Yes	Yes	
WALMART INC.	Board Member	11	Nov 21, 2014		Yes	Yes	
AMERICAN AIRLINES GROUP INC.	Executive		Nov 29, 2011	Jun 04, 2014	No	Yes	

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BOARD COMMITTEES

Company	Committee Type	Position
CHEVRON CORPORATION	Audit	Member
CHEVRON CORPORATION	Risk	Member
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Corporate Governance	Chair
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Nomination	Chair
WALMART INC.	Audit	Member
WALMART INC.	Corporate Governance	Member
WALMART INC.	Nomination	Member
WALMART INC.	Risk	Member

VOTING RESULTS

Company	Year	For %	Against, Withheld and / or Abstained %
CHEVRON CORPORATION	2026	98.4%	1.6%
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	2026	95.7%	4.3%
WALMART INC.	2026	98.2%	1.8%

DIRECTOR PAY (all values USD)

Company	Role	Tenure	Pay Year	Cash Fees	Total Awarded Pay	Shares Held
GENERAL ELECTRIC COMPANY	Lead Director	8	2025	191,467	393,392	1,172
WALMART INC.	Non-Executive	11	2026	138,571	368,796	57,913

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EU Regulation 2024/3005 disclosures

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GLOSSARY

MSCI ESG RATINGS AND SCORES

FINAL ESG RATING

- Letter ratings are relative within each MSCI ESG Ratings industry. Each Final Industry-Adjusted Company Score is converted to an equivalent rating on the AAA-CCC scale.

ESG PILLARS

- the ***Environment Score*** represents the weighted average of all Key Issues that fall under the Environment Pillar
- the ***Social Score*** represents the weighted average of all Key Issues that fall under the Social Pillar
- the ***Governance Score*** represents the sum of score deductions derived from Key Metrics included in Corporate Governance (including Board, Pay, Ownership & Control, and Accounting) and Corporate Behavior (including Business Ethics and Tax Transparency)
- the ***Environment Weight*** represents the sum of the weights of all Key Issues that fall under the Environment Pillar
- the ***Social Weight*** represents the sum of the weights of all Key Issues that fall under the Social Pillar
- the ***Governance Weight*** represents the sum of the weights of Corporate Governance and Corporate Behavior, with a minimum weight set at 33% for all rated issuers

KEY ISSUES

For each industry and Company-Specific Key Issue that contributes to the final rating:

- ***Weight*** contribution to the final rating
- ***Exposure*** Score (available for companies published since June 2011; excluding Raw Material Sourcing – Environmental)
- ***Management*** Score (available for companies published since June 2011; excluding Raw Material Sourcing – Environmental)
- Overall ***Key Issue Score***

WEIGHTED-AVERAGE KEY ISSUE SCORE VS. INDUSTRY RELATIVE SCORE

- the ***Weighted-Average Key Issue Score*** is dynamic, reflecting changes in any underlying scores as of the Last Update date, while the ***Industry Relative Score*** is more static and corresponds to the Rating Date. Issues that we determine do not present material risks or opportunities to companies in a given industry receive 0% weight and do not impact the overall ESG rating.

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All averages, percentiles, and rating distributions found in the report are based on companies in the relevant MSCI ESG Ratings Industry and are calculated based on industry scores as of the date of publication of this report.

ESTIMATED CARBON EMISSIONS

Carbon estimates are based on carbon intensity (carbon emissions/sales). The Estimate Key represents the source of the estimated carbon emissions data. E.CSI represents Company-Specific Intensity estimates based on previously disclosed data. E.GICSSI represents estimates based on the GICS Sub-Industry average. For E.GICSSI we set five levels of confidence (High, Moderately High, Moderate, Moderately Low, and Low). The Carbon Estimation Methodology document, available on ESG Manager, describes the estimation model in greater detail.

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IBISWorld

Retail Trade • 45291

Warehouse Clubs & Supercenters in the US

Load and behold: Greater use of online channels and strong engagement from middle-income households should support ongoing revenue growth

Taylor Kelly
Published: August 2026

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About

IBISWorld specializes in industry research with coverage on thousands of global industries. Our **comprehensive data and in-depth analysis** help businesses of all types gain quick and actionable insights on industries around the world. Busy professionals can spend less time researching and preparing for meetings, and more time focused on making strategic business decisions.

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About This Industry

Definition

This industry includes large stores that primarily retail a general line of grocery products and merchandise items (e.g., apparel and appliances). Warehouse clubs offer customers a wide selection of goods, often in bulk and at discounted prices, in exchange for a membership fee paid by each customer. Supercenters are large discount department stores that also sell perishable groceries. However, unlike warehouse clubs, supercenters don't require customers to join.

Codes

NAICS

2022	455211 – Warehouse Clubs and Supercenters
2017	452311 – Warehouse Clubs and Supercenters

ISIC

2006	4711 – Retail sale in non-specialized stores with food, beverages or tobacco predominating

What's Included

- Retailing apparel and accessories
- Retailing food and beverages
- Retailing fuel and other products
- Retailing health, beauty and wellness
- Retailing home and appliance

Companies

- Walmart
- Costco

Related Industries

Domestic industries

Competitors

- Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in the US
- Dollar & Variety Stores in the US
- Home Furnishings Stores in the US
- Department Stores in the US

Complementors

- Convenience Stores in the US

International industries

- Warehouse Clubs & Supercentres in Canada
- Department Stores in the UK
- Department Stores in Australia
- Supermarkets in China
- Supermarkets in Ireland
- Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in Australia
- Supermarkets in the UK
- Department Stores in New Zealand
- Department Stores in Ireland
- Supermarkets, Grocery & Convenience Stores in New Zealand
- Department Stores & Shopping Malls in China

Related Terms

COMPARABLE STORE SALES

A retail measure used to assess the true performance of retail outlets by taking out the effect of new store openings and focusing on the sales growth of existing stores.

HOMOGENEOUS GOODS

Items that are similar among retailers, with little or no differentiation.

LARGE-FORMAT STORE

A retail store that is differentiated by its sheer size and large range of products, including electronics, household goods and other consumer products.

MASS MERCHANDISER

A large retail store that offers a wide range of product categories.

POINT OF SALE (POS)

A system used at checkout in retail stores using computers and cash registers to capture transaction data at the time and place of sale.

RADIO FREQUENCY IDENTIFICATION (RFID)

A technology that tracks products from the time they leave the assembly line to the time they leave the store by releasing continuous signals from a chip.

STOCK KEEPING UNITS (SKUS)

Codes used by retailers to identify the lowest level of product detail.

Additional Resources

- Occupational Safety and Health Administration
- Food Marketing Institute
- International Council of Shopping Centers
- National Retail Federation
- American Apparel and Footwear Association

At a Glance

Revenue		Employees		Businesses	
$792.5bn	2021-26 ↑ 2.7% 2026-31 ↑ 1.5%	1.8m	2021-26 ↑ 1.7% 2026-31 ↑ 1.4%	16	2021-26 ↓ 1.2% 2026-31 ↑ 1.2%
Profit		**Profit Margin**		**Wages**	
$24.6bn	2021-26 ↓ 0.9%	3.1%	2021-26 ↓ 0.6pp	$67.9bn	2021-26 ↑ 0.9% 2026-31 ↑ 1.5%

Five-year growth rates display historic and forecast CAGRs

Major Players

Company	Revenue ($bn)	Market Share (%)
Walmart	510.7	64.5
Costco	213.3	26.9
Other Companies	68.5	8.6

Products & Services

Item	Revenue ($bn)	Market Share (%)
Food and beverages	300.4	37.9
Home and appliances	188.6	23.8
Health, beauty and wellness	145.8	18.4
Fuel and other	118.1	14.9
Apparel and accessories	39.6	5.0

Key External Drivers

Driver	Impact
Percentage of business conducted online	Positive
Population	Positive
Consumer spending	Positive
Per capita disposable income	Positive
Number of households	Positive
Corporate profit	Positive

Key Takeaways

Performance

Private-label expansion is accelerating as budget-conscious shoppers trade down while continuing to buy in bulk. Retailers are capitalizing on this shift by strengthening in-house brands, boosting profit and increasing basket sizes through value-driven assortments.

Warehouse clubs are enhancing membership value to sustain high renewal rates in a more competitive and cost-sensitive environment. They're adding exclusive perks, essential services and personalized offers to reinforce loyalty and justify annual fees.

Strategic partnerships and targeted M&A will become critical for scaling logistics and data capabilities. Collaborations with last-mile and tech providers, alongside acquisitions of AI and cloud platforms, help retailers accelerate innovation without heavy in-house development.

Omnichannel success increasingly depends on turning stores into flexible fulfillment and service hubs. Retailers that integrate logistics, data, and physical locations into a coordinated network will be better positioned to handle fragmented, multi-platform shopping journeys.

Products and Markets

Bulk grocery pricing remains the core traffic driver for warehouse clubs and supercenters. As inflation outpaces income growth, shoppers are shifting toward private labels and bulk staples to stretch budgets, boosting loyalty and accelerating share gains for value-focused formats.

Ancillary services and high-margin add-ons are increasing total basket size and reinforcing customer stickiness. Discount fuel, health and beauty products and convenient in-store services turn routine trips into multi-purpose visits, strengthening membership value and repeat traffic.

Middle-income households anchor sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters by balancing value with selective upgrades. They rely on one-stop trips for essentials and occasional higher-quality items, using bulk savings and broad assortments to stretch budgets without sacrificing choice.

Small businesses provide a steady demand base for warehouse clubs and supercenters through recurring bulk purchases. Their consistent orders for consumables such as paper goods, snacks and cleaning supplies help stabilize volume, even as they trim discretionary spending amid economic pressure.

SWOT

Strengths	High & Steady Barriers to Entry High Revenue per Employee Low Customer Class Concentration Low Imports Low Product/Service Concentration Low Volatility
Weaknesses	High Competition Low & Steady Level of Assistance Low Profit vs. Sector Average
Opportunities	High Revenue Growth (2021-2026) Percentage of business conducted online
Threats	Corporate profit

Industry Structure

Characteristic	Level & Trend
Concentration	High
Barriers to Entry	High, Steady
Regulation and Policy	Low, Steady
Life Cycle	Mature
Revenue Volatility	Low
Assistance	Low, Steady
Competition	High, Increasing
Innovation	Low

Executive Summary

Load and behold: Greater use of online channels and strong engagement from middle-income households should support ongoing revenue growth

Warehouse clubs and supercenters have navigated mounting cost volatility, particularly around energy and logistics, while sustaining steady growth through scale and diversified offerings. Strong membership models have helped anchor sales, with recurring fees and high renewal rates reinforcing the value proposition for budget-conscious households facing higher living costs. At the same time, chains have deepened digital engagement, expanding mobile apps, online ordering and personalized promotions to connect omnichannel supply chains with rising expectations for speed and convenience. Stores are also increasingly being reconfigured as multi-use fulfillment hubs, supporting click-and-collect, curbside pickup and same-day delivery, underpinned by growing investment in automation, data-driven inventory management and AI-powered decision tools. Within this model, private-label portfolios play a larger role in driving traffic, offering competitively priced bulk options that resonate with value-seeking shoppers and support resilience. Revenue has been expanding at a CAGR of 2.7% over the past five years and is expected to reach $792.5 billion in 2026, when revenue will climb by an estimated 1.7%.

Despite these topline gains, profit has fallen from its recent peak as merchandise and logistics costs have outpaced retail price growth, compressing percentage profit even as volumes remain high. Retailers have leaned more heavily on private-label assortments and ancillary in-store services to offset this pressure, using higher-margin store brands, fuel operations and service departments to lift basket value and strengthen loyalty without compromising value positioning. Membership income has become an even more critical stabilizer, providing a relatively predictable, high-margin revenue stream that helps absorb cost shocks while allowing leading chains to preserve everyday low prices and selective promotional strategies.

Tightening environmental regulations and broader ESG expectations will reshape logistics, refrigeration choices and disclosure practices, compelling large-format retailers to invest in cleaner fleets, emissions tracking and more sustainable supply chains. To deliver on these requirements while maintaining convenience, retailers are expected to pursue targeted M&A and partnerships in last-mile logistics, cloud-based order management and AI-enabled planning, accelerating the build-out of unified commerce platforms. These moves will likely widen performance gaps, as larger players with deep data pools and capital out-invest smaller rivals, reinforcing high market concentration. As stores evolve into multi-purpose hubs that combine retail, fulfillment and growing health and wellness services, including pharmacy-based programs linked to GLP-1 medications, private labels will remain central to value, differentiation and shopper retention. Over the next five years, revenue is forecast to grow at a CAGR of 1.5%, reaching $855.4 billion in 2031.

Performance

Key Takeaways

Private-label expansion is accelerating as budget-conscious shoppers trade down while continuing to buy in bulk. Retailers are capitalizing on this shift by strengthening in-house brands, boosting profit and increasing basket sizes through value-driven assortments.

Warehouse clubs are enhancing membership value to sustain high renewal rates in a more competitive and cost-sensitive environment. They're adding exclusive perks, essential services and personalized offers to reinforce loyalty and justify annual fees.

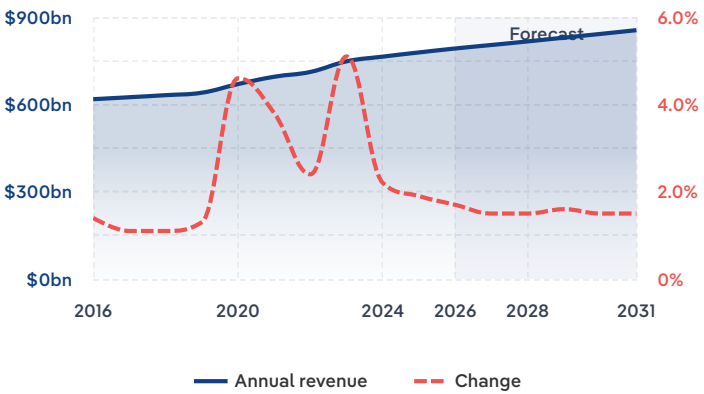
Strategic partnerships and targeted M&A will become critical for scaling logistics and data capabilities. Collaborations with last-mile and tech providers, alongside acquisitions of AI and cloud platforms, help retailers accelerate innovation without heavy in-house development.

Omnichannel success increasingly depends on turning stores into flexible fulfillment and service hubs. Retailers that integrate logistics, data, and physical locations into a coordinated network will be better positioned to handle fragmented, multi-platform shopping journeys.

Performance Snapshot

Revenue

Total value ($) and annual change from 2016 – 2031. Includes 5-year outlook.



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Revenue

$792.5bn

2021-26 ↑ 2.7%

2026-31 ↑ 1.5%

2026 Revenue Growth

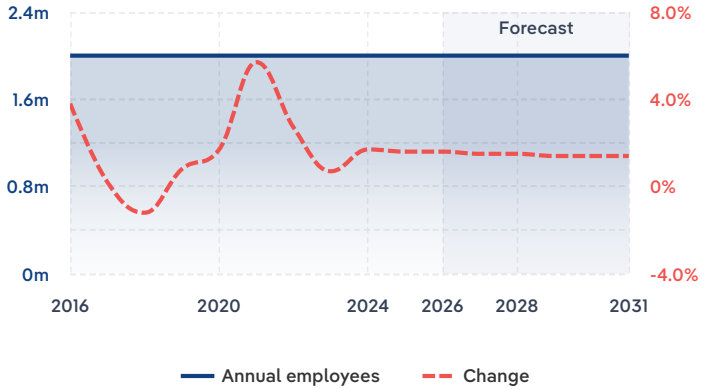
1.7% ↑ Increasing

Revenue Volatility

Low

Employees

Total number of employees and annual change from 2016 – 2031. Includes 5-year outlook.



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Employees

1.8m

2021-26 ↑ 1.7%

2026-31 ↑ 1.4%

Employees per Business

115.5k

2021-26 ↑ 2.9%

2026-31 ↑ 0.2%

Revenue per Employee

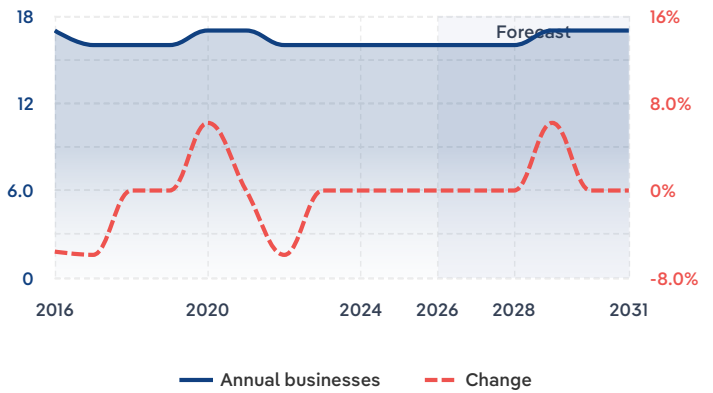
$428.7k

2021-26 ↑ 1.0%

2026-31 ↑ 0.1%

Businesses

Total number of businesses and annual change from 2016 – 2031. Includes 5-year outlook.



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Businesses

16

2021-26 ↓ 1.2%

2026-31 ↑ 1.2%

Employees per Business

115.5k

2021-26 ↑ 2.9%

2026-31 ↑ 0.2%

Revenue per Business

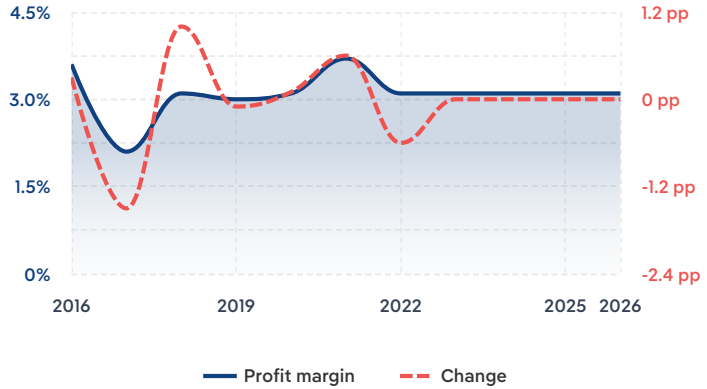
$49.5bn

2021-26 ↑ 3.9%

2026-31 ↑ 0.3%

Profit Margin

Total profit margin (%) and annual change from 2016 – 2026



Total Profit

$24.6bn

2021-26 ↓ 0.9%

Profit Margin

3.1% 2021-26 ↓ 0.6pp

Profit per Business

$1.5bn

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Current Performance

↑2021-26 Revenue CAGR: 2.7%

What's driving current industry performance?

Retailers build omnichannel supply chains to match rising expectations for convenience

- The popularity of online shopping has significantly influenced warehouse clubs and supercenters. Consumers increasingly prefer ordering online, leading these stores to enhance their digital presence and operations. They have invested heavily in e-commerce platforms, building user-friendly websites and mobile apps to attract and retain customers. This shift in preferences requires retailers to balance bulk-purchase formats with rising expectations for convenience, speed and digital engagement.
- According to a 2024 Deloitte study, almost seven in ten consumers are more likely to buy from a business that offers personalized mobile experiences. This underscores how digital engagement and customization are now critical in shaping customer loyalty and sales growth. Retailers increasingly use data from apps and online channels to tailor offers, refine assortments and target promotions to specific customers, strengthening loyalty while boosting the profitability of digital channels.
- To compete with pure online retailers like Amazon, many companies now offer curbside pickup and same-day delivery. These services offer greater convenience and help capture the rising demand for quick, flexible fulfillment. However, a Harris Poll survey conducted for Quad found that 71.0% of shoppers feel in-store visits enhance their relationship with a brand. This signals that retailers must invest in both digital and physical channels so that each complements the other.
- Companies are also changing distribution and fulfillment strategies to align inventory, delivery options and store networks with e-commerce habits. Walmart is redesigning closed Sam's Club locations into fulfillment centers for online sales and modernizing them to support omnichannel retail. Leading companies are also using their physical locations to support online order fulfillment, as seen by Costco, improving delivery speed and integrating digital and in-store experiences.
- These operational changes reflect growing emphasis on e-commerce flexibility and speed, encouraging physical stores to adopt robust omnichannel strategies. Companies that fail to adapt risk losing share to more agile competitors. Ongoing digital transformation will push retailers to merge physical scale with technological agility to deliver seamless experiences across channels. Those that successfully integrate these capabilities will be best positioned to sustain a competitive edge.

Shoppers are trading down to private labels while buying in bulk to manage household budgets

- Unfavorable economic conditions have driven more shoppers toward private-label products, which offer quality comparable to name brands at lower prices. Warehouse clubs and supercenters have responded by expanding their own private-label assortments to include a broader mix of organic, specialty and everyday essentials that can stand alongside mainstream brands. Focusing on private labels helps retailers capture a larger share of the value chain, supporting profitability even as consumers look for ways to cut spending.
- As household budgets tighten, the appeal of affordable alternatives has remained strong, prompting additional investment in developing and promoting house brands. Costco and Walmart feature highly recognizable in-house lines. According to a 2024 article from Numerator, Walmart has the top five private-label brands in the US, measured by US household market penetration, through its Great Value, Equate, Mainstays, Marketside and Freshness Guaranteed brands. Each of these brands has a household penetration rate of at least 67.0%, meaning that at least

two-thirds of households have tried them.

- Private-label products also fit naturally with bulk sales, enabling shoppers to trade down on brand while still buying up on quantity to lower per-unit costs. In supercenters, this has contributed to higher basket sizes as consumers stock up on private-label staples and household goods. Foot traffic has remained resilient as shoppers seek one-stop locations where they can stretch budgets across multiple categories.
- In turn, falling consumer confidence and mixed economic signals have prompted retailers to lean more heavily on private labels to keep value-conscious shoppers engaged. As shoppers become more cautious, they're increasingly willing to try store brands if they trust the retailer's quality standards and pricing strategy. Companies that diversify private-label lines, emphasize value-led pricing and invest in branding and packaging have become better positioned to win share from national brands and boost profit

Warehouse clubs are upgrading member benefits to protect renewal rates amid rising competition

- Membership-based warehouse clubs like Costco and Sam's Club have seen growth in membership sign-ups and renewals, driven partly by the perceived value members receive. Costco reports roughly 145.2 million members, citing membership income as a primary driver of profit growth, as it provides a stable, higher-value revenue stream. These fees help clubs offer consistently low merchandise prices, making membership a central pillar of their business strategy and competitive positioning.
- Economic uncertainty and higher living costs have made shoppers more selective about which memberships they keep, forcing them to weigh annual fees against everyday savings. At the same time, Costco's renewal rate of about 92.3% across the US and Canada shows that many households still view club memberships as essential tools for managing their budgets, indicating that members believe ongoing savings and benefits clearly outweigh the cost of staying enrolled.
- In response, these clubs have expanded exclusive member benefits, including discounts, special events and personalized offers, to retain and attract members. Costco's $1.50 hot dog combo meal and $4.99 rotisserie chicken are iconic deals that signal a member-first value promise and foster strong trust in the brand, with some shoppers visiting primarily for food offerings. Additional services, such as optical, pharmacy and travel departments, further embed these retailers in members' everyday routines and deepen the perceived value of staying loyal.
- While memberships help strengthen store patronage, they also raise expectations for service, product quality and convenience. Customers will cancel if they don't view the membership as worthwhile, pushing companies to continuously update and enhance benefits, services and digital features to stand out from competitors. Even so, the membership model allows these retailers to offer competitive prices while generating profitable, recurring revenue streams, making it increasingly attractive in a fluctuating retail market.
- Membership requirements can also help reduce common store issues. Consumers who pay for a membership and scan a personalized card before entry are generally less likely to steal, cause disruptions or treat the store carelessly. The added accountability helps hold customers to a higher standard, improving overall operational efficiency. Warehouse clubs that deliver elevated experiences while maintaining low prices are actively sustaining high renewal rates and pulling new members away from competing formats in an increasingly crowded retail landscape.

The conflict in Iran is amplifying global oil volatility and complicating cost planning

- The conflict in Iran has caused extensive damage to energy and transport infrastructure, including export terminals, pipelines and refining assets, while sharply disrupting regional oil and gas exports. Flows of crude and petroleum liquids through the Strait of Hormuz have fallen by nearly 30.0%, according to the Institute for Energy Research, with the route effectively closed to most tanker traffic. These disruptions have pushed oil prices substantially higher and raised concerns about a prolonged period of elevated energy costs.
- According to the US Energy Information Administration, shipments passing through the Strait of Hormuz in 2024 and the first quarter of 2025 accounted for more than one-quarter of all seaborne oil traded worldwide and roughly one-fifth of global oil and petroleum products consumed globally. Since Iran has effectively closed this vital passageway to most tanker traffic, concerns about heightened inflation risks and complicated planning for energy-intensive businesses have arisen.
- Disruptions to shipping and energy flows linked to the Iran conflict will likely embed a risk premium into global oil and gas prices, raising shipping, heating and electricity costs for large-format retailers. Extended volatility may prompt warehouse clubs and supercenters to pursue more energy-efficient investments, lock in longer-term utility and transportation contracts and reevaluate fuel sourcing strategies to stabilize operating expenses despite unsettled markets.
- Many warehouse club and supercenter locations sell gasoline and may face additional pressure on fuel economics if wholesale prices climb faster than they can adjust retail pump rates. However, because many of these retailers sell gas to boost in-store traffic and already see relatively low per-gallon earnings, they may be somewhat better positioned to absorb short-term price fluctuations. This model may leave them somewhat better positioned to absorb short-term price spikes while focusing on controlling broader operating costs.
- Retailers are likely to focus on maintaining operational efficiency while using targeted pricing and promotions to boost customer traffic amid higher fuel and energy costs. Those that can manage volatility through smarter contracting, efficiency upgrades and disciplined fuel pricing will be better placed to preserve performance. In contrast, companies that rely heavily on energy-intensive operations without mitigation strategies may see more pronounced pressure on expenses.

Retailers are modernizing backroom operations with automation to enhance efficiency

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters are under growing pressure to upgrade outdated systems as e-commerce expands and digital-first competitors scale up. Automation and AI-enabled tools enable retailers to improve customer experiences while optimizing inventory management and labor allocation. These technologies help large-format stores handle rising volumes more efficiently, maintain consistent

service levels and control operating costs as they continue to add staff and manage sizable workforces.

- Robotics, automated storage and enhanced picking systems for high-volume orders are helping retailers streamline repetitive tasks and boost productivity per order. Innovations such as automated guided vehicles, drones and automated sorting systems enable faster, more accurate order fulfillment while lowering handling costs. For instance, Walmart's Alphabot system uses small robots in fulfillment areas to locate products and pack them after a sale, accelerating processing and standardizing quality.
- AI is also reshaping the customer-facing side of warehouse clubs and supercenters. By analyzing transaction histories, app activity and in-store behavior, AI tools help retailers predict demand, reduce stockouts and tailor promotions more precisely to local preferences. These systems support customized product recommendations and dynamic pricing, allowing shoppers to see more relevant offers and assortments without changing the underlying bulk-purchase model.
- Taken together, automation and AI are pushing warehouse clubs and supercenters to reconfigure store layouts, backroom operations and fulfillment workflows around technology. Retailers that invest aggressively in automated picking, smart replenishment and AI-driven decision support can lift productivity and improve consistency, while those that move slowly risk falling behind more technologically advanced competitors.

Outlook

↑2026-31 Revenue CAGR: 1.5%

What's driving the industry outlook?

Retailers will pursue targeted M&A and partnerships to strengthen logistics and data systems

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters are expected to move from simply adding digital channels to building truly unified commerce systems, where stores, apps and delivery platforms operate as one connected network. Instead of treating online growth as a standalone goal, leading chains are increasingly focused on using omnichannel setups to improve service reliability, personalize offers and tighten cost control.
- Online and mobile shopping will keep gaining share, but the more important shift is how orders are routed and fulfilled. Physical locations are evolving into multi-use hubs that handle in-store shopping, click-and-collect, curbside pickup and same-day delivery from the same footprint. This trend will push larger brands to deepen ties with last-mile specialists and logistics tech companies, using AI-driven routing and real-time inventory visibility to balance speed against fulfillment costs.
- Warehouse clubs and supercenters will increasingly choose delivery and technology partners that can share granular customer and operational data to feed personalization engines, dynamic pricing tools and retail media networks. For instance, Costco has broadened its last-mile delivery footprint by maintaining long-standing partnerships with Instacart and deepening its collaboration with Uber Eats, helping expand its service coverage and curb unnecessary capital expenditures.
- Future M&A deals are likely to prioritize AI-enabled logistics, cloud-based order management and advanced data infrastructure, allowing chains to plug in capabilities such as predictive inventory, autonomous supply-chain control and real-time promise dates for delivery and pickup. This approach shortens the development timeline for complex tech, supports the rollout of new fulfillment formats and strengthens competitive positioning against digital-native marketplaces and emerging AI shopping agents.
- These trends suggest omnichannel success now depends on orchestration, with partnerships and acquisitions accelerating unified, AI-driven commerce. Chains that can turn stores into flexible fulfillment hubs, leverage partner networks for last-mile delivery and absorb specialized tech through M&A will be better placed to sustain growth as shopping journeys fragment across apps, social platforms and emerging AI interfaces.

Automation and AI will widen performance gaps between chains

- Advanced automation and AI tools will likely reinforce the scale advantages of the largest warehouse clubs and supercenters. Walmart and Costco account for over 90.0% of the market, with the remaining 10.0% controlled by about a dozen others. These major players' ability to invest heavily in robotics, AI-driven forecasting and sophisticated data platforms will help them keep lowering unit costs and tightening execution across stores, warehouses and digital channels.
- These technology programs are expected to support more efficient omnichannel models. As the largest chains integrate AI into inventory management, labor planning, pricing and personalized promotions, they can run leaner operations while using member and transaction data to drive higher basket sizes and stronger conversion online. Over time, this will deepen the link between scale, data richness and performance in the industry.
- Smaller banners and regional formats are likely to pursue more limited, plug-and-play solutions. Many will adopt off-the-shelf analytics tools, third-party fulfillment apps and basic automation to improve staffing and inventory, but they typically lack the data depth, in-house expertise and capital needed for fully customized systems. This narrows, but does not erase, the efficiency and customer-experience gap with the largest chains.
- As technology spending and data capabilities concentrate among a handful of national brands, the market structure is expected to remain highly consolidated. Membership models and large first-party data pools will give leading chains an advantage when deploying new AI tools and monetizing insights, supporting sustained growth and resilience. However, less resourced competitors risk falling further behind on cost efficiency, service quality and digital engagement.

Regulations and shopper preferences will drive greener business models

- Regulation is becoming a central driver of how warehouse clubs and supercenters manage logistics and environmental risk. Indirect source rules targeting large warehouses and logistics hubs, including measures such as California's Rule 2305 and similar proposals in states such as Colorado, New Jersey and New York City, make facilities partly responsible for tracking and reducing air pollution from truck traffic serving their sites. This will push companies toward cleaner fleets, routing changes and potentially redesigned footprints.
- Climate-related disclosure and supply chain ESG laws are also raising the bar. California's SB 253 Climate Corporate Data Accountability Act and companion SB 261 will require large businesses operating in the state, including major retailers above specified revenue thresholds, to report Scope 1, Scope 2 and eventually Scope 3 greenhouse gas emissions, increasing transparency around direct operations and value-chain impacts. These rules are expected to influence how chains measure emissions, prioritize efficiency projects and engage suppliers on climate performance.
- Refrigerant policy is expected to remain a source of uncertainty for warehouse clubs and supercenters. The hydrofluorocarbon phase-down under the AIM Act continues, but recent EPA actions under President Trump have relaxed and delayed parts of the Technology Transitions and related rules, extending deadlines and broadening allowable refrigerant choices to lower near-term costs. Retailers will still need to plan for eventual shifts to lower-impact systems, but with longer compliance horizons and more flexibility in how they stage upgrades.
- As these regulatory pressures build, warehouse clubs and supercenters are likely to work more closely with suppliers and logistics partners to redesign packaging, reformulate products and expand lines with verified sustainability certifications, while improving data and reporting systems to support credible environmental claims and avoid greenwashing risk. Chains that adapt their product mixes, logistics and disclosure practices to this evolving framework will be better positioned to maintain trust and capture segments of environmentally minded shoppers across both store and digital channels.

Private-label offerings will support resilience in changing economic conditions

- One of the core appeals of warehouse clubs and supercenters is their low unit prices on everyday essentials, and this is expected to remain central even as disposable income and consumer confidence improve. Value-seeking shoppers are likely to continue favoring private labels over some national brands, making store brands a more important lever for protecting traffic and basket size without relying solely on manufacturer promotions.
- Price differences between private labels and national brands are likely to underpin this shift. According to 2025 Numerator data, the price gap between store brands and national brands has widened by about 38.0% since 2019. This widening gap strengthens the value proposition of private labels and reinforces warehouse clubs' and supercenters' incentives to expand, promote and refine their own-brand portfolios for cost-conscious shoppers.
- Because Walmart and Costco already control the vast majority of sales, private-label development will remain highly concentrated among a small number of national chains. These players can use their scale and member data to segment store brands into different value tiers, introduce more on-trend items and tailor formulations, packaging and branding to specific shopper groups. Smaller banners will likely focus their own-brand efforts on a narrower set of categories where they can more clearly differentiate.
- As social-media-driven taste shifts, younger shoppers' preferences are expected to encourage faster refresh cycles and more experimentation in private labels. Warehouse clubs and supercenters that test collaborations, influencer-linked ranges and limited-time offerings within their store brands have the potential to help their private-label lines capture a greater share of spending while deepening loyalty to the retailer itself, not just to individual products.

Integrated health services will draw visitors beyond traditional grocery needs

- Health and wellness services, including pharmacy and optical care, are expected to become a more important reason for visiting warehouse clubs and supercenters. As these offerings expand, stores will increasingly function as one-stop destinations where shoppers fill prescriptions, manage chronic conditions, get eye exams and then pick up selected groceries or household items, even when they are not making a full food shop.
- GLP-1 medications are reinforcing this shift toward one-stop visits. As more people use these drugs, some households are changing what and how much they buy, prioritizing more intentional, health-oriented choices. In-store pharmacies and wellness teams can respond by offering tailored guidance and programs for GLP-1 users and by steering them toward suitable foods, supplements and health-adjacent products during the same trip.
- Large chains are already building GLP-1-linked weight-management services around their pharmacies. Costco has partnered with telehealth platform Sesame to offer members a subscription program that includes virtual clinical visits, lab work and access to GLP-1 prescriptions, while Walmart is expanding its Better Care Services to combine GLP-1 access, virtual care and nutrition support. These initiatives position pharmacies as anchors for broader health journeys that connect medicine, food and wellness.
- Smaller banners and clubs without pharmacy infrastructure are likely to feel GLP-1-related changes more directly through shifting food baskets. They may see lighter volumes in certain categories but have less ability to offset this with health services or targeted clinical programs. In contrast, large warehouse clubs and supercenters can use their pharmacies, optical centers and broader wellness offerings to anchor one-stop visits, cross-sell and stabilize overall spending as shopper behavior evolves.

Volatility

Low

What influences industry volatility?

Revenue is cushioned by everyday household spending

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters get most of their sales from everyday essentials like food and beverages, home and appliance items and health, beauty and wellness products. These are things people need regardless of economic conditions, so sales stay fairly steady. Because of that, sales tend to follow predictable patterns, avoiding big spikes or sharp declines and keeping overall revenue relatively stable.
- Since these products are frequently purchased and need to be restocked regularly, wholesalers benefit from a steady stream of transactions throughout the year rather than relying on occasional large purchases. This consistent buying behavior makes revenue less sensitive to short-term changes in consumer confidence and helps keep year-over-year growth relatively even, even after adjusting for inflation.

The dominance of two large brands stabilizes revenue

- Walmart and Costco together account for over 90.0% of sales in warehouse clubs and supercenters, meaning overall revenue mainly reflects the performance of these two very large, mature companies. Their scale, membership models and broad customer reach support steady year-over-year growth, helping the segment avoid sharp ups and downs in total revenue.
- Because these two chains set the tone on pricing, promotions and product ranges, conditions across the segment change gradually rather than suddenly. Smaller businesses tend to follow their lead, typically leading to fewer abrupt competitive shocks or large share price swings. This concentrated structure makes market-wide revenue behave more predictably and contributes to low measured volatility.

Blue Chip

Industry volatility vs. revenue growth (2021-2026 CAGR)



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses overcome volatility?

Control inventory

Managing inventory ensures that products are always available, particularly if the products are highly sought after because of a viral marketing campaign.

Secure a flexible workforce

Like other retail industries, warehouse clubs and supercenters have flexible workforces, which helps stores rotate staff as needed, particularly during extended holiday hours. Many retailers have struggled to maintain sufficient workforce levels in recent years, despite rising minimum wage requirements in many states.

Life Cycle

Mature

Life Cycle

Indication of the industry's stage in its life cycle compared to similar industries



*Growth is based on change in share of economy combined with change in establishment numbers

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Why is the industry mature?

Contribution to GDP

Warehouse clubs and supercenters now grow roughly in line with the broader US economy, which is what you'd expect from a mature stage. Revenue is still rising, but gains are modest, so the focus has shifted to squeezing more efficiency and value out of existing large-format stores.

Market Saturation

Retailers are deeply embedded in many urban and suburban markets, with big-box clubs and supercenters already serving most high-traffic areas. New sites exist but are harder to find and justify at scale, so growth leans more on remodeling, format tweaks and share gains within markets that already have strong coverage.

Innovation

Most breakthrough product innovation now happens at the manufacturing level, where new brands and categories are developed. Retailers in this space innovate mainly around how they sell, such as refining private labels, adjusting pack sizes, improving merchandising and experimenting with services like pharmacy, fuel and health offerings that deepen customer relationships.

Consolidation

The landscape for warehouse clubs and supercenters is already dominated by a few large players, so consolidation is less about big roll-up waves and more about targeted moves. Leading chains occasionally acquire regional banners or specific locations to strengthen coverage, but large-scale deals are limited, and smaller retailers still find it hard to gain meaningful share.

Technology and Systems

Warehouse clubs and supercenters face steady pressure from e-commerce and direct-to-consumer models that offer comparable products without a store visit. Leading chains respond by expanding omnichannel capabilities tailored to bulk and big-basket trips, including curbside pickup, scheduled delivery and more feature-rich mobile apps designed around the warehouse shopping experience.

Products and Markets

Key Takeaways

Bulk grocery pricing remains the core traffic driver for warehouse clubs and supercenters. As inflation outpaces income growth, shoppers are shifting toward private labels and bulk staples to stretch budgets, boosting loyalty and accelerating share gains for value-focused formats.

Ancillary services and high-margin add-ons are increasing total basket size and reinforcing customer stickiness. Discount fuel, health and beauty products and convenient in-store services turn routine trips into multi-purpose visits, strengthening membership value and repeat traffic.

Middle-income households anchor sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters by balancing value with selective upgrades. They rely on one-stop trips for essentials and occasional higher-quality items, using bulk savings and broad assortments to stretch budgets without sacrificing choice.

Small businesses provide a steady demand base for warehouse clubs and supercenters through recurring bulk purchases. Their consistent orders for consumables such as paper goods, snacks and cleaning supplies help stabilize volume, even as they trim discretionary spending amid economic pressure.

Largest Market

$300.4bn

Food and beverages

Product Innovation

Low

Products and Services

How are the industry's products and services performing?

Bulk grocery deals keep value-focused shoppers coming back

- Food and beverages are often the primary draw for consumers, particularly larger families, who visit warehouse clubs and supercenters to access bulk discounts and everyday deals on staples. The segment spans snack foods, beverages, meat, produce, dairy, frozen food and deli items sold at lower per-unit prices, encouraging shoppers to stock up on high-frequency consumables and supporting value-focused wholesale formats.
- Businesses and households, especially cost-conscious shoppers, rely on these stores to buy everyday goods in bulk and secure predictable savings on items they purchase regularly. With consumer prices rising faster than per-capita disposable income since 2021, many have redirected more of their grocery budgets toward value-oriented formats and in-house brands that help stretch paychecks further.
- Sales for Costco's Kirkland Signature brand are estimated to have climbed by more than 50.0% between 2021 and 2025, showing how inflation has nudged shoppers toward retail-owned labels that deliver national-brand quality at lower unit prices. As more consumers focus on total basket cost rather than specific logos, warehouse clubs and supercenters with strong private-label programs are capturing a larger share of everyday grocery spending.

Retailers focus on curated home goods to attract budget-conscious households

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters offer a broad assortment of home goods and appliances, including furniture, electronics, bed and bath products, and home décor. Intensifying competition from online retailers such as Amazon and Wayfair has pushed these operators to expand e-commerce and delivery capabilities. For example, Costco Logistics, which handles large, bulky deliveries and also removes old furniture, reports strong growth in online orders for sofas, saunas and oversized home goods.
- Major brands are additionally using private-label and curated assortments to strengthen their position in home goods. Walmart's Mainstays brand focuses on affordable furniture and home essentials, while earlier acquisitions such as Hayneedle and new online furniture labels have helped it offer trendier pieces at lower prices. Costco has broadened its furniture and décor range, promoting high-end items at warehouse prices and using limited-run assortments to draw more home-focused shoppers.

Health and beauty assortments help retailers capture more basket spend

- The health, beauty and wellness segment includes over-the-counter drugs, health aids, cosmetics and everyday personal-care items such as shampoos and lotions. Awareness has risen as consumers adopt a more holistic view of well-being that links appearance, preventive health and self-care routines. These products are often add-ons or impulse buys, but competitive pricing on necessities makes them attractive to buy at warehouse clubs and supercenters.
- This shift has boosted interest in items that promise both cosmetic

benefits and functional outcomes, from stress relief and better sleep to improved skin or hair health. Customers are often willing to pay a premium for products perceived to slow aging or address common ailments, especially when brands emphasize clean ingredients, ethical sourcing and transparent formulations that balance quality with value. That mix of necessity and perceived upgrade makes health and beauty a useful loyalty builder.

Fuel and ancillary services strengthen brands' value proposition

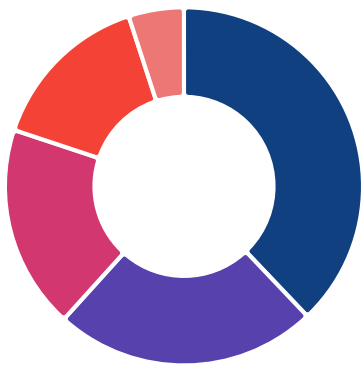
- A growing emphasis on convenience has led many warehouse clubs and supercenters to expand fuel and other ancillary services alongside their core merchandise, helping them become more like one-stop shops. Members can fill their tanks, pick up prescriptions, visit in-store optical shops and buy pet supplies and tobacco in the same trip. These services deepen the value of membership and make clubs a practical stop for everyday errands, not just bulk grocery runs.
- One of the main revenue drivers within the product segment is fuel. In fiscal year 2025, Costco sold 8.2 billion gallons of fuel worldwide and opened 27 new and 24 expanded gas stations. As ongoing geopolitical tensions with Iran drive gas prices higher, consumers are increasingly seeking outlets that offer consistently lower gas prices and reliable availability, making warehouse clubs' discounted fuel and extended hours a strong draw for value-focused drivers.

Warehouse clubs and supercenters blend licensed brands with everyday apparel basics

- The apparel and accessories segment includes a mix of in-house and national brands of clothing, shoes and accessories for women, men and children. Many shoppers are happy to buy clothing in bulk when they can stock up on everyday basics at low prices. Costco works directly with manufacturers and brand owners, such as Adidas, through licensing and "made-for-club" lines, while Walmart relies on private labels and curated ranges to deliver value.
- Social media and rapid trend cycles can quickly boost a particular item's popularity, so retailers need to adjust assortments fast to capture short-lived fashion demand. Fast-fashion dynamics also encourage purchases of costume jewelry and lower-priced, trend-driven apparel that reflect current styles. In parallel, more frequent assortment refreshes tend to lift inventory and sourcing costs, forcing bulk-oriented formats to balance trend responsiveness with tight product ranges and low everyday prices.

Products & Services Segmentation

Industry revenue in 2026 broken down by key product and service lines.



Food and beverages ($300.4bn) 37.9%
Home and appliances ($188.6bn) 23.8%
Health, beauty and wellness ($145.8bn) 18.4%
Fuel and other ($118.1bn) 14.9%
Apparel and accessories ($39.6bn) 5.0%

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

☆ Key Success Factors

What products or services do successful businesses offer?

Adopt a high-volume, low-margin strategy

Consumers are price-conscious, so warehouse clubs and supercenters will struggle if they have significant price markups. Focusing on a high-volume, low-profit sales strategy is more sustainable.

Supply a diverse range of products

Stores should supply a wide range of products comparable to those of their external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

Innovations

Low

What are innovations in industry products and services?

Digital upgrades reshape how members shop and receive goods

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters are turning large-format stores into omnichannel hubs by layering curbside pickup, same-day delivery and ship-to-home options onto their bulk, in-person model. Mobile apps and websites now feature richer product content, digital coupons and membership tools, making it easier for shoppers to research big-ticket items and everyday essentials and choose how they want orders fulfilled.
- These digital upgrades are increasingly paired with personalized offers based on past baskets and trip patterns. Targeted promotions on groceries, TVs, appliances and add-on services (such as installation or extended warranties) help nudge members toward higher-value baskets while keeping the experience simple. These tools continue to reshape how members discover, buy and receive products, making the overall service proposition feel more modern and flexible.

Major Markets

What's influencing demand from the industry's markets?

Middle-income households balance value and selective upgrades at clubs and supercenters

- Households earning between $40,000 and $125,000 make up a large share of the US population, so they naturally account for the largest share of sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters. These shoppers lean on large formats to cover groceries, household basics and selective discretionary items in a single trip, balancing careful budgeting with occasional upgrades in product quality and assortment.
- These store formats are deliberately designed around these car-owning, middle-income households. Warehouse clubs emphasize bulk packs, unit-price savings and membership perks for planned stock-up trips, while supercenters provide broad assortments and in-store services for more routine shopping. Together, they give this segment a convenient way to consolidate spending with a few large brands that can meet most weekly needs.

Affluent households drive big-ticket purchases at warehouse clubs and supercenters

- Households with incomes over $125,000 account for nearly a third of sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters, providing a resilient base for higher-value categories. Higher incomes make it easier to commit to larger stock-up baskets, so many affluent shoppers lean on clubs for bulk essentials and premium foods, while still seeking value through curated assortments, loyalty rewards and selective upgrades in categories such as electronics or wellness.
- Within this market, warehouse clubs tend to capture a greater share of primary grocery and household trips, whereas supercenters often play a complementary role for convenience missions and services. Membership perks, like cashback rewards, exclusive product tiers and fuel savings, reinforce clubs' appeal to affluent households. This encourages these households to purchase big-ticket items such as TVs, computers and household appliances through these formats, lifting average transaction sizes.

Lower-income households emphasize essentials and trade down in response to budget pressure

- Shoppers from households with incomes below $40,000 contribute a smaller but still meaningful share of sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters. They focus spending on groceries and household necessities, often trading down to private labels and lower-priced assortments when budgets tighten. In many communities, supercenters also function as one of the few full-line food retailers nearby, making them a critical resource in areas with constrained grocery access.
- Membership fees at warehouse clubs can be difficult for this market to justify, pushing many lower-income households toward supercenters and other non-membership formats for everyday trips. At the same time, expanded food assortments at dollar stores and

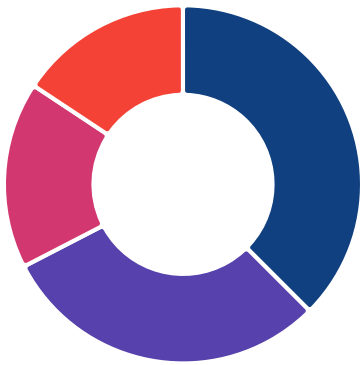
smaller value chains intensify competition for low-cost grocery missions, encouraging these shoppers to fragment their baskets across retailers that offer the sharpest perceived savings and manageable pack sizes, which can soften sales at larger formats.

Warehouse clubs and supercenters function as practical sourcing hubs for small businesses

- The business segment includes restaurants, offices, salons, child care centers, schools, motels and other enterprises that rely on warehouse clubs and supercenters for recurring supplies. These customers place larger, repeat orders for paper goods, cleaning products, snacks and basic ingredients, using bulk packs and lower unit prices to manage inventory efficiently and keep operating costs under control.
- Many large-format retailers also offer tax-exempt and resale purchasing privileges, which further enhance their appeal to budget-conscious businesses. This segment helps smooth sales by linking purchasing to ongoing operations and staff needs, though smaller businesses still respond quickly to economic pressure by emphasizing private-label essentials and trimming less critical premium purchases. Even so, their predictable purchasing patterns underpin steady volume in fast-moving consumables and help stabilize sales across nonfood categories.

Major Markets Segmentation

Industry revenue in 2026 broken down by key markets



- Households with incomes between $40,000 and $125,000 ($297.2bn) 37.5%
- Households with incomes above $125,000 ($237.0bn) 29.9%
- Households with incomes below $40,000 ($133.9bn) 16.9%
- Businesses ($124.4bn) 15.7%

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

International Trade

No data

Some industries don't directly import or export goods. See reports at the manufacturing level for international trade data on relevant products.

Geographic Breakdown

Key Takeaways

The Southeast stands out as a prime expansion zone for warehouse clubs and supercenters thanks to fast suburban growth and business-friendly policies. Retailers benefit from easier approvals, lower development costs and strong value-driven demand that supports rapid network scaling.

The Great Lakes region offers a stable, logistics-driven environment that sustains consistent demand for large-format retail. Dense freight networks and cost-conscious middle-income households make it efficient to operate while ensuring steady bulk-buying behavior across metro and suburban markets.

The West attracts warehouse club businesses with its mix of high incomes, car-oriented lifestyles and established big-box retail culture. Strong purchasing power and familiarity with membership models help sustain large basket sizes and reinforce long-term investment in the region.

Business Locations

State	Establishments (Units)	Establishments (%)	Revenue ($bn)	Revenue (%)	Wages ($m)	Wages (%)	Employment (k)	Employment (%)	Population (%)
Alabama	92	1.6	14.8	1.9	887.6	1.3	32,402	1.8	1.5
Alaska	18	0.3	3.9	0.5	246.8	0.4	6,904	0.4	0.2
Arizona	144	2.5	26.4	3.3	2,005.6	3.0	48,289	2.6	2.2
Arkansas	66	1.2	7.3	0.9	680.2	1.0	25,041	1.4	0.9
California	568	10.0	85.3	10.8	7,938.7	11.7	171,927	9.3	11.5
Colorado	117	2.1	22.9	2.9	1,447.5	2.1	35,428	1.9	1.8
Connecticut	53	0.9	7.6	1.0	636.6	0.9	15,542	0.8	1.1
Delaware	18	0.3	2.5	0.3	131.5	0.2	4,200	0.2	0.3
Florida	399	7.0	58.3	7.4	4,166.6	6.1	118,980	6.4	7.0
Georgia	182	3.2	14.0	1.8	2,031.6	3.0	58,784	3.2	3.3
Hawaii	22	0.4	5.5	0.7	286.5	0.4	9,488	0.5	0.4
Idaho	43	0.8	6.6	0.8	429.3	0.6	13,582	0.7	0.6
Illinois	226	4.0	34.4	4.3	3,040.3	4.5	76,671	4.2	3.7
Indiana	132	2.3	20.4	2.6	1,719.1	2.5	50,673	2.7	2.0
Iowa	63	1.1	5.7	0.7	589.7	0.9	20,149	1.1	0.9
Kansas	60	1.1	5.7	0.7	538.1	0.8	19,403	1.1	0.9
Kentucky	78	1.4	8.1	1.0	862.1	1.3	27,903	1.5	1.3
Louisiana	78	1.4	13.7	1.7	775.5	1.1	28,076	1.5	1.3
Maine	25	0.4	2.2	0.3	198.7	0.3	6,381	0.3	0.4
Maryland	87	1.5	16.4	2.1	1,089.0	1.6	29,689	1.6	1.8
Massachusetts	97	1.7	13.8	1.7	1,172.0	1.7	27,041	1.5	2.1
Michigan	199	3.5	29.0	3.7	2,722.8	4.0	73,988	4.0	3.0
Minnesota	130	2.3	20.0	2.5	1,382.3	2.0	42,769	2.3	1.7
Mississippi	53	0.9	4.5	0.6	501.1	0.7	17,544	0.9	0.9

State	Establishments (Units)	Establishments (%)	Revenue ($bn)	Revenue (%)	Wages ($m)	Wages (%)	Employment (k)	Employment (%)	Population (%)
Missouri	121	2.1	12.1	1.5	1,386.5	2.0	44,155	2.4	1.8
Montana	22	0.4	2.7	0.3	186.2	0.3	6,669	0.4	0.3
Nebraska	40	0.7	4.5	0.6	361.2	0.5	13,116	0.7	0.6
Nevada	57	1.0	6.0	0.8	596.9	0.9	17,233	0.9	1.0
New Hampshire	31	0.5	4.2	0.5	301.1	0.4	8,915	0.5	0.4
New Jersey	136	2.4	20.8	2.6	1,820.6	2.7	39,954	2.2	2.8
New Mexico	38	0.7	4.1	0.5	312.5	0.5	13,819	0.7	0.6
New York	263	4.6	37.4	4.7	2,937.3	4.3	65,174	3.5	5.8
North Carolina	173	3.0	17.3	2.2	1,813.7	2.7	55,971	3.0	3.3
North Dakota	16	0.3	2.1	0.3	141.3	0.2	5,669	0.3	0.2
Ohio	199	3.5	31.9	4.0	2,593.2	3.8	70,252	3.8	3.5
Oklahoma	78	1.4	7.0	0.9	749.8	1.1	27,907	1.5	1.2
Oregon	123	2.2	19.1	2.4	1,319.3	1.9	32,947	1.8	1.2
Pennsylvania	217	3.8	20.3	2.6	2,192.8	3.2	62,066	3.4	3.8
Rhode Island	14	0.2	1.4	0.2	110.8	0.2	3,483	0.2	0.3
South Carolina	82	1.4	8.1	1.0	846.0	1.2	26,933	1.5	1.6
South Dakota	19	0.3	1.8	0.2	137.7	0.2	6,159	0.3	0.3
Tennessee	120	2.1	11.4	1.4	1,343.0	2.0	41,029	2.2	2.1
Texas	450	7.9	52.4	6.6	6,085.6	9.0	164,518	8.9	9.4
Utah	78	1.4	13.1	1.7	909.5	1.3	25,164	1.4	1.0
Vermont	9	0.2	1.7	0.2	55.7	0.1	1,709	0.1	0.2
Virginia	150	2.6	30.6	3.9	2,060.2	3.0	49,126	2.7	2.6
Washington	149	2.6	35.3	4.5	2,470.1	3.6	50,555	2.7	2.3
West Virginia	30	0.5	2.2	0.3	211.2	0.3	10,879	0.6	0.5
Wisconsin	113	2.0	14.1	1.8	1,272.8	1.9	38,575	2.1	1.7
Wyoming	16	0.3	1.2	0.1	110.7	0.2	4,115	0.2	0.2

Where are businesses located?

The Southeast combines rapid suburban growth with retailer-friendly policies

- The Southeast offers some of the best conditions for expanding warehouse clubs and supercenters, with strong population growth, suburban development and value-oriented shopping behavior. Pro-growth regulatory frameworks in many states reduce zoning barriers and speed approvals, making it easier and cheaper to secure sites, build big-box formats and scale dense store and club networks across the region.
- The region also operates as a key logistics corridor, with expanding Atlantic ports in Georgia, Florida and the Carolinas and direct access to major interstate routes. Proximity to port-linked distribution hubs lowers transportation costs, improves delivery speed and supports import-heavy categories, encouraging chains like Walmart, Sam's Club and Costco to cluster regional distribution and store networks there.
- Many Southeastern states combine mid-range population densities with fast-growing suburbs and exurbs, which are well-suited to warehouse clubs and supercenters. Dense clusters of middle-income households with high car ownership support formats that rely on large parking lots,

highway access and shoppers willing to drive farther to stock up on bulk goods in a single, high-basket trip.

The Great Lakes region provides efficient freight links for warehouse clubs and supercenters

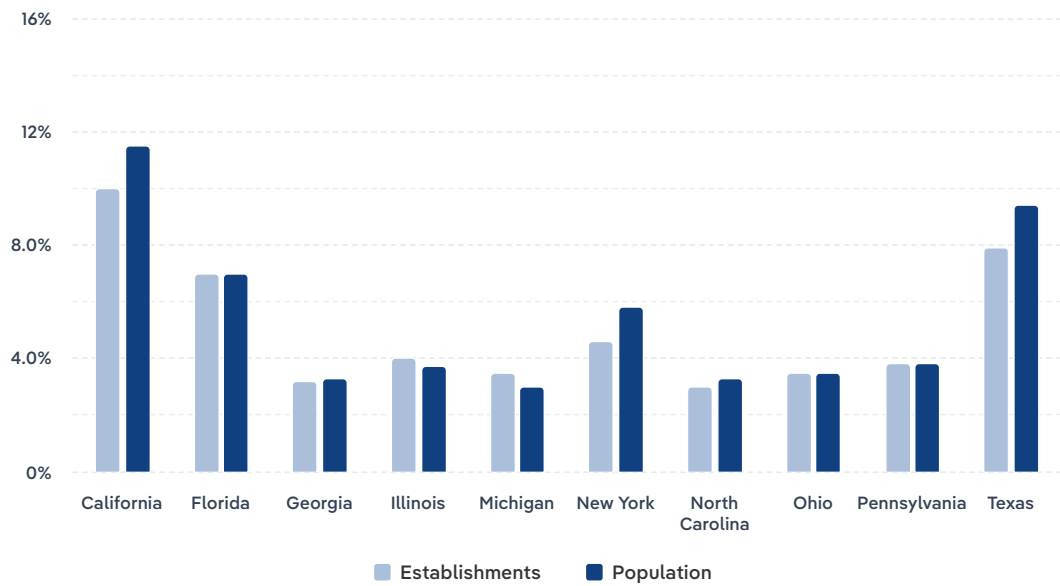
- The Great Lakes region supports a dense and expanding network of warehouse clubs and supercenters anchored by long-standing retail chains and steady population growth in its metro areas and suburbs. It is home to Meijer, a major family-owned supercenter operator with a strong presence in Illinois, Michigan, Ohio, Indiana, Wisconsin and Kentucky, reinforcing the region's orientation toward large-format, one-stop retail.
- The region's mix of manufacturing, logistics and service employers supports large middle-income populations that closely monitor everyday costs. These households often favor bulk purchasing of groceries, household essentials and general merchandise to manage budgets and reduce trip frequency, creating consistent demand for warehouse club and supercenter formats.
- A dense network of interstate highways, rail corridors and port facilities in the Great Lakes states supports a major freight and logistics hub, lowering inbound shipping and distribution costs for retailers. Paired with relatively affordable industrial and commercial sites, this environment makes it easier and cheaper to build and run large-format warehouse clubs and supercenters near heavily populated cities.

The West attracts warehouse club operators seeking high-income, car-oriented shoppers

- The West is a natural fit for warehouse clubs and supercenters because many households have relatively high disposable incomes and regularly buy larger baskets of groceries, household goods and general merchandise. That spending power helps support the per-trip volumes and membership economics these formats rely on, even when unit prices are higher than in lower-income regions.
- Western households are highly car-oriented and many live in suburban or exurban communities where large parcels, highway access and ample parking are easier to secure than in dense urban cores. That pattern makes it practical to develop and operate big-box warehouse clubs and supercenters on designated commercial corridors outside city centers, drawing customers from broad regional trade areas.
- Warehouse clubs have deep roots in the West, where the original warehouse club concept was introduced, and chains like Costco built their early US footprint. Over time, businesses concentrated investment in large Western states such as California and Washington, creating dense networks of clubs and big-box stores and reinforcing shopper familiarity with membership models and bulk-purchase shopping.

Business Concentration

Share of establishments (%) vs. share of population (%)



IBISWorld

Sources: IBISWorld

Key Success Factors

How do businesses use location to their advantage?

Operate in a highly visible location

Being in a highly visible spot off major roads keeps the store top of mind and easy to find, which can boost spontaneous visits and repeat traffic for big-box formats that rely on very high sales volumes.

Operate in a location that is close to key markets

Proximity to densely populated areas enables retailers to maximize foot traffic and sales. Clear signage, easy access and ample parking space also attract shoppers.

Competitive Forces

Key Takeaways

Retailers compete primarily on price. The retail model that warehouse clubs and supercenters use encourages shoppers to buy in bulk to achieve cost savings through a low price-per-use.

Online retailers pose the largest threat to warehouse clubs and supercenters. Because of lower overhead costs, online sellers can compete effectively based on price. In response, many warehouse clubs and supercenters have invested significantly in their online platforms.

Concentration	Competition	Barriers to Entry
High	High — Increasing	High — Steady
Substitutes	**Buyer Power**	**Supplier Power**
High — Steady	Moderate — Steady	Moderate — Steady

Concentration

What impacts the industry's market share concentration?

Economies of scale reinforce high revenue concentration

- Companies in the warehouse club and supercenter sector are highly concentrated, with Walmart (including Sam's Club) and Costco together accounting for well over 90.0% of industry revenue in 2026. Their dominant share reflects powerful economies of scale in purchasing, distribution and merchandising, which allow these chains to set the prevailing benchmarks for price and assortment in bulk retail.
- Scale advantages enable leading companies to negotiate favorable supplier terms, run dense logistics networks and operate large-format stores at high throughput, supporting low unit costs and everyday value propositions across food, household and discretionary categories. These efficiencies underpin strong brand recognition and membership loyalty, helping Walmart and Costco maintain their outsized share of sales and reinforcing the sector's persistently high level of concentration.

New and regional players remain confined to narrow parts of the industry

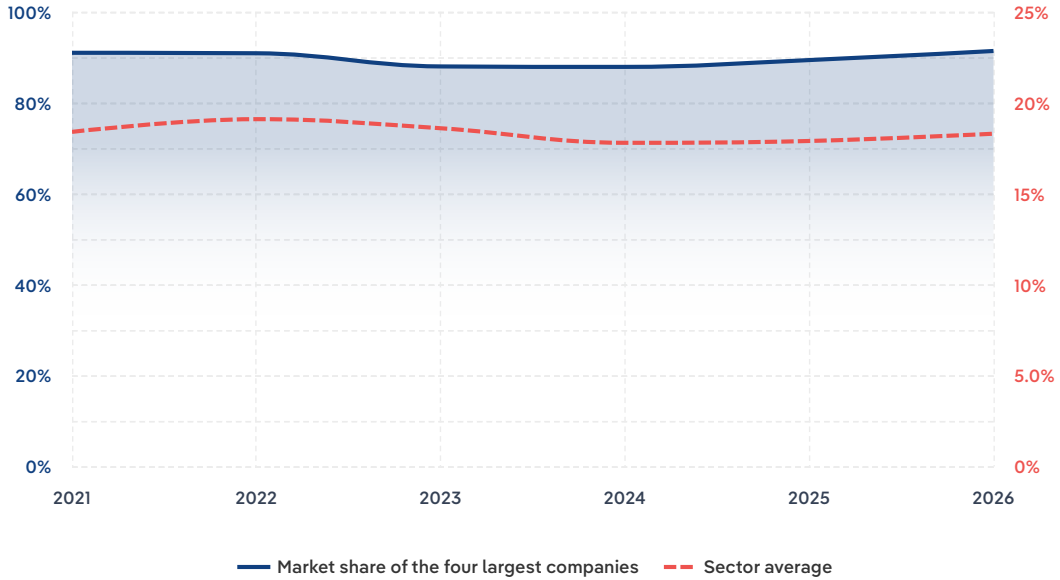
- With most sales concentrated among a few national chains, smaller warehouse clubs and supercenters typically compete in narrower roles, focusing on localized assortments, personalized service or niche categories rather than trying to replicate Walmart or Costco's model. Many newer concepts lean into differentiated store experiences or community positioning to attract members who value more than just price and selection.
- The dominance of large companies means growth opportunities for smaller and new businesses are often limited to selective regional expansion or specialty formats, rather than broad national rollouts. These businesses may carve out loyal customer bases in specific markets, but they rarely scale to match the reach or influence of the largest membership chains, which continue to anchor bulk purchasing and everyday value propositions.

Advanced logistics and pricing tools reinforce incumbents' strength

- Leading warehouse club and supercenter companies are investing heavily in automation, data analytics and AI across logistics, pricing and inventory management. These tools improve forecasting accuracy, keep shelves stocked and streamline distribution, lowering unit costs and supporting consistent value propositions for bulk and staple items across large store networks.
- Omnichannel platforms that integrate extensive store footprints with online ordering, click-and-collect and rapid delivery deepen customer loyalty and make shopping more convenient for members. By turning big-box locations into flexible fulfillment hubs and offering app-based services, dominant chains strengthen their role in everyday purchasing, while companies that cannot match this digital infrastructure risk falling behind in convenience and visibility. This performance gap reinforces the industry's high market concentration.

Market Share Concentration

Combined market share of the four largest companies in this industry



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

☆ Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses handle concentration?

Develop a strong reputation

Retailers can improve customer loyalty by developing a strong reputation for quality and price. Customers have many options when choosing between retailers, so a strong reputation will fuel higher revenue.

Leverage economies of scope

With economies of scope, warehouse clubs and supercenters can lower the cost of doing business, which typically translates into lower consumer prices. Given the high degree of market saturation, offering low prices is crucial.

Barriers to Entry

High | Steady

What challenges do potential industry entrants face?

Legal

- Individual states set employment, safety and business rules that large-format retailers must follow, including minimum wage laws, overtime, scheduling and worker protection standards. On top of that, federal and state trade and consumer regulations cover pricing, labeling, data privacy, sustainability and sourcing, making compliance complex for multi-category warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Start-Up Costs

- Large club stores and supercenters benefit from volume-based purchasing, distribution and advertising discounts that lower their costs. Matching this scale requires substantial upfront capital to stock inventory, buy equipment and fixtures, secure or develop large sites, and build regional logistics. New entrants must commit heavily before sales volumes are proven or stable.

Differentiation

- Establishing a distinct brand and loyal customer base is essential because most retailers can source comparable branded and private-label goods. Product differences are limited, so warehouse clubs and supercenters focus on format, membership structure, price positioning, assortment breadth and perceived quality. Creating that differentiation requires ongoing investment in marketing and customer experience.

Capital Expenses

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters need continuous capital to build and expand large footprints, modernize stores and maintain extensive logistics networks. Leading chains also invest heavily in automation, data analytics and digital channels like online ordering and delivery. New businesses must match this ongoing spending to meet customer expectations on price, convenience and shopping experience.

☆ Key Success Factors

How can potential entrants overcome barriers to entry?

Comply with government regulations

Warehouse clubs and supercenters handle and sell various food items, so they must adhere to a range of policies and regulations. Adhering to these policies can reduce operating expenses and limit exposure to fines.

Develop links with suppliers

Warehouse clubs and supercenters should stock the latest products and offer the widest variety to attract more shoppers and generate repeat business. Developing strong links with suppliers ensures that stores will have access to products.

Substitutes

High Steady

What are substitutes for industry services?

E-commerce

- Online retailers sidestep many of the fixed costs tied to large physical locations, enabling aggressive pricing and frequent promotions across everyday goods and discretionary items. Shoppers now expect a broad assortment, detailed reviews and personalized recommendations, which increase confidence and willingness to purchase. As e-commerce platforms expand bulk and subscription offerings, more routine stock-up trips can be shifted online rather than made in person.
- Warehouse clubs and supercenters have responded by treating stores as digital fulfillment hubs, integrating curbside pickup, same-day delivery and app-based ordering into their core offer. Members can now choose between in-store browsing and online convenience, often within the same brand ecosystem. The ability to sample products, access low-priced food courts and physically evaluate items still gives large-format stores a distinctive edge that pure online players struggle to replicate.

Supermarkets, furniture, hardware, department and dollar stores

- Supermarkets, furniture, hardware, department and dollar stores provide other large-scale retail environments where consumers can satisfy needs that overlap with club and supercenter offerings. These formats compete on assortment breadth, brand mix, store design, proximity, service and everyday pricing. Warehouse clubs and supercenters remain known for strong value on bulk purchases, yet traditional chains have sharpened private-label ranges and remodeled stores to emphasize quick, convenient trips.
- These stores often carry identical national brands and categories, using their own purchasing scale to closely track prices on key items. Recognizable banners and mature loyalty programs drive repeat visits, while newer membership tiers offer benefits that rival savings from bulk formats. As these retailers deepen omnichannel capabilities, such as drive-up pickup and rapid delivery, they increasingly offer comparable convenience for many common shopping missions.

Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses compete with substitutes?

Closely monitor the competition

Grocery stores and other substitutes compete on price because of the low level of product differentiation. Retailers must monitor when competitors offer discounts and promotions to avoid losing customers and adjust their own prices or offers in response.

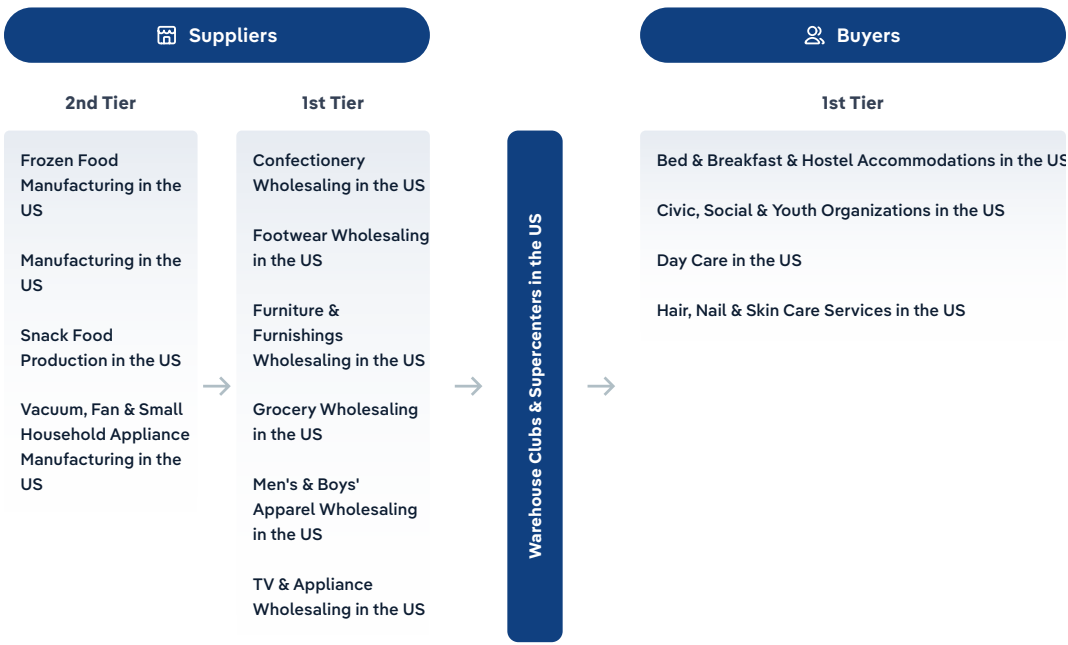
Develop a wide and expanding product range

Retailers should offer a wide range of products comparable to those of external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

Buyer & Supplier Power

Supply Chain

Direct and indirect supplier and buyer industries related to this industry



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

What power do buyers and suppliers have over the industry?

Moderate Steady

Buyers: Leveraging choice of formats and channels

- Buyers are typically highly price-conscious and can easily compare total basket costs across warehouse clubs, supermarkets, discount chains and online channels, which puts ongoing pressure on retailers to keep prices low and value strong. However, paid memberships, bulk-oriented

assortments and in-store convenience limit how freely they switch, so their overall influence on pricing and terms tends to be moderate.

- When perceived value deteriorates, many buyers are willing to move to cheaper brands or alternative retailers, which pushes warehouse clubs and supercenters to sustain sharp pricing and promotions. At the same time, loyalty programs, exclusive private-label ranges and reliable service increase switching costs and strengthen attachment to specific banners, helping to anchor buyer power at a moderate level in a highly competitive retail landscape.

Moderate Steady

Suppliers: Reinforcing dependence through unique product ranges

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters rely on manufacturers, distributors and private-label partners to secure must-have brands, seasonal items and bulk formats that attract shoppers, giving suppliers some influence over prices and promotions. However, large chains buy in high volumes, source from many vendors and can redirect orders when needed, so individual suppliers rarely hold dominant power in negotiations.
- Differentiated or exclusive products can create pockets of dependence, but a substantial share of inventory is generic, widely available or sold under retailer-controlled private labels. This limits most suppliers' ability to dictate commercial terms. Scale, professional procurement teams and the option to replace underperforming vendors help balance the relationship, so overall supplier power is best described as moderate.

☆ Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses manage buyer & supplier power?

Control distribution arrangements

Retailers compete on value and product offerings. Warehouse clubs and supercenters control their distribution facilities or maintain strict distributor agreements for low prices.

Develop a loyal customer base

Since some stores require paid membership, club stores and supercenters should ensure that consumers' needs are met and feel valued. Otherwise, consumers can easily switch to a competitor.

Companies

Key Takeaways

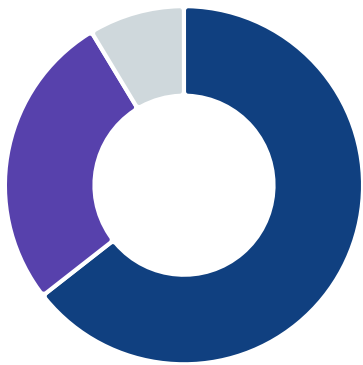
By attempting to freeze its global headcount for at least three years, Walmart is making a strategic shift toward tech-driven productivity. The move highlights how automation is increasingly replacing traditional labor growth across major retail operations.

Costco sells a wide range of products marketed under its in-house brand, Kirkland Signature. The Kirkland Signature line has seen a surge in sales over the past five years as economic uncertainty prompted customers to favor value-oriented items over national brands.

Market Share

Industry Market Share by Company

Industry-specific company revenue as a share of total industry revenue.



Walmart ($510.7bn) 64.5% Costco ($213.3bn) 26.9% Other Companies ($68.5bn) 8.6%

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

This chart has been simplified for the PDF and may not display all available data. View the full interactive chart on my.ibisworld.com for additional data and detail.

Company	Market Share (%)	Employees	Locations	Company Type	Headquarters
Walmart	64.5	10,000+	10,955	Public	Bentonville, Arkansas
Costco	26.9	10,000+	914	Public	Issaquah, Washington

Company Details

Walmart

Description

Walmart is a multinational retail corporation operating discount stores, supercenters, warehouse clubs and e-commerce platforms under the Walmart and Sam's Club brands. Headquartered in Bentonville, Arkansas, it is one of the world's largest retailers by revenue and store count. In the US, Walmart serves customers through thousands of stores, combining general merchandise, groceries and health and wellness services, including in-store pharmacies that dispense prescriptions and related services. Its common stock trades publicly under the ticker WMT.

Company Total Revenue (2026)

$713.2bn

Industry Specific Revenue (2026)

$510.7bn

Industry Market Share (2026)

64.5%

Employees (2026)

10,000+

Headquarters

Bentonville, Arkansas

Company Type

Public

Locations (Top 10)

Abbeville, Louisiana | Aberdeen, Maryland | Aberdeen, North Carolina | Aberdeen, South Dakota | Aberdeen, Washington | Abilene, Texas | Abingdon, Maryland | Abingdon, Virginia | Abington, Massachusetts | Acworth, Georgia

Other Industries

Online Children's Toy Sales in the US | Retail Trade in the US | Discount Department Stores in the US | Pharmacies & Drug Stores in the US | Online Home Furnishings Sales in the US | Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in the US | Online Gambling Services in the US | Online Grocery Sales in the US

A Full Locations list can be accessed in Atlas.

What's impacting Walmart's performance?

Walmart deepens its commitment to regenerative sustainability

- Walmart has adopted a range of ESG initiatives, including a goal to move beyond sustainability toward a regenerative approach that restores and replenishes natural systems. The company has focused on sourcing 20 key commodities more sustainably as part of its broader sustainable commodities agenda.
- Through Project Gigaton, Walmart set a goal to work with suppliers to reduce, avoid or sequester one gigaton of greenhouse gas emissions across its global value chain by 2030. Walmart and the Walmart Foundation have also committed to help protect, sustainably manage or restore at least 50 million acres of land and one million square miles of ocean by 2030. Another major goal is to achieve zero emissions in Walmart's own global operations by 2040, without relying on carbon offsets.

Affluent shoppers drive Walmart's e-grocery growth

- Walmart's e-grocery platform has seen a surge in activity from affluent households, adding to its traditionally strong base of lower-income shoppers. High-income households are spending more and ordering more often from Walmart, driving record e-commerce grocery sales gains. This affluent segment, earning over $200,000 annually, now constitutes about 8.0% of Walmart's active users, as of 2024 and is expanding much faster than lower-income cohorts.
- At the same time, Walmart continues to rely on its core value-focused shoppers, using low prices and a broad assortment to anchor overall volume. In contrast, supermarkets and Target have experienced weaker online growth among higher-income households, allowing Walmart to capture a larger share of affluent online grocery spending. This evolving mix of value-oriented and higher-income shoppers is

strengthening Walmart's competitive position in the online grocery market and broadening its appeal across income tiers.

You can view and download more company details on my.ibisworld.com.

Costco

Description

Costco Wholesale Corporation is a publicly listed, membership-based warehouse club retailer headquartered in Issaquah, Washington. It traces its roots to Price Club, founded in 1976 and opened the first Costco warehouse in Seattle in 1983 before adopting the Costco Wholesale name in 1999. Costco operates large-format, membership-only warehouses that sell a curated range of branded and private-label products in bulk at low margins. The group has a substantial footprint across North America, Europe, Asia and Australia.

Company Total Revenue (2026)

$269.9bn

Industry Specific Revenue (2026)

$213.3bn

Industry Market Share (2026)

26.9%

Employees (2026)

10,000+

Headquarters

Issaquah, Washington

Company Type

Public

Locations (Top 10)

Albany, Oregon
Albuquerque, New Mexico
Alexandria, Virginia
Alhambra, California
Allentown, Pennsylvania
Aloha, Oregon
Alpharetta, Georgia
Altamonte Springs, Florida
Anchorage, Alaska
Ankeny, Iowa

Other Industries

Optical Goods Retailing in the US
Grocery Wholesaling in the UK
Gas Stations with Convenience Stores in the US
Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in the US

A Full Locations list can be accessed in Atlas.

What's impacting Costco's performance?

Digital offerings become more popular

- Costco continues to prioritize in-warehouse traffic, but it has gradually expanded its digital and omnichannel capabilities in the United States and other key markets. The investment in its online shopping platform has paid off, with a reported 44.4% climb in e-commerce sales in fiscal year 2021, following roughly 50.0% growth the year before. While e-commerce still represents a smaller share of overall sales than some competitors, online sales have accelerated.
- The introduction of new digital features, such as same-day delivery and expanded online product offerings, has attracted a broader customer base and boosted overall sales. According to the latest figures, Costco's e-commerce business has grown by more than 10.0% year over year for eight consecutive quarters through fiscal Q1 2026, including 20.5% growth in Q1 2026, well ahead of the wider retail average.

Executive perks and app improvements boost Costco member value

- Costco is testing in-aisle scanning technology that lets members scan items on their phones, pay digitally and present a QR code at exit, while expanding membership scanners at entrances and food courts to tighten access and speed verification. The company is updating its mobile app to emphasize digital memberships and renewals, supporting younger shoppers and enabling faster, more convenient interactions in high-volume US warehouses.
- The company is also enriching member benefits, including enhanced perks for Executive members, such as Instacart discounts and extended shopping hours, as well as improved rewards for Costco Anywhere Visa cardholders at gas stations. Combined with the ongoing expansion of US locations and business centers, these measures strengthen loyalty and help maintain Costco's competitive edge in the warehouse club industry by improving perceived value and operational efficiency.

You can view and download more company details on my.ibisworld.com.

External Environment

Key Takeaways

Individual states cover regulations relevant to the retail industry in general. Congress and the state enact trade regulations to maintain a free and competitive economy.

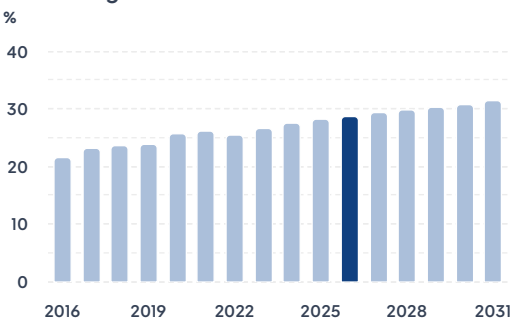
Economic development tax credits help governments attract and support growing businesses. By offering tax breaks in return for local job creation and investment, companies like Costco can reinvest savings into expansion, efficiency and lower prices.

Regulation & Policy		Assistance	
Low	Steady	Low	Steady

External Drivers

What demographic and macroeconomic factors impact the industry?

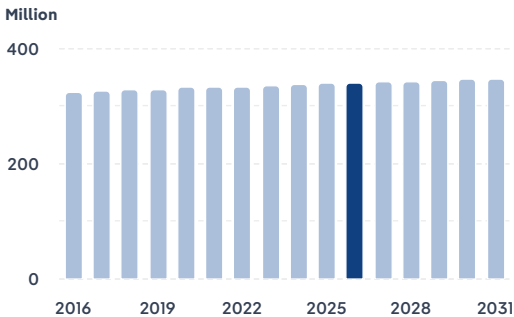
Percentage of business conducted online



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Growth in the share of purchases made online increases competition for warehouse clubs and supercenters, as e-commerce retailers offer convenience, delivery and extensive product selection. This shift can draw spending away from physical locations and reduce foot traffic. When online growth slows, it creates an opportunity for brick-and-mortar stores to regain customers and strengthen in-store sales performance.

Population

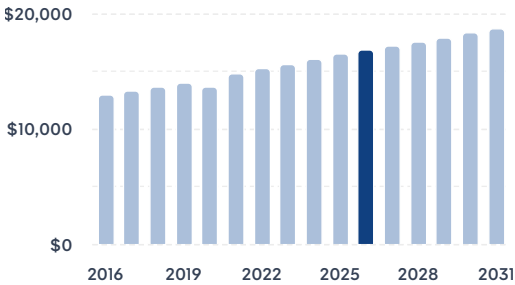


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Population growth expands the total number of potential customers for warehouse clubs and supercenters, supporting steady increases in sales volume. A larger population leads to higher demand for bulk goods, groceries and household essentials. Slower population growth, however, limits the pace of customer base expansion, constraining long-term revenue growth and store network expansion.

Consumer spending

$ billion

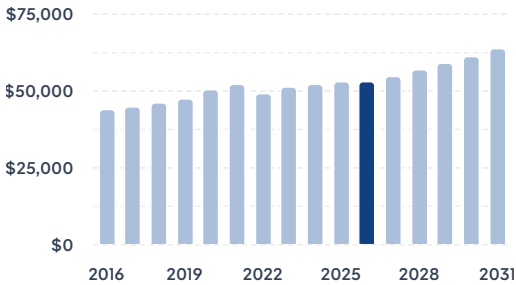


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Consumer spending reflects how frequently households shop and how much they purchase per visit at warehouse clubs and supercenters. Strong spending levels drive higher transaction volumes, as consumers make more trips and purchase a wider mix of goods. When spending slows, households consolidate purchases and cut back on nonessential items, limiting sales growth and reducing overall store activity.

Per capita disposable income

$

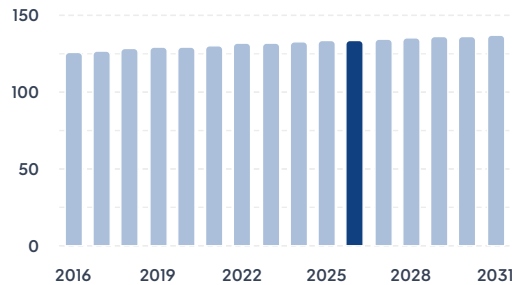


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Per capita disposable income captures consumers' ability to spend beyond basic necessities, shaping purchasing decisions at warehouse clubs and supercenters. Higher income levels support trade-ups to premium products, larger pack sizes and discretionary goods. When income growth is limited, shoppers shift toward lower-cost alternatives and essentials, reducing average transaction values even if store traffic remains relatively stable.

Number of households

Million

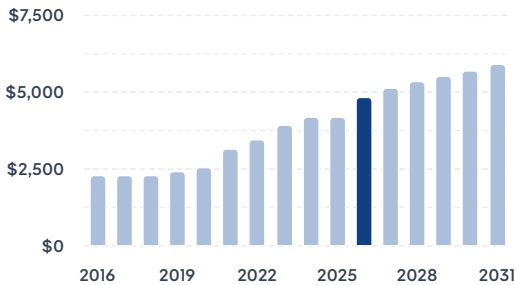


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Changes in the median age influence the types of products consumers prioritize at warehouse clubs and supercenters. An aging population tends to increase demand for health, wellness and essential goods, which supports stable sales. However, slower growth among younger consumers may reduce demand for trend-driven and discretionary categories, limiting opportunities to expand product offerings in certain segments.

Corporate profit

$ billion



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Higher corporate profit supports stronger business purchasing activity, particularly for bulk office supplies, breakroom goods and operational essentials sold by warehouse clubs and supercenters. Business customers typically buy in large quantities, contributing meaningfully to revenue. When corporate profit weakens, companies reduce discretionary spending and delay restocking, posing a clear threat to sales generated from this important customer segment.

Regulation & Policy

Low Steady

What regulations impact the industry?

Antitrust laws

Some of the most important antitrust laws affecting warehouse clubs and supercenters include the Sherman Antitrust Act, the Clayton Antitrust Act, the Hart-Scott-Rodino Act and the Robinson-Patman Act. These acts prohibit the formation of monopolies, restrict certain forms of price discrimination and protect independent business owners. The explosive popularity of Walmart and Costco has heightened scrutiny of competitive conditions in the retail sector and concerns about market concentration among large-format retailers, potentially leading to more regulation in the coming years. Individual states also have their own antitrust laws and enforcement frameworks that can apply to warehouse

clubs and supercenters in addition to federal law.

Americans with Disabilities Act

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) prohibits discrimination against people with disabilities in several areas, including employment, transportation, public accommodations, communications and access to state and local government programs and services. More retailers are hiring workers with disabilities because they are fully capable of performing most required tasks. Many customers prefer to support a business that hires and supports individuals with disabilities because it reinforces positive perceptions of the brand and the shopping experience. Warehouse clubs and supercenters must make their stores accessible to customers with disabilities and ensure reasonable accommodations for employees to avoid fines and other penalties.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

The EPA establishes standards for waste management, emissions and other environmental impacts. Stores are required to manage waste, such as packaging materials and expired products, in compliance with applicable federal, state and local regulations. Non-compliance can result in hefty fines and harm a company's reputation for environmental stewardship. The EPA protects people and the environment from significant health risks, while also sponsoring and conducting research. As environmental concerns intensify, environmental regulations and standards are expected to tighten, raising operating costs for retailers that must invest in compliance, equipment and reporting systems.

Occupational Safety and Health Act

The Occupational Safety and Health Act requires employers to provide safe working conditions. Most of these standards pertain to strenuous or hazardous work, but many also apply to all businesses. Warehouse clubs and supercenters must adhere to standards governing machinery, ergonomics and accident reporting. The growing use of technology and equipment has heightened the safety standards that retailers must follow, raising compliance costs. Regular safety audits and employee training sessions are crucial to prevent workplace injuries and ensure legal compliance.

Credit programs

The laws that impact retailers' credit programs include the Federal Consumer Credit Protection Act and its associated Truth in Lending provisions, which require written disclosure of information relating to financing. Under the Federal Fair Credit Reporting Act, consumers must be informed when credit information is used in decisions that may deny or limit credit. Also, the Federal Equal Credit Opportunity Act prohibits discrimination against credit applicants based on certain grounds. These acts are intended to protect consumers and promote fair, non-discriminatory access to credit, including credit offered by retailers.

Tariffs

Tariffs apply to merchandise sourced from global suppliers and warehouse clubs and supercenters typically purchase items from importers or wholesalers after those tariffs are applied. Changes in tariff rates directly affect landed costs, influencing sourcing decisions and retail pricing strategies. Recent US tariff policy has focused on maintaining and adjusting duties on goods from major trading partners, especially China, raising costs in import-heavy categories such as electronics, apparel and certain food items. In response, large retailers and warehouse clubs have diversified sourcing, renegotiated supplier terms, selectively passed higher costs to consumers, and, in some cases, increased reliance on domestic manufacturers where feasible.

Assistance

Low Steady

What assistance is available to this industry?

Government

Tax credits

Economic development tax credits are a powerful tool that governments use to attract businesses. These credits reduce a company's tax liability in exchange for commitments to create jobs and invest in local infrastructure. In addition to tax credits, governments may also provide other forms of incentives such as tax rebates, exemptions, or grants tied to project performance. This support can result in significant savings and may allow businesses to allocate more resources toward improving operational efficiency, expanding product lines and potentially lowering prices. In recent years, large warehouse clubs such as Costco have been the focus of multi-million-dollar, performance-based incentive packages from state and local governments designed to support new warehouse developments and associated job creation.

Non-government

National Retail Federation (NRF) and business loans

The NRF is the world's largest retail trade association. It conducts programs and services in research, education, training, information technology and government affairs and policy advocacy to protect and advance the interests of various retail businesses. Private-sector banks and lending institutions offer loans and other commercial financing products tailored for large retail formats, providing critical capital for new store openings, inventory purchases, or technological upgrades. Access to affordable financing helps warehouse clubs and supercenters maintain competitiveness and meet consumer demand.

Financial Benchmarks

Key Takeaways

Purchasing costs have rebounded to more typical levels after pandemic-era lows. As supply chains normalized and product mixes shifted toward higher-cost fresh and prepared items, merchandise expenses rose, though sourcing strategies kept pricing competitive.

Wage pressure has eased even as staffing levels expand across stores. Lower overtime and normalized hiring conditions have reduced average salaries relative to revenue, though operations remain labor-intensive and larger chains still offer more competitive compensation.

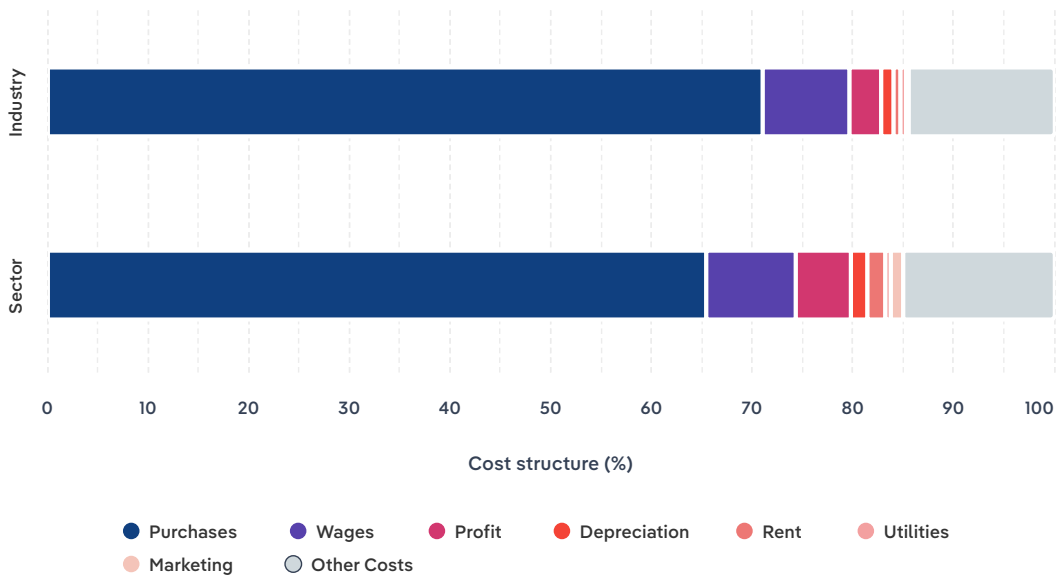
Profit has cooled from its peak but remains stable overall. Membership fees, private-label products and in-store services continue to cushion profitability, helping retailers offset higher costs while maintaining a strong value proposition for shoppers.

Profit Margin	Average Wage	Largest Cost
3.1% ↓ Lower than sector	$36.7k ↑ Higher than sector	Purchases
		71.1% of Revenue

Cost Structure

Cost Structure Benchmarks

Average operating costs by industry and sector as a share (%) of revenue 2026



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

What trends impact industry costs?

Purchasing costs have moved from a pandemic low back to typical levels

- Purchases' share of revenue was relatively low in 2021, when pandemic-era discounting, supplier concessions and a heavier mix of lower-priced lines temporarily restrained merchandise costs. As supply chains stabilized and wholesale prices for food and household goods moved higher,

purchasing costs gradually returned to a more typical share of revenue, edging up through 2023 before settling at current levels.

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters have added more fresh, organic and prepared foods, which tend to carry higher unit costs even when sold in bulk. For example, Costco has flagged persistent cost pressure in key fresh and ancillary categories, including eggs and cocoa, prompting selective price increases and more disciplined cost management as it works to protect its value-focused reputation with members.
- Direct sourcing from manufacturers and bulk-value pricing help bypass some intermediate markups and keep shelf prices competitive, which is key for supercenters and warehouse clubs whose value is driven by their money-saving. With input cost growth moderating and purchasing strategies now well established, merchandise costs appear to have normalized at their historic levels.

Growing headcount now coincides with lower average salaries and wage intensity

- Wages' revenue share has moved down from historically high levels, even though headcount has continued to climb. Pandemic-driven staffing shortages and hazard pay in 2021 added to already elevated labor costs, but as hiring conditions normalized, overtime and premium pay eased. Since employment has grown faster than total wage expenditures and revenue has grown faster than employment, average salaries have edged lower, shrinking the wages' revenue share.
- Despite this drop, warehouse clubs and supercenters still rely heavily on workers for daily operations, including customer service, maintaining large store displays and performing inventory checks. However, employment has risen while the number of establishments has remained relatively steady, pushing the employee-to-establishment ratio higher. This pattern shows that these formats remain operationally labor-reliant, even though labor costs have fallen relative to revenue.
- Notably, wage outcomes depend on employer scale. The two largest chains account for more than 90.0% of market revenue, leaving over a dozen smaller businesses to compete for the remaining share, often with leaner wage and benefit structures. In turn, larger players tend to pay somewhat higher hourly rates and offer more comprehensive benefits, widening the compensation gap between dominant chains and smaller rivals as aggregate wage intensity declines.

Profit has fallen from its peak but remains supported by memberships and offerings

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters convert low per-unit earnings into solid, but relatively low compared to the broader sector, profit through scale, membership fees and in-store services. Profit has slipped from its 2021 high as merchandise and logistics costs have risen faster than prices, but these formats still rely on very high sales volumes, bulk purchasing, selective assortments and bare-bones store designs to keep operating costs low and shelf prices competitive.
- Membership income has become even more important as the percentage profit has edged lower. For warehouse clubs, annual and executive fees provide a relatively stable, high-margin revenue stream that supports profit even when merchandise profitability is under pressure. Costco, for example, highlights membership fees as a core profit driver, prioritizing renewal rates and member loyalty over aggressive price increases, which helps preserve its value-focused positioning in a higher-cost environment.
- For both supercenters and warehouse clubs, private-label goods and in-store ancillary services provide additional support for profit. Private-label ranges typically earn a higher profit margin than comparable national brands while still being marketed as low-priced options, lifting basket value without alienating cost-conscious shoppers. In-house services, from fuel pumps to embedded franchises, help lock in loyalty and boost visit frequency, offsetting competition from online retailers and sustaining profit.

Long-lived fixtures and equipment help keep depreciation predictable

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters' depreciation mainly reflects the cost of running very large, no-frills stores, heavy-duty shelving and racking, refrigeration and material-handling equipment. These formats stretch asset lives through preventive maintenance and durable, energy-efficient fixtures, from lighting to refrigeration. That approach helps keep depreciation a steady share of revenue, even though the store footprint and equipment base remain substantial.
- These retailers also increasingly invest in automation and warehouse management systems that support high-volume operations, such as upgraded inventory-tracking systems, self-checkout and backroom handling equipment. New systems are rolled out in stages and designed to operate for many years, so added capital does not translate into sharp swings in annual depreciation. Instead, depreciation has stayed relatively stable as a portion of revenue while underpinning long-term productivity across large-format stores.

Large stores in prime locations carry high rents but remain affordable through scale

- Urban and high-traffic areas command higher rents, as shown by leaders such as Walmart and Costco, which operate large-format stores often exceeding 100,000 square feet. Even so, many warehouse clubs and supercenters secure long-term, net leases with flat or modest escalation clauses, helping keep rent a predictable, stable share of revenue even as market rents rose sharply earlier in the decade.
- These chains balance costly flagship locations with new stores in suburban areas where real estate is less expensive, and they close underperforming sites to preserve steady rent-to-revenue ratios. As membership, private-label assortments and bulk purchasing drive revenue in line with rental costs. and as commercial and warehouse rent growth has recently moderated, rent has remained a constant and manageable share of revenue for warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Utility costs stay manageable as stores modernize equipment and monitor usage closely

- Utility spending for warehouse clubs and supercenters is driven by their very large store footprints and heavy use of lighting, HVAC and

refrigeration. These formats have steadily rolled out LED lighting, high-efficiency HVAC and modern refrigeration, along with better maintenance routines and staff training. Together, those steps help keep utility costs a fairly steady share of revenue, even as stores stay large and busy.

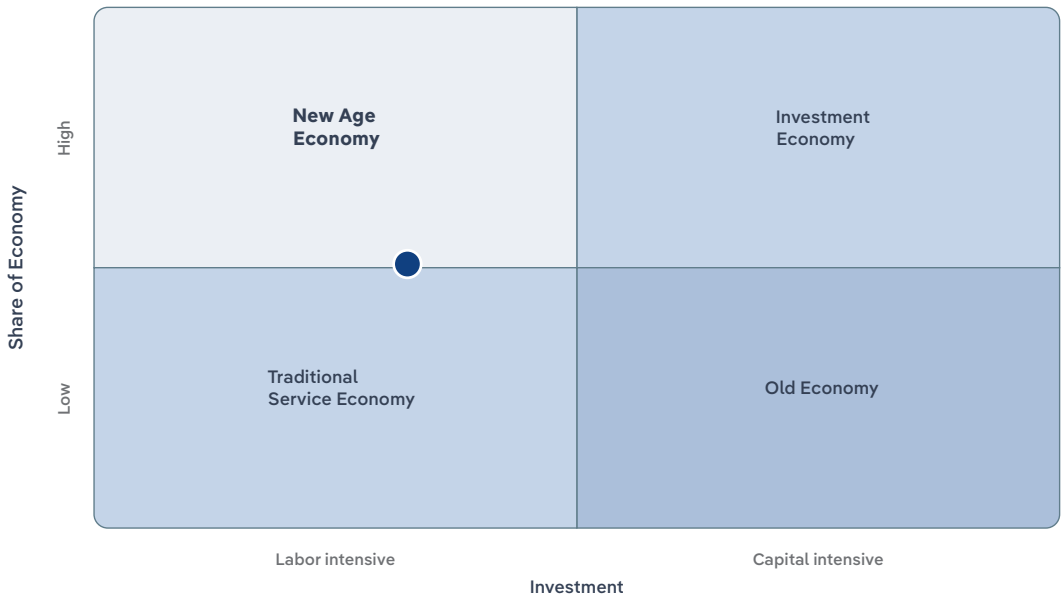
- Many leading chains use automation and smart sensors to monitor energy use in real time, adjusting lighting, temperature and equipment settings as traffic and weather change. Some have also added rooftop solar or other on-site renewables to offset grid power. These efficiency gains and the adoption of renewables have kept utility costs relatively stable, even as underlying energy prices have become more volatile amid grid expansion and elevated electricity demand.

Strong value reputations let warehouse clubs grow with minimal marketing spend

- Retailers like Costco and Walmart emphasize operational efficiency, value pricing and high-volume sales, with Costco in particular relying less on traditional mass advertising than many other chains. Costco aims for product markups of no more than about 14.0% on national brands and 15.0% on its private-label items, supporting its reputation for low prices and reducing the need for extensive promotional spending. Streamlined assortments and bulk sales also lower overhead and simplify marketing.
- These retailers lean on in-store promotions, free samples and recognizable value cues, such as Costco's $1.50 hot dog combo, to drive repeat visits and retention. Strong brand recognition, memberships and word of mouth help keep foot traffic high without marketing taking up a large portion of the budget. Overall, this model allows warehouse clubs and supercenters to sustain sales growth while holding marketing costs to a very small share of revenue.

New Age Economy

Share of economy vs. Investment



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Financial Ratios

Days' Receivables	Interest Coverage	Debt/Net Worth
31.0 ↓ Lower than sector	3.4 ↑ Higher than sector	3.7 ↓ Lower than sector

Earnings Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
EBIT/Revenue	2.8	3.2	7.9	4.8	5.5	6.1	4.8	3.5
EBITDA/Revenue	5.1	5.4	10.2	9.2	8.1	9.2	7.6	5.9
Leverage Ratio	19.4	18.4	9.8	10.9	12.4	11.0	14.2	34.6

Income Statement

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Advertising	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.4	0.8	0.5	0.4	0.6
Amortization	1.2	1.3	0.5	2.8	1.0	1.4	1.4	1.2
Bad debts	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.2
Business receipts	95.1	97.1	98.5	98.2	98.2	98.3	97.4	96.8
Charitable contributions	0.4	0.4	0.0	0.2	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.3
Compensation of officers	1.4	1.3	1.5	3.9	2.5	2.6	2.1	1.6
Cost of goods	79.7	81.3	73.1	67.0	72.1	70.7	74.6	78.0
Depletion	0.1	0.0	0.7	0.1	0.0	0.3	0.2	0.2
Depreciation	1.1	0.9	1.2	1.5	1.6	1.4	1.2	1.1
Dividends, domestic corporations	0.3	0.4	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.2
Employee benefit programs	1.1	1.0	0.5	3.3	2.4	2.1	1.7	1.3
Expenses	79.7	81.3	73.1	67.0	72.1	70.7	74.6	78.0
Gross Profit	20.3	18.7	26.9	33.0	27.9	29.3	25.4	22.0
Interest Income	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.9	0.0	0.4	0.3	0.3
Interest Paid	0.7	0.7	0.4	0.5	1.6	0.8	0.8	0.7
Net gain, noncapital assets	1.2	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.3	0.3
Net Income	1.6	2.0	5.0	3.7	3.1	3.9	3.1	1.6
Net L-T cap gain less net ST loss	1.0	0.0	0.4	0.1	1.7	0.7	0.6	0.4
Net loss, noncapital assets	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.3	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.2
Net S-T cap gain less net LT loss	0.5	0.5	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.4
Other deductions	3.7	3.1	6.5	6.1	4.5	5.7	4.8	4.7
Other receipts	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.1	0.0	0.2	0.3	0.4
Pension, profit sharing plans, stock, annuity	0.7	0.5	1.1	2.6	0.9	1.5	1.2	0.8
Rent Income	1.3	1.4	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5	0.9
Rent paid	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.3	1.3	1.2	1.1	0.9
Repairs	0.7	0.7	0.5	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.5	0.6
Royalties	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.6	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.4
Salaries and wages	5.3	4.6	5.3	5.4	6.4	5.7	5.4	4.8
Sales/Fixed Assets	1.4	1.5	1.1	0.9	0.8	0.9	1.1	2.0

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Taxes paid	0.5	0.5	2.5	0.6	0.8	1.3	1.0	1.2
Total Revenue	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

Balance Sheet

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Accounts payable	11.2	12.9	16.8	17.1	7.6	13.8	13.1	11.2
Accumulated amortization	0.3	0.1	7.7	2.3	1.4	3.8	2.4	1.3
Accumulated depletion	0.0	0.0	0.8	0.9	0.9	0.9	0.5	0.3
Accumulated depreciation	20.8	19.5	22.2	36.3	41.8	33.4	28.1	22.8
Additional paid-in capital	44.0	25.6	12.9	6.3	25.9	15.0	22.9	29.5
Allowance for bad debts	0.7	0.4	0.1	1.1	0.1	0.4	0.5	0.4
Capital stock	-0.9	9.0	0.9	1.0	-15.7	-4.6	-1.2	1.4
Cash and Equivalents	3.2	2.3	15.3	10.8	3.0	9.7	6.9	4.2
Cost of treasury stock	3.4	4.5	2.3	7.9	7.9	6.1	5.2	4.3
Current Assets	17.2	16.2	44.1	47.5	25.3	38.9	30.0	22.7
Current Liabilities	22.4	22.0	34.4	40.7	19.2	31.5	27.7	23.0
Depletable assets	0.0	0.0	3.6	4.0	3.9	3.8	2.3	1.2
Government Obligations	0.9	1.2	0.9	1.2	0.0	0.7	0.8	1.1
Intangible assets (Amortizable)	3.0	3.1	10.2	8.4	6.5	8.4	6.2	5.2
Inventories	9.7	9.8	9.5	20.6	10.2	13.4	12.0	10.7
Land	8.5	9.9	4.0	4.7	7.0	5.2	6.8	8.8
Loans from shareholders	6.2	8.6	9.6	4.5	3.6	5.9	6.5	8.2
Loans to shareholders	2.0	7.3	1.2	2.2	2.4	1.9	3.0	4.2
Mort, notes, and bonds under 1 yr	4.0	0.8	2.8	10.9	6.6	6.8	5.0	3.6
Mort, notes, bonds, 1 yr or more	24.7	13.9	16.1	24.0	39.2	26.5	23.6	21.9
Mortgage and real estate loans	1.4	1.3	0.9	2.8	2.5	2.1	1.8	1.5
Net worth	36.2	43.2	27.0	19.7	27.2	24.6	30.7	36.9
Notes and accounts receivable	1.5	1.1	3.6	3.0	8.5	5.1	3.5	2.3
Other assets	16.2	14.6	12.6	7.2	20.3	13.4	14.2	14.3
Other current assets	1.2	1.4	14.0	9.5	3.5	9.0	5.9	3.7
Other current liabilities	7.2	8.3	14.8	12.8	5.1	10.9	9.6	8.2
Other investments	35.6	32.4	8.2	10.7	12.1	10.3	19.8	25.8
Other liabilities	10.5	12.3	13.0	11.1	10.7	11.6	11.5	10.1
Property, Plant and Equipment	38.5	35.6	46.1	54.3	64.4	54.9	47.8	41.6

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Retained earnings, appropriated	-3.5	-0.7	-4.1	-1.0	-14.7	-6.6	-4.8	-3.7
Retained earnings-unappropriated	0.0	13.8	19.6	21.3	39.6	26.8	18.8	14.0
Tax Exempt Securities	0.0	0.0	0.7	1.4	0.0	0.7	0.4	0.2
Total assets	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
Total liabilities	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

Liquidity Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Current Ratio	0.8	0.7	1.3	1.2	1.3	1.3	1.1	1.0
Days' Inventory	44.5	44.1	47.5	111.9	51.4	70.3	59.9	41.0
Days' Payables	51.2	57.8	84.0	92.8	38.3	71.7	64.9	43.5
Days' Receivables	5.4	3.9	13.2	11.1	31.0	18.4	12.9	7.5
Inventory Turnover	8.2	8.3	7.7	3.3	7.1	6.0	6.9	14.2
Payables Turnover	7.1	6.3	4.3	3.9	9.5	5.9	6.3	11.4
Quick Ratio	0.3	0.3	1.0	0.7	0.8	0.8	0.6	0.5
Sales/Receivables	67.8	92.5	27.7	33.0	11.8	24.2	46.6	113.1
Sales/Working Capital	-18.3	-16.8	10.2	14.6	16.2	13.7	1.2	-12.6

Coverage Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	1.3	6.5	22.8	16.1	14.9	18.0	12.4	8.3
Interest Coverage	3.8	4.7	20.1	10.1	3.4	11.2	8.4	6.0

Leverage Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Debt/Net Worth	2.8	2.3	3.7	5.1	3.7	4.2	3.5	2.9
Fixed Assets/Net Worth	2.0	1.6	3.5	5.6	4.6	4.6	3.5	2.5
Tangible Net Worth	36.2	43.2	27.0	19.7	27.2	24.6	30.7	36.9

Operating Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
EBIT/Revenue	2.8	3.2	7.9	4.8	5.5	6.1	4.8	3.5
EBITDA/Revenue	5.1	5.4	10.2	9.2	8.1	9.2	7.6	5.9
Return on Assets, %	2.8	3.2	7.9	4.8	5.5	6.1	4.8	4.5
Sales/Total Assets	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.4

Cash Flow & Debt Service Ratios (% of sales)

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Cash after Operations	2.0	9.7	18.4	12.4	40.4	23.7	16.6	14.2
Cash from Trading	7.7	16.5	32.9	21.1	53.2	35.7	26.3	23.0
Debt Service P&I Coverage	-0.2	3.6	2.5	1.1	5.2	2.9	2.4	3.5
Interest Coverage (Operating Cash)	-1.5	13.0	25.8	28.4	30.4	28.2	19.2	18.8
Net Cash after Operations	-1.1	8.7	10.2	13.4	48.9	24.2	16.0	13.4

Industry Tax Structure

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Taxes Paid/Revenue	0.5	0.5	2.5	0.6	0.8	1.3	1.0	1.2

Valuation Multiples

Earnings Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
EV/Revenue	0.7	0.6	0.4	0.5	0.7	0.5	0.6	0.7
EV/EBITDA	6.6	5.9	3.9	5.3	9.2	6.1	6.2	38.1
EV/EBIT	24.4	20.3	5.1	10.1	13.4	9.6	14.7	9.9

Key Ratios

Year	Revenue per Employee ($k)	Revenue per Enterprise ($bn)	Employees per Establishment (Units)	Employees per Enterprise (k)	Average Wage ($k)	Wages/ Revenue (%)	Establishments per Enterprise (Units)	IVA/Revenue (%)
2007	510.1	7.5	293.3	14.7	34.3	6.7	50.1	11.2
2008	378.4	15.9	311.5	42.0	33.1	8.8	135.0	13.8
2009	369.9	24.0	314.7	64.8	32.9	8.9	206.0	13.0
2010	400.7	22.6	293.9	56.3	34.1	8.5	191.5	13.4
2011	419.0	32.8	286.4	78.2	34.3	8.2	273.1	13.2
2012	407.5	18.0	270.0	44.1	34.8	8.5	163.4	13.6
2013	407.7	48.9	275.2	119.9	33.4	8.2	435.7	12.7
2014	411.8	37.4	270.3	90.9	34.7	8.4	336.3	13.0
2015	399.0	33.8	268.9	84.8	35.9	9.0	315.5	13.0
2016	390.0	36.4	278.0	93.2	35.8	9.2	335.4	13.7
2017	393.3	39.1	279.0	99.3	36.3	9.2	355.9	12.1
2018	402.7	39.5	280.1	98.1	37.4	9.3	350.2	13.5
2019	404.6	40.0	274.1	98.9	38.2	9.4	360.9	13.5
2020	416.1	39.4	282.4	94.7	38.2	9.2	335.5	13.4
2021	408.4	40.9	300.6	100.1	38.1	9.3	333.1	14.3
2022	407.2	44.5	308.6	109.3	35.5	8.7	354.1	13.4
2023	425.2	46.8	315.8	110.0	36.7	8.6	348.3	12.8

Year	Revenue per Employee ($k)	Revenue per Enterprise ($bn)	Employees per Establishment (Units)	Employees per Enterprise (k)	Average Wage ($k)	Wages/ Revenue (%)	Establishments per Enterprise (Units)	IVA/Revenue (%)
2024	427.0	47.8	319.1	111.9	36.7	8.6	350.7	12.8
2025	428.2	48.7	322.2	113.7	36.7	8.6	352.9	12.9
2026	428.7	49.5	324.9	115.5	36.7	8.6	355.6	12.9
2027	428.9	50.3	328.1	117.2	36.7	8.6	357.3	12.9
2028	429.1	51.1	330.8	119.0	36.7	8.6	359.6	12.9
2029	429.8	48.8	333.0	113.6	36.7	8.6	341.1	12.9
2030	430.4	49.6	334.8	115.1	36.7	8.5	343.8	12.9
2031	430.9	50.3	336.2	116.8	36.8	8.5	347.4	12.9
2032	431.4	51.1	337.5	118.5	36.8	8.5	351.1	12.9

Key Statistics

Industry Data

Values

Year	Revenue ($m)	IVA ($m)	Establishments (Units)	Enterprises (Units)	Employment (Units)	Wages ($m)
2007	495,007.7	55,279.2	3,308	66	970,321	33,322.7
2008	525,056.4	72,371.3	4,454	33	1,387,411	45,958.4
2009	527,462.3	68,644.3	4,531	22	1,425,930	46,888.0
2010	541,321.2	72,737.1	4,597	24	1,350,864	46,073.1
2011	557,114.1	73,495.2	4,643	17	1,329,609	45,578.5
2012	575,528.0	78,362.2	5,230	32	1,412,175	49,120.3
2013	586,527.5	74,619.8	5,228	12	1,438,580	48,051.8
2014	598,838.1	78,027.3	5,381	16	1,454,239	50,509.0
2015	609,297.0	78,927.4	5,679	18	1,527,210	54,896.7
2016	618,121.8	84,486.1	5,702	17	1,584,912	56,669.8
2017	624,854.7	75,438.0	5,694	16	1,588,736	57,723.6
2018	632,021.0	85,572.6	5,603	16	1,569,558	58,722.3
2019	640,434.0	86,476.9	5,775	16	1,582,798	60,415.1
2020	670,139.6	89,553.0	5,703	17	1,610,492	61,452.1
2021	695,277.7	99,269.4	5,663	17	1,702,516	64,914.6
2022	711,913.3	95,026.5	5,665	16	1,748,344	62,073.8
2023	748,274.0	96,011.0	5,573	16	1,759,712	64,508.1
2024	764,475.9	98,122.0	5,611	16	1,790,292	65,685.9
2025	778,928.3	100,328.8	5,646	16	1,819,103	66,780.2
2026	792,481.2	102,111.1	5,690	16	1,848,727	67,880.8
2027	804,490.6	103,809.5	5,717	16	1,875,652	68,877.4
2028	816,823.5	105,578.8	5,754	16	1,903,593	69,909.4
2029	829,722.7	107,135.7	5,798	17	1,930,687	70,926.2
2030	842,382.0	108,317.7	5,845	17	1,957,008	71,916.2
2031	855,424.0	110,054.1	5,905	17	1,985,203	72,967.8
2032	868,978.4	111,839.6	5,969	17	2,014,246	74,053.0

Annual Change

Year	Revenue (%)	IVA (%)	Establishments (%)	Enterprises (%)	Employment (%)	Wages (%)
2008	6.1	30.9	34.6	-50.0	43.0	37.9
2009	0.5	-5.1	1.7	-33.3	2.8	2.0
2010	2.6	6.0	1.5	9.1	-5.3	-1.7
2011	2.9	1.0	1.0	-29.2	-1.6	-1.1
2012	3.3	6.6	12.6	88.2	6.2	7.8
2013	1.9	-4.8	-0.0	-62.5	1.9	-2.2
2014	2.1	4.6	2.9	33.3	1.1	5.1
2015	1.7	1.2	5.5	12.5	5.0	8.7
2016	1.4	7.0	0.4	-5.6	3.8	3.2
2017	1.1	-10.7	-0.1	-5.9	0.2	1.9
2018	1.1	13.4	-1.6	0.0	-1.2	1.7
2019	1.3	1.1	3.1	0.0	0.8	2.9
2020	4.6	3.6	-1.2	6.3	1.7	1.7
2021	3.8	10.8	-0.7	0.0	5.7	5.6
2022	2.4	-4.3	0.0	-5.9	2.7	-4.4
2023	5.1	1.0	-1.6	0.0	0.7	3.9
2024	2.2	2.2	0.7	0.0	1.7	1.8
2025	1.9	2.2	0.6	0.0	1.6	1.7
2026	1.7	1.8	0.8	0.0	1.6	1.6
2027	1.5	1.7	0.5	0.0	1.5	1.5
2028	1.5	1.7	0.6	0.0	1.5	1.5
2029	1.6	1.5	0.8	6.3	1.4	1.5
2030	1.5	1.1	0.8	0.0	1.4	1.4
2031	1.5	1.6	1.0	0.0	1.4	1.5
2032	1.6	1.6	1.1	0.0	1.5	1.5

Figures are inflation adjusted to 2026-2027

Key Success Factors

Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses overcome volatility?

Control inventory

Managing inventory ensures that products are always available, particularly if the products are highly sought after because of a viral marketing campaign.

Secure a flexible workforce

Like other retail industries, warehouse clubs and supercenters have flexible workforces, which helps stores rotate staff as needed, particularly during extended holiday hours. Many retailers have struggled to maintain sufficient workforce levels in recent years, despite rising minimum wage requirements in many states.

What products or services do successful businesses offer?

Adopt a high-volume, low-margin strategy

Consumers are price-conscious, so warehouse clubs and supercenters will struggle if they have significant price markups. Focusing on a high-volume, low-profit sales strategy is more sustainable.

Supply a diverse range of products

Stores should supply a wide range of products comparable to those of their external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

How do businesses use location to their advantage?

Operate in a highly visible location

Being in a highly visible spot off major roads keeps the store top of mind and easy to find, which can boost spontaneous visits and repeat traffic for big-box formats that rely on very high sales volumes.

Operate in a location that is close to key markets

Proximity to densely populated areas enables retailers to maximize foot traffic and sales. Clear signage, easy access and ample parking space also attract shoppers.

How do successful businesses handle concentration?

Develop a strong reputation

Retailers can improve customer loyalty by developing a strong reputation for quality and price. Customers have many options when choosing between retailers, so a strong reputation will fuel higher revenue.

Leverage economies of scope

With economies of scope, warehouse clubs and supercenters can lower the cost of doing business, which typically translates into lower consumer prices. Given the high degree of market saturation, offering low prices is crucial.

How can potential entrants overcome barriers to entry?

Comply with government regulations

Warehouse clubs and supercenters handle and sell various food items, so they must adhere to a range of policies and regulations. Adhering to these policies can reduce operating expenses and limit exposure to fines.

Develop links with suppliers

Warehouse clubs and supercenters should stock the latest products and offer the widest variety to attract more shoppers and generate repeat business. Developing strong links with suppliers ensures that stores will have access to products.

How do successful businesses compete with substitutes?

Closely monitor the competition

Grocery stores and other substitutes compete on price because of the low level of product differentiation. Retailers must monitor when competitors offer discounts and promotions to avoid losing customers and adjust their own prices or offers in response.

Develop a wide and expanding product range

Retailers should offer a wide range of products comparable to those of external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

How do successful businesses manage buyer & supplier power?

Control distribution arrangements

Retailers compete on value and product offerings. Warehouse clubs and supercenters control their distribution facilities or maintain strict distributor agreements for low prices.

Develop a loyal customer base

Since some stores require paid membership, club stores and supercenters should ensure that consumers' needs are met and feel valued. Otherwise, consumers can easily switch to a competitor.

Call Preparation Questions

Role Specific Questions

Sales & Marketing

Have any products seen significantly increased sales volumes?

- Food and beverages typically make up the largest part of revenue. Warehouse clubs and supercenters rely on sales from all sort of products to remain competitive.

Are your company's sales heavily dependent on the health of the US economy?

- Demand is fairly stable regardless of the health of the overall economy.
- When the economy is strong, low-income earners spend more at industry stores.
- When the economy is weak, high-income consumers turn to supercenters and warehouse clubs in search of a bargain.

Strategy & Operations

Have rising input costs negatively affected your company's sales?

- Rising input costs have a higher impact on profit rather than sales.
- Strong increases in the world price of oil will boost transportation costs and hurt profit.

Do you contract directly with manufacturers to reduce purchase costs?

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters generally have strong buying power as a result of their size. Most stores contract directly with manufacturers, rather than wholesalers, to reduce purchase costs.

Technology

How does your company utilize new technology, like [example: RFID tags, etc.], in its operations?

- Having proper inventory levels is very important in this industry. New technology, including RFID tags, has helped reduce issues with inventory and demand.

How has your company reacted to the rise of online sales in recent years? How have you worked to combat this increased competition?

- While some stores have boosted their online presence in response to high demand for e-commerce, many supercenters have struggled because of growing online sales.

Compliance

Have any regulatory expenses significantly impacted profitability recently?

- While tariff rates impact profitability, no major regulatory change has taken place in recent years.

What does your company do to remain compliant with new consumer regulations?

- Most stores are large enough to have in-house compliance teams. Otherwise, industry associations help support these retailers in regard to compliance.

Finance

How often does your company purchase new equipment? Have you recently been looking to upgrade your stores or distribution centers in any way?

- Technological changes do not strongly impact this industry. Most stores rarely need to purchase new equipment. To remain competitive with e-commerce, many warehouse clubs and supercenters are renovating their stores to incorporate new technology.

How have volatile input prices affected profit in recent years? In what ways have you been able to leverage your economies of scale to secure favorable contracts with suppliers?

- Since the industry resells new goods, profit is directly affected by the price they must pay to upstream manufacturers.

External Impacts Questions

World price of crude oil

Are you able to pass on increasing crude oil prices to your customers in the form of higher gas prices? Does demand for your discounted gasoline increase when the price of gasoline increases?

- Many warehouse clubs and supercenters have gasoline stations that generate a share of revenue. Revenue typically increases when gas prices rise.

Percentage of services conducted online

How does online retail affect your business model? Have you considered changing your revenue model to offer online purchasing?

- An increase in the percentage of services conducted online reflects an increase in the share of consumers who opt to purchase their items online, which siphons revenue from warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Per capita disposable income

What incentives or promotions do you provide to get consumers into your stores, especially when disposable income is low?

- While warehouse clubs and supercenters remain attractive during periods of low disposable income due to their discounted prices, consumers spend less per trip when disposable income is low.

Internal Issues Questions

Having a loyal customer base

What do you do to promote loyalty within your stores? Do you have loyalty or rewards cards?

- Since some stores require paid membership. Warehouse clubs and supercenters should ensure that consumers' needs are met.
- This industry is extremely competitive and stores have limited levels of differentiation.

Ability to control stock on hand

How do you maintain optimum quality control?

- Retailers in this industry need to have stringent control measures to ensure that popular items are reordered, low-selling stock is disposed of and a sufficient product range is available.

Control of distribution

Does your company have close relationships with distributors? How can you make those relationships more secure?

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters compete on value offerings. To maintain low prices, stores often control their own distribution facilities or maintain strict agreements with distributors.

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Warehouse Clubs & Supercenters in the US

Load and behold: Greater use of online channels and strong engagement from middle-income households should support ongoing revenue growth

Taylor Kelly
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About

IBISWorld specializes in industry research with coverage on thousands of global industries. Our **comprehensive data and in-depth analysis** help businesses of all types gain quick and actionable insights on industries around the world. Busy professionals can spend less time researching and preparing for meetings, and more time focused on making strategic business decisions.

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About This Industry

Definition

This industry includes large stores that primarily retail a general line of grocery products and merchandise items (e.g., apparel and appliances). Warehouse clubs offer customers a wide selection of goods, often in bulk and at discounted prices, in exchange for a membership fee paid by each customer. Supercenters are large discount department stores that also sell perishable groceries. However, unlike warehouse clubs, supercenters don't require customers to join.

Codes

NAICS

2022	455211 – Warehouse Clubs and Supercenters
2017	452311 – Warehouse Clubs and Supercenters

ISIC

2006	4711 – Retail sale in non-specialized stores with food, beverages or tobacco predominating

What's Included

- Retailing apparel and accessories
- Retailing food and beverages
- Retailing fuel and other products
- Retailing health, beauty and wellness
- Retailing home and appliance

Companies

- Walmart
- Costco

Related Industries

Domestic industries

Competitors

- Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in the US
- Dollar & Variety Stores in the US
- Home Furnishings Stores in the US
- Department Stores in the US

Complementors

- Convenience Stores in the US

International industries

- Warehouse Clubs & Supercentres in Canada
- Department Stores in the UK
- Department Stores in Australia
- Supermarkets in China
- Supermarkets in Ireland
- Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in Australia
- Supermarkets in the UK
- Department Stores in New Zealand
- Department Stores in Ireland
- Supermarkets, Grocery & Convenience Stores in New Zealand
- Department Stores & Shopping Malls in China

Related Terms

COMPARABLE STORE SALES

A retail measure used to assess the true performance of retail outlets by taking out the effect of new store openings and focusing on the sales growth of existing stores.

HOMOGENEOUS GOODS

Items that are similar among retailers, with little or no differentiation.

LARGE-FORMAT STORE

A retail store that is differentiated by its sheer size and large range of products, including electronics, household goods and other consumer products.

MASS MERCHANDISER

A large retail store that offers a wide range of product categories.

POINT OF SALE (POS)

A system used at checkout in retail stores using computers and cash registers to capture transaction data at the time and place of sale.

RADIO FREQUENCY IDENTIFICATION (RFID)

A technology that tracks products from the time they leave the assembly line to the time they leave the store by releasing continuous signals from a chip.

STOCK KEEPING UNITS (SKUS)

Codes used by retailers to identify the lowest level of product detail.

Additional Resources

- Occupational Safety and Health Administration
- Food Marketing Institute
- International Council of Shopping Centers
- National Retail Federation
- American Apparel and Footwear Association

At a Glance

Revenue		Employees		Businesses	
$792.5bn	2021-26 ↑ 2.7% 2026-31 ↑ 1.5%	1.8m	2021-26 ↑ 1.7% 2026-31 ↑ 1.4%	16	2021-26 ↓ 1.2% 2026-31 ↑ 1.2%
Profit		**Profit Margin**		**Wages**	
$24.6bn	2021-26 ↓ 0.9%	3.1%	2021-26 ↓ 0.6pp	$67.9bn	2021-26 ↑ 0.9% 2026-31 ↑ 1.5%

Five-year growth rates display historic and forecast CAGRs

Major Players

Company	Revenue ($bn)	Market Share (%)
Walmart	510.7	64.5
Costco	213.3	26.9
Other Companies	68.5	8.6

Products & Services

Item	Revenue ($bn)	Market Share (%)
Food and beverages	300.4	37.9
Home and appliances	188.6	23.8
Health, beauty and wellness	145.8	18.4
Fuel and other	118.1	14.9
Apparel and accessories	39.6	5.0

Key External Drivers

Driver	Impact
Percentage of business conducted online	Positive
Population	Positive
Consumer spending	Positive
Per capita disposable income	Positive
Number of households	Positive
Corporate profit	Positive

Key Takeaways

Performance

Private-label expansion is accelerating as budget-conscious shoppers trade down while continuing to buy in bulk. Retailers are capitalizing on this shift by strengthening in-house brands, boosting profit and increasing basket sizes through value-driven assortments.

Warehouse clubs are enhancing membership value to sustain high renewal rates in a more competitive and cost-sensitive environment. They're adding exclusive perks, essential services and personalized offers to reinforce loyalty and justify annual fees.

Strategic partnerships and targeted M&A will become critical for scaling logistics and data capabilities. Collaborations with last-mile and tech providers, alongside acquisitions of AI and cloud platforms, help retailers accelerate innovation without heavy in-house development.

Omnichannel success increasingly depends on turning stores into flexible fulfillment and service hubs. Retailers that integrate logistics, data, and physical locations into a coordinated network will be better positioned to handle fragmented, multi-platform shopping journeys.

Products and Markets

Bulk grocery pricing remains the core traffic driver for warehouse clubs and supercenters. As inflation outpaces income growth, shoppers are shifting toward private labels and bulk staples to stretch budgets, boosting loyalty and accelerating share gains for value-focused formats.

Ancillary services and high-margin add-ons are increasing total basket size and reinforcing customer stickiness. Discount fuel, health and beauty products and convenient in-store services turn routine trips into multi-purpose visits, strengthening membership value and repeat traffic.

Middle-income households anchor sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters by balancing value with selective upgrades. They rely on one-stop trips for essentials and occasional higher-quality items, using bulk savings and broad assortments to stretch budgets without sacrificing choice.

Small businesses provide a steady demand base for warehouse clubs and supercenters through recurring bulk purchases. Their consistent orders for consumables such as paper goods, snacks and cleaning supplies help stabilize volume, even as they trim discretionary spending amid economic pressure.

SWOT

Strengths	High & Steady Barriers to Entry High Revenue per Employee Low Customer Class Concentration Low Imports Low Product/Service Concentration Low Volatility
Weaknesses	High Competition Low & Steady Level of Assistance Low Profit vs. Sector Average
Opportunities	High Revenue Growth (2021-2026) Percentage of business conducted online
Threats	Corporate profit

Industry Structure

Characteristic	Level & Trend
Concentration	High
Barriers to Entry	High Steady
Regulation and Policy	Low Steady
Life Cycle	Mature
Revenue Volatility	Low
Assistance	Low Steady
Competition	High Increasing
Innovation	Low

Executive Summary

Load and behold: Greater use of online channels and strong engagement from middle-income households should support ongoing revenue growth

Warehouse clubs and supercenters have navigated mounting cost volatility, particularly around energy and logistics, while sustaining steady growth through scale and diversified offerings. Strong membership models have helped anchor sales, with recurring fees and high renewal rates reinforcing the value proposition for budget-conscious households facing higher living costs. At the same time, chains have deepened digital engagement, expanding mobile apps, online ordering and personalized promotions to connect omnichannel supply chains with rising expectations for speed and convenience. Stores are also increasingly being reconfigured as multi-use fulfillment hubs, supporting click-and-collect, curbside pickup and same-day delivery, underpinned by growing investment in automation, data-driven inventory management and AI-powered decision tools. Within this model, private-label portfolios play a larger role in driving traffic, offering competitively priced bulk options that resonate with value-seeking shoppers and support resilience. Revenue has been expanding at a CAGR of 2.7% over the past five years and is expected to reach $792.5 billion in 2026, when revenue will climb by an estimated 1.7%.

Despite these topline gains, profit has fallen from its recent peak as merchandise and logistics costs have outpaced retail price growth, compressing percentage profit even as volumes remain high. Retailers have leaned more heavily on private-label assortments and ancillary in-store services to offset this pressure, using higher-margin store brands, fuel operations and service departments to lift basket value and strengthen loyalty without compromising value positioning. Membership income has become an even more critical stabilizer, providing a relatively predictable, high-margin revenue stream that helps absorb cost shocks while allowing leading chains to preserve everyday low prices and selective promotional strategies.

Tightening environmental regulations and broader ESG expectations will reshape logistics, refrigeration choices and disclosure practices, compelling large-format retailers to invest in cleaner fleets, emissions tracking and more sustainable supply chains. To deliver on these requirements while maintaining convenience, retailers are expected to pursue targeted M&A and partnerships in last-mile logistics, cloud-based order management and AI-enabled planning, accelerating the build-out of unified commerce platforms. These moves will likely widen performance gaps, as larger players with deep data pools and capital out-invest smaller rivals, reinforcing high market concentration. As stores evolve into multi-purpose hubs that combine retail, fulfillment and growing health and wellness services, including pharmacy-based programs linked to GLP-1 medications, private labels will remain central to value, differentiation and shopper retention. Over the next five years, revenue is forecast to grow at a CAGR of 1.5%, reaching $855.4 billion in 2031.

Performance

Key Takeaways

Private-label expansion is accelerating as budget-conscious shoppers trade down while continuing to buy in bulk. Retailers are capitalizing on this shift by strengthening in-house brands, boosting profit and increasing basket sizes through value-driven assortments.

Warehouse clubs are enhancing membership value to sustain high renewal rates in a more competitive and cost-sensitive environment. They're adding exclusive perks, essential services and personalized offers to reinforce loyalty and justify annual fees.

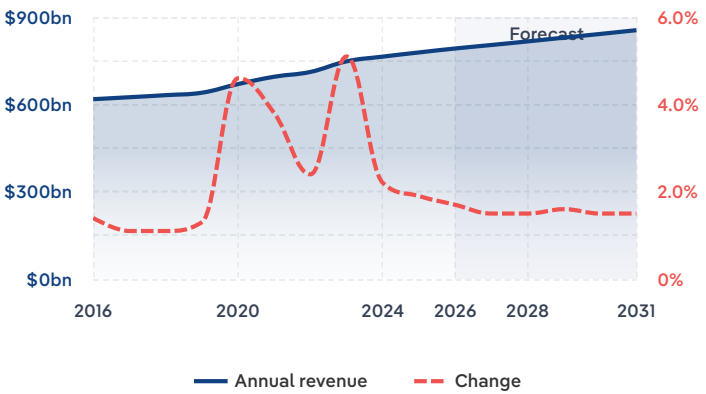
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Omnichannel success increasingly depends on turning stores into flexible fulfillment and service hubs. Retailers that integrate logistics, data, and physical locations into a coordinated network will be better positioned to handle fragmented, multi-platform shopping journeys.

Performance Snapshot

Revenue

Total value ($) and annual change from 2016 – 2031. Includes 5-year outlook.



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Revenue

$792.5bn

2021-26 ↑ 2.7%

2026-31 ↑ 1.5%

2026 Revenue Growth

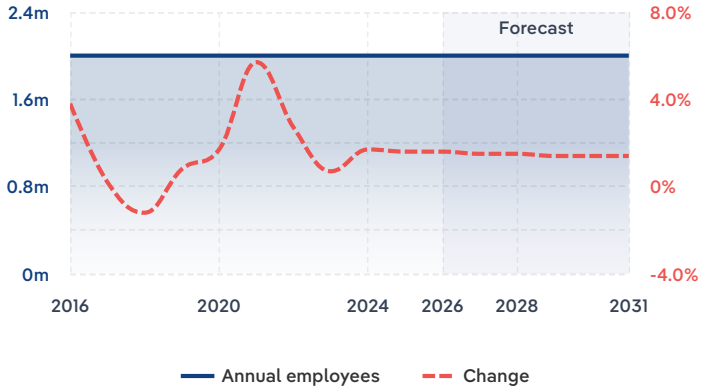
1.7% ↑ Increasing

Revenue Volatility

Low

Employees

Total number of employees and annual change from 2016 – 2031. Includes 5-year outlook.



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

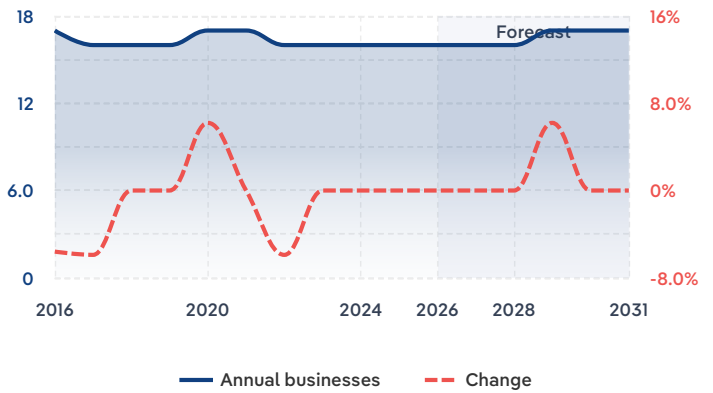
Employees
1.8m
2021-26 ↑ 1.7%
2026-31 ↑ 1.4%

Employees per Business
115.5k
2021-26 ↑ 2.9%
2026-31 ↑ 0.2%

Revenue per Employee
$428.7k
2021-26 ↑ 1.0%
2026-31 ↑ 0.1%

Businesses

Total number of businesses and annual change from 2016 – 2031. Includes 5-year outlook.



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

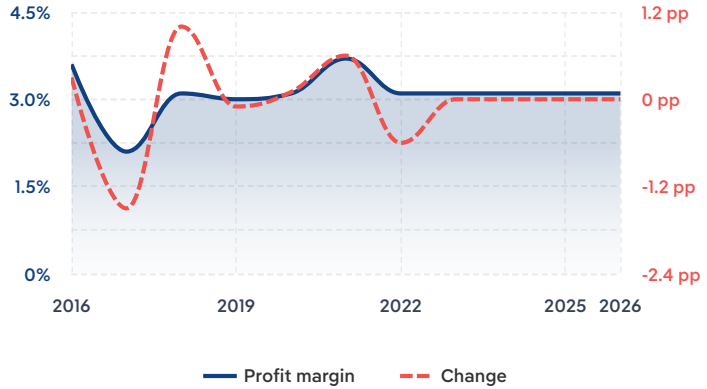
Businesses
16
2021-26 ↓ 1.2%
2026-31 ↑ 1.2%

Employees per Business
115.5k
2021-26 ↑ 2.9%
2026-31 ↑ 0.2%

Revenue per Business
$49.5bn
2021-26 ↑ 3.9%
2026-31 ↑ 0.3%

Profit Margin

Total profit margin (%) and annual change from 2016 – 2026



Total Profit

$24.6bn

2021-26 ↓ 0.9%

Profit Margin

3.1% 2021-26 ↓ 0.6pp

Profit per Business

$1.5bn

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Current Performance

↑2021-26 Revenue CAGR: 2.7%

What's driving current industry performance?

Retailers build omnichannel supply chains to match rising expectations for convenience

- The popularity of online shopping has significantly influenced warehouse clubs and supercenters. Consumers increasingly prefer ordering online, leading these stores to enhance their digital presence and operations. They have invested heavily in e-commerce platforms, building user-friendly websites and mobile apps to attract and retain customers. This shift in preferences requires retailers to balance bulk-purchase formats with rising expectations for convenience, speed and digital engagement.
- According to a 2024 Deloitte study, almost seven in ten consumers are more likely to buy from a business that offers personalized mobile experiences. This underscores how digital engagement and customization are now critical in shaping customer loyalty and sales growth. Retailers increasingly use data from apps and online channels to tailor offers, refine assortments and target promotions to specific customers, strengthening loyalty while boosting the profitability of digital channels.
- To compete with pure online retailers like Amazon, many companies now offer curbside pickup and same-day delivery. These services offer greater convenience and help capture the rising demand for quick, flexible fulfillment. However, a Harris Poll survey conducted for Quad found that 71.0% of shoppers feel in-store visits enhance their relationship with a brand. This signals that retailers must invest in both digital and physical channels so that each complements the other.
- Companies are also changing distribution and fulfillment strategies to align inventory, delivery options and store networks with e-commerce habits. Walmart is redesigning closed Sam's Club locations into fulfillment centers for online sales and modernizing them to support omnichannel retail. Leading companies are also using their physical locations to support online order fulfillment, as seen by Costco, improving delivery speed and integrating digital and in-store experiences.
- These operational changes reflect growing emphasis on e-commerce flexibility and speed, encouraging physical stores to adopt robust omnichannel strategies. Companies that fail to adapt risk losing share to more agile competitors. Ongoing digital transformation will push retailers to merge physical scale with technological agility to deliver seamless experiences across channels. Those that successfully integrate these capabilities will be best positioned to sustain a competitive edge.

Shoppers are trading down to private labels while buying in bulk to manage household budgets

- Unfavorable economic conditions have driven more shoppers toward private-label products, which offer quality comparable to name brands at lower prices. Warehouse clubs and supercenters have responded by expanding their own private-label assortments to include a broader mix of organic, specialty and everyday essentials that can stand alongside mainstream brands. Focusing on private labels helps retailers capture a larger share of the value chain, supporting profitability even as consumers look for ways to cut spending.
- As household budgets tighten, the appeal of affordable alternatives has remained strong, prompting additional investment in developing and promoting house brands. Costco and Walmart feature highly recognizable in-house lines. According to a 2024 article from Numerator, Walmart has the top five private-label brands in the US, measured by US household market penetration, through its Great Value, Equate, Mainstays, Marketside and Freshness Guaranteed brands. Each of these brands has a household penetration rate of at least 67.0%, meaning that at least

two-thirds of households have tried them.

- Private-label products also fit naturally with bulk sales, enabling shoppers to trade down on brand while still buying up on quantity to lower per-unit costs. In supercenters, this has contributed to higher basket sizes as consumers stock up on private-label staples and household goods. Foot traffic has remained resilient as shoppers seek one-stop locations where they can stretch budgets across multiple categories.
- In turn, falling consumer confidence and mixed economic signals have prompted retailers to lean more heavily on private labels to keep value-conscious shoppers engaged. As shoppers become more cautious, they're increasingly willing to try store brands if they trust the retailer's quality standards and pricing strategy. Companies that diversify private-label lines, emphasize value-led pricing and invest in branding and packaging have become better positioned to win share from national brands and boost profit

Warehouse clubs are upgrading member benefits to protect renewal rates amid rising competition

- Membership-based warehouse clubs like Costco and Sam's Club have seen growth in membership sign-ups and renewals, driven partly by the perceived value members receive. Costco reports roughly 145.2 million members, citing membership income as a primary driver of profit growth, as it provides a stable, higher-value revenue stream. These fees help clubs offer consistently low merchandise prices, making membership a central pillar of their business strategy and competitive positioning.
- Economic uncertainty and higher living costs have made shoppers more selective about which memberships they keep, forcing them to weigh annual fees against everyday savings. At the same time, Costco's renewal rate of about 92.3% across the US and Canada shows that many households still view club memberships as essential tools for managing their budgets, indicating that members believe ongoing savings and benefits clearly outweigh the cost of staying enrolled.
- In response, these clubs have expanded exclusive member benefits, including discounts, special events and personalized offers, to retain and attract members. Costco's $1.50 hot dog combo meal and $4.99 rotisserie chicken are iconic deals that signal a member-first value promise and foster strong trust in the brand, with some shoppers visiting primarily for food offerings. Additional services, such as optical, pharmacy and travel departments, further embed these retailers in members' everyday routines and deepen the perceived value of staying loyal.
- While memberships help strengthen store patronage, they also raise expectations for service, product quality and convenience. Customers will cancel if they don't view the membership as worthwhile, pushing companies to continuously update and enhance benefits, services and digital features to stand out from competitors. Even so, the membership model allows these retailers to offer competitive prices while generating profitable, recurring revenue streams, making it increasingly attractive in a fluctuating retail market.
- Membership requirements can also help reduce common store issues. Consumers who pay for a membership and scan a personalized card before entry are generally less likely to steal, cause disruptions or treat the store carelessly. The added accountability helps hold customers to a higher standard, improving overall operational efficiency. Warehouse clubs that deliver elevated experiences while maintaining low prices are actively sustaining high renewal rates and pulling new members away from competing formats in an increasingly crowded retail landscape.

The conflict in Iran is amplifying global oil volatility and complicating cost planning

- The conflict in Iran has caused extensive damage to energy and transport infrastructure, including export terminals, pipelines and refining assets, while sharply disrupting regional oil and gas exports. Flows of crude and petroleum liquids through the Strait of Hormuz have fallen by nearly 30.0%, according to the Institute for Energy Research, with the route effectively closed to most tanker traffic. These disruptions have pushed oil prices substantially higher and raised concerns about a prolonged period of elevated energy costs.
- According to the US Energy Information Administration, shipments passing through the Strait of Hormuz in 2024 and the first quarter of 2025 accounted for more than one-quarter of all seaborne oil traded worldwide and roughly one-fifth of global oil and petroleum products consumed globally. Since Iran has effectively closed this vital passageway to most tanker traffic, concerns about heightened inflation risks and complicated planning for energy-intensive businesses have arisen.
- Disruptions to shipping and energy flows linked to the Iran conflict will likely embed a risk premium into global oil and gas prices, raising shipping, heating and electricity costs for large-format retailers. Extended volatility may prompt warehouse clubs and supercenters to pursue more energy-efficient investments, lock in longer-term utility and transportation contracts and reevaluate fuel sourcing strategies to stabilize operating expenses despite unsettled markets.
- Many warehouse club and supercenter locations sell gasoline and may face additional pressure on fuel economics if wholesale prices climb faster than they can adjust retail pump rates. However, because many of these retailers sell gas to boost in-store traffic and already see relatively low per-gallon earnings, they may be somewhat better positioned to absorb short-term price fluctuations. This model may leave them somewhat better positioned to absorb short-term price spikes while focusing on controlling broader operating costs.
- Retailers are likely to focus on maintaining operational efficiency while using targeted pricing and promotions to boost customer traffic amid higher fuel and energy costs. Those that can manage volatility through smarter contracting, efficiency upgrades and disciplined fuel pricing will be better placed to preserve performance. In contrast, companies that rely heavily on energy-intensive operations without mitigation strategies may see more pronounced pressure on expenses.

Retailers are modernizing backroom operations with automation to enhance efficiency

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters are under growing pressure to upgrade outdated systems as e-commerce expands and digital-first competitors scale up. Automation and AI-enabled tools enable retailers to improve customer experiences while optimizing inventory management and labor allocation. These technologies help large-format stores handle rising volumes more efficiently, maintain consistent

service levels and control operating costs as they continue to add staff and manage sizable workforces.

- Robotics, automated storage and enhanced picking systems for high-volume orders are helping retailers streamline repetitive tasks and boost productivity per order. Innovations such as automated guided vehicles, drones and automated sorting systems enable faster, more accurate order fulfillment while lowering handling costs. For instance, Walmart's Alphabot system uses small robots in fulfillment areas to locate products and pack them after a sale, accelerating processing and standardizing quality.
- AI is also reshaping the customer-facing side of warehouse clubs and supercenters. By analyzing transaction histories, app activity and in-store behavior, AI tools help retailers predict demand, reduce stockouts and tailor promotions more precisely to local preferences. These systems support customized product recommendations and dynamic pricing, allowing shoppers to see more relevant offers and assortments without changing the underlying bulk-purchase model.
- Taken together, automation and AI are pushing warehouse clubs and supercenters to reconfigure store layouts, backroom operations and fulfillment workflows around technology. Retailers that invest aggressively in automated picking, smart replenishment and AI-driven decision support can lift productivity and improve consistency, while those that move slowly risk falling behind more technologically advanced competitors.

Outlook

↑2026-31 Revenue CAGR: 1.5%

What's driving the industry outlook?

Retailers will pursue targeted M&A and partnerships to strengthen logistics and data systems

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters are expected to move from simply adding digital channels to building truly unified commerce systems, where stores, apps and delivery platforms operate as one connected network. Instead of treating online growth as a standalone goal, leading chains are increasingly focused on using omnichannel setups to improve service reliability, personalize offers and tighten cost control.
- Online and mobile shopping will keep gaining share, but the more important shift is how orders are routed and fulfilled. Physical locations are evolving into multi-use hubs that handle in-store shopping, click-and-collect, curbside pickup and same-day delivery from the same footprint. This trend will push larger brands to deepen ties with last-mile specialists and logistics tech companies, using AI-driven routing and real-time inventory visibility to balance speed against fulfillment costs.
- Warehouse clubs and supercenters will increasingly choose delivery and technology partners that can share granular customer and operational data to feed personalization engines, dynamic pricing tools and retail media networks. For instance, Costco has broadened its last-mile delivery footprint by maintaining long-standing partnerships with Instacart and deepening its collaboration with Uber Eats, helping expand its service coverage and curb unnecessary capital expenditures.
- Future M&A deals are likely to prioritize AI-enabled logistics, cloud-based order management and advanced data infrastructure, allowing chains to plug in capabilities such as predictive inventory, autonomous supply-chain control and real-time promise dates for delivery and pickup. This approach shortens the development timeline for complex tech, supports the rollout of new fulfillment formats and strengthens competitive positioning against digital-native marketplaces and emerging AI shopping agents.
- These trends suggest omnichannel success now depends on orchestration, with partnerships and acquisitions accelerating unified, AI-driven commerce. Chains that can turn stores into flexible fulfillment hubs, leverage partner networks for last-mile delivery and absorb specialized tech through M&A will be better placed to sustain growth as shopping journeys fragment across apps, social platforms and emerging AI interfaces.

Automation and AI will widen performance gaps between chains

- Advanced automation and AI tools will likely reinforce the scale advantages of the largest warehouse clubs and supercenters. Walmart and Costco account for over 90.0% of the market, with the remaining 10.0% controlled by about a dozen others. These major players' ability to invest heavily in robotics, AI-driven forecasting and sophisticated data platforms will help them keep lowering unit costs and tightening execution across stores, warehouses and digital channels.
- These technology programs are expected to support more efficient omnichannel models. As the largest chains integrate AI into inventory management, labor planning, pricing and personalized promotions, they can run leaner operations while using member and transaction data to drive higher basket sizes and stronger conversion online. Over time, this will deepen the link between scale, data richness and performance in the industry.
- Smaller banners and regional formats are likely to pursue more limited, plug-and-play solutions. Many will adopt off-the-shelf analytics tools, third-party fulfillment apps and basic automation to improve staffing and inventory, but they typically lack the data depth, in-house expertise and capital needed for fully customized systems. This narrows, but does not erase, the efficiency and customer-experience gap with the largest chains.
- As technology spending and data capabilities concentrate among a handful of national brands, the market structure is expected to remain highly consolidated. Membership models and large first-party data pools will give leading chains an advantage when deploying new AI tools and monetizing insights, supporting sustained growth and resilience. However, less resourced competitors risk falling further behind on cost efficiency, service quality and digital engagement.

Regulations and shopper preferences will drive greener business models

- Regulation is becoming a central driver of how warehouse clubs and supercenters manage logistics and environmental risk. Indirect source rules targeting large warehouses and logistics hubs, including measures such as California's Rule 2305 and similar proposals in states such as Colorado, New Jersey and New York City, make facilities partly responsible for tracking and reducing air pollution from truck traffic serving their sites. This will push companies toward cleaner fleets, routing changes and potentially redesigned footprints.
- Climate-related disclosure and supply chain ESG laws are also raising the bar. California's SB 253 Climate Corporate Data Accountability Act and companion SB 261 will require large businesses operating in the state, including major retailers above specified revenue thresholds, to report Scope 1, Scope 2 and eventually Scope 3 greenhouse gas emissions, increasing transparency around direct operations and value-chain impacts. These rules are expected to influence how chains measure emissions, prioritize efficiency projects and engage suppliers on climate performance.
- Refrigerant policy is expected to remain a source of uncertainty for warehouse clubs and supercenters. The hydrofluorocarbon phase-down under the AIM Act continues, but recent EPA actions under President Trump have relaxed and delayed parts of the Technology Transitions and related rules, extending deadlines and broadening allowable refrigerant choices to lower near-term costs. Retailers will still need to plan for eventual shifts to lower-impact systems, but with longer compliance horizons and more flexibility in how they stage upgrades.
- As these regulatory pressures build, warehouse clubs and supercenters are likely to work more closely with suppliers and logistics partners to redesign packaging, reformulate products and expand lines with verified sustainability certifications, while improving data and reporting systems to support credible environmental claims and avoid greenwashing risk. Chains that adapt their product mixes, logistics and disclosure practices to this evolving framework will be better positioned to maintain trust and capture segments of environmentally minded shoppers across both store and digital channels.

Private-label offerings will support resilience in changing economic conditions

- One of the core appeals of warehouse clubs and supercenters is their low unit prices on everyday essentials, and this is expected to remain central even as disposable income and consumer confidence improve. Value-seeking shoppers are likely to continue favoring private labels over some national brands, making store brands a more important lever for protecting traffic and basket size without relying solely on manufacturer promotions.
- Price differences between private labels and national brands are likely to underpin this shift. According to 2025 Numerator data, the price gap between store brands and national brands has widened by about 38.0% since 2019. This widening gap strengthens the value proposition of private labels and reinforces warehouse clubs' and supercenters' incentives to expand, promote and refine their own-brand portfolios for cost-conscious shoppers.
- Because Walmart and Costco already control the vast majority of sales, private-label development will remain highly concentrated among a small number of national chains. These players can use their scale and member data to segment store brands into different value tiers, introduce more on-trend items and tailor formulations, packaging and branding to specific shopper groups. Smaller banners will likely focus their own-brand efforts on a narrower set of categories where they can more clearly differentiate.
- As social-media-driven taste shifts, younger shoppers' preferences are expected to encourage faster refresh cycles and more experimentation in private labels. Warehouse clubs and supercenters that test collaborations, influencer-linked ranges and limited-time offerings within their store brands have the potential to help their private-label lines capture a greater share of spending while deepening loyalty to the retailer itself, not just to individual products.

Integrated health services will draw visitors beyond traditional grocery needs

- Health and wellness services, including pharmacy and optical care, are expected to become a more important reason for visiting warehouse clubs and supercenters. As these offerings expand, stores will increasingly function as one-stop destinations where shoppers fill prescriptions, manage chronic conditions, get eye exams and then pick up selected groceries or household items, even when they are not making a full food shop.
- GLP-1 medications are reinforcing this shift toward one-stop visits. As more people use these drugs, some households are changing what and how much they buy, prioritizing more intentional, health-oriented choices. In-store pharmacies and wellness teams can respond by offering tailored guidance and programs for GLP-1 users and by steering them toward suitable foods, supplements and health-adjacent products during the same trip.
- Large chains are already building GLP-1-linked weight-management services around their pharmacies. Costco has partnered with telehealth platform Sesame to offer members a subscription program that includes virtual clinical visits, lab work and access to GLP-1 prescriptions, while Walmart is expanding its Better Care Services to combine GLP-1 access, virtual care and nutrition support. These initiatives position pharmacies as anchors for broader health journeys that connect medicine, food and wellness.
- Smaller banners and clubs without pharmacy infrastructure are likely to feel GLP-1-related changes more directly through shifting food baskets. They may see lighter volumes in certain categories but have less ability to offset this with health services or targeted clinical programs. In contrast, large warehouse clubs and supercenters can use their pharmacies, optical centers and broader wellness offerings to anchor one-stop visits, cross-sell and stabilize overall spending as shopper behavior evolves.

Volatility

Low

What influences industry volatility?

Revenue is cushioned by everyday household spending

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters get most of their sales from everyday essentials like food and beverages, home and appliance items and health, beauty and wellness products. These are things people need regardless of economic conditions, so sales stay fairly steady. Because of that, sales tend to follow predictable patterns, avoiding big spikes or sharp declines and keeping overall revenue relatively stable.
- Since these products are frequently purchased and need to be restocked regularly, wholesalers benefit from a steady stream of transactions throughout the year rather than relying on occasional large purchases. This consistent buying behavior makes revenue less sensitive to short-term changes in consumer confidence and helps keep year-over-year growth relatively even, even after adjusting for inflation.

The dominance of two large brands stabilizes revenue

- Walmart and Costco together account for over 90.0% of sales in warehouse clubs and supercenters, meaning overall revenue mainly reflects the performance of these two very large, mature companies. Their scale, membership models and broad customer reach support steady year-over-year growth, helping the segment avoid sharp ups and downs in total revenue.
- Because these two chains set the tone on pricing, promotions and product ranges, conditions across the segment change gradually rather than suddenly. Smaller businesses tend to follow their lead, typically leading to fewer abrupt competitive shocks or large share price swings. This concentrated structure makes market-wide revenue behave more predictably and contributes to low measured volatility.

Blue Chip

Industry volatility vs. revenue growth (2021-2026 CAGR)



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

☆ Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses overcome volatility?

Control inventory

Managing inventory ensures that products are always available, particularly if the products are highly sought after because of a viral marketing campaign.

Secure a flexible workforce

Like other retail industries, warehouse clubs and supercenters have flexible workforces, which helps stores rotate staff as needed, particularly during extended holiday hours. Many retailers have struggled to maintain sufficient workforce levels in recent years, despite rising minimum wage requirements in many states.

Life Cycle

Mature

Life Cycle

Indication of the industry's stage in its life cycle compared to similar industries



*Growth is based on change in share of economy combined with change in establishment numbers

IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Why is the industry mature?

Contribution to GDP

Warehouse clubs and supercenters now grow roughly in line with the broader US economy, which is what you'd expect from a mature stage. Revenue is still rising, but gains are modest, so the focus has shifted to squeezing more efficiency and value out of existing large-format stores.

Market Saturation

Retailers are deeply embedded in many urban and suburban markets, with big-box clubs and supercenters already serving most high-traffic areas. New sites exist but are harder to find and justify at scale, so growth leans more on remodeling, format tweaks and share gains within markets that already have strong coverage.

Innovation

Most breakthrough product innovation now happens at the manufacturing level, where new brands and categories are developed. Retailers in this space innovate mainly around how they sell, such as refining private labels, adjusting pack sizes, improving merchandising and experimenting with services like pharmacy, fuel and health offerings that deepen customer relationships.

Consolidation

The landscape for warehouse clubs and supercenters is already dominated by a few large players, so consolidation is less about big roll-up waves and more about targeted moves. Leading chains occasionally acquire regional banners or specific locations to strengthen coverage, but large-scale deals are limited, and smaller retailers still find it hard to gain meaningful share.

Technology and Systems

Warehouse clubs and supercenters face steady pressure from e-commerce and direct-to-consumer models that offer comparable products without a store visit. Leading chains respond by expanding omnichannel capabilities tailored to bulk and big-basket trips, including curbside pickup, scheduled delivery and more feature-rich mobile apps designed around the warehouse shopping experience.

Products and Markets

Key Takeaways

Bulk grocery pricing remains the core traffic driver for warehouse clubs and supercenters. As inflation outpaces income growth, shoppers are shifting toward private labels and bulk staples to stretch budgets, boosting loyalty and accelerating share gains for value-focused formats.

Ancillary services and high-margin add-ons are increasing total basket size and reinforcing customer stickiness. Discount fuel, health and beauty products and convenient in-store services turn routine trips into multi-purpose visits, strengthening membership value and repeat traffic.

Middle-income households anchor sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters by balancing value with selective upgrades. They rely on one-stop trips for essentials and occasional higher-quality items, using bulk savings and broad assortments to stretch budgets without sacrificing choice.

Small businesses provide a steady demand base for warehouse clubs and supercenters through recurring bulk purchases. Their consistent orders for consumables such as paper goods, snacks and cleaning supplies help stabilize volume, even as they trim discretionary spending amid economic pressure.

Largest Market

$300.4bn

Food and beverages

Product Innovation

Low

Products and Services

How are the industry's products and services performing?

Bulk grocery deals keep value-focused shoppers coming back

- Food and beverages are often the primary draw for consumers, particularly larger families, who visit warehouse clubs and supercenters to access bulk discounts and everyday deals on staples. The segment spans snack foods, beverages, meat, produce, dairy, frozen food and deli items sold at lower per-unit prices, encouraging shoppers to stock up on high-frequency consumables and supporting value-focused wholesale formats.
- Businesses and households, especially cost-conscious shoppers, rely on these stores to buy everyday goods in bulk and secure predictable savings on items they purchase regularly. With consumer prices rising faster than per-capita disposable income since 2021, many have redirected more of their grocery budgets toward value-oriented formats and in-house brands that help stretch paychecks further.
- Sales for Costco's Kirkland Signature brand are estimated to have climbed by more than 50.0% between 2021 and 2025, showing how inflation has nudged shoppers toward retail-owned labels that deliver national-brand quality at lower unit prices. As more consumers focus on total basket cost rather than specific logos, warehouse clubs and supercenters with strong private-label programs are capturing a larger share of everyday grocery spending.

Retailers focus on curated home goods to attract budget-conscious households

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters offer a broad assortment of home goods and appliances, including furniture, electronics, bed and bath products, and home décor. Intensifying competition from online retailers such as Amazon and Wayfair has pushed these operators to expand e-commerce and delivery capabilities. For example, Costco Logistics, which handles large, bulky deliveries and also removes old furniture, reports strong growth in online orders for sofas, saunas and oversized home goods.
- Major brands are additionally using private-label and curated assortments to strengthen their position in home goods. Walmart's Mainstays brand focuses on affordable furniture and home essentials, while earlier acquisitions such as Hayneedle and new online furniture labels have helped it offer trendier pieces at lower prices. Costco has broadened its furniture and décor range, promoting high-end items at warehouse prices and using limited-run assortments to draw more home-focused shoppers.

Health and beauty assortments help retailers capture more basket spend

- The health, beauty and wellness segment includes over-the-counter drugs, health aids, cosmetics and everyday personal-care items such as shampoos and lotions. Awareness has risen as consumers adopt a more holistic view of well-being that links appearance, preventive health and self-care routines. These products are often add-ons or impulse buys, but competitive pricing on necessities makes them attractive to buy at warehouse clubs and supercenters.
- This shift has boosted interest in items that promise both cosmetic

benefits and functional outcomes, from stress relief and better sleep to improved skin or hair health. Customers are often willing to pay a premium for products perceived to slow aging or address common ailments, especially when brands emphasize clean ingredients, ethical sourcing and transparent formulations that balance quality with value. That mix of necessity and perceived upgrade makes health and beauty a useful loyalty builder.

Fuel and ancillary services strengthen brands' value proposition

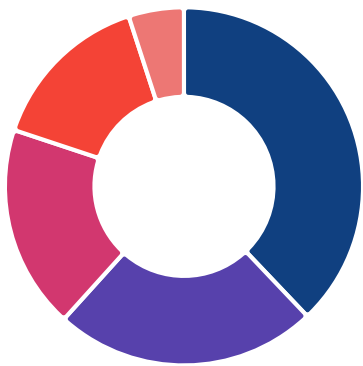
- A growing emphasis on convenience has led many warehouse clubs and supercenters to expand fuel and other ancillary services alongside their core merchandise, helping them become more like one-stop shops. Members can fill their tanks, pick up prescriptions, visit in-store optical shops and buy pet supplies and tobacco in the same trip. These services deepen the value of membership and make clubs a practical stop for everyday errands, not just bulk grocery runs.
- One of the main revenue drivers within the product segment is fuel. In fiscal year 2025, Costco sold 8.2 billion gallons of fuel worldwide and opened 27 new and 24 expanded gas stations. As ongoing geopolitical tensions with Iran drive gas prices higher, consumers are increasingly seeking outlets that offer consistently lower gas prices and reliable availability, making warehouse clubs' discounted fuel and extended hours a strong draw for value-focused drivers.

Warehouse clubs and supercenters blend licensed brands with everyday apparel basics

- The apparel and accessories segment includes a mix of in-house and national brands of clothing, shoes and accessories for women, men and children. Many shoppers are happy to buy clothing in bulk when they can stock up on everyday basics at low prices. Costco works directly with manufacturers and brand owners, such as Adidas, through licensing and "made-for-club" lines, while Walmart relies on private labels and curated ranges to deliver value.
- Social media and rapid trend cycles can quickly boost a particular item's popularity, so retailers need to adjust assortments fast to capture short-lived fashion demand. Fast-fashion dynamics also encourage purchases of costume jewelry and lower-priced, trend-driven apparel that reflect current styles. In parallel, more frequent assortment refreshes tend to lift inventory and sourcing costs, forcing bulk-oriented formats to balance trend responsiveness with tight product ranges and low everyday prices.

Products & Services Segmentation

Industry revenue in 2026 broken down by key product and service lines.



Food and beverages ($300.4bn) 37.9%
Home and appliances ($188.6bn) 23.8%
Health, beauty and wellness ($145.8bn) 18.4%
Fuel and other ($118.1bn) 14.9%
Apparel and accessories ($39.6bn) 5.0%

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

☆ Key Success Factors

What products or services do successful businesses offer?

Adopt a high-volume, low-margin strategy

Consumers are price-conscious, so warehouse clubs and supercenters will struggle if they have significant price markups. Focusing on a high-volume, low-profit sales strategy is more sustainable.

Supply a diverse range of products

Stores should supply a wide range of products comparable to those of their external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

Innovations

Low

What are innovations in industry products and services?

Digital upgrades reshape how members shop and receive goods

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters are turning large-format stores into omnichannel hubs by layering curbside pickup, same-day delivery and ship-to-home options onto their bulk, in-person model. Mobile apps and websites now feature richer product content, digital coupons and membership tools, making it easier for shoppers to research big-ticket items and everyday essentials and choose how they want orders fulfilled.
- These digital upgrades are increasingly paired with personalized offers based on past baskets and trip patterns. Targeted promotions on groceries, TVs, appliances and add-on services (such as installation or extended warranties) help nudge members toward higher-value baskets while keeping the experience simple. These tools continue to reshape how members discover, buy and receive products, making the overall service proposition feel more modern and flexible.

Major Markets

What's influencing demand from the industry's markets?

Middle-income households balance value and selective upgrades at clubs and supercenters

- Households earning between $40,000 and $125,000 make up a large share of the US population, so they naturally account for the largest share of sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters. These shoppers lean on large formats to cover groceries, household basics and selective discretionary items in a single trip, balancing careful budgeting with occasional upgrades in product quality and assortment.
- These store formats are deliberately designed around these car-owning, middle-income households. Warehouse clubs emphasize bulk packs, unit-price savings and membership perks for planned stock-up trips, while supercenters provide broad assortments and in-store services for more routine shopping. Together, they give this segment a convenient way to consolidate spending with a few large brands that can meet most weekly needs.

Affluent households drive big-ticket purchases at warehouse clubs and supercenters

- Households with incomes over $125,000 account for nearly a third of sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters, providing a resilient base for higher-value categories. Higher incomes make it easier to commit to larger stock-up baskets, so many affluent shoppers lean on clubs for bulk essentials and premium foods, while still seeking value through curated assortments, loyalty rewards and selective upgrades in categories such as electronics or wellness.
- Within this market, warehouse clubs tend to capture a greater share of primary grocery and household trips, whereas supercenters often play a complementary role for convenience missions and services. Membership perks, like cashback rewards, exclusive product tiers and fuel savings, reinforce clubs' appeal to affluent households. This encourages these households to purchase big-ticket items such as TVs, computers and household appliances through these formats, lifting average transaction sizes.

Lower-income households emphasize essentials and trade down in response to budget pressure

- Shoppers from households with incomes below $40,000 contribute a smaller but still meaningful share of sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters. They focus spending on groceries and household necessities, often trading down to private labels and lower-priced assortments when budgets tighten. In many communities, supercenters also function as one of the few full-line food retailers nearby, making them a critical resource in areas with constrained grocery access.
- Membership fees at warehouse clubs can be difficult for this market to justify, pushing many lower-income households toward supercenters and other non-membership formats for everyday trips. At the same time, expanded food assortments at dollar stores and

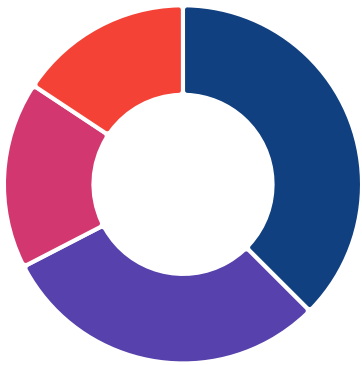
smaller value chains intensify competition for low-cost grocery missions, encouraging these shoppers to fragment their baskets across retailers that offer the sharpest perceived savings and manageable pack sizes, which can soften sales at larger formats.

Warehouse clubs and supercenters function as practical sourcing hubs for small businesses

- The business segment includes restaurants, offices, salons, child care centers, schools, motels and other enterprises that rely on warehouse clubs and supercenters for recurring supplies. These customers place larger, repeat orders for paper goods, cleaning products, snacks and basic ingredients, using bulk packs and lower unit prices to manage inventory efficiently and keep operating costs under control.
- Many large-format retailers also offer tax-exempt and resale purchasing privileges, which further enhance their appeal to budget-conscious businesses. This segment helps smooth sales by linking purchasing to ongoing operations and staff needs, though smaller businesses still respond quickly to economic pressure by emphasizing private-label essentials and trimming less critical premium purchases. Even so, their predictable purchasing patterns underpin steady volume in fast-moving consumables and help stabilize sales across nonfood categories.

Major Markets Segmentation

Industry revenue in 2026 broken down by key markets



- Households with incomes between $40,000 and $125,000 ($297.2bn) 37.5%
- Households with incomes above $125,000 ($237.0bn) 29.9%
- Households with incomes below $40,000 ($133.9bn) 16.9%
- Businesses ($124.4bn) 15.7%

IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

International Trade

No data

Some industries don't directly import or export goods. See reports at the manufacturing level for international trade data on relevant products.

Geographic Breakdown

Key Takeaways

The Southeast stands out as a prime expansion zone for warehouse clubs and supercenters thanks to fast suburban growth and business-friendly policies. Retailers benefit from easier approvals, lower development costs and strong value-driven demand that supports rapid network scaling.

The Great Lakes region offers a stable, logistics-driven environment that sustains consistent demand for large-format retail. Dense freight networks and cost-conscious middle-income households make it efficient to operate while ensuring steady bulk-buying behavior across metro and suburban markets.

The West attracts warehouse club businesses with its mix of high incomes, car-oriented lifestyles and established big-box retail culture. Strong purchasing power and familiarity with membership models help sustain large basket sizes and reinforce long-term investment in the region.

Business Locations

State	Establishments (Units)	Establishments (%)	Revenue ($bn)	Revenue (%)	Wages ($m)	Wages (%)	Employment (k)	Employment (%)	Population (%)
Alabama	92	1.6	14.8	1.9	887.6	1.3	32,402	1.8	1.5
Alaska	18	0.3	3.9	0.5	246.8	0.4	6,904	0.4	0.2
Arizona	144	2.5	26.4	3.3	2,005.6	3.0	48,289	2.6	2.2
Arkansas	66	1.2	7.3	0.9	680.2	1.0	25,041	1.4	0.9
California	568	10.0	85.3	10.8	7,938.7	11.7	171,927	9.3	11.5
Colorado	117	2.1	22.9	2.9	1,447.5	2.1	35,428	1.9	1.8
Connecticut	53	0.9	7.6	1.0	636.6	0.9	15,542	0.8	1.1
Delaware	18	0.3	2.5	0.3	131.5	0.2	4,200	0.2	0.3
Florida	399	7.0	58.3	7.4	4,166.6	6.1	118,980	6.4	7.0
Georgia	182	3.2	14.0	1.8	2,031.6	3.0	58,784	3.2	3.3
Hawaii	22	0.4	5.5	0.7	286.5	0.4	9,488	0.5	0.4
Idaho	43	0.8	6.6	0.8	429.3	0.6	13,582	0.7	0.6
Illinois	226	4.0	34.4	4.3	3,040.3	4.5	76,671	4.2	3.7
Indiana	132	2.3	20.4	2.6	1,719.1	2.5	50,673	2.7	2.0
Iowa	63	1.1	5.7	0.7	589.7	0.9	20,149	1.1	0.9
Kansas	60	1.1	5.7	0.7	538.1	0.8	19,403	1.1	0.9
Kentucky	78	1.4	8.1	1.0	862.1	1.3	27,903	1.5	1.3
Louisiana	78	1.4	13.7	1.7	775.5	1.1	28,076	1.5	1.3
Maine	25	0.4	2.2	0.3	198.7	0.3	6,381	0.3	0.4
Maryland	87	1.5	16.4	2.1	1,089.0	1.6	29,689	1.6	1.8
Massachusetts	97	1.7	13.8	1.7	1,172.0	1.7	27,041	1.5	2.1
Michigan	199	3.5	29.0	3.7	2,722.8	4.0	73,988	4.0	3.0
Minnesota	130	2.3	20.0	2.5	1,382.3	2.0	42,769	2.3	1.7
Mississippi	53	0.9	4.5	0.6	501.1	0.7	17,544	0.9	0.9

State	Establishments (Units)	Establishments (%)	Revenue ($bn)	Revenue (%)	Wages ($m)	Wages (%)	Employment (k)	Employment (%)	Population (%)
Missouri	121	2.1	12.1	1.5	1,386.5	2.0	44,155	2.4	1.8
Montana	22	0.4	2.7	0.3	186.2	0.3	6,669	0.4	0.3
Nebraska	40	0.7	4.5	0.6	361.2	0.5	13,116	0.7	0.6
Nevada	57	1.0	6.0	0.8	596.9	0.9	17,233	0.9	1.0
New Hampshire	31	0.5	4.2	0.5	301.1	0.4	8,915	0.5	0.4
New Jersey	136	2.4	20.8	2.6	1,820.6	2.7	39,954	2.2	2.8
New Mexico	38	0.7	4.1	0.5	312.5	0.5	13,819	0.7	0.6
New York	263	4.6	37.4	4.7	2,937.3	4.3	65,174	3.5	5.8
North Carolina	173	3.0	17.3	2.2	1,813.7	2.7	55,971	3.0	3.3
North Dakota	16	0.3	2.1	0.3	141.3	0.2	5,669	0.3	0.2
Ohio	199	3.5	31.9	4.0	2,593.2	3.8	70,252	3.8	3.5
Oklahoma	78	1.4	7.0	0.9	749.8	1.1	27,907	1.5	1.2
Oregon	123	2.2	19.1	2.4	1,319.3	1.9	32,947	1.8	1.2
Pennsylvania	217	3.8	20.3	2.6	2,192.8	3.2	62,066	3.4	3.8
Rhode Island	14	0.2	1.4	0.2	110.8	0.2	3,483	0.2	0.3
South Carolina	82	1.4	8.1	1.0	846.0	1.2	26,933	1.5	1.6
South Dakota	19	0.3	1.8	0.2	137.7	0.2	6,159	0.3	0.3
Tennessee	120	2.1	11.4	1.4	1,343.0	2.0	41,029	2.2	2.1
Texas	450	7.9	52.4	6.6	6,085.6	9.0	164,518	8.9	9.4
Utah	78	1.4	13.1	1.7	909.5	1.3	25,164	1.4	1.0
Vermont	9	0.2	1.7	0.2	55.7	0.1	1,709	0.1	0.2
Virginia	150	2.6	30.6	3.9	2,060.2	3.0	49,126	2.7	2.6
Washington	149	2.6	35.3	4.5	2,470.1	3.6	50,555	2.7	2.3
West Virginia	30	0.5	2.2	0.3	211.2	0.3	10,879	0.6	0.5
Wisconsin	113	2.0	14.1	1.8	1,272.8	1.9	38,575	2.1	1.7
Wyoming	16	0.3	1.2	0.1	110.7	0.2	4,115	0.2	0.2

Where are businesses located?

The Southeast combines rapid suburban growth with retailer-friendly policies

- The Southeast offers some of the best conditions for expanding warehouse clubs and supercenters, with strong population growth, suburban development and value-oriented shopping behavior. Pro-growth regulatory frameworks in many states reduce zoning barriers and speed approvals, making it easier and cheaper to secure sites, build big-box formats and scale dense store and club networks across the region.
- The region also operates as a key logistics corridor, with expanding Atlantic ports in Georgia, Florida and the Carolinas and direct access to major interstate routes. Proximity to port-linked distribution hubs lowers transportation costs, improves delivery speed and supports import-heavy categories, encouraging chains like Walmart, Sam's Club and Costco to cluster regional distribution and store networks there.
- Many Southeastern states combine mid-range population densities with fast-growing suburbs and exurbs, which are well-suited to warehouse clubs and supercenters. Dense clusters of middle-income households with high car ownership support formats that rely on large parking lots,

highway access and shoppers willing to drive farther to stock up on bulk goods in a single, high-basket trip.

The Great Lakes region provides efficient freight links for warehouse clubs and supercenters

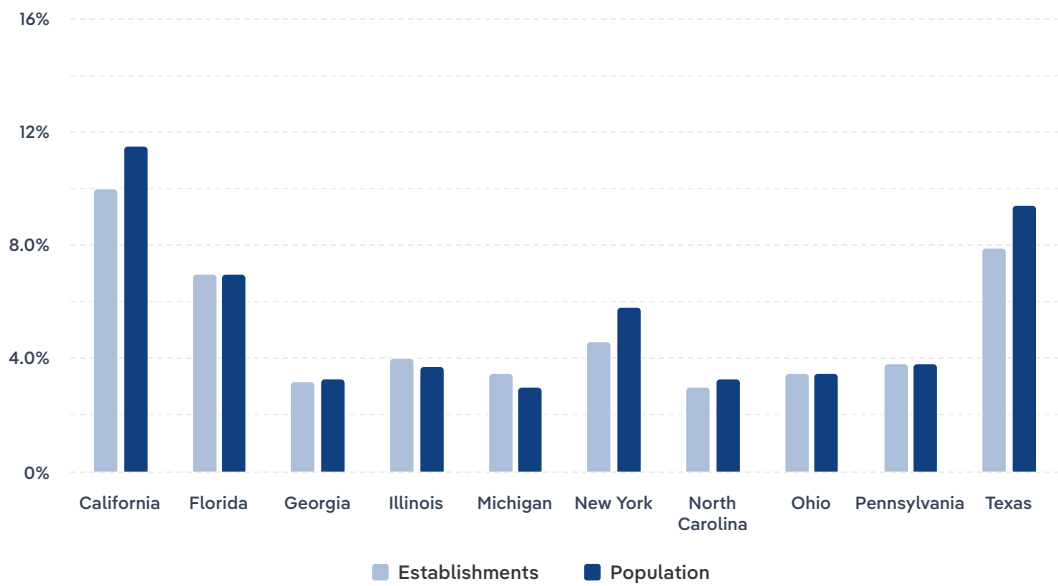
- The Great Lakes region supports a dense and expanding network of warehouse clubs and supercenters anchored by long-standing retail chains and steady population growth in its metro areas and suburbs. It is home to Meijer, a major family-owned supercenter operator with a strong presence in Illinois, Michigan, Ohio, Indiana, Wisconsin and Kentucky, reinforcing the region's orientation toward large-format, one-stop retail.
- The region's mix of manufacturing, logistics and service employers supports large middle-income populations that closely monitor everyday costs. These households often favor bulk purchasing of groceries, household essentials and general merchandise to manage budgets and reduce trip frequency, creating consistent demand for warehouse club and supercenter formats.
- A dense network of interstate highways, rail corridors and port facilities in the Great Lakes states supports a major freight and logistics hub, lowering inbound shipping and distribution costs for retailers. Paired with relatively affordable industrial and commercial sites, this environment makes it easier and cheaper to build and run large-format warehouse clubs and supercenters near heavily populated cities.

The West attracts warehouse club operators seeking high-income, car-oriented shoppers

- The West is a natural fit for warehouse clubs and supercenters because many households have relatively high disposable incomes and regularly buy larger baskets of groceries, household goods and general merchandise. That spending power helps support the per-trip volumes and membership economics these formats rely on, even when unit prices are higher than in lower-income regions.
- Western households are highly car-oriented and many live in suburban or exurban communities where large parcels, highway access and ample parking are easier to secure than in dense urban cores. That pattern makes it practical to develop and operate big-box warehouse clubs and supercenters on designated commercial corridors outside city centers, drawing customers from broad regional trade areas.
- Warehouse clubs have deep roots in the West, where the original warehouse club concept was introduced, and chains like Costco built their early US footprint. Over time, businesses concentrated investment in large Western states such as California and Washington, creating dense networks of clubs and big-box stores and reinforcing shopper familiarity with membership models and bulk-purchase shopping.

Business Concentration

Share of establishments (%) vs. share of population (%)



IBISWorld

Sources: IBISWorld

Key Success Factors

How do businesses use location to their advantage?

Operate in a highly visible location

Being in a highly visible spot off major roads keeps the store top of mind and easy to find, which can boost spontaneous visits and repeat traffic for big-box formats that rely on very high sales volumes.

Operate in a location that is close to key markets

Proximity to densely populated areas enables retailers to maximize foot traffic and sales. Clear signage, easy access and ample parking space also attract shoppers.

Competitive Forces

Key Takeaways

Retailers compete primarily on price. The retail model that warehouse clubs and supercenters use encourages shoppers to buy in bulk to achieve cost savings through a low price-per-use.

Online retailers pose the largest threat to warehouse clubs and supercenters. Because of lower overhead costs, online sellers can compete effectively based on price. In response, many warehouse clubs and supercenters have invested significantly in their online platforms.

Concentration	Competition	Barriers to Entry
High	High — Increasing	High — Steady
Substitutes	**Buyer Power**	**Supplier Power**
High — Steady	Moderate — Steady	Moderate — Steady

Concentration

What impacts the industry's market share concentration?

Economies of scale reinforce high revenue concentration

- Companies in the warehouse club and supercenter sector are highly concentrated, with Walmart (including Sam's Club) and Costco together accounting for well over 90.0% of industry revenue in 2026. Their dominant share reflects powerful economies of scale in purchasing, distribution and merchandising, which allow these chains to set the prevailing benchmarks for price and assortment in bulk retail.
- Scale advantages enable leading companies to negotiate favorable supplier terms, run dense logistics networks and operate large-format stores at high throughput, supporting low unit costs and everyday value propositions across food, household and discretionary categories. These efficiencies underpin strong brand recognition and membership loyalty, helping Walmart and Costco maintain their outsized share of sales and reinforcing the sector's persistently high level of concentration.

New and regional players remain confined to narrow parts of the industry

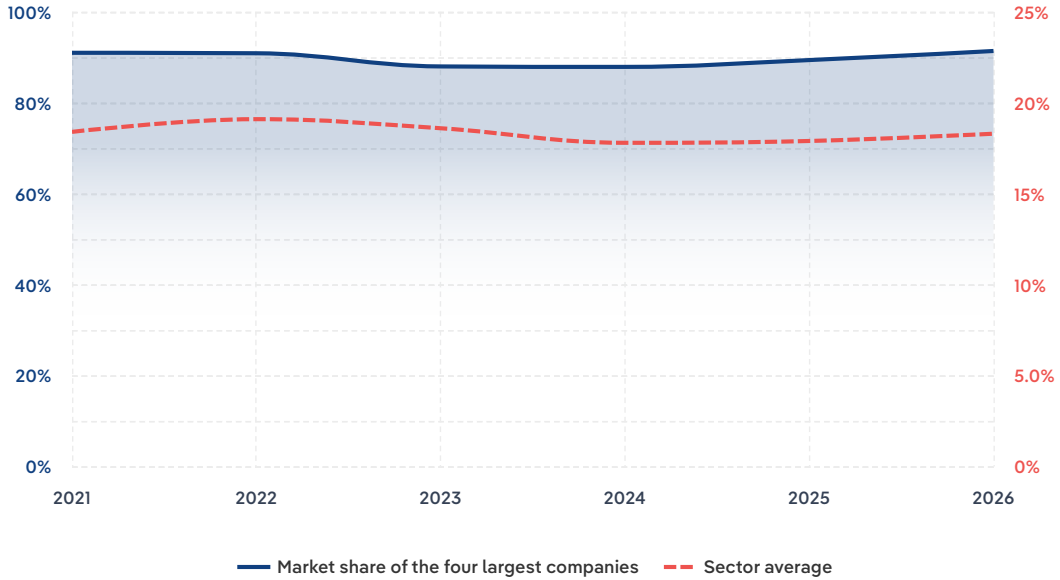
- With most sales concentrated among a few national chains, smaller warehouse clubs and supercenters typically compete in narrower roles, focusing on localized assortments, personalized service or niche categories rather than trying to replicate Walmart or Costco's model. Many newer concepts lean into differentiated store experiences or community positioning to attract members who value more than just price and selection.
- The dominance of large companies means growth opportunities for smaller and new businesses are often limited to selective regional expansion or specialty formats, rather than broad national rollouts. These businesses may carve out loyal customer bases in specific markets, but they rarely scale to match the reach or influence of the largest membership chains, which continue to anchor bulk purchasing and everyday value propositions.

Advanced logistics and pricing tools reinforce incumbents' strength

- Leading warehouse club and supercenter companies are investing heavily in automation, data analytics and AI across logistics, pricing and inventory management. These tools improve forecasting accuracy, keep shelves stocked and streamline distribution, lowering unit costs and supporting consistent value propositions for bulk and staple items across large store networks.
- Omnichannel platforms that integrate extensive store footprints with online ordering, click-and-collect and rapid delivery deepen customer loyalty and make shopping more convenient for members. By turning big-box locations into flexible fulfillment hubs and offering app-based services, dominant chains strengthen their role in everyday purchasing, while companies that cannot match this digital infrastructure risk falling behind in convenience and visibility. This performance gap reinforces the industry's high market concentration.

Market Share Concentration

Combined market share of the four largest companies in this industry



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

☆ Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses handle concentration?

Develop a strong reputation

Retailers can improve customer loyalty by developing a strong reputation for quality and price. Customers have many options when choosing between retailers, so a strong reputation will fuel higher revenue.

Leverage economies of scope

With economies of scope, warehouse clubs and supercenters can lower the cost of doing business, which typically translates into lower consumer prices. Given the high degree of market saturation, offering low prices is crucial.

Barriers to Entry

High | Steady

What challenges do potential industry entrants face?

Legal

- Individual states set employment, safety and business rules that large-format retailers must follow, including minimum wage laws, overtime, scheduling and worker protection standards. On top of that, federal and state trade and consumer regulations cover pricing, labeling, data privacy, sustainability and sourcing, making compliance complex for multi-category warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Start-Up Costs

- Large club stores and supercenters benefit from volume-based purchasing, distribution and advertising discounts that lower their costs. Matching this scale requires substantial upfront capital to stock inventory, buy equipment and fixtures, secure or develop large sites, and build regional logistics. New entrants must commit heavily before sales volumes are proven or stable.

Differentiation

- Establishing a distinct brand and loyal customer base is essential because most retailers can source comparable branded and private-label goods. Product differences are limited, so warehouse clubs and supercenters focus on format, membership structure, price positioning, assortment breadth and perceived quality. Creating that differentiation requires ongoing investment in marketing and customer experience.

Capital Expenses

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters need continuous capital to build and expand large footprints, modernize stores and maintain extensive logistics networks. Leading chains also invest heavily in automation, data analytics and digital channels like online ordering and delivery. New businesses must match this ongoing spending to meet customer expectations on price, convenience and shopping experience.

☆ Key Success Factors

How can potential entrants overcome barriers to entry?

Comply with government regulations

Warehouse clubs and supercenters handle and sell various food items, so they must adhere to a range of policies and regulations. Adhering to these policies can reduce operating expenses and limit exposure to fines.

Develop links with suppliers

Warehouse clubs and supercenters should stock the latest products and offer the widest variety to attract more shoppers and generate repeat business. Developing strong links with suppliers ensures that stores will have access to products.

Substitutes

High Steady

What are substitutes for industry services?

E-commerce

- Online retailers sidestep many of the fixed costs tied to large physical locations, enabling aggressive pricing and frequent promotions across everyday goods and discretionary items. Shoppers now expect a broad assortment, detailed reviews and personalized recommendations, which increase confidence and willingness to purchase. As e-commerce platforms expand bulk and subscription offerings, more routine stock-up trips can be shifted online rather than made in person.
- Warehouse clubs and supercenters have responded by treating stores as digital fulfillment hubs, integrating curbside pickup, same-day delivery and app-based ordering into their core offer. Members can now choose between in-store browsing and online convenience, often within the same brand ecosystem. The ability to sample products, access low-priced food courts and physically evaluate items still gives large-format stores a distinctive edge that pure online players struggle to replicate.

Supermarkets, furniture, hardware, department and dollar stores

- Supermarkets, furniture, hardware, department and dollar stores provide other large-scale retail environments where consumers can satisfy needs that overlap with club and supercenter offerings. These formats compete on assortment breadth, brand mix, store design, proximity, service and everyday pricing. Warehouse clubs and supercenters remain known for strong value on bulk purchases, yet traditional chains have sharpened private-label ranges and remodeled stores to emphasize quick, convenient trips.
- These stores often carry identical national brands and categories, using their own purchasing scale to closely track prices on key items. Recognizable banners and mature loyalty programs drive repeat visits, while newer membership tiers offer benefits that rival savings from bulk formats. As these retailers deepen omnichannel capabilities, such as drive-up pickup and rapid delivery, they increasingly offer comparable convenience for many common shopping missions.

Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses compete with substitutes?

Closely monitor the competition

Grocery stores and other substitutes compete on price because of the low level of product differentiation. Retailers must monitor when competitors offer discounts and promotions to avoid losing customers and adjust their own prices or offers in response.

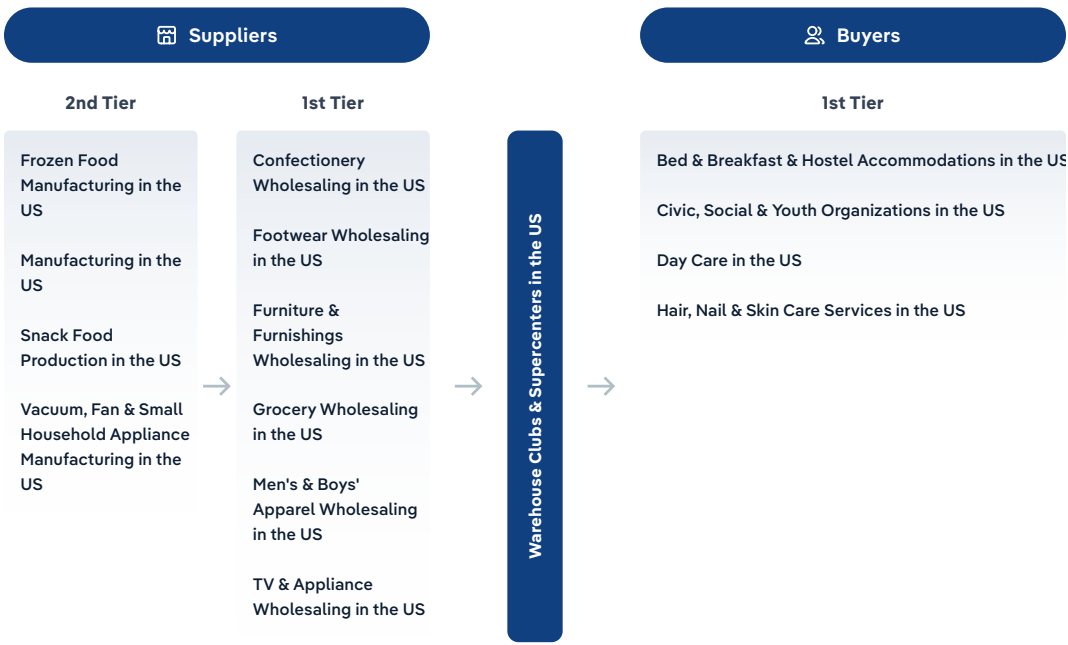
Develop a wide and expanding product range

Retailers should offer a wide range of products comparable to those of external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

Buyer & Supplier Power

Supply Chain

Direct and indirect supplier and buyer industries related to this industry



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

What power do buyers and suppliers have over the industry?

Moderate Steady

Buyers: Leveraging choice of formats and channels

- Buyers are typically highly price-conscious and can easily compare total basket costs across warehouse clubs, supermarkets, discount chains and online channels, which puts ongoing pressure on retailers to keep prices low and value strong. However, paid memberships, bulk-oriented

assortments and in-store convenience limit how freely they switch, so their overall influence on pricing and terms tends to be moderate.

- When perceived value deteriorates, many buyers are willing to move to cheaper brands or alternative retailers, which pushes warehouse clubs and supercenters to sustain sharp pricing and promotions. At the same time, loyalty programs, exclusive private-label ranges and reliable service increase switching costs and strengthen attachment to specific banners, helping to anchor buyer power at a moderate level in a highly competitive retail landscape.

Moderate Steady

Suppliers: Reinforcing dependence through unique product ranges

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters rely on manufacturers, distributors and private-label partners to secure must-have brands, seasonal items and bulk formats that attract shoppers, giving suppliers some influence over prices and promotions. However, large chains buy in high volumes, source from many vendors and can redirect orders when needed, so individual suppliers rarely hold dominant power in negotiations.
- Differentiated or exclusive products can create pockets of dependence, but a substantial share of inventory is generic, widely available or sold under retailer-controlled private labels. This limits most suppliers' ability to dictate commercial terms. Scale, professional procurement teams and the option to replace underperforming vendors help balance the relationship, so overall supplier power is best described as moderate.

☆ Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses manage buyer & supplier power?

Control distribution arrangements

Retailers compete on value and product offerings. Warehouse clubs and supercenters control their distribution facilities or maintain strict distributor agreements for low prices.

Develop a loyal customer base

Since some stores require paid membership, club stores and supercenters should ensure that consumers' needs are met and feel valued. Otherwise, consumers can easily switch to a competitor.

Companies

Key Takeaways

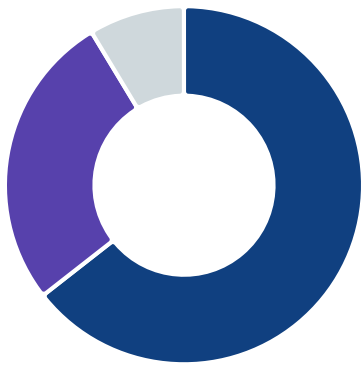
By attempting to freeze its global headcount for at least three years, Walmart is making a strategic shift toward tech-driven productivity. The move highlights how automation is increasingly replacing traditional labor growth across major retail operations.

Costco sells a wide range of products marketed under its in-house brand, Kirkland Signature. The Kirkland Signature line has seen a surge in sales over the past five years as economic uncertainty prompted customers to favor value-oriented items over national brands.

Market Share

Industry Market Share by Company

Industry-specific company revenue as a share of total industry revenue.



Walmart ($510.7bn) 64.5% Costco ($213.3bn) 26.9% Other Companies ($68.5bn) 8.6%

IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

This chart has been simplified for the PDF and may not display all available data. View the full interactive chart on my.ibisworld.com for additional data and detail.

Company	Market Share (%)	Employees	Locations	Company Type	Headquarters
Walmart	64.5	10,000+	10,955	Public	Bentonville, Arkansas
Costco	26.9	10,000+	914	Public	Issaquah, Washington

Company Details

Walmart

Description

Walmart is a multinational retail corporation operating discount stores, supercenters, warehouse clubs and e-commerce platforms under the Walmart and Sam's Club brands. Headquartered in Bentonville, Arkansas, it is one of the world's largest retailers by revenue and store count. In the US, Walmart serves customers through thousands of stores, combining general merchandise, groceries and health and wellness services, including in-store pharmacies that dispense prescriptions and related services. Its common stock trades publicly under the ticker WMT.

Company Total Revenue (2026)

$713.2bn

Industry Specific Revenue (2026)

$510.7bn

Industry Market Share (2026)

64.5%

Employees (2026)

10,000+

Headquarters

Bentonville, Arkansas

Company Type

Public

Locations (Top 10)

Abbeville, Louisiana
Aberdeen, Maryland
Aberdeen, North Carolina
Aberdeen, South Dakota
Aberdeen, Washington
Abilene, Texas
Abingdon, Maryland
Abingdon, Virginia
Abington, Massachusetts
Acworth, Georgia

Other Industries

Online Children's Toy Sales in the US
Retail Trade in the US
Discount Department Stores in the US
Pharmacies & Drug Stores in the US
Online Home Furnishings Sales in the US
Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in the US
Online Gambling Services in the US
Online Grocery Sales in the US

A Full Locations list can be accessed in Atlas.

What's impacting Walmart's performance?

Walmart deepens its commitment to regenerative sustainability

- Walmart has adopted a range of ESG initiatives, including a goal to move beyond sustainability toward a regenerative approach that restores and replenishes natural systems. The company has focused on sourcing 20 key commodities more sustainably as part of its broader sustainable commodities agenda.
- Through Project Gigaton, Walmart set a goal to work with suppliers to reduce, avoid or sequester one gigaton of greenhouse gas emissions across its global value chain by 2030. Walmart and the Walmart Foundation have also committed to help protect, sustainably manage or restore at least 50 million acres of land and one million square miles of ocean by 2030. Another major goal is to achieve zero emissions in Walmart's own global operations by 2040, without relying on carbon offsets.

Affluent shoppers drive Walmart's e-grocery growth

- Walmart's e-grocery platform has seen a surge in activity from affluent households, adding to its traditionally strong base of lower-income shoppers. High-income households are spending more and ordering more often from Walmart, driving record e-commerce grocery sales gains. This affluent segment, earning over $200,000 annually, now constitutes about 8.0% of Walmart's active users, as of 2024 and is expanding much faster than lower-income cohorts.
- At the same time, Walmart continues to rely on its core value-focused shoppers, using low prices and a broad assortment to anchor overall volume. In contrast, supermarkets and Target have experienced weaker online growth among higher-income households, allowing Walmart to capture a larger share of affluent online grocery spending. This evolving mix of value-oriented and higher-income shoppers is

strengthening Walmart's competitive position in the online grocery market and broadening its appeal across income tiers.

You can view and download more company details on my.ibisworld.com.

Costco

Description

Costco Wholesale Corporation is a publicly listed, membership-based warehouse club retailer headquartered in Issaquah, Washington. It traces its roots to Price Club, founded in 1976 and opened the first Costco warehouse in Seattle in 1983 before adopting the Costco Wholesale name in 1999. Costco operates large-format, membership-only warehouses that sell a curated range of branded and private-label products in bulk at low margins. The group has a substantial footprint across North America, Europe, Asia and Australia.

Company Total Revenue (2026)

$269.9bn

Industry Specific Revenue (2026)

$213.3bn

Industry Market Share (2026)

26.9%

Employees (2026)

10,000+

Headquarters

Issaquah, Washington

Company Type

Public

Locations (Top 10)

Albany, Oregon
Albuquerque, New Mexico
Alexandria, Virginia
Alhambra, California
Allentown, Pennsylvania
Aloha, Oregon
Alpharetta, Georgia
Altamonte Springs, Florida
Anchorage, Alaska
Ankeny, Iowa

Other Industries

Optical Goods Retailing in the US
Grocery Wholesaling in the UK
Gas Stations with Convenience Stores in the US
Supermarkets & Grocery Stores in the US

A Full Locations list can be accessed in Atlas.

What's impacting Costco's performance?

Digital offerings become more popular

- Costco continues to prioritize in-warehouse traffic, but it has gradually expanded its digital and omnichannel capabilities in the United States and other key markets. The investment in its online shopping platform has paid off, with a reported 44.4% climb in e-commerce sales in fiscal year 2021, following roughly 50.0% growth the year before. While e-commerce still represents a smaller share of overall sales than some competitors, online sales have accelerated.
- The introduction of new digital features, such as same-day delivery and expanded online product offerings, has attracted a broader customer base and boosted overall sales. According to the latest figures, Costco's e-commerce business has grown by more than 10.0% year over year for eight consecutive quarters through fiscal Q1 2026, including 20.5% growth in Q1 2026, well ahead of the wider retail average.

Executive perks and app improvements boost Costco member value

- Costco is testing in-aisle scanning technology that lets members scan items on their phones, pay digitally and present a QR code at exit, while expanding membership scanners at entrances and food courts to tighten access and speed verification. The company is updating its mobile app to emphasize digital memberships and renewals, supporting younger shoppers and enabling faster, more convenient interactions in high-volume US warehouses.
- The company is also enriching member benefits, including enhanced perks for Executive members, such as Instacart discounts and extended shopping hours, as well as improved rewards for Costco Anywhere Visa cardholders at gas stations. Combined with the ongoing expansion of US locations and business centers, these measures strengthen loyalty and help maintain Costco's competitive edge in the warehouse club industry by improving perceived value and operational efficiency.

You can view and download more company details on my.ibisworld.com.

External Environment

Key Takeaways

Individual states cover regulations relevant to the retail industry in general. Congress and the state enact trade regulations to maintain a free and competitive economy.

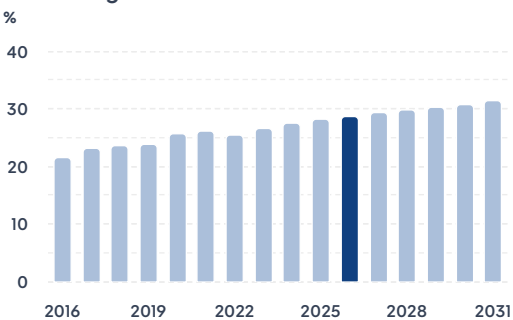
Economic development tax credits help governments attract and support growing businesses. By offering tax breaks in return for local job creation and investment, companies like Costco can reinvest savings into expansion, efficiency and lower prices.

Regulation & Policy		Assistance	
Low	Steady	Low	Steady

External Drivers

What demographic and macroeconomic factors impact the industry?

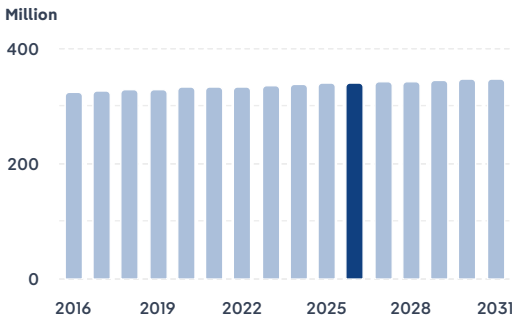
Percentage of business conducted online



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Growth in the share of purchases made online increases competition for warehouse clubs and supercenters, as e-commerce retailers offer convenience, delivery and extensive product selection. This shift can draw spending away from physical locations and reduce foot traffic. When online growth slows, it creates an opportunity for brick-and-mortar stores to regain customers and strengthen in-store sales performance.

Population

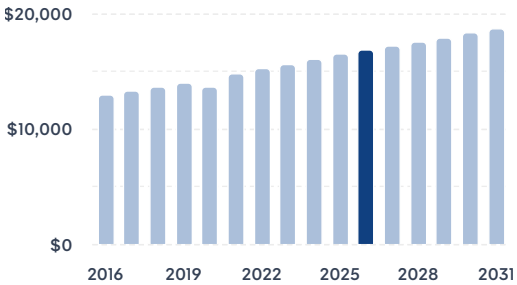


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Population growth expands the total number of potential customers for warehouse clubs and supercenters, supporting steady increases in sales volume. A larger population leads to higher demand for bulk goods, groceries and household essentials. Slower population growth, however, limits the pace of customer base expansion, constraining long-term revenue growth and store network expansion.

Consumer spending

$ billion

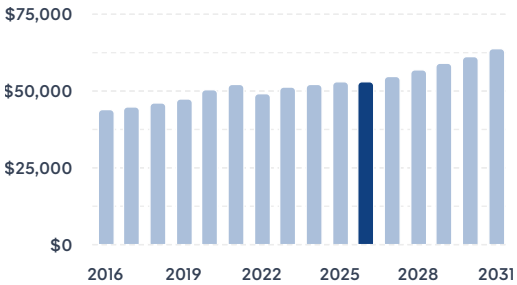


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Consumer spending reflects how frequently households shop and how much they purchase per visit at warehouse clubs and supercenters. Strong spending levels drive higher transaction volumes, as consumers make more trips and purchase a wider mix of goods. When spending slows, households consolidate purchases and cut back on nonessential items, limiting sales growth and reducing overall store activity.

Per capita disposable income

$

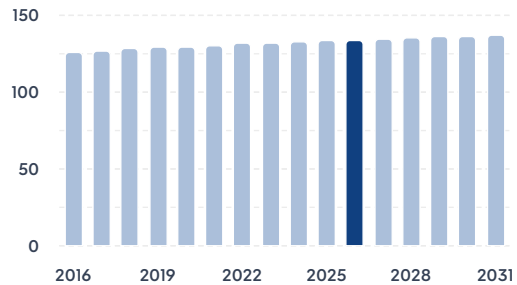


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Per capita disposable income captures consumers' ability to spend beyond basic necessities, shaping purchasing decisions at warehouse clubs and supercenters. Higher income levels support trade-ups to premium products, larger pack sizes and discretionary goods. When income growth is limited, shoppers shift toward lower-cost alternatives and essentials, reducing average transaction values even if store traffic remains relatively stable.

Number of households

Million

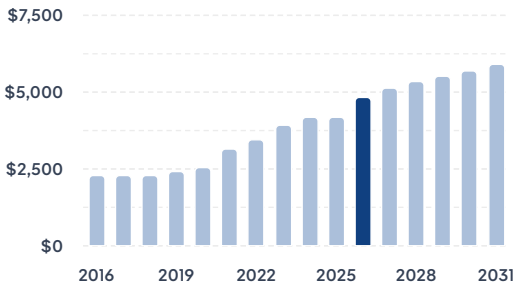


IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Changes in the median age influence the types of products consumers prioritize at warehouse clubs and supercenters. An aging population tends to increase demand for health, wellness and essential goods, which supports stable sales. However, slower growth among younger consumers may reduce demand for trend-driven and discretionary categories, limiting opportunities to expand product offerings in certain segments.

Corporate profit

$ billion



IBISWorld Source: IBISWorld

Higher corporate profit supports stronger business purchasing activity, particularly for bulk office supplies, breakroom goods and operational essentials sold by warehouse clubs and supercenters. Business customers typically buy in large quantities, contributing meaningfully to revenue. When corporate profit weakens, companies reduce discretionary spending and delay restocking, posing a clear threat to sales generated from this important customer segment.

Regulation & Policy

Low Steady

What regulations impact the industry?

Antitrust laws

Some of the most important antitrust laws affecting warehouse clubs and supercenters include the Sherman Antitrust Act, the Clayton Antitrust Act, the Hart-Scott-Rodino Act and the Robinson-Patman Act. These acts prohibit the formation of monopolies, restrict certain forms of price discrimination and protect independent business owners. The explosive popularity of Walmart and Costco has heightened scrutiny of competitive conditions in the retail sector and concerns about market concentration among large-format retailers, potentially leading to more regulation in the coming years. Individual states also have their own antitrust laws and enforcement frameworks that can apply to warehouse

clubs and supercenters in addition to federal law.

Americans with Disabilities Act

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) prohibits discrimination against people with disabilities in several areas, including employment, transportation, public accommodations, communications and access to state and local government programs and services. More retailers are hiring workers with disabilities because they are fully capable of performing most required tasks. Many customers prefer to support a business that hires and supports individuals with disabilities because it reinforces positive perceptions of the brand and the shopping experience. Warehouse clubs and supercenters must make their stores accessible to customers with disabilities and ensure reasonable accommodations for employees to avoid fines and other penalties.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

The EPA establishes standards for waste management, emissions and other environmental impacts. Stores are required to manage waste, such as packaging materials and expired products, in compliance with applicable federal, state and local regulations. Non-compliance can result in hefty fines and harm a company's reputation for environmental stewardship. The EPA protects people and the environment from significant health risks, while also sponsoring and conducting research. As environmental concerns intensify, environmental regulations and standards are expected to tighten, raising operating costs for retailers that must invest in compliance, equipment and reporting systems.

Occupational Safety and Health Act

The Occupational Safety and Health Act requires employers to provide safe working conditions. Most of these standards pertain to strenuous or hazardous work, but many also apply to all businesses. Warehouse clubs and supercenters must adhere to standards governing machinery, ergonomics and accident reporting. The growing use of technology and equipment has heightened the safety standards that retailers must follow, raising compliance costs. Regular safety audits and employee training sessions are crucial to prevent workplace injuries and ensure legal compliance.

Credit programs

The laws that impact retailers' credit programs include the Federal Consumer Credit Protection Act and its associated Truth in Lending provisions, which require written disclosure of information relating to financing. Under the Federal Fair Credit Reporting Act, consumers must be informed when credit information is used in decisions that may deny or limit credit. Also, the Federal Equal Credit Opportunity Act prohibits discrimination against credit applicants based on certain grounds. These acts are intended to protect consumers and promote fair, non-discriminatory access to credit, including credit offered by retailers.

Tariffs

Tariffs apply to merchandise sourced from global suppliers and warehouse clubs and supercenters typically purchase items from importers or wholesalers after those tariffs are applied. Changes in tariff rates directly affect landed costs, influencing sourcing decisions and retail pricing strategies. Recent US tariff policy has focused on maintaining and adjusting duties on goods from major trading partners, especially China, raising costs in import-heavy categories such as electronics, apparel and certain food items. In response, large retailers and warehouse clubs have diversified sourcing, renegotiated supplier terms, selectively passed higher costs to consumers, and, in some cases, increased reliance on domestic manufacturers where feasible.

Assistance

Low Steady

What assistance is available to this industry?

Government

Tax credits

Economic development tax credits are a powerful tool that governments use to attract businesses. These credits reduce a company's tax liability in exchange for commitments to create jobs and invest in local infrastructure. In addition to tax credits, governments may also provide other forms of incentives such as tax rebates, exemptions, or grants tied to project performance. This support can result in significant savings and may allow businesses to allocate more resources toward improving operational efficiency, expanding product lines and potentially lowering prices. In recent years, large warehouse clubs such as Costco have been the focus of multi-million-dollar, performance-based incentive packages from state and local governments designed to support new warehouse developments and associated job creation.

Non-government

National Retail Federation (NRF) and business loans

The NRF is the world's largest retail trade association. It conducts programs and services in research, education, training, information technology and government affairs and policy advocacy to protect and advance the interests of various retail businesses. Private-sector banks and lending institutions offer loans and other commercial financing products tailored for large retail formats, providing critical capital for new store openings, inventory purchases, or technological upgrades. Access to affordable financing helps warehouse clubs and supercenters maintain competitiveness and meet consumer demand.

Financial Benchmarks

Key Takeaways

Purchasing costs have rebounded to more typical levels after pandemic-era lows. As supply chains normalized and product mixes shifted toward higher-cost fresh and prepared items, merchandise expenses rose, though sourcing strategies kept pricing competitive.

Wage pressure has eased even as staffing levels expand across stores. Lower overtime and normalized hiring conditions have reduced average salaries relative to revenue, though operations remain labor-intensive and larger chains still offer more competitive compensation.

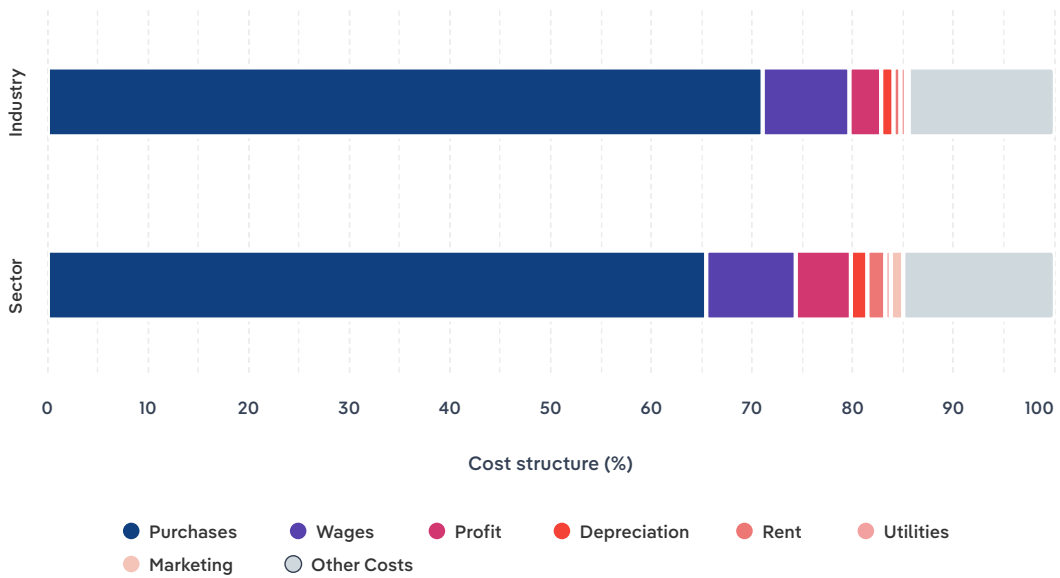
Profit has cooled from its peak but remains stable overall. Membership fees, private-label products and in-store services continue to cushion profitability, helping retailers offset higher costs while maintaining a strong value proposition for shoppers.

Profit Margin	Average Wage	Largest Cost
3.1% ↓ Lower than sector	$36.7k ↑ Higher than sector	Purchases
		71.1% of Revenue

Cost Structure

Cost Structure Benchmarks

Average operating costs by industry and sector as a share (%) of revenue 2026



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

What trends impact industry costs?

Purchasing costs have moved from a pandemic low back to typical levels

- Purchases' share of revenue was relatively low in 2021, when pandemic-era discounting, supplier concessions and a heavier mix of lower-priced lines temporarily restrained merchandise costs. As supply chains stabilized and wholesale prices for food and household goods moved higher,

purchasing costs gradually returned to a more typical share of revenue, edging up through 2023 before settling at current levels.

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters have added more fresh, organic and prepared foods, which tend to carry higher unit costs even when sold in bulk. For example, Costco has flagged persistent cost pressure in key fresh and ancillary categories, including eggs and cocoa, prompting selective price increases and more disciplined cost management as it works to protect its value-focused reputation with members.
- Direct sourcing from manufacturers and bulk-value pricing help bypass some intermediate markups and keep shelf prices competitive, which is key for supercenters and warehouse clubs whose value is driven by their money-saving. With input cost growth moderating and purchasing strategies now well established, merchandise costs appear to have normalized at their historic levels.

Growing headcount now coincides with lower average salaries and wage intensity

- Wages' revenue share has moved down from historically high levels, even though headcount has continued to climb. Pandemic-driven staffing shortages and hazard pay in 2021 added to already elevated labor costs, but as hiring conditions normalized, overtime and premium pay eased. Since employment has grown faster than total wage expenditures and revenue has grown faster than employment, average salaries have edged lower, shrinking the wages' revenue share.
- Despite this drop, warehouse clubs and supercenters still rely heavily on workers for daily operations, including customer service, maintaining large store displays and performing inventory checks. However, employment has risen while the number of establishments has remained relatively steady, pushing the employee-to-establishment ratio higher. This pattern shows that these formats remain operationally labor-reliant, even though labor costs have fallen relative to revenue.
- Notably, wage outcomes depend on employer scale. The two largest chains account for more than 90.0% of market revenue, leaving over a dozen smaller businesses to compete for the remaining share, often with leaner wage and benefit structures. In turn, larger players tend to pay somewhat higher hourly rates and offer more comprehensive benefits, widening the compensation gap between dominant chains and smaller rivals as aggregate wage intensity declines.

Profit has fallen from its peak but remains supported by memberships and offerings

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters convert low per-unit earnings into solid, but relatively low compared to the broader sector, profit through scale, membership fees and in-store services. Profit has slipped from its 2021 high as merchandise and logistics costs have risen faster than prices, but these formats still rely on very high sales volumes, bulk purchasing, selective assortments and bare-bones store designs to keep operating costs low and shelf prices competitive.
- Membership income has become even more important as the percentage profit has edged lower. For warehouse clubs, annual and executive fees provide a relatively stable, high-margin revenue stream that supports profit even when merchandise profitability is under pressure. Costco, for example, highlights membership fees as a core profit driver, prioritizing renewal rates and member loyalty over aggressive price increases, which helps preserve its value-focused positioning in a higher-cost environment.
- For both supercenters and warehouse clubs, private-label goods and in-store ancillary services provide additional support for profit. Private-label ranges typically earn a higher profit margin than comparable national brands while still being marketed as low-priced options, lifting basket value without alienating cost-conscious shoppers. In-house services, from fuel pumps to embedded franchises, help lock in loyalty and boost visit frequency, offsetting competition from online retailers and sustaining profit.

Long-lived fixtures and equipment help keep depreciation predictable

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters' depreciation mainly reflects the cost of running very large, no-frills stores, heavy-duty shelving and racking, refrigeration and material-handling equipment. These formats stretch asset lives through preventive maintenance and durable, energy-efficient fixtures, from lighting to refrigeration. That approach helps keep depreciation a steady share of revenue, even though the store footprint and equipment base remain substantial.
- These retailers also increasingly invest in automation and warehouse management systems that support high-volume operations, such as upgraded inventory-tracking systems, self-checkout and backroom handling equipment. New systems are rolled out in stages and designed to operate for many years, so added capital does not translate into sharp swings in annual depreciation. Instead, depreciation has stayed relatively stable as a portion of revenue while underpinning long-term productivity across large-format stores.

Large stores in prime locations carry high rents but remain affordable through scale

- Urban and high-traffic areas command higher rents, as shown by leaders such as Walmart and Costco, which operate large-format stores often exceeding 100,000 square feet. Even so, many warehouse clubs and supercenters secure long-term, net leases with flat or modest escalation clauses, helping keep rent a predictable, stable share of revenue even as market rents rose sharply earlier in the decade.
- These chains balance costly flagship locations with new stores in suburban areas where real estate is less expensive, and they close underperforming sites to preserve steady rent-to-revenue ratios. As membership, private-label assortments and bulk purchasing drive revenue in line with rental costs. and as commercial and warehouse rent growth has recently moderated, rent has remained a constant and manageable share of revenue for warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Utility costs stay manageable as stores modernize equipment and monitor usage closely

- Utility spending for warehouse clubs and supercenters is driven by their very large store footprints and heavy use of lighting, HVAC and

refrigeration. These formats have steadily rolled out LED lighting, high-efficiency HVAC and modern refrigeration, along with better maintenance routines and staff training. Together, those steps help keep utility costs a fairly steady share of revenue, even as stores stay large and busy.

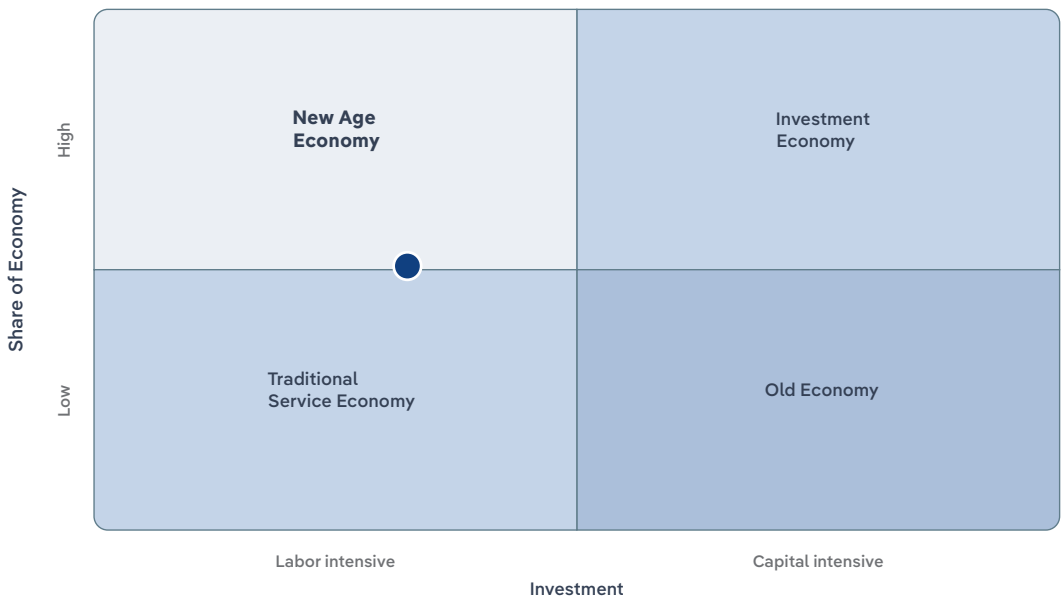
- Many leading chains use automation and smart sensors to monitor energy use in real time, adjusting lighting, temperature and equipment settings as traffic and weather change. Some have also added rooftop solar or other on-site renewables to offset grid power. These efficiency gains and the adoption of renewables have kept utility costs relatively stable, even as underlying energy prices have become more volatile amid grid expansion and elevated electricity demand.

Strong value reputations let warehouse clubs grow with minimal marketing spend

- Retailers like Costco and Walmart emphasize operational efficiency, value pricing and high-volume sales, with Costco in particular relying less on traditional mass advertising than many other chains. Costco aims for product markups of no more than about 14.0% on national brands and 15.0% on its private-label items, supporting its reputation for low prices and reducing the need for extensive promotional spending. Streamlined assortments and bulk sales also lower overhead and simplify marketing.
- These retailers lean on in-store promotions, free samples and recognizable value cues, such as Costco's $1.50 hot dog combo, to drive repeat visits and retention. Strong brand recognition, memberships and word of mouth help keep foot traffic high without marketing taking up a large portion of the budget. Overall, this model allows warehouse clubs and supercenters to sustain sales growth while holding marketing costs to a very small share of revenue.

New Age Economy

Share of economy vs. Investment



IBISWorld

Source: IBISWorld

Financial Ratios

Days' Receivables	Interest Coverage	Debt/Net Worth
31.0 ↓ Lower than sector	3.4 ↑ Higher than sector	3.7 ↓ Lower than sector

Earnings Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
EBIT/Revenue	2.8	3.2	7.9	4.8	5.5	6.1	4.8	3.5
EBITDA/Revenue	5.1	5.4	10.2	9.2	8.1	9.2	7.6	5.9
Leverage Ratio	19.4	18.4	9.8	10.9	12.4	11.0	14.2	34.6

Income Statement

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Advertising	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.4	0.8	0.5	0.4	0.6
Amortization	1.2	1.3	0.5	2.8	1.0	1.4	1.4	1.2
Bad debts	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.2
Business receipts	95.1	97.1	98.5	98.2	98.2	98.3	97.4	96.8
Charitable contributions	0.4	0.4	0.0	0.2	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.3
Compensation of officers	1.4	1.3	1.5	3.9	2.5	2.6	2.1	1.6
Cost of goods	79.7	81.3	73.1	67.0	72.1	70.7	74.6	78.0
Depletion	0.1	0.0	0.7	0.1	0.0	0.3	0.2	0.2
Depreciation	1.1	0.9	1.2	1.5	1.6	1.4	1.2	1.1
Dividends, domestic corporations	0.3	0.4	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.2
Employee benefit programs	1.1	1.0	0.5	3.3	2.4	2.1	1.7	1.3
Expenses	79.7	81.3	73.1	67.0	72.1	70.7	74.6	78.0
Gross Profit	20.3	18.7	26.9	33.0	27.9	29.3	25.4	22.0
Interest Income	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.9	0.0	0.4	0.3	0.3
Interest Paid	0.7	0.7	0.4	0.5	1.6	0.8	0.8	0.7
Net gain, noncapital assets	1.2	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.3	0.3
Net Income	1.6	2.0	5.0	3.7	3.1	3.9	3.1	1.6
Net L-T cap gain less net ST loss	1.0	0.0	0.4	0.1	1.7	0.7	0.6	0.4
Net loss, noncapital assets	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.3	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.2
Net S-T cap gain less net LT loss	0.5	0.5	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.4
Other deductions	3.7	3.1	6.5	6.1	4.5	5.7	4.8	4.7
Other receipts	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.1	0.0	0.2	0.3	0.4
Pension, profit sharing plans, stock, annuity	0.7	0.5	1.1	2.6	0.9	1.5	1.2	0.8
Rent Income	1.3	1.4	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5	0.9
Rent paid	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.3	1.3	1.2	1.1	0.9
Repairs	0.7	0.7	0.5	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.5	0.6
Royalties	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.6	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.4
Salaries and wages	5.3	4.6	5.3	5.4	6.4	5.7	5.4	4.8
Sales/Fixed Assets	1.4	1.5	1.1	0.9	0.8	0.9	1.1	2.0

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Taxes paid	0.5	0.5	2.5	0.6	0.8	1.3	1.0	1.2
Total Revenue	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

Balance Sheet

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Accounts payable	11.2	12.9	16.8	17.1	7.6	13.8	13.1	11.2
Accumulated amortization	0.3	0.1	7.7	2.3	1.4	3.8	2.4	1.3
Accumulated depletion	0.0	0.0	0.8	0.9	0.9	0.9	0.5	0.3
Accumulated depreciation	20.8	19.5	22.2	36.3	41.8	33.4	28.1	22.8
Additional paid-in capital	44.0	25.6	12.9	6.3	25.9	15.0	22.9	29.5
Allowance for bad debts	0.7	0.4	0.1	1.1	0.1	0.4	0.5	0.4
Capital stock	-0.9	9.0	0.9	1.0	-15.7	-4.6	-1.2	1.4
Cash and Equivalents	3.2	2.3	15.3	10.8	3.0	9.7	6.9	4.2
Cost of treasury stock	3.4	4.5	2.3	7.9	7.9	6.1	5.2	4.3
Current Assets	17.2	16.2	44.1	47.5	25.3	38.9	30.0	22.7
Current Liabilities	22.4	22.0	34.4	40.7	19.2	31.5	27.7	23.0
Depletable assets	0.0	0.0	3.6	4.0	3.9	3.8	2.3	1.2
Government Obligations	0.9	1.2	0.9	1.2	0.0	0.7	0.8	1.1
Intangible assets (Amortizable)	3.0	3.1	10.2	8.4	6.5	8.4	6.2	5.2
Inventories	9.7	9.8	9.5	20.6	10.2	13.4	12.0	10.7
Land	8.5	9.9	4.0	4.7	7.0	5.2	6.8	8.8
Loans from shareholders	6.2	8.6	9.6	4.5	3.6	5.9	6.5	8.2
Loans to shareholders	2.0	7.3	1.2	2.2	2.4	1.9	3.0	4.2
Mort, notes, and bonds under 1 yr	4.0	0.8	2.8	10.9	6.6	6.8	5.0	3.6
Mort, notes, bonds, 1 yr or more	24.7	13.9	16.1	24.0	39.2	26.5	23.6	21.9
Mortgage and real estate loans	1.4	1.3	0.9	2.8	2.5	2.1	1.8	1.5
Net worth	36.2	43.2	27.0	19.7	27.2	24.6	30.7	36.9
Notes and accounts receivable	1.5	1.1	3.6	3.0	8.5	5.1	3.5	2.3
Other assets	16.2	14.6	12.6	7.2	20.3	13.4	14.2	14.3
Other current assets	1.2	1.4	14.0	9.5	3.5	9.0	5.9	3.7
Other current liabilities	7.2	8.3	14.8	12.8	5.1	10.9	9.6	8.2
Other investments	35.6	32.4	8.2	10.7	12.1	10.3	19.8	25.8
Other liabilities	10.5	12.3	13.0	11.1	10.7	11.6	11.5	10.1
Property, Plant and Equipment	38.5	35.6	46.1	54.3	64.4	54.9	47.8	41.6

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Retained earnings, appropriated	-3.5	-0.7	-4.1	-1.0	-14.7	-6.6	-4.8	-3.7
Retained earnings-unappropriated	0.0	13.8	19.6	21.3	39.6	26.8	18.8	14.0
Tax Exempt Securities	0.0	0.0	0.7	1.4	0.0	0.7	0.4	0.2
Total assets	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
Total liabilities	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

Liquidity Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Current Ratio	0.8	0.7	1.3	1.2	1.3	1.3	1.1	1.0
Days' Inventory	44.5	44.1	47.5	111.9	51.4	70.3	59.9	41.0
Days' Payables	51.2	57.8	84.0	92.8	38.3	71.7	64.9	43.5
Days' Receivables	5.4	3.9	13.2	11.1	31.0	18.4	12.9	7.5
Inventory Turnover	8.2	8.3	7.7	3.3	7.1	6.0	6.9	14.2
Payables Turnover	7.1	6.3	4.3	3.9	9.5	5.9	6.3	11.4
Quick Ratio	0.3	0.3	1.0	0.7	0.8	0.8	0.6	0.5
Sales/Receivables	67.8	92.5	27.7	33.0	11.8	24.2	46.6	113.1
Sales/Working Capital	-18.3	-16.8	10.2	14.6	16.2	13.7	1.2	-12.6

Coverage Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	1.3	6.5	22.8	16.1	14.9	18.0	12.4	8.3
Interest Coverage	3.8	4.7	20.1	10.1	3.4	11.2	8.4	6.0

Leverage Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Debt/Net Worth	2.8	2.3	3.7	5.1	3.7	4.2	3.5	2.9
Fixed Assets/Net Worth	2.0	1.6	3.5	5.6	4.6	4.6	3.5	2.5
Tangible Net Worth	36.2	43.2	27.0	19.7	27.2	24.6	30.7	36.9

Operating Ratios

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
EBIT/Revenue	2.8	3.2	7.9	4.8	5.5	6.1	4.8	3.5
EBITDA/Revenue	5.1	5.4	10.2	9.2	8.1	9.2	7.6	5.9
Return on Assets, %	2.8	3.2	7.9	4.8	5.5	6.1	4.8	4.5
Sales/Total Assets	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.4

Cash Flow & Debt Service Ratios (% of sales)

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Cash after Operations	2.0	9.7	18.4	12.4	40.4	23.7	16.6	14.2
Cash from Trading	7.7	16.5	32.9	21.1	53.2	35.7	26.3	23.0
Debt Service P&I Coverage	-0.2	3.6	2.5	1.1	5.2	2.9	2.4	3.5
Interest Coverage (Operating Cash)	-1.5	13.0	25.8	28.4	30.4	28.2	19.2	18.8
Net Cash after Operations	-1.1	8.7	10.2	13.4	48.9	24.2	16.0	13.4

Industry Tax Structure

Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
Taxes Paid/Revenue	0.5	0.5	2.5	0.6	0.8	1.3	1.0	1.2

Valuation Multiples

Earnings Ratio	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	3-Year	5-Year	10-Year
EV/Revenue	0.7	0.6	0.4	0.5	0.7	0.5	0.6	0.7
EV/EBITDA	6.6	5.9	3.9	5.3	9.2	6.1	6.2	38.1
EV/EBIT	24.4	20.3	5.1	10.1	13.4	9.6	14.7	9.9

Key Ratios

Year	Revenue per Employee ($k)	Revenue per Enterprise ($bn)	Employees per Establishment (Units)	Employees per Enterprise (k)	Average Wage ($k)	Wages/ Revenue (%)	Establishments per Enterprise (Units)	IVA/Revenue (%)
2007	510.1	7.5	293.3	14.7	34.3	6.7	50.1	11.2
2008	378.4	15.9	311.5	42.0	33.1	8.8	135.0	13.8
2009	369.9	24.0	314.7	64.8	32.9	8.9	206.0	13.0
2010	400.7	22.6	293.9	56.3	34.1	8.5	191.5	13.4
2011	419.0	32.8	286.4	78.2	34.3	8.2	273.1	13.2
2012	407.5	18.0	270.0	44.1	34.8	8.5	163.4	13.6
2013	407.7	48.9	275.2	119.9	33.4	8.2	435.7	12.7
2014	411.8	37.4	270.3	90.9	34.7	8.4	336.3	13.0
2015	399.0	33.8	268.9	84.8	35.9	9.0	315.5	13.0
2016	390.0	36.4	278.0	93.2	35.8	9.2	335.4	13.7
2017	393.3	39.1	279.0	99.3	36.3	9.2	355.9	12.1
2018	402.7	39.5	280.1	98.1	37.4	9.3	350.2	13.5
2019	404.6	40.0	274.1	98.9	38.2	9.4	360.9	13.5
2020	416.1	39.4	282.4	94.7	38.2	9.2	335.5	13.4
2021	408.4	40.9	300.6	100.1	38.1	9.3	333.1	14.3
2022	407.2	44.5	308.6	109.3	35.5	8.7	354.1	13.4
2023	425.2	46.8	315.8	110.0	36.7	8.6	348.3	12.8

Year	Revenue per Employee ($k)	Revenue per Enterprise ($bn)	Employees per Establishment (Units)	Employees per Enterprise (k)	Average Wage ($k)	Wages/ Revenue (%)	Establishments per Enterprise (Units)	IVA/Revenue (%)
2024	427.0	47.8	319.1	111.9	36.7	8.6	350.7	12.8
2025	428.2	48.7	322.2	113.7	36.7	8.6	352.9	12.9
2026	428.7	49.5	324.9	115.5	36.7	8.6	355.6	12.9
2027	428.9	50.3	328.1	117.2	36.7	8.6	357.3	12.9
2028	429.1	51.1	330.8	119.0	36.7	8.6	359.6	12.9
2029	429.8	48.8	333.0	113.6	36.7	8.6	341.1	12.9
2030	430.4	49.6	334.8	115.1	36.7	8.5	343.8	12.9
2031	430.9	50.3	336.2	116.8	36.8	8.5	347.4	12.9
2032	431.4	51.1	337.5	118.5	36.8	8.5	351.1	12.9

Key Statistics

Industry Data

Values

Year	Revenue ($m)	IVA ($m)	Establishments (Units)	Enterprises (Units)	Employment (Units)	Wages ($m)
2007	495,007.7	55,279.2	3,308	66	970,321	33,322.7
2008	525,056.4	72,371.3	4,454	33	1,387,411	45,958.4
2009	527,462.3	68,644.3	4,531	22	1,425,930	46,888.0
2010	541,321.2	72,737.1	4,597	24	1,350,864	46,073.1
2011	557,114.1	73,495.2	4,643	17	1,329,609	45,578.5
2012	575,528.0	78,362.2	5,230	32	1,412,175	49,120.3
2013	586,527.5	74,619.8	5,228	12	1,438,580	48,051.8
2014	598,838.1	78,027.3	5,381	16	1,454,239	50,509.0
2015	609,297.0	78,927.4	5,679	18	1,527,210	54,896.7
2016	618,121.8	84,486.1	5,702	17	1,584,912	56,669.8
2017	624,854.7	75,438.0	5,694	16	1,588,736	57,723.6
2018	632,021.0	85,572.6	5,603	16	1,569,558	58,722.3
2019	640,434.0	86,476.9	5,775	16	1,582,798	60,415.1
2020	670,139.6	89,553.0	5,703	17	1,610,492	61,452.1
2021	695,277.7	99,269.4	5,663	17	1,702,516	64,914.6
2022	711,913.3	95,026.5	5,665	16	1,748,344	62,073.8
2023	748,274.0	96,011.0	5,573	16	1,759,712	64,508.1
2024	764,475.9	98,122.0	5,611	16	1,790,292	65,685.9
2025	778,928.3	100,328.8	5,646	16	1,819,103	66,780.2
2026	792,481.2	102,111.1	5,690	16	1,848,727	67,880.8
2027	804,490.6	103,809.5	5,717	16	1,875,652	68,877.4
2028	816,823.5	105,578.8	5,754	16	1,903,593	69,909.4
2029	829,722.7	107,135.7	5,798	17	1,930,687	70,926.2
2030	842,382.0	108,317.7	5,845	17	1,957,008	71,916.2
2031	855,424.0	110,054.1	5,905	17	1,985,203	72,967.8
2032	868,978.4	111,839.6	5,969	17	2,014,246	74,053.0

Annual Change

Year	Revenue (%)	IVA (%)	Establishments (%)	Enterprises (%)	Employment (%)	Wages (%)
2008	6.1	30.9	34.6	-50.0	43.0	37.9
2009	0.5	-5.1	1.7	-33.3	2.8	2.0
2010	2.6	6.0	1.5	9.1	-5.3	-1.7
2011	2.9	1.0	1.0	-29.2	-1.6	-1.1
2012	3.3	6.6	12.6	88.2	6.2	7.8
2013	1.9	-4.8	-0.0	-62.5	1.9	-2.2
2014	2.1	4.6	2.9	33.3	1.1	5.1
2015	1.7	1.2	5.5	12.5	5.0	8.7
2016	1.4	7.0	0.4	-5.6	3.8	3.2
2017	1.1	-10.7	-0.1	-5.9	0.2	1.9
2018	1.1	13.4	-1.6	0.0	-1.2	1.7
2019	1.3	1.1	3.1	0.0	0.8	2.9
2020	4.6	3.6	-1.2	6.3	1.7	1.7
2021	3.8	10.8	-0.7	0.0	5.7	5.6
2022	2.4	-4.3	0.0	-5.9	2.7	-4.4
2023	5.1	1.0	-1.6	0.0	0.7	3.9
2024	2.2	2.2	0.7	0.0	1.7	1.8
2025	1.9	2.2	0.6	0.0	1.6	1.7
2026	1.7	1.8	0.8	0.0	1.6	1.6
2027	1.5	1.7	0.5	0.0	1.5	1.5
2028	1.5	1.7	0.6	0.0	1.5	1.5
2029	1.6	1.5	0.8	6.3	1.4	1.5
2030	1.5	1.1	0.8	0.0	1.4	1.4
2031	1.5	1.6	1.0	0.0	1.4	1.5
2032	1.6	1.6	1.1	0.0	1.5	1.5

Figures are inflation adjusted to 2026-2027

Key Success Factors

Key Success Factors

How do successful businesses overcome volatility?

Control inventory

Managing inventory ensures that products are always available, particularly if the products are highly sought after because of a viral marketing campaign.

Secure a flexible workforce

Like other retail industries, warehouse clubs and supercenters have flexible workforces, which helps stores rotate staff as needed, particularly during extended holiday hours. Many retailers have struggled to maintain sufficient workforce levels in recent years, despite rising minimum wage requirements in many states.

What products or services do successful businesses offer?

Adopt a high-volume, low-margin strategy

Consumers are price-conscious, so warehouse clubs and supercenters will struggle if they have significant price markups. Focusing on a high-volume, low-profit sales strategy is more sustainable.

Supply a diverse range of products

Stores should supply a wide range of products comparable to those of their external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

How do businesses use location to their advantage?

Operate in a highly visible location

Being in a highly visible spot off major roads keeps the store top of mind and easy to find, which can boost spontaneous visits and repeat traffic for big-box formats that rely on very high sales volumes.

Operate in a location that is close to key markets

Proximity to densely populated areas enables retailers to maximize foot traffic and sales. Clear signage, easy access and ample parking space also attract shoppers.

How do successful businesses handle concentration?

Develop a strong reputation

Retailers can improve customer loyalty by developing a strong reputation for quality and price. Customers have many options when choosing between retailers, so a strong reputation will fuel higher revenue.

Leverage economies of scope

With economies of scope, warehouse clubs and supercenters can lower the cost of doing business, which typically translates into lower consumer prices. Given the high degree of market saturation, offering low prices is crucial.

How can potential entrants overcome barriers to entry?

Comply with government regulations

Warehouse clubs and supercenters handle and sell various food items, so they must adhere to a range of policies and regulations. Adhering to these policies can reduce operating expenses and limit exposure to fines.

Develop links with suppliers

Warehouse clubs and supercenters should stock the latest products and offer the widest variety to attract more shoppers and generate repeat business. Developing strong links with suppliers ensures that stores will have access to products.

How do successful businesses compete with substitutes?

Closely monitor the competition

Grocery stores and other substitutes compete on price because of the low level of product differentiation. Retailers must monitor when competitors offer discounts and promotions to avoid losing customers and adjust their own prices or offers in response.

Develop a wide and expanding product range

Retailers should offer a wide range of products comparable to those of external competitors, such as supermarkets, grocery stores, department stores and furniture stores.

How do successful businesses manage buyer & supplier power?

Control distribution arrangements

Retailers compete on value and product offerings. Warehouse clubs and supercenters control their distribution facilities or maintain strict distributor agreements for low prices.

Develop a loyal customer base

Since some stores require paid membership, club stores and supercenters should ensure that consumers' needs are met and feel valued. Otherwise, consumers can easily switch to a competitor.

Call Preparation Questions

Role Specific Questions

Sales & Marketing

Have any products seen significantly increased sales volumes?

- Food and beverages typically make up the largest part of revenue. Warehouse clubs and supercenters rely on sales from all sort of products to remain competitive.

Are your company's sales heavily dependent on the health of the US economy?

- Demand is fairly stable regardless of the health of the overall economy.
- When the economy is strong, low-income earners spend more at industry stores.
- When the economy is weak, high-income consumers turn to supercenters and warehouse clubs in search of a bargain.

Strategy & Operations

Have rising input costs negatively affected your company's sales?

- Rising input costs have a higher impact on profit rather than sales.
- Strong increases in the world price of oil will boost transportation costs and hurt profit.

Do you contract directly with manufacturers to reduce purchase costs?

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters generally have strong buying power as a result of their size. Most stores contract directly with manufacturers, rather than wholesalers, to reduce purchase costs.

Technology

How does your company utilize new technology, like [example: RFID tags, etc.], in its operations?

- Having proper inventory levels is very important in this industry. New technology, including RFID tags, has helped reduce issues with inventory and demand.

How has your company reacted to the rise of online sales in recent years? How have you worked to combat this increased competition?

- While some stores have boosted their online presence in response to high demand for e-commerce, many supercenters have struggled because of growing online sales.

Compliance

Have any regulatory expenses significantly impacted profitability recently?

- While tariff rates impact profitability, no major regulatory change has taken place in recent years.

What does your company do to remain compliant with new consumer regulations?

- Most stores are large enough to have in-house compliance teams. Otherwise, industry associations help support these retailers in regard to compliance.

Finance

How often does your company purchase new equipment? Have you recently been looking to upgrade your stores or distribution centers in any way?

- Technological changes do not strongly impact this industry. Most stores rarely need to purchase new equipment. To remain competitive with e-commerce, many warehouse clubs and supercenters are renovating their stores to incorporate new technology.

How have volatile input prices affected profit in recent years? In what ways have you been able to leverage your economies of scale to secure favorable contracts with suppliers?

- Since the industry resells new goods, profit is directly affected by the price they must pay to upstream manufacturers.

External Impacts Questions

World price of crude oil

Are you able to pass on increasing crude oil prices to your customers in the form of higher gas prices? Does demand for your discounted gasoline increase when the price of gasoline increases?

- Many warehouse clubs and supercenters have gasoline stations that generate a share of revenue. Revenue typically increases when gas prices rise.

Percentage of services conducted online

How does online retail affect your business model? Have you considered changing your revenue model to offer online purchasing?

- An increase in the percentage of services conducted online reflects an increase in the share of consumers who opt to purchase their items online, which siphons revenue from warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Per capita disposable income

What incentives or promotions do you provide to get consumers into your stores, especially when disposable income is low?

- While warehouse clubs and supercenters remain attractive during periods of low disposable income due to their discounted prices, consumers spend less per trip when disposable income is low.

Internal Issues Questions

Having a loyal customer base

What do you do to promote loyalty within your stores? Do you have loyalty or rewards cards?

- Since some stores require paid membership. Warehouse clubs and supercenters should ensure that consumers' needs are met.
- This industry is extremely competitive and stores have limited levels of differentiation.

Ability to control stock on hand

How do you maintain optimum quality control?

- Retailers in this industry need to have stringent control measures to ensure that popular items are reordered, low-selling stock is disposed of and a sufficient product range is available.

Control of distribution

Does your company have close relationships with distributors? How can you make those relationships more secure?

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters compete on value offerings. To maintain low prices, stores often control their own distribution facilities or maintain strict agreements with distributors.

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Warehouse Clubs & Supercenters in the US

Taylor Kelly
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About

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Risk Overview

Recent Developments

Companies Overview

By attempting to freeze its global headcount for at least three years, Walmart is making a strategic shift toward tech-driven productivity. The move highlights how automation is increasingly replacing traditional labor growth across major retail operations.

Costco sells a wide range of products marketed under its in-house brand, Kirkland Signature. The Kirkland Signature line has seen a surge in sales over the past five years as economic uncertainty prompted customers to favor value-oriented items over national brands.

Competitive Forces

Retailers compete primarily on price. The retail model that warehouse clubs and supercenters use encourages shoppers to buy in bulk to achieve cost savings through a low price-per-use.

Online retailers pose the largest threat to warehouse clubs and supercenters. Because of lower overhead costs, online sellers can compete effectively based on price. In response, many warehouse clubs and supercenters have invested significantly in their online platforms.

External Environment

Individual states cover regulations relevant to the retail industry in general. Congress and the state enact trade regulations to maintain a free and competitive economy.

Economic development tax credits help governments attract and support growing businesses. By offering tax breaks in return for local job creation and investment, companies like Costco can reinvest savings into expansion, efficiency and lower prices.

Financial Benchmarks

Purchasing costs have rebounded to more typical levels after pandemic-era lows. As supply chains normalized and product mixes shifted toward higher-cost fresh and prepared items, merchandise expenses rose, though sourcing strategies kept pricing competitive.

Wage pressure has eased even as staffing levels expand across stores. Lower overtime and normalized hiring conditions have reduced average salaries relative to revenue, though operations remain labor-intensive and larger chains still offer more competitive compensation.

Profit has cooled from its peak but remains stable overall. Membership fees, private-label products and in-store services continue to cushion profitability, helping retailers offset higher costs while maintaining a strong value proposition for shoppers.

Geographic Breakdown

The Southeast stands out as a prime expansion zone for warehouse clubs and supercenters thanks to fast suburban growth and business-friendly policies. Retailers benefit from easier approvals, lower development costs and strong value-driven demand that supports rapid network scaling.

The Great Lakes region offers a stable, logistics-driven environment that sustains consistent demand for large-format retail. Dense freight networks and cost-conscious middle-income households make it efficient to operate while ensuring steady bulk-buying behavior across metro and suburban markets.

The West attracts warehouse club businesses with its mix of high incomes, car-oriented lifestyles and established big-box retail culture. Strong purchasing power and familiarity with membership models help sustain large basket sizes and reinforce long-term investment in the region.

Performance

Private-label expansion is accelerating as budget-conscious shoppers trade down while continuing to buy in bulk. Retailers are capitalizing on this shift by strengthening in-house brands, boosting profit and increasing basket sizes through value-driven assortments.

Warehouse clubs are enhancing membership value to sustain high renewal rates in a more competitive and cost-sensitive environment. They're adding exclusive perks, essential services and personalized offers to reinforce loyalty and justify annual fees.

Strategic partnerships and targeted M&A will become critical for scaling logistics and data capabilities. Collaborations with last-mile and tech providers, alongside acquisitions of AI and cloud platforms, help retailers accelerate innovation without heavy in-house development.

Omnichannel success increasingly depends on turning stores into flexible fulfillment and service hubs. Retailers that integrate logistics, data, and physical locations into a coordinated network will be better positioned to handle fragmented, multi-platform shopping journeys.

Products Markets

Bulk grocery pricing remains the core traffic driver for warehouse clubs and supercenters. As inflation outpaces income growth, shoppers are shifting toward private labels and bulk staples to stretch budgets, boosting loyalty and accelerating share gains for value-focused formats.

Ancillary services and high-margin add-ons are increasing total basket size and reinforcing customer stickiness. Discount fuel, health and beauty products and convenient in-store services turn routine trips into multi-purpose visits, strengthening membership value and repeat traffic.

Middle-income households anchor sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters by balancing value with selective upgrades. They rely on one-stop trips for essentials and occasional higher-quality items, using bulk savings and broad assortments to stretch budgets without sacrificing choice.

Small businesses provide a steady demand base for warehouse clubs and supercenters through recurring bulk purchases. Their consistent orders for consumables such as paper goods, snacks and cleaning supplies help stabilize volume, even as they trim discretionary spending amid economic pressure.

Industry Definition & Activities

Definition

This industry includes large stores that primarily retail a general line of grocery products and merchandise items (e.g., apparel and appliances). Warehouse clubs offer customers a wide selection of goods, often in bulk and at discounted prices, in exchange for a membership fee paid by each customer. Supercenters are large discount department stores that also sell perishable groceries. However, unlike warehouse clubs, supercenters don't require customers to join.

The primary activities of this industry are:

- Retailing food and beverages
- Retailing home and appliance
- Retailing health, beauty and wellness
- Retailing apparel and accessories
- Retailing fuel and other products

Industry Risk Score

Risk Component	Level	Weight (%)	Score
Structural risk	Medium - Low	25	4.5
Growth risk	Medium - High	25	5.4
Sensitivity risk	Medium	50	4.8
Overall risk	Medium	N/A	4.9

Note

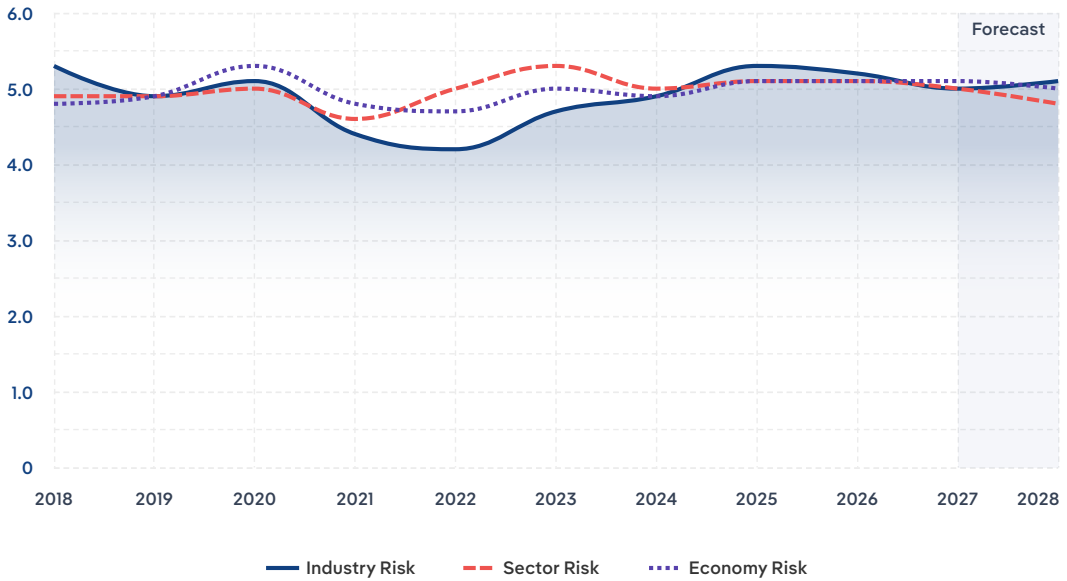
Forecast Period: Ending April 15, 2027

The overall risk score is calculated by evaluating three areas: industry structure (structural risk), future outlook (growth risk) and exposure to economic forces (sensitivity risk). Each component is scored on a scale from 1 to 9, with 1 being the lowest risk and 9 the highest. The three component scores are then weighted and combined to produce the overall risk score.

Risk Rating Analysis

Risk Rating

Overall risk in the Warehouse Clubs & Supercenters industry is forecast to be MEDIUM over 2027. The primary negative factor affecting this industry is high competition, while the primary positive factor is a low revenue volatility. Overall risk will be slightly lower than the previous year, a result of favorable movements in corporate profit as well as per capita disposable income. However, their impact will be partially offset by a projected rise in growth risk.



IBISWorld

Sources: IBISWorld

Risk Score Trend Analysis

Overall risk in the Warehouse Clubs & Supercenters industry is forecast to be MEDIUM over 2027. The primary negative factor affecting this industry is high competition, while the primary positive factor is a low revenue volatility. Overall risk will be slightly lower than the previous year, a result of favorable movements in corporate profit as well as per capita disposable income. However, their impact will be partially offset by a projected rise in growth risk.

Risk Score Context

In 2027, the average risk score for all US industries is expected to be in the MEDIUM band. Furthermore, the risk score for the Retail Trade sector, which includes this industry, is also at a MEDIUM level. Therefore, the level of risk in the Warehouse Clubs & Supercenters industry will be similar to that of the US economy and the Retail Trade sector.

Structural Risk Analysis

Structural risk will be MEDIUM-LOW over the outlook period. This industry struggles with high competition. Businesses competing for market share must incur expenses to differentiate offerings or keep prices low to entice demand. This results in greater likelihood of declining revenue and lower profits. This industry is currently in the mature phase of its life cycle which exhibits limited growth in demand opportunities and forces operators to compete for the remaining sales in order to survive. Existing operators will benefit from steady, low levels of assistance from outside organizations as this assistance mitigates some risk experienced elsewhere. Operators in the industry benefit from high and steady barriers to entry which buffer against long-run competition by hindering the entry of new players to the marketplace.

Growth Risk Score Analysis

Growth risk is expected to be MEDIUM-HIGH over the outlook period. IBISWorld forecasts that annual industry revenue will grow 1.5% to $804.5 billion. In comparison, revenue expanded 1.8% per year between 2024 and 2026.

Sensitivity Risk Analysis

Sensitivity risk is forecast to be MEDIUM over the outlook period, down marginally from 2026. The two factors with the most significant impacts on the industry are corporate profit and per capita disposable income. A rise in either of these factors will lower industry risk.

Corporate profit: Small businesses stock up on a range of office supplies, from coffee and desk chairs to staples and kitchen supplies. Improved corporate profit and business sentiment encourage increased spending at warehouse clubs. This segment is important to performance, as offices tend to place bulk orders that generate significant revenue. This factor's contribution to risk is expected to decrease in the coming year.

Per capita disposable income: High disposable income levels strengthen the likelihood that households will spend liberally on discretionary goods, strengthening overall sales at warehouse clubs and supercenters. While these establishments remain attractive when disposable income is low, consumers spend less per trip. Warehouse clubs and supercenters cater to growing appetites for consumer products and spending on these goods is closely related to per capita disposable income. This factor's contribution to risk is expected to decrease in the coming year.

Percentage of business conducted online: Brick-and-mortar stores incur higher overhead costs than online retailers. Online retailers can offer lower prices, wider inventories and easy direct shipping. A boost in the percentage of services conducted online reflects an expansion in the share of consumers who opt to purchase items online, siphoning revenue from warehouse clubs and supercenters. When the percentage drop, it poses as an opportunity for physical retailers to recapture foot traffic. This factor's contribution to risk is expected to increase in the coming year.

World price of crude oil: Many warehouse clubs and supercenters have gasoline stations that generate a share of revenue. Revenue typically increases with an uptick in the world price of crude oil since higher oil prices enable retailers to charge more for gasoline. Retailers typically sell their gasoline at competitive rates and price-conscious consumers prefer industry-operated gas stations when oil prices are high. When these prices drop, retailers' competitive edge dampens and revenue may slow. This factor's contribution to risk is expected to increase in the coming year.

Number of households: The number of households measures the level of household formation. Warehouse clubs and supercenters provide essential items for different types of markets, including households and individuals. As the number of households climbs, so will retail sales, as the industry will have a larger customer base. Growth in the number of households represents a potential opportunity for the industry, while declines pose a threat. This factor's contribution to risk is expected to remain the same in the coming year.

Structural Risk

Structural Risk Score

Structure Component	Level	Trend	Weight (%)	Score
Barriers to Entry	High	Steady	13	3.0
Competition	High	N/A	20	9.0
Industry Exports	Low	Steady	7	1.0
Industry Imports	Low	Steady	7	2.0
Level of Assistance	Low	Steady	13	7.0
Life Cycle Stage	Mature	N/A	20	5.0
Volatility of Industry	Low	N/A	20	1.0
Overall Structural Risk Score	Medium - Low	N/A	N/A	4.5

Note

The structural risk score reflects how an industry's fundamental characteristics affect its overall risk. Seven components are evaluated individually, then weighted and combined to calculate the score.

Barriers to Entry

High Steady

Legal

- Individual states set employment, safety and business rules that large-format retailers must follow, including minimum wage laws, overtime, scheduling and worker protection standards. On top of that, federal and state trade and consumer regulations cover pricing, labeling, data privacy, sustainability and sourcing, making compliance complex for multi-category warehouse clubs and supercenters.

Start-Up Costs

- Large club stores and supercenters benefit from volume-based purchasing, distribution and advertising discounts that lower their costs. Matching this scale requires substantial upfront capital to stock inventory, buy equipment and fixtures, secure or develop large sites, and build regional logistics. New entrants must commit heavily before sales volumes are proven or stable.

Differentiation

- Establishing a distinct brand and loyal customer base is essential because most retailers can source comparable branded and private-label goods. Product differences are limited, so warehouse clubs and supercenters focus on format, membership structure, price positioning, assortment breadth and perceived quality. Creating that differentiation requires ongoing investment in marketing and customer experience.

Capital Expenses

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters need continuous capital to build and expand large footprints, modernize stores and maintain extensive logistics networks. Leading chains also invest heavily in automation, data analytics and digital channels like online ordering and delivery. New businesses must match this ongoing spending to meet customer expectations on price, convenience and shopping experience.

Competition

High Increasing

- **Retailers compete primarily on price.** The retail model that warehouse clubs and supercenters use encourages shoppers to buy in bulk to achieve cost savings through a low price-per-use.
- **Online retailers pose the largest threat to warehouse clubs and supercenters.** Because of lower overhead costs, online sellers can

compete effectively based on price. In response, many warehouse clubs and supercenters have invested significantly in their online platforms.

Domestic And International Markets

Exports		Imports	
Low	Steady	Low	Steady

Assistance

Low Steady

National Retail Federation (NRF) and business loans

- The NRF is the world's largest retail trade association. It conducts programs and services in research, education, training, information technology and government affairs and policy advocacy to protect and advance the interests of various retail businesses. Private-sector banks and lending institutions offer loans and other commercial financing products tailored for large retail formats, providing critical capital for new store openings, inventory purchases, or technological upgrades. Access to affordable financing helps warehouse clubs and supercenters maintain competitiveness and meet consumer demand.

Tax credits

- Economic development tax credits are a powerful tool that governments use to attract businesses. These credits reduce a company's tax liability in exchange for commitments to create jobs and invest in local infrastructure. In addition to tax credits, governments may also provide other forms of incentives such as tax rebates, exemptions, or grants tied to project performance. This support can result in significant savings and may allow businesses to allocate more resources toward improving operational efficiency, expanding product lines and potentially lowering prices. In recent years, large warehouse clubs such as Costco have been the focus of multi-million-dollar, performance-based incentive packages from state and local governments designed to support new warehouse developments and associated job creation.

Life Cycle

Mature

Contribution to GDP

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters now grow roughly in line with the broader US economy, which is what you'd expect from a mature stage. Revenue is still rising, but gains are modest, so the focus has shifted to squeezing more efficiency and value out of existing large-format stores.

Market Saturation

- Retailers are deeply embedded in many urban and suburban markets, with big-box clubs and supercenters already serving most high-traffic areas. New sites exist but are harder to find and justify at scale, so growth leans more on remodeling, format tweaks and share gains within markets that already have strong coverage.

Innovation

- Most breakthrough product innovation now happens at the manufacturing level, where new brands and categories are developed. Retailers in this space innovate mainly around how they sell, such as refining private labels, adjusting pack sizes, improving merchandising and experimenting with services like pharmacy, fuel and health offerings that deepen customer relationships.

Consolidation

- The landscape for warehouse clubs and supercenters is already dominated by a few large players, so consolidation is less about big roll-up waves and more about targeted moves. Leading chains occasionally acquire regional banners or specific locations to strengthen coverage, but large-scale deals are limited, and smaller retailers still find it hard to gain meaningful share.

Technology and Systems

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters face steady pressure from e-commerce and direct-to-consumer models that offer comparable products without a store visit. Leading chains respond by expanding omnichannel capabilities tailored to bulk and big-basket trips,

including curbside pickup, scheduled delivery and more feature-rich mobile apps designed around the warehouse shopping experience.

Volatility

Low

Revenue is cushioned by everyday household spending

- Warehouse clubs and supercenters get most of their sales from everyday essentials like food and beverages, home and appliance items and health, beauty and wellness products. These are things people need regardless of economic conditions, so sales stay fairly steady. Because of that, sales tend to follow predictable patterns, avoiding big spikes or sharp declines and keeping overall revenue relatively stable.
- Since these products are frequently purchased and need to be restocked regularly, wholesalers benefit from a steady stream of transactions throughout the year rather than relying on occasional large purchases. This consistent buying behavior makes revenue less sensitive to short-term changes in consumer confidence and helps keep year-over-year growth relatively even, even after adjusting for inflation.

The dominance of two large brands stabilizes revenue

- Walmart and Costco together account for over 90.0% of sales in warehouse clubs and supercenters, meaning overall revenue mainly reflects the performance of these two very large, mature companies. Their scale, membership models and broad customer reach support steady year-over-year growth, helping the segment avoid sharp ups and downs in total revenue.
- Because these two chains set the tone on pricing, promotions and product ranges, conditions across the segment change gradually rather than suddenly. Smaller businesses tend to follow their lead, typically leading to fewer abrupt competitive shocks or large share price swings. This concentrated structure makes market-wide revenue behave more predictably and contributes to low measured volatility.

Growth Risk

Growth Risk Score

Growth Component	Level	Revenue (%)	Weight (%)	Score
2025-2027 Annualized growth	Medium	1.8	25	5.2
2027-2028 Forecast growth	Medium - High	1.5	75	5.5
Overall Growth Risk Score	Medium - High	N/A	N/A	5.4

Note

The growth risk score compares an industry's forecast revenue growth with its past performance and with expected growth across all industries. Higher growth rates generally indicate lower risk for industry operators.

Growth Risk Analysis

Warehouse clubs and supercenters have navigated mounting cost volatility, particularly around energy and logistics, while sustaining steady growth through scale and diversified offerings. Strong membership models have helped anchor sales, with recurring fees and high renewal rates reinforcing the value proposition for budget-conscious households facing higher living costs. At the same time, chains have deepened digital engagement, expanding mobile apps, online ordering and personalized promotions to connect omnichannel supply chains with rising expectations for speed and convenience. Stores are also increasingly being reconfigured as multi-use fulfillment hubs, supporting click-and-collect, curbside pickup and same-day delivery, underpinned by growing investment in automation, data-driven inventory management and AI-powered decision tools. Within this model, private-label portfolios play a larger role in driving traffic, offering competitively priced bulk options that resonate with value-seeking shoppers and support resilience. Revenue has been expanding at a CAGR of 2.7% over the past five years and is expected to reach $792.5 billion in 2026, when revenue will climb by an estimated 1.7%.

Despite these topline gains, profit has fallen from its recent peak as merchandise and logistics costs have outpaced retail price growth, compressing percentage profit even as volumes remain high. Retailers have leaned more heavily on private-label assortments and ancillary in-store services to offset this pressure, using higher-margin store brands, fuel operations and service departments to lift basket value and strengthen loyalty without compromising value positioning. Membership income has become an even more critical stabilizer, providing a relatively predictable, high-margin revenue stream that helps absorb cost shocks while allowing leading chains to preserve everyday low prices and selective promotional strategies.

Tightening environmental regulations and broader ESG expectations will reshape logistics, refrigeration choices and disclosure practices, compelling large-format retailers to invest in cleaner fleets, emissions tracking and more sustainable supply chains. To deliver on these requirements while maintaining convenience, retailers are expected to pursue targeted M&A and partnerships in last-mile logistics, cloud-based order management and AI-enabled planning, accelerating the build-out of unified commerce platforms. These moves will likely widen performance gaps, as larger players with deep data pools and capital out-invest smaller rivals, reinforcing high market concentration. As stores evolve into multi-purpose hubs that combine retail, fulfillment and growing health and wellness services, including pharmacy-based programs linked to GLP-1 medications, private labels will remain central to value, differentiation and shopper retention. Over the next five years, revenue is forecast to grow at a CAGR of 1.5%, reaching $855.4 billion in 2031.

Sensitivity Risk

Sensitivity Risk Score

Sensitivity Component	Level	Weight (%)	Score
Per capita disposable income	Low	30	3.8
Corporate profit	Medium	30	5.3
World price of crude oil	Medium - High	10	5.8
Number of households	Medium - High	5	5.3
Percentage of business conducted online	Medium - Low	25	4.7
Overall Sensitivity Risk Score	Medium	N/A	4.8

Note

We calculate sensitivity risk by examining external and exogenous factors that affect risk within the industry. Examples include input costs, number of housing starts, commodity prices, etc. This component contributes to 50% of the overall score.

Sensitivity Risk Analysis

Corporate profit

Estimated Value in 2026

$4,813.2 billion

2021-26 CAGR ↑ 9.1 %

2025-26 Change ↑ 15.8 %

Forecast Value in 2031

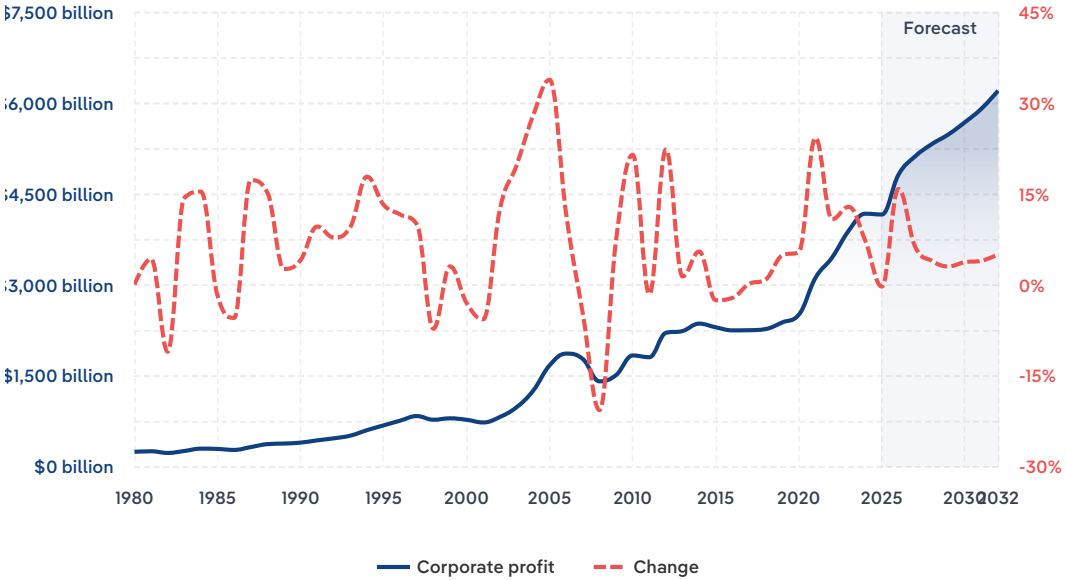
$5,904.0 billion

2026-31 CAGR ↑ 4.2 %

2026-27 Change ↑ 6.3 %

Corporate profit

The percentage change in real household disposable income from 1980-2032



IBISWorld

Sources: IBISWorld

Year	$ billion	Change (%)
1980	240.2	N/A
1981	250.4	4.3
1982	222.7	-11.1
1983	254.6	14.3
1984	293.6	15.3
1985	288.3	-1.8
1986	272.4	-5.5
1987	319.4	17.2
1988	368.0	15.2
1989	377.5	2.6
1990	392.8	4.0
1991	430.4	9.6
1992	463.9	7.8
1993	508.1	9.5
1994	598.6	17.8
1995	677.4	13.2
1996	755.9	11.6

Year	$ billion	Change (%)
1997	831.1	10.0
1998	770.5	-7.3
1999	793.8	3.0
2000	769.6	-3.0
2001	725.6	-5.7
2002	815.7	12.4
2003	976.1	19.7
2004	1,248.3	27.9
2005	1,670.2	33.8
2006	1,861.7	11.5
2007	1,770.5	-4.9
2008	1,403.9	-20.7
2009	1,508.3	7.4
2010	1,831.1	21.4
2011	1,802.2	-1.6
2012	2,203.9	22.3
2013	2,234.1	1.4
2014	2,356.1	5.5
2015	2,295.5	-2.6
2016	2,245.2	-2.2
2017	2,247.5	0.1
2018	2,266.6	0.8
2019	2,376.0	4.8
2020	2,503.8	5.4
2021	3,110.4	24.2
2022	3,445.9	10.8
2023	3,888.2	12.8
2024	4,170.2	7.3
2025	4,157.2	-0.3
2026	4,813.2	15.8
2027	5,115.5	6.3
2028	5,317.5	3.9
2029	5,477.0	3.0
2030	5,679.7	3.7
2031	5,904.0	3.9
2032	6,199.2	5.0

This item refers to corporate profit earned across all industries. Profit is calculated by subtracting the value of the following from revenue: wages after inventory valuation and capital consumption adjustments. Data is sourced from the Bureau of Economic Analysis and is presented in 2017 dollars.

Current Performance

Corporate profit is anticipated to increase by 10.2% in 2026, reaching $4,582.88 billion. Massive investment in AI infrastructure, including data center construction, is the main driver behind recent growth. Interest rate cuts toward the end of 2024 and 2025 lowered financing costs and bolstered business investment. Steady consumer demand, resilient job markets and record-level earnings from large technology firms will support profit. However, tariffs are projected to raise input costs for businesses reliant on imports, limiting profit gains.

From 2021 through 2026, corporate profit has shown robust recovery and subsequent moderation. In 2021, profit rebounded significantly, expanding by 24.2% as economic activity accelerated. Growth continued at 10.8% in 2022 as companies passed higher costs onto consumers, maintaining robust margins despite inflationary pressure. In 2023, profit increased by 9.9%, with interest rate hikes beginning to temper consumption and raise borrowing expenses, but strong performances among large technology companies continued to drive growth.

By 2024, high interest rates persisted, but resilient labor markets and strong consumer spending sustained an estimated 7.3% growth in profit. Monetary policy began to shift in late 2024, with rate cuts easing pressure on corporate financing. Macroeconomic trends like digital technology adoption, globalized supply chains and productivity enhancements contributed to profit stability. Meanwhile, cost pressures from labor and energy markets, as well as shifting trade and tariff regimes, intermittently constrained growth.

From 2021 through 2026, corporate profit grew at a CAGR of 8.1%, reflecting a post-pandemic rebound followed by normalization as disruptions waned. Macro trends, including strong consumer demand, capital investment in technology and labor market adjustments, played critical roles. However, evolving tariffs, global supply chain shifts and persistent inflation underscored ongoing risks to profit.

Outlook

Corporate profit is forecast to increase by 4.5% in 2027. AI-driven investments and efficiency gains are a leading catalyst for US corporate profit growth heading into 2027. Strong earnings are set to be powered by positive operating leverage, AI-fueled productivity, accommodating tax and regulatory policy and increased M&A activity, particularly benefiting financials, industrials and healthcare.

From 2026 through 2031, corporate profit levels are expected to grow, with profit expected to reach $5,694.58 billion by 2031. Deregulatory measures may create a more business-friendly environment, but these benefits could be offset by rising operational costs tied to tariffs, labor expenses and regulatory compliance. Companies may increase domestic production and invest in automation, though high initial costs will temper immediate profitability gains. Labor union activity is anticipated to pressure wages, further constraining growth.

Shifts in tax policy, with some states lowering corporate tax rates, may slightly ease the corporate tax burden. Firms might recapture increased costs through higher prices for goods and services, but consumer tolerance for price increases may be tested amid inflation expectations and economic uncertainty. Over the next five years, profit expansion will be limited by these converging trends, despite opportunities for growth among firms investing in efficiency improvements and automation.

World price of crude oil

Estimated Value in 2026

89.33 $ per barrel

2021-26 CAGR ↑ 5.2 %

2025-26 Change ↑ 31.9 %

Forecast Value in 2031

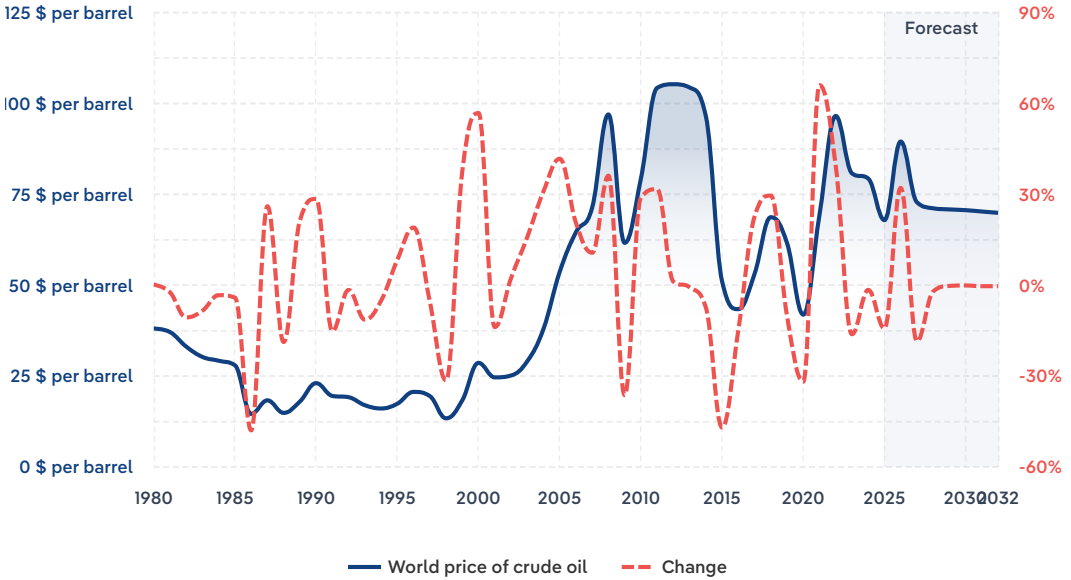
70.10 $ per barrel

2026-31 CAGR ↓ 4.7 %

2026-27 Change ↓ 18.7 %

World price of crude oil

The percentage change in real household disposable income from 1980-2032



IBISWorld

Sources: IBISWorld

Year	$ per barrel	Change (%)
1980	37.92	N/A
1981	36.95	-2.6
1982	32.95	-10.8
1983	30.11	-8.6
1984	29.06	-3.5
1985	27.81	-4.3
1986	14.44	-48.1
1987	18.17	25.8
1988	14.73	-18.9
1989	17.85	21.1
1990	22.90	28.3
1991	19.39	-15.3
1992	19.04	-1.8
1993	16.84	-11.5
1994	15.94	-5.3
1995	17.25	8.2
1996	20.50	18.8

Year	$ per barrel	Change (%)
1997	19.35	-5.6
1998	13.24	-31.6
1999	18.18	37.3
2000	28.47	56.6
2001	24.49	-14.0
2002	25.00	2.1
2003	28.91	15.6
2004	37.81	30.8
2005	53.51	41.5
2006	64.40	20.4
2007	71.19	10.5
2008	96.77	35.9
2009	61.50	-36.4
2010	79.14	28.7
2011	104.1	31.5
2012	105.1	1.0
2013	104.2	-0.9
2014	96.33	-7.5
2015	50.91	-47.1
2016	43.26	-15.0
2017	52.98	22.5
2018	68.53	29.4
2019	61.43	-10.4
2020	41.77	-32.0
2021	69.25	65.8
2022	96.36	39.2
2023	80.60	-16.4
2024	79.17	-1.8
2025	67.74	-14.4
2026	89.33	31.9
2027	72.65	-18.7
2028	70.99	-2.3
2029	70.68	-0.4
2030	70.47	-0.3
2031	70.10	-0.5
2032	69.74	-0.5

The world price of crude oil represents the benchmark price for petroleum in international markets, measured in nominal U.S. dollars per barrel. This metric reflects a composite or weighted average of major pricing benchmarks, including Brent crude (the European benchmark), West Texas Intermediate (WTI, the U.S. benchmark), and the OPEC basket. Crude oil pricing reflects the intersection of global supply dynamics, geopolitical events, OPEC+ production decisions, inventory levels, refining capacity constraints, and macroeconomic conditions. Data is sourced from the International Monetary Fund.

Current Performance

The world price of crude oil is expected to average $89.33 per barrel in 2026, representing a 31.9% increase from the $67.74 per barrel recorded in 2025. This increase is being driven by hostilities that broke out in Iran in late February 2026. A major consequence of these hostilities has been that the Strait of Hormuz, a major bottleneck for shipments out of the Persian Gulf, has effectively been closed to most shipping. This has been driving up oil prices as the market has been pricing in expectations of a future shortage; as the conflict has dragged on, that shortage has become more of a physical reality, and the risk that oil prices will be higher for longer has increased. More recent attacks on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait have restricted Saudi Oil exports through the Red Sea, which had been bypassing the Strait of Hormuz.

Prior to the conflict in Iran, the global oil market was facing oversupply, characterized by OPEC+ production increases, rising non-OPEC output, and concerns about demand growth. Saudi Arabia, the world's largest oil exporter, slashed December crude prices for Asian buyers in response to oversupply conditions, signaling expectations of continued price pressure.

The five-year period from 2021 to 2026 witnessed extraordinary volatility in crude oil prices. The compound annual growth rate of 2.6% during this period masks dramatic year-to-year swings driven by the COVID-19 pandemic, geopolitical conflicts, and shifts in production policy. In 2020, prices collapsed to $41.77 per barrel as pandemic lockdowns decimated global fuel demand and storage capacity approached limits. The subsequent recovery saw prices surge to $69.25 in 2021 and peak at $96.36 in 2022, driven by post-pandemic demand recovery, Russia's invasion of Ukraine, and Western sanctions on Russian energy exports.

The 2023-2024 period brought renewed price volatility, with crude averaging $80.60 in 2023 before moderating to $79.17 in 2024. OPEC+ maintained production discipline through voluntary cuts, with Saudi Arabia bearing the largest reductions to support prices. However, rising output from Iran and Venezuela, both exempt from OPEC+ quotas, along with strong U.S. shale production that reached near-record levels of 13.6 million barrels per day, offset these cuts. The transition to 2025 saw accelerating price declines as OPEC+ members began unwinding voluntary production cuts.

Outlook

The world price of crude oil is forecast to decline -18.7% to $72.65 per barrel in 2027, reflecting expectations of resumed travel through the Strait of Hormuz in the third quarter of 2026. The US Energy Information Administration projects that Brent crude (which is included in the average price reported by this BED) will average $90 per barrel in the second half of 2026 and fall to average $67 per barrel in the second half of 2027 as exports from the Middle East rebound and global inventories begin to build. Still, the situation remains volatile, and the near-term outlook is uncertain.

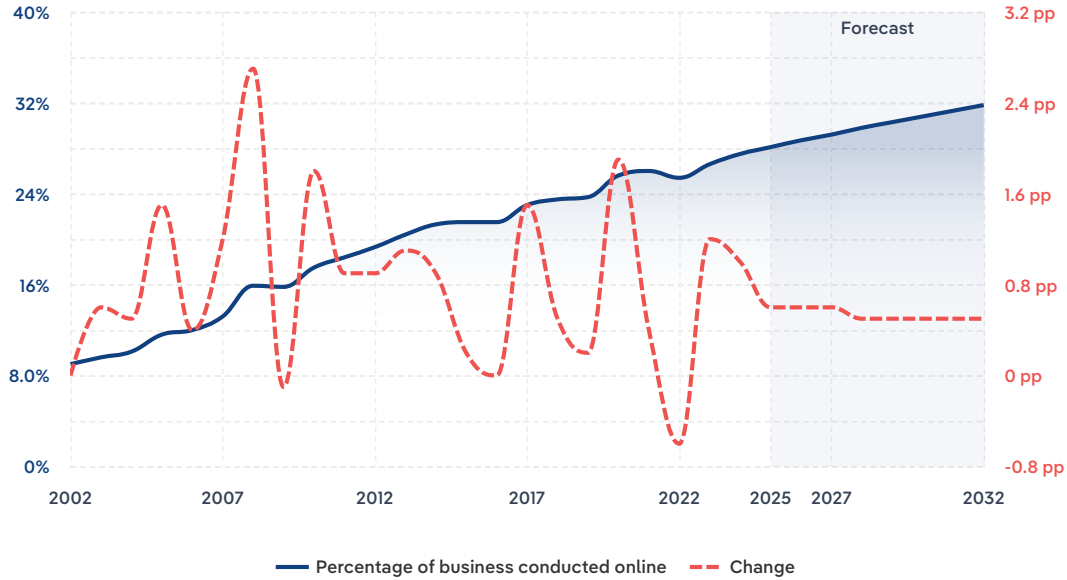
Crude oil prices are projected to stabilize in the $70 per barrel range through 2031, averaging approximately $70.10 per barrel in 2031. This represents a compound annual decline of -4.7% from 2026 levels, reflecting a resumption of regular production and export from the Middle East, along with structural headwinds including accelerating electric vehicle adoption, improving energy efficiency, renewable energy penetration and potentially softer demand growth from China. The outlook for oil prices is subject to a range of uncertainties, including the evolving situations in Iran and Venezuela, and the global transition to green energy.

Percentage of business conducted online

Estimated Value in 2026		Forecast Value in 2031	
28.7%	2021-26 AAGR ↑ 0.5 pp 2025-26 Change ↑ 0.6 pp	31.3%	2026-31 AAGR ↑ 0.5 pp 2026-27 Change ↑ 0.6 pp

Percentage of business conducted online

The percentage change in real household disposable income from 2002-2032



IBISWorld

Sources: IBISWorld

Year	%	Change (pp)
2002	9.0	N/A
2003	9.6	0.6
2004	10.1	0.5
2005	11.6	1.5
2006	12.0	0.4
2007	13.2	1.2
2008	15.9	2.7
2009	15.8	-0.1
2010	17.5	1.8
2011	18.4	0.9
2012	19.3	0.9
2013	20.4	1.1
2014	21.3	0.9
2015	21.5	0.2
2016	21.5	-0.0
2017	23.0	1.5
2018	23.5	0.5

Year	%	Change (pp)
2019	23.7	0.2
2020	25.6	1.9
2021	26.0	0.4
2022	25.4	-0.6
2023	26.6	1.2
2024	27.5	1.0
2025	28.1	0.6
2026	28.7	0.6
2027	29.2	0.6
2028	29.8	0.5
2029	30.3	0.5
2030	30.8	0.5
2031	31.3	0.5
2032	31.8	0.5

The percentage of business conducted online represents the increasing use of the internet by consumers and businesses for services they historically demanded in person (e.g. the use of email instead of written letters or video streaming services instead of DVDs). IBISWorld uses the revenue generated electronically in the manufacturing, wholesaling, retail and services sectors as a percentage of total revenue as a proxy for this effect. Data is sourced from the United States Census Bureau.

Current Performance

The share of business conducted online in the United States is climbing 2.1% to 28.7% in 2026, underpinned by stronger internet infrastructure and expanded data capacity that make digital platforms viable for a wider range of commercial activity. Retail migration remains the defining driver. Merchants continue shifting volume from physical storefronts to online channels, moving a growing portion of transaction activity into digital environments. Mobile device improvements amplify the effect, smoothing the checkout process enough to pull in buyers who previously defaulted to in-store visits. Social commerce contributes a distinct layer of growth. Familiarity with integrated shopping features on social platforms runs highest among younger consumers, who increasingly complete purchases without leaving those environments and return to them for repeat transactions. Deloitte survey data places digital capability expansion near the top of CFO priority lists for the year, indicating that budget allocation is following the demand shift rather than lagging it.

Key events shaping this five-year period include the structural change initiated by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020, which resulted in a sharp 7.9% increase in the online share of business activity. The pandemic's effects, hybrid work models, wide-scale adoption of online shopping, and higher digital literacy, anchored permanent behavioral adjustments among consumers and businesses. The reopening of the economy in 2021 saw a slowdown in the rate of growth for online business activity, but the foundation laid during the pandemic established elevated levels of digital engagement. The growing presence of digital advertising and the decline of traditional media reinforced reliance on e-commerce and digital services. Mobile applications became more integral to purchasing behavior, encouraging seamless user experiences and frequent online buying. Accessibility and affordability of broadband internet in new regions modestly expanded the addressable digital market, making digital transformation a critical cost-reduction strategy for firms and incentivizing further investments in online infrastructure.

Over the period from 2021 to 2026, the share of online business activity grew at an annualized rate of 2.0%, reflecting the persistent trend towards greater digital engagement. The sustained increase in online commerce was primarily driven by technological advancements, shifting consumer preferences, and ongoing business process digitalization that accelerated after the structural changes in 2020.

Outlook

The online business rate is set to climb 1.9% to 29.2% in 2027, driven by sustained investment in internet infrastructure and cloud-based platforms that lower the barrier to digital adoption for consumers and enterprises alike. Sector-specific demand accounts for much of the acceleration. A 2026 Deloitte survey points to airlines as a leading adopter on two fronts: carriers are expanding New Distribution Capability implementations to gain direct control over fare content and merchandising, while simultaneously scaling cybersecurity investment to protect the systems handling those transactions. Both categories deepen reliance on connectivity-dependent services. Adjacent capabilities

compound the shift. Real-time tracking and similar tools are moving from optional add-ons to baseline expectations across logistics, retail and service industries, sustaining demand growth beyond the forecast year.

From 2026 to 2031, data capacity expansion within internet networks and improvements in mobile technology are forecast to drive further increases in online transactions and the rollout of additional digital services. Cost reductions enabled by ongoing advances in cloud computing will likely continue to motivate companies to transition analog business processes online. The growing digital familiarity among younger generations is expected to reinforce this trend and cement the long-term dominance of online business activity. The proliferation of data centers will add capacity, support lower latency for business operations, and allow increased deployment of AI software in digital commerce. The rising importance of digital advertising and the further decline of print media are anticipated to accelerate digital migration in the business environment.

Risk Score Methodology

What is Industry Risk?

Industry risk is the difficulty or otherwise of operating in an industry. We calculate industry risk using non-financial information. We represent industry risk with forward-looking numerical scores for specific industries. Industry Risk Scores measure the expected risk for the upcoming 12 to 18 months.

Industry Risk Scoring Methodology

We represent industry risk on a scale of 1 to 9, where 1 represents the lowest risk, and 9 is the highest risk.Industry risk is broken down into Growth, Structure and Sensitivity risk, which are combined to calculate the overall risk score.

Growth: Growth risk is a combination of recent and forecast growth scores. Growth scores account for between 0 and 25% of the overall score.The base case contribution is 25%, which is dampened at inflection points where extreme declines produce misleading positive forecast growth.

Structure: We calculate structural risk by analyzing internal industry risk factors.These factors are an industry's volatility, barriers to entry, external assistance, trade exposure, imports and exports (if any), industry life cycle and amount of competition. When our analysis identifies that an external factor creates a transitory shift to industry structure, the ratings are subjected to a structural adjustment score. The structure score contributes 25% plus any contribution dampened from the growth score.

Sensitivity: We calculate sensitivity risk by examining external and exogenous factors that affect risk within the industry.Examples include input costs, number of housing starts, commodity prices, etc.This component contributes to 50% of the overall score.

Risk Rating Score Ranges

Very Low	Low	Medium-Low	Moderate	Medium-High	High	Very High
1.0-3.0	3.0-4.1	4.1-4.7	4.7-5.3	5.3-5.9	5.9-7.0	7.0-9.0

IBISWorld

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Mumbai Viral Video | FlipkartDelivery Agent Accidentally Steps On Woman's Rangoli, Quietly Fixes It (WATCH)
11/07/2026

A Mumbai woman discovered a little act of kindness on her CCTV footage after a Flipkart delivery agent, who had accidentally stepped on her rangoli, took a moment to sit down and fix the design before heading off.

As the client opened the door to retrieve her product, the delivery man was seen in the video ringing the doorbell and pulling out his phone. The man went to exit after she took the delivery and shut the door, only to realize that he had unintentionally stepped on the rangoli close to the entry.
Instead than leaving it destroyed and going away, he took a seat next to it and started meticulously reassembling the design. Before getting up and walking away, he spent some time repairing the pattern and was able to restore a significant chunk of it.

Drashti clarified in her commentary that she had taken a long time creating the rangoli and did not anticipate that anyone would take the effort to fix it. She expressed gratitude to the delivery agent for fixing the design without being asked, saying that it had brightened her day.

Watch Viral Video

View this post on InstagramA post shared by Drashtiiiiii (@drashtiisthisyouu)

Viewers responded favorably to the video, praising the delivery person for accepting responsibility for an unintentional error. Even though he might have received complaints from another client for being late, one user noted that he had taken time out of his hectic delivery schedule to fix the rangoli.

Some said he must have been concerned after inadvertently destroying something the woman had worked so hard to create, while others explained the action as a reminder that tiny deeds of kindness may rebuild one's confidence in humanity.

Source: Asianet News

He Turns Walmart's Shopper Data Into Profits -- WSJ
11/07/2026

Seth Dallaire is bringing his data-mining expertise from Amazon to the ad market, an area where giant Walmart is small

By Suzanne Vranica and Sarah Nassauer
To understand how Walmart obsesses over its customers, Seth Dallaire suggests picturing how K-pop fans study every move of the band BTS.

The retailer's chief growth officer is big on customer data and big on storytelling. The key to getting buy-in, Dallaire said, has been translating the unfamiliar ad-speak and strategies he picked up in jobs at tech companies, like monetizing shopper data, into the language his Walmart colleagues know: a relentless focus on lowering costs for customers.

"You really have to be part of the furniture," Dallaire said in an interview. "I'm going to sit in your meetings, I'm going to learn as much as I can.My ask back is just some reciprocity: that you be willing to listen to me."

Dallaire, 56 years old, spent most of his career building the advertising business at Amazon and was doing the same at Instacart when Walmart recruited him five years ago as a rare outside senior hire. Earlier this year Dallaire was promoted to oversee nearly all of Walmart's high-growth businesses globally.

Walmart executives have long touted the potential to monetize the data it collects on the 280 million people who pass through its nearly 11,000 stores and digital channels each week in 19 countries. They anonymize it and sell the insights into shopper behavior to product manufacturers that sell their wares through Walmart. Access to this consumer data has created a huge ad business.

Dallaire is under pressure to boost revenue and profits. Walmart's domestic in-store sales have slowed and rival Amazon unseated it as the largest U.S. company by annual revenue earlier this year.

Walmart generated nearly $6.4 billion in global ad revenue in its last fiscal year, a fraction of Amazon's $68.6 billion, according to the companies.

Raised in Seattle, Dallaire was captain of the lacrosse team at Vassar College and went on to earn an M.B.A. from New York University's Stern School of Business.

He envisioned a career in music or media, but changed course while sharing an office space with two employees of instant-messaging startup Mirabilis, during his summer internship at a micropayments startup. He watched them skateboard through the office -- actually an apartment space on Manhattan's West 4th Street -- high-fiving over their recent sale to AOL, a deal valued at roughly $400 million.

"It was super exciting," Dallaire said on a 2023 episode of "Grit," a podcast hosted by Kleiner Perkins partner Joubin Mirzadegan. "They were fired up and I'm like, 'Holy smokes.'" Dallaire was hooked on tech.

He started as an account manager in business development at Amazon but quickly turned to ads, taking roles at Microsoft and then Yahoo. More than a decade later, he returned to Amazon and helped build its fledgling ad operations into the third largest digital ad business in the U.S., behind Google and Meta Platforms, with about $10 billion in ad revenue by the time he departed, according to Emarketer.

Dallaire hosted team holiday parties at his parents' Seattle home in the early days. His mom and dad passed out hors d'oeuvres and mingled with the staff. He expensed pizza and beer kegs.

Instacart in 2019 recruited Dallaire, who had established a reputation for driving revenue by connecting shopper data, ads, e-commerce and ad measurement.

Walmart's ad business was slow to build, with false starts and resets before it convinced Dallaire to join in 2021.

As Walmart chief growth officer, Dallaire must win over clients accustomed to the advertising world's wine-and-dine courtships, while staying within Walmart's strict rules that it traces to founder Sam Walton's ethos of spending as little as possible to pass along lower prices to shoppers. Walmart executives are prohibited from offering or accepting even a free cup of coffee when doing business deals.

At the annual Cannes Lions ad festival in June, Walmart spent roughly $3 million, according to people familiar with the matter, to entertain clients with a DJ and Americana food including bite-sized burgers, fries and ice cream on a hotel roof and a suite to show off new ad offerings. Dallaire paid out of pocket for the drinks used to toast his birthday. Amazon, meanwhile, poured millions into an immersive, acre-sized space complete with espresso martinis, a fountain spouting rosé and caricature artists drawing portraits of attendees.

At Walmart, Dallaire found he had to overcome internal friction over giving priority to ad sales.

Store merchants historically negotiated directly with consumer brands for shelf placement, and when centralized ad teams tried selling digital banner ads online, merchants worried their trade budgets would disappear, former employees said.

After learning the term "cart rail," a prominent pallet of goods displayed at the store entrance -- say, a stack of ketchup bottles during grilling season -- Dallaire used the term to translate for store-focused colleagues that a home-page banner ad on the Walmart app is the digital equivalent. It creates awareness for shoppers entering a digital storefront.

Dallaire showed skeptics how ad profits can make their way back to merchant budgets, a lifeline for low-margin categories like food, and can be reinvested to lower prices or remodel stores. While physical retail operates on razor-thin operating margins, often 2% to 3% for grocery items, digital advertising can boast profit margins of 70% to 90%.

With Dallaire, "everything is backed by data," said Lisa Utzschneider, a veteran ad tech executive who worked with Dallaire at Amazon more than a decade ago. He is known for his methodical approach, sifting through numbers-heavy presentations and zeroing in on anomalies to pinpoint issues or identify new growth opportunities.

Dallaire embraced Bentonville, Ark., a company town where Sam Walton's heirs have funded a prestigious art museum, restaurants, cafes and a STEM school. He first commuted to the job from California, before building a home a few blocks off the central square where Walton opened a five-and-dime store in 1950.

Dallaire spearheaded Walmart's $2.3 billion Vizio acquisition in 2024, which catapulted the retailer into electronics manufacturing and into the streaming business via WatchFree+, Vizio's free, ad-supported streaming service. To explain to colleagues why Walmart should buy a TV brand in pursuit of shopper data and ad revenue, he often used the analogy of his grandparents' 1950s-style wooden TV console cabinet. Then, hardware was so important that a TV was considered stylish furniture. Now it's all about the software inside, he would say.

And earlier this year, Dallaire led Walmart's $1.4 billion purchase of Vibe.co, an ad tech platform that works with small and midsize businesses to expand Walmart's share of streaming TV ad spend. Smaller brands have been a key growth area for Meta and Amazon.

He now oversees Walmart's ad business, which sells in-store and digital ads, the Walmart+ subscription business, an online marketplace where third-party sellers list goods, and

smart TV maker Vizio. Those businesses account for roughly one-third of the retail giant's total operating income.

Dallaire said he tries to balance Walmart's past with its quickly evolving future.

Walmart recently demolished its headquarters building, a low-slung and dingy former warehouse it used since 1971 that embodied the company's low-cost ethos, and moved into a sprawling new office complex. Dallaire stopped by to pick up a brick from the rubble as a keepsake.

"I've only been here five years," he said, but "I do have some nostalgia for it."

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(END) Dow Jones Newswires

November 07, 2026 02:57 ET (07:57 GMT)

Source: Dow Jones Newswires

EXCHANGE --- He Turns Walmart's Shopper Data Into Profits --- Seth Dallaire is bringing his data-mining expertise from Amazon to the ad market, an area where giant Walmart is small
11/07/2026

To understand how Walmart obsesses over its customers, Seth Dallaire suggests picturing how K-pop fans study every move of the band BTS.

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Seth Dallaire

-- Early years: Grew up a latchkey kid

-- First job: Paper route

-- What he likes about Arkansas: The hiking trails

-- How he refuels: Hiking in the desert and listening to live music

-- A book he recommends to his teams: "The Goal," a management-oriented novel by Eliyahu M. Goldratt

Source: The Wall Street Journal

Walmart Backs Zipline With 300 More Drone Sites as $1.5B Raise Closes
11/06/2026

The 300-site expansion builds on Walmart's 2 million drone deliveries to date, with Zipline using its new capital to expand U.S. manufacturing and hiring.

View image.
Zipline closed a $1.5 billion funding round at a $21.5 billion post-money valuation, pairing the raise with a national multi-year agreement with Walmart to scale their partnership to 300 more drone delivery sites.

The combination moves the drone delivery company further beyond a series of regional pilots toward a nationwide network built around its large retail and food delivery partners. Zipline has flown for Walmart in its home of northwest Arkansas since their partnership began in 2021, and expanded the collaboration to Dallas-Fort Worth, Texas earlier this year.

The round was led by investment firms Paradigm, WCM Investment Management and Layer Global, with participation from Valor, Fidelity, Uber, Tiger Global, J.P. Morgan, ARK Invest and Salesforce Ventures.

Zipline said it will use the capital to expand its U.S. manufacturing facilities and ramp up hiring, with demand for faster delivery running ahead of what ground networks can supply through congested roads and rising costs.

The valuation marks a sharp repricing for Zipline, which was valued at $7.85 billion earlier this year, according to the Wall Street Journal. In September, the delivery company was reported to be in talks to raise about $1 billion that would give the firm a roughly $20 billion valuation.

The closed round came in larger on both counts, with Paradigm returning as a lead investor after putting $200 million into Zipline in March.

Walmart, which operates the largest retail drone delivery program in the U.S. and has completed more than 2 million drone deliveries to date, is the largest single commitment behind that expansion.

The new agreement will add 300 Zipline sites nationwide with the potential to expand further, leveraging a physical network that puts 90 percent of Americans within 10 miles of a Walmart store.

“We see customers try drone delivery for the novelty and then continue to come back to it for the convenience when they need something in minutes,” said Greg Cathey, senior vice president of e-commerce fulfillment transformation at Walmart, in a statement. “Walmart’s stores put us close to the communities we serve. With Zipline, we can build on that proximity and bring this fast delivery option to even more customers across the country.”

Zipline CEO Keller Cliffton framed the Walmart expansion as a change in how customers use the service once speed becomes routine.

“Five years ago, Walmart and Zipline made our first deliveries together. Back then, the idea of autonomous delivery seemed impossible to most people. Today, customers order from us multiple times a day,” said Cliffton. “When you can get what you need in 10-30 minutes it takes a huge amount of anxiety out of life. People can plan their lives around their loved ones, not errands.”

Uber, which announced a strategic partnership with Zipline in August to bring drone delivery to Uber Eats, is the other anchor partner in the drone delivery provider’s national push. Uber also made a separate investment in Zipline, with first deployments planned for later this year in Zipline’s existing markets. The companies are targeting 1 million drone deliveries a day by the end of 2029, a goal that would require a rollout into dozens of additional cities after Dallas and Houston.

Across customers, the operating evidence is concentrated in Dallas-Fort Worth, where Zipline said it has completed more than 1 million deliveries this year alone. In October, the median Zipline order was delivered 19 minutes after checkout, compared with more than 30 minutes for traditional delivery.

A cohort of its longest-tenured restaurants saw Zipline’s share of their delivery revenue grow from 10.8 percent to 34.9 percent between March and October, with delivery gross merchandise value rising 26 percent. Eighty percent of that increase came from Zipline orders.

That growth is coming from a small customer base, with Zipline saying only 5 percent of U.S. restaurant orders are for delivery, with most of those orders constrained to customers within a couple of miles of a store.

Although the company has flown 150 million commercial autonomous miles without a safety incident, the regulatory framework for its ambitions to scale remains unfinished. The Federal Aviation Administration’s Part 108 rule, which would make routine beyond-visual-line-of-sight operations standard instead of waiver by waiver, has been pending review at the White House regulatory office since July.

Zipline currently flies under Part 135 approvals, and it has a separate proposal under FAA review that would allow as many as 220,000 deliveries a day across Houston, San Antonio, Austin, Amarillo and El Paso. This would be a significant step up from the roughly 30,000 daily deliveries authorized in Dallas-Fort Worth.

The competitive field is moving in parallel, with Alphabet’s Wing working with restaurant, retail and healthcare partners, DoorDash developing its own drones and Amazon Prime Air expecting to offer drone delivery in more than 500 select markets.

Zipline presently operates in Texas, Arkansas and Ohio, with plans to launch soon in Arizona.

The 300-site expansion builds on Walmart's 2 million drone deliveries to date, with Zipline using its new capital to expand U.S. manufacturing and hiring. (Walmart)

Source: Sourcing Journal

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